

Exercise, Movement & Wellness Reference Library

A structured, RAG-ready reference covering exercises, yoga, stretching, mobility, warm-up & cool-down routines, breathing, meditation & mind-reset practices, chronic-condition and recovery guidance, and population-specific training profiles for women, kids, seniors, adaptive athletes, and diverse lifestyles.

Built for ZITLAS | AI Athlete Experience Platform

Fitness and wellness guidance only. Not medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment.

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SECTION 1

Exercise Database

Strength, hypertrophy, and conditioning exercises across every major muscle group and movement pattern, with full coaching detail for each entry.

Chest

Barbell Bench PressEX-0001 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (sternal head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, triceps brachii, serratus anterior
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, flat bench, power rack with safeties	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-65
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3-5	REPS	5-10
REST	90-180 s	BREATHING	Inhale and brace at the top, hold through the descent, exhale forcefully past the sticking point.

EXECUTION

1. Lie supine with eyes directly under the bar; plant feet flat and drive them into the floor.

2. Retract and depress the scapulae, creating a small natural arch in the lower back.

3. Grip the bar so forearms are vertical at the bottom position — usually 1.5x shoulder width.

4. Unrack, bring the bar to the lower chest/sternum with elbows at roughly 45-60 degrees from the torso.

5. Touch the chest under control, then drive the bar up and slightly back toward the shoulders.

COMMON MISTAKES

• Bouncing the bar off the ribcage to generate momentum.

• Flaring elbows to 90 degrees, which shears the shoulder joint.

• Letting the hips lift off the bench to shorten the range of motion.

• Gripping the bar so wide that forearms angle inward at the bottom.

COACH TIPS

• Think of pushing yourself away from the bar rather than pushing the bar away.

• Screw the feet into the floor to build whole-body tension before the first rep.

• Wrists stack directly over the elbows throughout the press.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

• Always use a spotter or set safety pins at chest height.

• Never use a thumbless (suicide) grip.

• Warm up the rotator cuff before heavy loads.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

• Acute shoulder impingement or labral pain

• Recent pectoral tear or repair

• Uncontrolled hypertension (heavy near-maximal loads)

PROGRESSION

Add 2.5 kg per week; introduce 2-second paused reps at the chest.

REGRESSION

Dumbbell bench press, machine chest press, or elevated push-up.

ALTERNATIVES

Dumbbell Bench Press, Machine Chest Press, Floor Press

RECORD ID

EX-0001

TAGS #chest #push #horizontal-press #compound #hypertrophy #gym

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0001::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0001::3set_full_rom_30s]

Incline Barbell Bench PressEX-0002 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (clavicular head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, triceps brachii
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, adjustable bench, rack	LOAD TYPE	Equipment

ENERGY COST	6.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-65
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	6-12
REST	90-150 s	BREATHING	Inhale on the descent; exhale as the bar clears the halfway point.

EXECUTION

1. Set the bench to 30-45 degrees. Steeper angles shift work to the front delt.
2. Set the shoulder blades back and down against the pad; feet flat on the floor.
3. Unrack and lower the bar toward the upper chest, just below the collarbone.
4. Keep elbows tucked to about 45 degrees from the torso.
5. Press up and slightly back until the elbows are near lockout.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Setting the bench above 45 degrees and turning it into a shoulder press.
- Touching the bar too high on the throat line.
- Losing scapular retraction as fatigue accumulates.

COACH TIPS

- 30 degrees gives the best clavicular recruitment for most builds.
- Keep the bar path slightly diagonal, not straight up and down.
- Pause 1 second at the chest to eliminate bounce.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Use a spotter for the last two reps of a hard set.
- Do not shrug the shoulders toward the ears under load.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Anterior shoulder instability
- Active AC joint pain

PROGRESSION	Progress load, then add a paused variant; finish with incline dumbbell press.
REGRESSION	Incline dumbbell press or incline machine press.
ALTERNATIVES	Incline Dumbbell Press, Landmine Press, Machine Chest Press
RECORD ID	EX-0002

TAGS #chest #upper-chest #push #compound #hypertrophy #gym

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0002::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0002::3set_full_rom_30s]

Decline Barbell Bench Press

EX-0003 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (costal/lower fibres)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii, anterior deltoid
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, decline bench, rack	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	18-60
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	6-12
REST	90-150 s	BREATHING	Inhale at the top, exhale through the concentric.

EXECUTION

1. Secure the legs in the roller pads and lie back on a 15-30 degree decline.
2. Have a spotter hand off the bar — self-unracking on a decline is awkward.
3. Lower the bar to the lower chest, just above the sternum's base.
4. Keep elbows moderately tucked; press straight up over the lower chest.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Unracking without a spotter.
- Letting the head hang and creating pressure in the skull.
- Excessive decline angle beyond 30 degrees.

COACH TIPS

- Decline reduces anterior deltoid demand — useful when the shoulders are cranky.
- Keep range of motion full; the decline already shortens it slightly.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Always use a spotter for the hand-off and re-rack.
- Sit up slowly afterwards to avoid a blood-pressure drop.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acid reflux or hiatal hernia
- Glaucoma or retinal conditions
- Uncontrolled hypertension

PROGRESSION	Add load, then progress to weighted chest dips.
REGRESSION	Chest dip or flat dumbbell press.

ALTERNATIVES	Chest Dip, Dumbbell Bench Press, Machine Chest Press
RECORD ID	EX-0003
TAGS #chest #lower-chest #push #compound #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0003::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0003::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Dumbbell Bench Press

EX-0004 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (sternal head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, triceps brachii, rotator cuff
EQUIPMENT	Two dumbbells, flat bench	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-12
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Inhale on the descent, exhale on the press.

EXECUTION

1. Sit on the bench with the dumbbells resting on the thighs.
2. Kick the dumbbells up one knee at a time as you lie back.
3. Set the dumbbells at chest level, palms facing forward, elbows at 45 degrees.
4. Press up and slightly together without clanging the bells.
5. Lower under control until the elbows are just below torso level.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Lowering the weights past a comfortable stretch and straining the shoulder capsule.
- Pressing the dumbbells straight up with no convergence.
- Dropping the dumbbells from the top instead of returning them to the thighs.

COACH TIPS

- Dumbbells allow a longer range and a more shoulder-friendly path than a barbell.
- Independent limbs expose and correct side-to-side strength asymmetry.
- Squeeze the handles hard — grip tension improves pressing stability.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Learn the safe kick-up and set-down technique before going heavy.
- Never let a training partner pull on your wrists to assist.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Recent shoulder dislocation
- Acute biceps tendinopathy

PROGRESSION	Increase load; then progress to a 3-second eccentric.
REGRESSION	Floor press (shortened range) or machine chest press.
ALTERNATIVES	Barbell Bench Press, Floor Press, Push-Up
RECORD ID	EX-0004
TAGS #chest #push #dumbbell #compound #hypertrophy #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0004::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0004::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Incline Dumbbell Press

EX-0005 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (clavicular head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, triceps brachii
EQUIPMENT	Two dumbbells, adjustable bench	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-12
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Set the bench to 30 degrees and sit with dumbbells on the thighs.
2. Kick up and lie back, keeping the shoulder blades pinned to the pad.
3. Start with the dumbbells at upper-chest height, elbows under the wrists.
4. Press up and inward, stopping just short of the bells touching.
5. Lower slowly until a mild stretch is felt across the upper chest.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Bench angle too steep, converting it into a shoulder press.
- Bouncing the dumbbells off the chest.
- Letting the elbows drift behind the torso at the bottom.

COACH TIPS

- Keep a slight bend in the elbows at lockout to keep tension on the chest.
- A neutral (palms-in) grip is a good option for irritated shoulders.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Set the dumbbells down on the thighs, not the floor beside you.
- Do not arch aggressively on an incline.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Anterior shoulder impingement
- Uncontrolled shoulder instability

PROGRESSION

Add load, then unilateral alternating presses for core demand.

REGRESSION

Incline machine press or incline push-up.

ALTERNATIVES

Incline Barbell Bench Press, Landmine Press, Incline Push-Up

RECORD ID

EX-0005

TAGS #chest #upper-chest #dumbbell #push #hypertrophy #gym

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0005::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0005::3set_full_rom_30s]

Flat Dumbbell Fly

EX-0006 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (sternal head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, biceps brachii (stabiliser)
EQUIPMENT	Two light dumbbells, flat bench	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-65
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-15
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Inhale as the arms open, exhale as they close.

EXECUTION

1. Lie flat with a dumbbell in each hand, pressed above the chest, palms facing each other.
2. Set a fixed, soft bend of about 15 degrees in the elbows and keep it there.
3. Open the arms in a wide arc until a stretch is felt across the chest.
4. Stop when the upper arms reach torso level — do not go deeper.
5. Hug the arms back together along the same arc, squeezing the chest at the top.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using a bent-arm press instead of a true arc.
- Going far too heavy — the fly is a stretch-position movement, not a strength lift.
- Dropping the arms below bench level and overloading the shoulder capsule.

COACH TIPS

- The elbow angle is fixed. If it changes, the load is too heavy.
- Slow the eccentric; this movement earns most of its stimulus in the stretch.
- Finish the rep by imagining you are squeezing a ball between the forearms.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Start with 30-40% of your dumbbell press load.
- Never bounce out of the bottom stretch.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Shoulder impingement
- Recent pec strain or tear
- Elbow ligament injury

PROGRESSION

Add a 2-second hold in the stretched position; then move to cable flies for constant tension.

REGRESSION

Pec deck machine — fixed path, easier to control.

ALTERNATIVES

Pec Deck Machine, Cable Crossover (High to Low), Incline Dumbbell Fly

RECORD ID

EX-0006

TAGS #chest #isolation #stretch-position #dumbbell #hypertrophy

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0006::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0006::3set_full_rom_30s]

Incline Dumbbell Fly

EX-0007 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (clavicular head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid
EQUIPMENT	Two light dumbbells, incline bench	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.5 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-65
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-15
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Inhale opening, exhale closing.

EXECUTION

1. Set the bench to 30 degrees; hold dumbbells above the upper chest, palms facing.
2. Lock a soft elbow bend and open the arms in a wide arc.
3. Stop at torso level where the upper chest stretch peaks.
4. Return along the identical arc and squeeze.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Bending and straightening the elbows (turning it into a press).
- Excessive range that stresses the front of the shoulder.

COACH TIPS

- Lighter than the flat fly — the incline lengthens the lever.
- Pause at the top for a full second to raise time under tension.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Use a spotter's knee under the elbows if you are new to the movement.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Shoulder impingement**
- **Recent pec tear**

PROGRESSION	Progress to incline cable fly.
REGRESSION	Pec deck or a lighter flat fly.
ALTERNATIVES	Cable Crossover (Low to High), Pec Deck Machine, Flat Dumbbell Fly
RECORD ID	EX-0007

TAGS #chest #upper-chest #isolation #hypertrophy

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0007::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0007::3set_full_rom_30s]

Cable Crossover (High to Low)

EX-0008 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (costal/lower fibres)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, serratus anterior
EQUIPMENT	Dual cable station, D-handles	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	5.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Fat Loss, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-15
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale as the hands come together, inhale on the return.

EXECUTION

1. Set both pulleys above head height and take a handle in each hand.
2. Step forward into a split stance so the cables are under light tension.
3. Hinge the torso forward about 15 degrees; soft bend in the elbows.
4. Sweep the hands down and together toward the belt line, crossing slightly.
5. Squeeze for one second, then let the cables draw the arms back with control.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Standing bolt upright, which turns the movement into a triceps pushdown.
- Using so much weight that the torso rocks forward to finish the rep.
- Letting the elbows straighten and lock.

COACH TIPS

- Cables keep tension constant across the entire arc — unlike dumbbells.
- Cross the hands slightly to add adduction and hit the inner chest.
- This is the highest-value finishing movement for lower chest.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute shoulder impingement • Recent pec repair
• Control the return; a snapped-back cable can wrench the shoulder.		
PROGRESSION	Progress to a 2-second squeeze plus a slow 4-second eccentric.	
REGRESSION	Pec deck machine or resistance band fly.	
ALTERNATIVES	Pec Deck Machine, Resistance Band Fly, Flat Dumbbell Fly	
RECORD ID	EX-0008	
TAGS #chest #lower-chest #cable #isolation #constant-tension		
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0008::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0008::3set full rom 30s]		

Cable Crossover (Low to High)		EX-0009 Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (clavicular head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid
EQUIPMENT	Dual cable station, D-handles	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	5.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-15
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale on the sweep up, inhale on the return.
EXECUTION 1. Set both pulleys at the lowest setting; grab a handle in each hand, palms forward. 2. Step into a staggered stance, chest tall, slight forward lean. 3. Sweep the hands up and inward, finishing at collarbone height. 4. Squeeze, then lower along the same arc under control.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Shrugging the traps to help lift the handles. • Finishing above the head, which hands the work to the front delt.		COACH TIPS • Stop the hands at chin height — beyond that the chest disengages. • Keep the ribcage down; do not lean back.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the wrists neutral, not extended.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Anterior shoulder pain • AC joint irritation	
PROGRESSION	Single-arm version for greater range and core anti-rotation demand.		
REGRESSION	Incline dumbbell fly.		
ALTERNATIVES	Incline Dumbbell Fly, Pec Deck Machine, Resistance Band Fly		
RECORD ID	EX-0009		
TAGS #chest #upper-chest #cable #isolation			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0009::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0009::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Pec Deck Machine				EX-0010 Beginner
CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (sternal head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid	
EQUIPMENT	Pec deck / chest fly machine	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	4.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-75	
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1	
SETS	3	REPS	10-15	
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale closing, inhale opening.	

EXECUTION

1. Adjust the seat so the handles sit at mid-chest height.
2. Sit tall with the back flat against the pad and feet planted.
3. Grip the handles with a soft elbow bend and shoulder blades pinned back.
4. Bring the handles together in front of the sternum and squeeze for one second.
5. Open slowly until a stretch is felt, stopping before the shoulders roll forward.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Setting the seat too low, forcing the elbows above the shoulders.
- Letting the shoulders round forward at the stretch.
- Slamming the pads together.

COACH TIPS

- The safest chest isolation for beginners — the path is fixed.
- Excellent choice as a pre-exhaust before pressing.
- Drive the elbows together, not the hands.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Set the range-of-motion pin so the stretch never becomes painful.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Recent shoulder surgery
- Acute pec strain

PROGRESSION

Add a 3-second eccentric or a drop set on the final round.

REGRESSION

Resistance band fly, seated.

ALTERNATIVES

Cable Crossover (High to Low), Flat Dumbbell Fly, Resistance Band Fly

RECORD ID

EX-0010

TAGS #chest #isolation #machine #beginner-safe #hypertrophy

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0010::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0010::3set_full_rom_30s]

Machine Chest Press

EX-0011 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, triceps brachii
EQUIPMENT	Seated chest press machine	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	5.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-75
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-15
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale pressing, inhale returning.

EXECUTION

1. Set the seat so the handles align with the mid-chest, not the collarbone.
2. Sit with the back flat, feet planted, shoulder blades against the pad.
3. Press the handles forward until the elbows are nearly straight.
4. Return under control until the hands are level with the chest.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Seat too high, which shifts load onto the shoulders.
- Locking the elbows aggressively at the end range.
- Letting the weight stack touch down between reps.

COACH TIPS

- The best entry point for a beginner learning the horizontal press pattern.
- Also the safest way to train to true muscular failure without a spotter.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep one hand able to release if a set fails.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute shoulder impingement

PROGRESSION

Move to dumbbell bench press once the pattern is stable.

REGRESSION

Resistance band chest press.

ALTERNATIVES

Dumbbell Bench Press, Push-Up, Resistance Band Chest Press

RECORD ID

EX-0011

TAGS #chest #machine #push #beginner-safe #gym

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0011::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0011::3set_full_rom_30s]

Smith Machine Bench Press

EX-0012 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii, anterior deltoid
EQUIPMENT	Smith machine, flat bench	LOAD TYPE	Equipment

ENERGY COST	5.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-12
REST	75-120 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.
EXECUTION 1. Position the bench so the bar path descends over the mid-chest. 2. Set the shoulder blades back; grip slightly wider than shoulders. 3. Rotate the bar to unhook it, lower to the chest, press back up. 4. Rotate to re-hook at the top of the final rep.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Placing the bench too far forward so the bar lands on the throat. • Relying on the fixed path and never developing free-weight stability.		COACH TIPS • Useful for training close to failure alone, since the safety hooks catch the bar. • Set the safety stops just below chest level before the first rep.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Verify the hook mechanism engages before unloading the bar. • Never train to failure without the safeties set.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Shoulder impingement (fixed path may not suit your anatomy)	
PROGRESSION	Transition to barbell bench press for stabiliser development.		
REGRESSION	Machine chest press.		
ALTERNATIVES	Barbell Bench Press, Machine Chest Press, Dumbbell Bench Press		
RECORD ID	EX-0012		
TAGS #chest #smith-machine #push #gym #solo-safe			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0012::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0012::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Standard Push-Up		EX-0013 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii, anterior deltoid, rectus abdominis, serratus anterior
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	7.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, General Fitness, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-75
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-25
REST	45-75 s	BREATHING	Inhale on the descent, exhale on the press.
EXECUTION 1. Place hands slightly wider than the shoulders, directly under the collarbones. 2. Extend the legs, squeeze the glutes and brace the abdominals into a rigid plank. 3. Lower the chest toward the floor, elbows tracking back at roughly 45 degrees. 4. Stop when the chest is a fist's height from the ground. 5. Press the floor away, pushing the upper back apart at the top.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the hips sag, which loads the lumbar spine. • Flaring the elbows to 90 degrees and grinding the shoulder. • Dropping the head forward so the chin leads instead of the chest. • Half-repping — stopping high because of fatigue.		COACH TIPS • The push-up is a moving plank. If the core fails, the set is over. • Push the ground away rather than pulling yourself up. • Protract the shoulder blades fully at the top to train the serratus.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the wrists warm; use push-up handles or fists if wrist extension hurts.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute wrist injury • Recent shoulder surgery	
PROGRESSION	Elevate the feet, add a weight vest, or progress to archer push-ups.		
REGRESSION	Incline push-up with hands on a bench or wall.		
ALTERNATIVES	Incline Push-Up, Decline Push-Up, Dumbbell Bench Press		

RECORD ID	EX-0013
TAGS #chest #bodyweight #push #home #no-equipment #travel	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0013::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0013::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Incline Push-Up

EX-0014 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (sternal head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii, anterior deltoid, core
EQUIPMENT	Bench, chair, wall or countertop	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	5.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-80
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-0-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	10-20
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Place the hands on a raised surface, slightly wider than shoulder width.
2. Walk the feet back until the body is a straight line from head to heels.
3. Lower the chest to the surface with the elbows at 45 degrees.
4. Press back up and fully extend.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Placing the hands too far forward and stressing the shoulders.
- Piking the hips upward.
- Using a wobbly or rolling surface.

COACH TIPS

- The higher the surface, the easier the rep. Lower it gradually week by week.
- This is the single best regression for a first push-up.
- A kitchen counter, staircase, or park bench all work.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Ensure the surface cannot slide.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute wrist pain**

PROGRESSION	Lower the surface every 1-2 weeks until you reach the floor.
REGRESSION	Wall push-up — the easiest variation available.
ALTERNATIVES	Standard Push-Up, Wall Push-Up, Machine Chest Press
RECORD ID	EX-0014

TAGS [#chest](#) [#bodyweight](#) [#regression](#) [#beginner-safe](#) [#home](#) [#senior-friendly](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0014::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0014::3set_full_rom_30s]

Decline Push-Up

EX-0015 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (clavicular head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, triceps brachii, core
EQUIPMENT	Bench, box or step	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	8.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Fat Loss, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-65
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-15
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Place the feet on a bench or box roughly 30-45 cm high.
2. Set the hands on the floor slightly wider than the shoulders.
3. Brace hard — the elevated feet increase the anti-extension demand.
4. Lower the chest to the floor, then press back to full extension.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Elevating the feet so high it becomes a shoulder press.
- Letting the lower back arch as the core fatigues.

COACH TIPS

- Feet elevation shifts load to the upper chest and front delt.
- Stop the set the moment the hips sag — quality over count.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Do not use an unstable box. • Keep the neck neutral; do not crane the head.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Wrist injury • Shoulder impingement • Uncontrolled hypertension
PROGRESSION	Elevate the feet higher, or add a weight vest.	
REGRESSION	Standard push-up on the floor.	
ALTERNATIVES	Standard Push-Up, Incline Barbell Bench Press, Pike Push-Up	
RECORD ID	EX-0015	
TAGS #chest #upper-chest #bodyweight #home #no-equipment		
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0015::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0015::3set_full_rom_30s]		

Diamond Push-Up		EX-0016 Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (inner fibres), anterior deltoid
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	7.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-60
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	6-15
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.
EXECUTION 1. Form a diamond with the thumbs and index fingers directly under the sternum. 2. Set a rigid plank; squeeze the glutes. 3. Lower the chest toward the hands, keeping the elbows tucked close to the ribs. 4. Press up until the elbows lock without letting the hips rise first.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Flaring the elbows outward, which defeats the triceps emphasis. • Placing the hands too far forward, straining the wrists. • Shortening the range because the leverage is harder.		COACH TIPS • This is the highest-triceps-activation bodyweight push in most EMG studies. • If the wrists complain, do it on parallel handles or fists.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Warm the wrists thoroughly. • Do not force the hands into a perfect diamond if it hurts.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Wrist extension pain • Elbow tendinopathy	
PROGRESSION	Elevate the feet, then add a weight vest.		
REGRESSION	Close-grip push-up with hands shoulder-width apart.		
ALTERNATIVES	Standard Push-Up, Close-Grip Bench Press, Triceps Dip		
RECORD ID	EX-0016		
TAGS #chest #triceps #bodyweight #no-equipment #home			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0016::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0016::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Wide-Grip Push-Up				EX-0017 Beginner
CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (sternal head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid	
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight	
ENERGY COST	7.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness, Fat Loss	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-65	
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0	
SETS	3	REPS	10-20	
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.	

EXECUTION

1. Place the hands roughly 1.5x shoulder width apart, fingers slightly turned out.
2. Brace the trunk and squeeze the glutes.
3. Lower until the upper arms reach torso level.
4. Press up while imagining you are pulling the hands toward each other.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Going so wide the shoulders take the load instead of the chest.
- Sagging hips.
- Bottoming out with the chest on the floor and resting.

COACH TIPS

- Wider hands increase the chest stretch but reduce total range.
- Turn the fingers out 15-20 degrees to spare the wrists.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Stop if you feel a pinch at the front of the shoulder.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Shoulder impingement**
- **Wrist injury**

PROGRESSION

Elevate the feet or add a pause at the bottom.

REGRESSION

Standard-width or incline push-up.

ALTERNATIVES

Standard Push-Up, Flat Dumbbell Fly, Pec Deck Machine

RECORD ID

EX-0017

TAGS [#chest](#) [#bodyweight](#) [#no-equipment](#) [#home](#) [#apartment-friendly](#)MEDIA [\[IMG::EX-0017::demo_front_lateral\]](#) [\[VID::EX-0017::3set_full_rom_30s\]](#)**Archer Push-Up**

EX-0018 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (unilateral)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii, core, serratus anterior
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	8.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-50
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	5-10 per side
REST	75-90 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Take a wide push-up position, hands well outside shoulder width.
2. Shift the bodyweight toward the right hand as you lower.
3. The left arm straightens out to the side, acting as a kickstand.
4. Press back up through the working arm, then alternate sides.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the straight arm bend and share the load.
- Rotating the hips instead of keeping the pelvis square.
- Rushing before the standard push-up is strong.

COACH TIPS

- A genuine bridge toward the one-arm push-up.
- Keep the extended arm's palm rotated so the fingers point sideways.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Master 20 clean standard push-ups first.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Shoulder instability**
- **Elbow injury**
- **Wrist injury**

PROGRESSION

Reduce the assist from the straight arm; then attempt one-arm negatives.

REGRESSION

Standard push-up, or archer push-up with knees down.

ALTERNATIVES

Standard Push-Up, Deficit Push-Up, Ring Push-Up

RECORD ID

EX-0018

TAGS [#chest](#) [#unilateral](#) [#bodyweight](#) [#advanced](#) [#calisthenics](#)MEDIA [\[IMG::EX-0018::demo_front_lateral\]](#) [\[VID::EX-0018::3set_full_rom_30s\]](#)**Deficit Push-Up**

EX-0019 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii, anterior deltoid

EQUIPMENT	Two low boxes, books, or push-up handles	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	7.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-60
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	8-15
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Set two low, stable surfaces slightly wider than the shoulders.
2. Take a push-up position with the hands on the surfaces.
3. Lower until the chest drops below the level of the hands.
4. Press back to full lockout without losing the plank.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Sinking so deep the shoulders round forward under load.
- Using surfaces that can shift or roll.

COACH TIPS

- The extra range increases the stretch and the hypertrophy stimulus.
- Push-up handles also keep the wrists neutral.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Test the surfaces with bodyweight before performing a set.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Shoulder impingement**
- **Recent pec strain**

PROGRESSION	Increase deficit height, or elevate the feet as well.
REGRESSION	Standard floor push-up.
ALTERNATIVES	Standard Push-Up, Ring Push-Up, Flat Dumbbell Fly
RECORD ID	EX-0019

TAGS [#chest](#) [#bodyweight](#) [#stretch-position](#) [#home](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0019::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0019::3set_full_rom_30s]

Ring / TRX Push-Up

EX-0020 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Serratus anterior, rotator cuff, core, triceps brachii
EQUIPMENT	Gymnastic rings or TRX suspension trainer	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	8.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-55
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	6-12
REST	75-90 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Set the rings or straps at roughly knee to mid-shin height.
2. Take a plank position with the handles under the shoulders, arms straight.
3. Externally rotate the hands so the thumbs point slightly outward.
4. Lower the chest between the handles, elbows at 45 degrees.
5. Press up and turn the hands out again at the top.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the handles drift wide and wobble uncontrolled.
- Attempting rings before floor push-ups are strong.
- Losing the plank and piking at the hips.

COACH TIPS

- Instability roughly doubles rotator cuff and serratus demand.
- Raise the handles to reduce difficulty; lower them to increase it.
- The turn-out at the top adds a valuable external-rotation cue.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Check the anchor point rating before every session.
- Keep the straps short enough that the handles cannot swing away.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Shoulder instability**
- **Rotator cuff tear**
- **Elbow injury**

PROGRESSION	Lower the anchor, elevate the feet, or add a weight vest.
REGRESSION	Raise the handles higher for a steeper, easier angle.
ALTERNATIVES	Standard Push-Up, Deficit Push-Up, Dumbbell Bench Press

RECORD ID	EX-0020
TAGS #chest #trx #rings #instability #calisthenics #advanced	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0020::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0020::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Chest Dip

EX-0021 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (costal/lower fibres)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii, anterior deltoid, rhomboids
EQUIPMENT	Parallel bars or dip station	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	8.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-55
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	6-12
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Inhale on the descent, exhale on the press.

EXECUTION

1. Mount the bars with arms locked and shoulders pressed down away from the ears.
2. Lean the torso forward roughly 30 degrees and cross the ankles behind.
3. Lower until the upper arms are parallel to the floor, elbows flared slightly.
4. Press back up while maintaining the forward lean throughout.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Staying upright, which turns it into a triceps dip.
- Descending below parallel and overstretching the shoulder capsule.
- Shrugging the shoulders toward the ears at the bottom.
- Bouncing out of the bottom position.

COACH TIPS

- Forward lean is the switch that moves load from triceps to chest.
- Depress the scapulae hard at the top of every rep.
- Stop at parallel — deeper is not better here.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Build with band-assisted or machine-assisted dips first.
- Never bounce; the bottom of a dip is the shoulder's most vulnerable position.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Shoulder impingement or instability**
- **Sternoclavicular joint pain**
- **Recent pec tear**

PROGRESSION	Add a dip belt with 5-10 kg; then progress to weighted ring dips.
REGRESSION	Band-assisted dip, or bench dip with feet on the floor.
ALTERNATIVES	Decline Barbell Bench Press, Standard Push-Up, Machine Chest Press
RECORD ID	EX-0021

TAGS [#chest](#) [#lower-chest](#) [#bodyweight](#) [#calisthenics](#) [#advanced](#) [#compound](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0021::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0021::3set_full_rom_30s]

Svend Press

EX-0022 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (inner fibres)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, forearm flexors
EQUIPMENT	Two light weight plates (2.5-5 kg each)	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	3.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-2-1
SETS	2-3	REPS	10-15
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale pressing out, inhale returning.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall and press two plates together flat between the palms at chest height.
2. Squeeze the plates hard enough that they do not slip — that squeeze is the exercise.
3. Press the plates straight forward until the arms are extended.
4. Return to the chest, maintaining maximum inward pressure the whole time.

COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the squeeze relax during the press. • Using plates so heavy the wrists collapse. • Shrugging the shoulders.		COACH TIPS • Pure isometric adduction — excellent as a chest pre-exhaust or finisher. • Cannot be loaded heavy, and does not need to be.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Perform over a mat; a dropped plate on bare feet is a genuine risk.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Wrist injury • Elbow tendinopathy	
PROGRESSION	Hold the end position for 5 seconds on the final rep.		
REGRESSION	Squeeze a foam roller or ball between the palms.		
ALTERNATIVES	Pec Deck Machine, Cable Crossover (High to Low), Flat Dumbbell Fly		
RECORD ID	EX-0022		
TAGS #chest #isolation #isometric #warm-up #finisher			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0022::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0022::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Landmine Press

EX-0023 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (clavicular head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, serratus anterior, core
EQUIPMENT	Barbell in a landmine attachment or corner	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	8-12 per side
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale pressing, inhale returning.

EXECUTION

1. Wedge one end of a barbell in a landmine sleeve or a padded corner.
2. Kneel or stand in a staggered stance, holding the free end at the shoulder.
3. Brace the trunk and press the bar up and forward along its natural arc.
4. Lock out with the arm extended, then return to the shoulder under control.

COMMON MISTAKES • Fighting the arc and trying to press straight up. • Letting the ribcage flare and the lower back extend. • Rotating the torso to gain leverage.		COACH TIPS • The arced path is far friendlier to shoulders than an overhead press. • An excellent primary press for anyone with impingement history. • The half-kneeling version doubles as an anti-extension core drill.		
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Anchor the bar end so it cannot slide out. • Start with the bar alone before loading plates.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute shoulder fracture • Uncontrolled hypertension		
PROGRESSION	Move from half-kneeling to standing; then load with plates.			
REGRESSION	Incline dumbbell press at a low angle.			
ALTERNATIVES	Incline Dumbbell Press, Machine Chest Press, Standard Push-Up			
RECORD ID	EX-0023			
TAGS #chest #upper-chest #landmine #shoulder-friendly #unilateral				
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0023::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0023::3set_full_rom_30s]				

Dumbbell Floor Press

EX-0024 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii
EQUIPMENT	Two dumbbells, floor	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	5.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-75
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0

SETS	3-4	REPS	8-12
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.
EXECUTION 1. Lie on the floor with knees bent, feet flat, dumbbells at the chest. 2. Press up until the arms are nearly straight, shoulder blades still on the floor. 3. Lower until the back of the upper arms just touch the floor. 4. Pause briefly on the floor, then press again — no bounce.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Bouncing the elbows off the floor. • Arching the lower back hard to generate leverage. • Flaring the elbows to 90 degrees.		COACH TIPS • The floor caps the range, protecting an irritated shoulder. • Also the best home press when no bench is available. • Great tool for building lockout strength.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Rest the dumbbells on the hips and roll back to get into position safely.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Recent elbow injury	
PROGRESSION		Add load, then move to a full-range bench press.	
REGRESSION		Machine chest press or push-up.	
ALTERNATIVES		Dumbbell Bench Press, Machine Chest Press, Standard Push-Up	
RECORD ID		EX-0024	
TAGS #chest #floor-press #dumbbell #home #shoulder-friendly			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0024::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0024::3set full rom 30s]			

Resistance Band Chest Press

EX-0025 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, triceps brachii
EQUIPMENT	Long loop resistance band, anchor point	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	5.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, General Fitness, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-80
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-20
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale pressing, inhale returning.

EXECUTION

1. Anchor a band behind you at chest height (door anchor or sturdy post).

2. Face away, hold a handle in each hand at chest level, step forward for tension.

3. Adopt a staggered stance and brace the core.

4. Press the hands forward and slightly together until the arms extend.

5. Return slowly, resisting the band's pull.

COMMON MISTAKES • Standing square, which lets the band pull you backwards. • Letting the band snap the hands back at speed. • Anchoring to a door that opens toward you.	COACH TIPS • Bands give ascending resistance — hardest at lockout, matching the strength curve. • The single most travel-friendly chest builder available. • Step further forward to increase tension without buying a heavier band.
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SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Inspect the band for nicks or tears before every session. • Never anchor at eye level in a way that can recoil into the face.	SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Recent shoulder surgery
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PROGRESSION	Use a thicker band or step further from the anchor.
REGRESSION	Machine chest press or incline push-up.
ALTERNATIVES	Machine Chest Press, Standard Push-Up, Resistance Band Fly
RECORD ID	EX-0025

TAGS #chest #resistance-band #travel #home #apartment-friendly #hostel

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0025::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0025::3set full rom 30s]

Resistance Band Fly				EX-0026 Beginner
CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid	
EQUIPMENT	Long resistance band, anchor point	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	4.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Muscle Gain	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-80	
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1	
SETS	3	REPS	12-20	
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale closing, inhale opening.	
EXECUTION 1. Anchor the band behind you at chest height. 2. Hold a handle in each hand, arms out wide, soft bend in the elbows. 3. Step forward until the band is taut with the arms open. 4. Bring the hands together in front of the sternum in a wide arc; squeeze. 5. Open slowly back to the stretch.				
COMMON MISTAKES • Bending the elbows into a press. • Allowing the band to yank the arms back open.		COACH TIPS • Bands hold tension at the fully contracted position, which dumbbells cannot. • Pairs perfectly with band chest press as a two-move home chest session.		
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Check the anchor and the band for wear.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Shoulder impingement		
PROGRESSION		Thicker band, or a longer step forward.		
REGRESSION		Pec deck machine, or a seated band fly.		
ALTERNATIVES		Pec Deck Machine, Cable Crossover (High to Low), Flat Dumbbell Fly		
RECORD ID		EX-0026		
TAGS #chest #isolation #resistance-band #home #travel MEDIA [IMG::EX-0026::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0026::3set_full_rom_30s]				

Clap Push-Up		EX-0027 Advanced	
CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii, anterior deltoid, core
EQUIPMENT	None (soft surface recommended)	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	10.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Athletic, Strength, Fat Loss
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-45
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	1-0-X-0
SETS	3-5	REPS	3-6
REST	90-180 s	BREATHING	Exhale sharply on the push, inhale on the reset.
EXECUTION 1. Start in a rigid push-up position with the core braced hard. 2. Descend to a normal push-up depth, then explode upward as violently as possible. 3. Leave the floor, clap the hands once, and return them under the shoulders. 4. Absorb the landing by immediately bending the elbows into the next rep.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Attempting these before 25 strict push-ups are easy. • Landing with locked, straight elbows — a common wrist and elbow injury cause. • Continuing when the reps lose height, which trains slowness, not power.		COACH TIPS • Stop the set the moment hand height drops. Power work is not endurance work. • Land soft. The landing is the exercise, not the clap. • Keep total reps low: 3-5 per set is plenty.	

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Perform on a mat or grass, never on tile. • Warm up the wrists and shoulders fully.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Wrist or elbow injury • Shoulder instability • Untrained beginners • Osteoporosis	
PROGRESSION	Progress to double-clap or behind-the-back clap push-ups.		
REGRESSION	Explosive push-up without leaving the floor, or hands-elevated clap push-up.		
ALTERNATIVES	Standard Push-Up, Medicine Ball Chest Pass, Plyometric Box Jump		
RECORD ID	EX-0027		
TAGS #chest #plyometrics #power #explosive #bodyweight #advanced			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0027::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0027::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Dumbbell Pullover		EX-0028 Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (sternal), latissimus dorsi	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Serratus anterior, triceps long head
EQUIPMENT	One dumbbell, flat bench	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	5.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-60
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	10-15
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Inhale as the weight travels overhead, exhale as it returns.
EXECUTION 1. Lie along or across a flat bench with the hips slightly lower than the shoulders. 2. Hold one dumbbell with both palms cupped under the top plate. 3. Start with the arms extended above the chest, elbows softly bent. 4. Lower the dumbbell back over the head until a deep chest and lat stretch is felt. 5. Pull it back over the chest along the same arc.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Going too heavy and losing control behind the head. • Bending the elbows to cheat the weight up. • Overextending the lumbar spine at the stretch.		COACH TIPS • Keep the ribcage pulled down; the stretch should be felt in the chest, not the back. • A rare movement that loads both the chest and lat in the lengthened position. • Use a lighter weight than instinct suggests.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Have a spotter or use a lighter dumbbell if performed across the bench. • Ensure the dumbbell's collars are tight.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Shoulder impingement • Lumbar hyperextension pain • Recent rib injury	
PROGRESSION	Add load slowly; or switch to a cable pullover for constant tension.		
REGRESSION	Straight-arm cable pulldown.		
ALTERNATIVES	Straight-Arm Cable Pulldown, Flat Dumbbell Fly, Lat Pulldown		
RECORD ID	EX-0028		
TAGS #chest #lats #stretch-position #dumbbell #hypertrophy			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0028::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0028::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Medicine Ball Chest Pass (Wall)				EX-0029 Beginner
CATEGORY	Chest	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii, anterior deltoid, core	
EQUIPMENT	3-6 kg medicine ball, solid wall	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	8.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Athletic, Fat Loss, General Fitness	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-60	

ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	X-0-X-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	5-8
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale sharply on the throw, inhale on the catch.

EXECUTION

1. Stand 1.5-2 m from a solid wall, ball held at chest height.

2. Set an athletic stance: knees soft, chest tall, core braced.

3. Push the ball explosively at the wall, extending both arms fully.

4. Catch the rebound with soft elbows and immediately reset for the next throw.

COMMON MISTAKES	COACH TIPS
• Throwing with the arms only and no leg drive. • Catching with straight, locked arms. • Using a bouncy ball that returns unpredictably.	• Trains the rate of force development the bench press cannot. • Keep reps at 5-8 and rest fully — this is a power drill. • Use a non-bouncing slam-style ball if the rebound is unmanageable.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS	SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST
• Use a concrete or brick wall, never drywall or glass. • Clear the area behind you.	• Wrist or finger injury • Recent shoulder surgery

PROGRESSION	Heavier ball, or single-arm passes.
REGRESSION	Standing band chest press performed quickly.
ALTERNATIVES	Clap Push-Up, Resistance Band Chest Press, Barbell Bench Press
RECORD ID	EX-0029

TAGS #chest #power #medicine-ball #athletic #explosive #sports-conditioning

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0029::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0029::3set full rom 30s]

Back

Conventional Deadlift

EX-0030 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Erector spinae, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, latissimus dorsi, trapezius, forearm flexors
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, bumper plates	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	8.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-60
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-0-1-1
SETS	3-5	REPS	3-6
REST	180-300 s	BREATHING	Big brace and hold through the pull; exhale at lockout or between reps.
EXECUTION - Stand with mid-foot under the bar, feet hip-width. The bar touches the shins. - Hinge at the hips and grip just outside the knees; drop the hips until the shins meet the bar. - Set the chest tall, lats squeezed (imagine crushing oranges in the armpits), spine neutral. - Take the slack out of the bar, brace, then push the floor away and stand up. - Lock out by driving the hips forward — do not lean back at the top.			
COMMON MISTAKES - Rounding the lower back — the single most common cause of deadlift injury. - Yanking the bar off the floor without taking out the slack. - Hyperextending the spine at lockout.		COACH TIPS - The deadlift is a push, not a pull. Drive the floor down. - Keep the bar in contact with the legs the whole way up. - If the hips shoot up first, the weight is too heavy.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS - Master the hip hinge pattern with a dowel before loading. - Never round the spine to complete a rep — reset instead.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST - Acute lower back pain or disc herniation - Uncontrolled hypertension - Late-stage pregnancy - Untrained beginners without coaching	
PROGRESSION		Add 2.5-5 kg per session while form holds; then add deficit deadlifts.	

REGRESSION	Trap bar deadlift or Romanian deadlift from the knee.
ALTERNATIVES	Trap Bar Deadlift, Romanian Deadlift, Rack Pull
RECORD ID	EX-0030
TAGS #back #posterior-chain #hinge #compound #strength #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0030::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0030::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Trap Bar Deadlift

EX-0031 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, quadriceps	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Erector spinae, trapezius, forearm flexors
EQUIPMENT	Hex/trap bar, plates	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	8.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-0-1-1
SETS	3-5	REPS	5-8
REST	120-180 s	BREATHING	Brace at the bottom, exhale at the top.

EXECUTION

1. Step inside the hex bar with feet hip-width.
2. Hinge and grip the neutral handles; hips slightly lower than a straight-bar setup.
3. Brace, chest tall, then stand by driving the feet into the floor.
4. Lower under control until the plates touch, then reset.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Squatting the weight up with the hips too low.
- Rounding the upper back.
- Bouncing plates off the floor.

COACH TIPS

- The neutral grip and centred load make this far safer to learn than a straight bar.
- The best first heavy hinge for most ZITLAS users.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Use the high handles until hip mobility allows the low handles.
- Keep the neck neutral.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute lower back pain**
- **Uncontrolled hypertension**

PROGRESSION	Progress load, then move to a conventional barbell deadlift.
REGRESSION	Kettlebell deadlift or dumbbell Romanian deadlift.
ALTERNATIVES	Conventional Deadlift, Romanian Deadlift, Goblet Squat
RECORD ID	EX-0031
TAGS #back #hinge #trap-bar #beginner-safe #compound #strength	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0031::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0031::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Romanian Deadlift

EX-0032 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Erector spinae, latissimus dorsi
EQUIPMENT	Barbell or two dumbbells	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-65
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-12
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Inhale on the way down, exhale standing up.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall holding the bar at the hips, knees softly bent (about 15 degrees).
2. Push the hips backwards, letting the bar slide down the thighs.
3. Keep the shins vertical and the spine neutral; descend until a hamstring stretch limits you.
4. Drive the hips forward to stand, squeezing the glutes at the top.

COMMON MISTAKES • Bending the knees more as the bar descends — that makes it a deadlift. • Letting the bar drift away from the legs. • Chasing depth by rounding the lower back.		COACH TIPS • Depth is set by hamstring flexibility, not by touching the floor. • Keep the lats engaged so the bar stays glued to the thigh.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Start with an empty bar or light dumbbells. • Stop the set if the back rounds.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lumbar disc injury • Severe hamstring strain	
PROGRESSION	Add load; then progress to single-leg Romanian deadlifts.		
REGRESSION	Dumbbell RDL from a shortened range, or a hip hinge with a dowel.		
ALTERNATIVES	Single-Leg Romanian Deadlift, Good Morning, Conventional Deadlift		
RECORD ID	EX-0032		
TAGS #back #hamstrings #hinge #posterior-chain #hypertrophy			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0032::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0032::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Pull-Up (Pronated Grip)

EX-0033 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Biceps brachii, teres major, rhomboids, lower trapezius
EQUIPMENT	Pull-up bar	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	8.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-60
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1
SETS	3-5	REPS	3-12
REST	90-180 s	BREATHING	Exhale on the way up, inhale on the descent.

EXECUTION

1. Hang from the bar with an overhand grip slightly wider than the shoulders.
2. Begin by depressing the shoulder blades — pull them down before the elbows bend.
3. Drive the elbows down and back until the chin clears the bar.
4. Lower under full control to a complete dead hang.

COMMON MISTAKES • Kipping or swinging the legs to generate momentum. • Stopping short of a full hang, which sacrifices the strongest range. • Shrugging the shoulders toward the ears at the bottom.		COACH TIPS • Initiate with the scapulae, not the arms. This one cue fixes most pull-ups. • Squeeze the glutes and brace to stop the body swinging.		
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Build with negatives and band-assisted reps before attempting full reps. • Do not add load until 8 clean bodyweight reps are possible.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Shoulder impingement • Acute elbow tendinopathy • Recent shoulder dislocation		
PROGRESSION	Add a dip belt with 2.5-5 kg; then progress to weighted or archer pull-ups.			
REGRESSION	Band-assisted pull-up, lat pulldown, or inverted row.			
ALTERNATIVES	Lat Pulldown, Inverted Row, Chin-Up			
RECORD ID	EX-0033			
TAGS #back #lats #vertical-pull #bodyweight #calisthenics #compound MEDIA [IMG::EX-0033::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0033::3set_full_rom_30s]				

Chin-Up (Supinated Grip)

EX-0034 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi, biceps brachii	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Rhomboids, lower trapezius, brachialis
EQUIPMENT	Pull-up bar	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	8.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-60

ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1
SETS	3-4	REPS	4-12
REST	90-150 s	BREATHING	Exhale up, inhale down.
EXECUTION 1. Hang with an underhand grip at roughly shoulder width. 2. Depress the shoulder blades, then pull the chest toward the bar. 3. Clear the chin above the bar and squeeze at the top. 4. Lower slowly to a full hang.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Swinging or kipping. • Cutting the descent short. • Flaring the elbows wide, which reduces biceps leverage.		COACH TIPS • The supinated grip recruits far more biceps — most people can do more chin-ups than pull-ups. • An excellent first vertical pull for beginners.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the wrists stacked; if the elbows ache, switch to a neutral grip.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Elbow tendinopathy • Wrist injury	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or slow the eccentric to 5 seconds.		
REGRESSION	Band-assisted chin-up or inverted row.		
ALTERNATIVES	Pull-Up (Pronated Grip), Lat Pulldown, Inverted Row		
RECORD ID	EX-0034		
TAGS #back #lats #biceps #vertical-pull #bodyweight #calisthenics			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0034::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0034::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Neutral-Grip Pull-Up

EX-0035 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Brachialis, biceps brachii, teres major
EQUIPMENT	Parallel pull-up handles or rings	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	8.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-60
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1
SETS	3-4	REPS	4-12
REST	90-150 s	BREATHING	Exhale up, inhale down.
EXECUTION 1. Grip two parallel handles, palms facing each other. 2. Depress the scapulae, then pull the sternum toward the handles. 3. Clear the chin, squeeze, and lower under control.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Kipping. • Partial range at the bottom. • Craning the neck to clear the bar.		COACH TIPS • The most shoulder- and elbow-friendly vertical pull. • The default choice for anyone with cranky elbows.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Check the handle attachment is secure.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Shoulder impingement • Recent elbow surgery	
PROGRESSION	Add a weight vest.		
REGRESSION	Band-assisted neutral pull-up.		
ALTERNATIVES	Chin-Up, Lat Pulldown, Pull-Up (Pronated Grip)		
RECORD ID	EX-0035		
TAGS #back #lats #vertical-pull #joint-friendly #calisthenics			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0035::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0035::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Lat Pulldown (Wide Grip)		EX-0036 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Biceps brachii, rhomboids, lower trapezius
EQUIPMENT	Lat pulldown machine	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	5.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-75
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-15
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale pulling down, inhale on the return.
EXECUTION 1. Set the thigh pad so it pins the legs firmly. 2. Grip the bar wider than shoulder width; sit tall with a slight backward lean. 3. Pull the bar to the upper chest by driving the elbows down and back. 4. Squeeze the lats for one second, then let the bar rise until the arms fully extend.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Pulling the bar behind the neck — high risk, no added benefit. • Leaning far back and turning it into a row. • Using the biceps to yank instead of driving with the elbows.		COACH TIPS • Let the shoulder blades rise fully at the top — that stretch is the point. • Think of the hands as hooks. The lats do the work. • The best regression on the path to a first pull-up.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Never pull behind the neck. • Do not let the stack pull you off the seat.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute shoulder impingement	
PROGRESSION	Reduce assistance until bodyweight pull-ups become possible.		
REGRESSION	Band-assisted lat pulldown, or a seated band pulldown.		
ALTERNATIVES	Pull-Up (Pronated Grip), Straight-Arm Cable Pulldown, Inverted Row		
RECORD ID	EX-0036		
TAGS #back #lats #machine #vertical-pull #beginner-safe #gym MEDIA [IMG::EX-0036::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0036::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Close-Grip Lat Pulldown		EX-0037 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi (lower fibres)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Biceps brachii, teres major
EQUIPMENT	Lat pulldown machine, V-bar attachment	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	5.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-75
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	8-15
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale down, inhale up.
EXECUTION 1. Attach a V-bar and set the thigh pad. 2. Sit tall, grip the neutral handles, lean back about 15 degrees. 3. Pull the handles to the sternum, elbows driving straight down. 4. Control the return to a full stretch.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Excessive backward lean. • Bouncing the stack at the bottom of the stretch.		COACH TIPS • The close neutral grip emphasises the lower lat fibres and lets you load heavier. • Keep the chest up and the elbows tracking past the ribs.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the thigh pad tight to stop the hips lifting.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Elbow tendinopathy	
PROGRESSION		Increase load, or add a 3-second squeeze at the bottom.	

REGRESSION	Seated cable row.
ALTERNATIVES	Lat Pulldown (Wide Grip), Seated Cable Row, Neutral-Grip Pull-Up
RECORD ID	EX-0037
TAGS #back #lats #machine #vertical-pull #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0037::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0037::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Barbell Bent-Over Row

EX-0038 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi, rhomboids	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Trapezius, posterior deltoid, erector spinae, biceps brachii
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, plates	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	7.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-60
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	6-12
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Inhale and brace before the rep; exhale at the top of the row.

EXECUTION

1. Stand hip-width, hinge until the torso is 15-45 degrees above horizontal.
2. Grip the bar just outside the knees, spine neutral, shins vertical.
3. Row the bar to the lower ribs or upper abdomen, elbows tracking back.
4. Lower under control to full arm extension without letting the torso rise.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using the torso as a lever and jerking the bar up.
- Rounding the lumbar spine.
- Rowing to the chest with flared elbows, which turns it into a rear delt row.

COACH TIPS

- Set the torso angle and do not let it change for the whole set.
- Pull with the elbows; the hands are hooks.
- If the last reps require body English, the set is finished.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Brace the trunk hard throughout.
- Do not perform with an acutely painful back.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute lower back pain
- Disc herniation
- Uncontrolled hypertension

PROGRESSION	Add load; then progress to a Pendlay row from a dead stop.
REGRESSION	Chest-supported row or single-arm dumbbell row.
ALTERNATIVES	Chest-Supported Row, Single-Arm Dumbbell Row, Seated Cable Row
RECORD ID	EX-0038
TAGS #back #lats #horizontal-pull #compound #hypertrophy #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0038::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0038::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Pendlay Row

EX-0039 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi, rhomboids	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Trapezius, posterior deltoid, erector spinae
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, bumper plates	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	7.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-55
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	1-0-X-1
SETS	4-5	REPS	3-6
REST	120-180 s	BREATHING	Inhale and brace on the floor, exhale at the top.

EXECUTION

1. Hinge until the torso is parallel to the floor; the bar rests on the ground.
2. Grip just outside the knees, brace, and explosively row the bar to the lower sternum.
3. Return the bar all the way to the floor and let it settle for a beat.
4. Reset the brace before every rep.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the torso rise above parallel.
- Bouncing the bar off the floor to gain momentum.
- Rounding the back to reach the bar.

COACH TIPS

- Every rep starts from a dead stop, removing the stretch reflex.
- Builds explosive pulling strength for deadlifts and Olympic lifts.
- Keep sets short — 5 hard reps is the sweet spot.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Requires strong isometric back endurance. Master the bent-over row first.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Any lower back pathology
- Hamstring strain limiting the hinge

PROGRESSION

Add load, keeping the torso strictly parallel.

REGRESSION

Standard bent-over row with a higher torso angle.

ALTERNATIVES

Barbell Bent-Over Row, Chest-Supported Row, Conventional Deadlift

RECORD ID

EX-0039

TAGS [#back](#) [#horizontal-pull](#) [#explosive](#) [#strength](#) [#advanced](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0039::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0039::3set_full_rom_30s]

Single-Arm Dumbbell Row

EX-0040 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Rhomboids, posterior deltoid, biceps brachii, obliques
EQUIPMENT	One dumbbell, flat bench	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-12 per side
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale rowing, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Place the left knee and left hand on a bench, right foot on the floor.
2. Let the right arm hang, dumbbell in hand, spine flat and parallel to the floor.
3. Row the dumbbell to the hip, driving the elbow past the ribs.
4. Lower under control until the lat is fully stretched, then repeat.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rotating the torso to hoist the weight.
- Rowing straight up to the shoulder rather than back to the hip.
- Shrugging at the top.

COACH TIPS

- Keep the hips square. If the torso twists, drop the weight.
- The supported position removes lower back fatigue, so you can push the lats harder.
- Allow the shoulder blade to travel — protract at the bottom, retract at the top.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Ensure the bench is stable.
- Keep a neutral neck, eyes down.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute shoulder injury

PROGRESSION

Add load, or perform a 2-second pause at the top.

REGRESSION

Chest-supported dumbbell row.

ALTERNATIVES

Chest-Supported Row, Seated Cable Row, Barbell Bent-Over Row

RECORD ID

EX-0040

TAGS [#back](#) [#lats](#) [#unilateral](#) [#dumbbell](#) [#horizontal-pull](#) [#beginner-safe](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0040::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0040::3set_full_rom_30s]

Chest-Supported Row

EX-0041 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
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PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rhomboids, latissimus dorsi	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Middle trapezius, posterior deltoid, biceps brachii
EQUIPMENT	Incline bench, two dumbbells	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-75
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3-4	REPS	10-15
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale rowing, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Set an incline bench to 30-45 degrees and lie chest-down on it.

2. Let the arms hang straight, dumbbell in each hand.

3. Row both dumbbells toward the hips, squeezing the shoulder blades together.

4. Lower slowly to a full stretch.

COMMON MISTAKES	COACH TIPS
• Lifting the chest off the pad to cheat. • Shrugging instead of retracting. • Cutting the stretch short.	• Chest support eliminates the lower back as a limiting factor. • The best rowing choice for anyone with back pain history. • Pause 1 second with the shoulder blades pinned.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS	SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST
• Adjust the bench height so the dumbbells clear the floor.	• Acute chest or rib injury

PROGRESSION	Add load; then progress to a T-bar or barbell row.
REGRESSION	Seated cable row.
ALTERNATIVES	Seated Cable Row, Single-Arm Dumbbell Row, Barbell Bent-Over Row
RECORD ID	EX-0041

TAGS [#back](#) [#rhomboids](#) [#horizontal-pull](#) [#back-friendly](#) [#beginner-safe](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0041::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0041::3set_full_rom_30s]

Seated Cable Row

EX-0042 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi, rhomboids	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Middle trapezius, biceps brachii, posterior deltoid
EQUIPMENT	Seated row machine, V-bar	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	5.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-75
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3-4	REPS	10-15
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale rowing, inhale on the return.
EXECUTION 1. Sit with a slight knee bend, feet on the platform, chest tall. 2. Grip the handle, arms extended, and let the shoulder blades protract forward. 3. Row the handle to the navel, driving the elbows straight back. 4. Squeeze for one second, then return slowly to a full stretch.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Rocking the torso back and forth like a rowing machine. • Rounding the lower back at the stretch. • Pulling the handle to the chest instead of the navel.		COACH TIPS • Let the shoulder blades move — a locked scapula wastes half the exercise. • The torso stays roughly vertical throughout.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Do not let the stack yank you forward at the end of a hard set.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain (use a chest-supported row instead)	
PROGRESSION	Increase load, or add a 2-second squeeze.		
REGRESSION	Resistance band seated row.		
ALTERNATIVES	Chest-Supported Row, Barbell Bent-Over Row, Resistance Band Row		

RECORD ID	EX-0042
TAGS #back #cable #horizontal-pull #machine #beginner-safe #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0042::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0042::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Inverted Row

EX-0043 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi, rhomboids	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Middle trapezius, biceps brachii, core
EQUIPMENT	Barbell in a rack, Smith machine, or TRX	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	6.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Strength, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-70
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-20
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale pulling, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Set a bar at hip height and lie underneath it.
2. Grip slightly wider than shoulders; body straight from head to heels.
3. Pull the chest to the bar, squeezing the shoulder blades.
4. Lower under control to full arm extension.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the hips sag toward the floor.
- Shrugging the shoulders instead of retracting.
- Cutting the range short and never touching the bar.

COACH TIPS

- Raise the bar to make it easier; lower it (or elevate the feet) to make it harder.
- The most scalable horizontal pull in existence — usable by a 10-year-old or an athlete.
- The best partner exercise for building a first pull-up.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Confirm the bar is locked into the rack pins.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute shoulder injury**

PROGRESSION	Lower the bar, elevate the feet, then add a weight vest.
REGRESSION	Raise the bar higher for a steeper, easier angle.
ALTERNATIVES	Pull-Up (Pronated Grip), Seated Cable Row, Resistance Band Row
RECORD ID	EX-0043
TAGS #back #bodyweight #horizontal-pull #scalable #home #partner	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0043::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0043::3set_full_rom_30s]	

T-Bar Row

EX-0044 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi, rhomboids	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Middle trapezius, posterior deltoid, erector spinae
EQUIPMENT	T-bar row machine or landmine + V-handle	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-60
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-12
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Exhale rowing, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Straddle the bar, hinge to a 30-45 degree torso angle, knees soft.
2. Grip the handles and set a neutral spine with the chest tall.
3. Row the handle to the lower sternum, elbows close to the body.
4. Lower slowly to full extension.

COMMON MISTAKES • Standing up as the set fatigues. • Rounding the lower back. • Using momentum from a hip thrust.		COACH TIPS • The neutral grip and centred load allow heavy loading with less lumbar shear than a barbell row. • A chest-supported T-bar removes the back entirely if that is a concern.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Anchor the bar end securely if using a landmine setup.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain • Disc herniation	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or move to a chest-supported T-bar for stricter form.		
REGRESSION	Chest-supported dumbbell row.		
ALTERNATIVES	Barbell Bent-Over Row, Chest-Supported Row, Seated Cable Row		
RECORD ID	EX-0044		
TAGS #back #lats #horizontal-pull #landmine #gym MEDIA [IMG::EX-0044::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0044::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Straight-Arm Cable Pulldown		EX-0045 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Teres major, triceps long head, rectus abdominis
EQUIPMENT	Cable machine, straight bar or rope, high pulley	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-15
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale on the sweep down, inhale on the return.
EXECUTION 1. Stand facing a high pulley, feet hip-width, hinge slightly at the hips. 2. Hold the bar with straight arms, a soft elbow bend locked in place. 3. Sweep the bar down in an arc until it reaches the thighs. 4. Let the arms rise back overhead until a lat stretch is felt.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Bending the elbows and turning it into a triceps pushdown. • Standing bolt upright, which shortens the arc. • Using so much weight that the torso rocks.		COACH TIPS • The only reliable way to train the lat without the biceps being a limiting factor. • Superb as a lat pre-exhaust or a pump finisher.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the ribcage down; do not extend the lumbar spine.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Shoulder impingement in overhead flexion	
PROGRESSION	Add a 2-second squeeze at the thighs, or use a single-arm variant.		
REGRESSION	Resistance band straight-arm pulldown.		
ALTERNATIVES	Lat Pulldown (Wide Grip), Dumbbell Pullover, Pull-Up (Pronated Grip)		
RECORD ID	EX-0045		
TAGS #back #lats #isolation #cable #pre-exhaust			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0045::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0045::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Face Pull				EX-0046 Beginner
CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Posterior deltoid, rhomboids	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Middle/lower trapezius, external rotators	
EQUIPMENT	Cable machine, rope attachment, high pulley	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	4.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Athletic	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-80	
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1	

SETS	3	REPS	12-20
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale pulling, inhale returning.
EXECUTION			
1. Set the pulley slightly above head height and grip the rope with thumbs back. 2. Step back to create tension; arms extended, palms facing each other. 3. Pull the rope toward the forehead, separating the hands as you go. 4. Finish with the elbows high and the hands beside the ears; squeeze, then return slowly.			
COMMON MISTAKES		COACH TIPS	
• Going too heavy and turning it into a high row. • Letting the elbows drop below the wrists. • Shrugging the upper traps.		• The single highest-value corrective for desk posture and shoulder health. • Should be a staple in every ZITLAS program, not an afterthought. • Light weight, high reps, perfect control.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST	
• If the traps take over, halve the weight.		• Acute rotator cuff tear	
PROGRESSION	Add an external rotation at the end range (a W-pull).		
REGRESSION	Resistance band pull-apart.		
ALTERNATIVES	Band Pull-Apart, Reverse Fly, Seated Cable Row		
RECORD ID	EX-0046		
TAGS #back #rear-delt #posture #corrective #shoulder-health #office			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0046::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0046::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Band Pull-Apart

EX-0047 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rhomboids, posterior deltoid	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Middle trapezius, external rotators
EQUIPMENT	Light resistance band	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	3.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-85
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	2-3	REPS	15-25
REST	30-45 s	BREATHING	Exhale opening, inhale closing.
EXECUTION 1. Hold a light band at shoulder height with straight arms, hands shoulder-width. 2. Keep the ribcage down and the shoulders away from the ears. 3. Pull the band apart until it touches the sternum. 4. Squeeze the shoulder blades, then return with control.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Bending the elbows. • Arching the lower back. • Shrugging the traps.		COACH TIPS • The perfect warm-up and desk-break drill — no fatigue cost, high postural payoff. • Can be done 3-5 times per week.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Inspect the band for tears; a snapping band at eye level is dangerous.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Recent shoulder surgery	
PROGRESSION	Thicker band, or hold the end position for 3 seconds.		
REGRESSION	Widen the grip to reduce tension.		
ALTERNATIVES	Face Pull, Reverse Fly, Wall Angel		
RECORD ID	EX-0047		
TAGS #back #rear-delt #posture #warm-up #office #travel #home MEDIA [IMG::EX-0047::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0047::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Reverse Fly (Dumbbell)

EX-0048 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Posterior deltoid	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Rhomboids, middle trapezius
EQUIPMENT	Two light dumbbells, incline bench (optional)	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-80
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-20
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale raising, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Hinge forward to 45 degrees or lie chest-down on an incline bench.
2. Hold light dumbbells with a soft elbow bend, palms facing each other.
3. Raise the arms out to the sides until level with the torso.
4. Squeeze the shoulder blades, then lower slowly.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using heavy weight and swinging.
- Shrugging so the traps do the work.
- Raising the arms above shoulder level.

COACH TIPS

- Rear delts respond to volume and control, not load. Stay light.
- Turn the thumbs slightly down to bias the posterior deltoid.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Support the head on the bench to spare the neck.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute shoulder impingement

PROGRESSION

Add a 2-second hold at the top; then progress to a cable reverse fly.

REGRESSION

Band pull-apart.

ALTERNATIVES

Face Pull, Band Pull-Apart, Chest-Supported Row

RECORD ID

EX-0048

TAGS [#back](#) [#rear-delt](#) [#isolation](#) [#posture](#) [#hypertrophy](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0048::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0048::3set_full_rom_30s]

Barbell Shrug

EX-0049 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Upper trapezius	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Levator scapulae, forearm flexors
EQUIPMENT	Barbell or two heavy dumbbells	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-65
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3-4	REPS	10-15
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Exhale shrugging up, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall holding the bar at arm's length in front of the thighs.
2. Keep the arms straight and the chin tucked.
3. Elevate the shoulders straight up toward the ears as high as possible.
4. Hold for one second at the top, then lower slowly to a full stretch.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rolling the shoulders backwards, which grinds the AC joint for no benefit.
- Bending the elbows and pulling with the biceps.
- Bouncing the weight with the knees.

COACH TIPS

- Traps elevate the scapula. They do not rotate it. Straight up, straight down.
- A 1-second peak hold is worth more than 20 kg of extra load.
- Use straps once grip becomes the limiting factor.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Do not roll the shoulders.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute neck pain
- Cervical disc issues

PROGRESSION	Add load with straps, or use a longer 3-second peak hold.
REGRESSION	Dumbbell shrug with a lighter load.
ALTERNATIVES	Farmer's Carry, Face Pull, Rack Pull
RECORD ID	EX-0049
TAGS #back #traps #isolation #grip #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0049::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0049::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Rack Pull

EX-0050 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Erector spinae, trapezius	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, latissimus dorsi, forearm flexors
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, power rack with pins	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	7.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-60
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3-4	REPS	4-8
REST	150-240 s	BREATHING	Brace at the start, exhale at lockout.

EXECUTION

1. Set the pins so the bar starts at or just below the knees.
2. Take a deadlift stance and grip; set the lats and brace.
3. Drive the hips forward and stand tall, keeping the bar against the legs.
4. Lower back to the pins under control — do not drop the bar.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Setting the pins so high the movement becomes a shrug.
- Hyperextending the spine at the top.
- Dropping the bar onto the pins.

COACH TIPS

- Overloads the top half of the deadlift and builds a thick upper back.
- Useful for anyone whose deadlift fails above the knee.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Use bar padding on the pins to protect the knurling and reduce noise.
- Keep the load appropriate — the shortened range invites ego lifting.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute lower back pain**
- **Uncontrolled hypertension**

PROGRESSION	Lower the pins progressively toward the floor.
REGRESSION	Romanian deadlift from a shortened range.
ALTERNATIVES	Conventional Deadlift, Barbell Shrug, Romanian Deadlift
RECORD ID	EX-0050
TAGS #back #traps #hinge #overload #strength #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0050::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0050::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Good Morning

EX-0051 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Erector spinae, hamstrings	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, adductor magnus
EQUIPMENT	Barbell on the upper back	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	5.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	18-55
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	8-12
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Inhale on the descent, exhale standing.

EXECUTION

1. Rack a light bar high on the traps, feet hip-width, knees softly bent.
2. Brace hard, then push the hips backwards while the chest travels forward.
3. Descend until the torso is close to parallel or hamstring tension stops you.
4. Drive the hips forward and squeeze the glutes to stand.

COMMON MISTAKES • Loading heavy before the pattern is grooved — the classic injury route. • Rounding the lumbar spine. • Turning it into a squat by bending the knees.		COACH TIPS • Start with an empty bar. Genuinely. Even strong lifters. • The hips move back, not down. • Superb hamstring and spinal-erector strengthener when respected.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Set safety pins if squatting inside a rack. • This exercise punishes ego more than any other.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Any lower back pathology • Beginners • Osteoporosis • Pregnancy	
PROGRESSION	Add small load increments (2.5 kg), keeping the spine neutral.		
REGRESSION	Romanian deadlift, or a dowel-only hip hinge drill.		
ALTERNATIVES	Romanian Deadlift, Back Extension, Conventional Deadlift		
RECORD ID	EX-0051		
TAGS #back #posterior-chain #hinge #advanced #strength			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0051::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0051::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Back Extension (45-Degree)

EX-0052 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Erector spinae, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings
EQUIPMENT	45-degree hyperextension bench	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	4.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-75
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-20
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Set the pad just below the hip crease so the hips can flex freely.
2. Cross the arms over the chest, spine neutral.
3. Hinge forward at the hips until a hamstring stretch is felt.
4. Squeeze the glutes to return to a straight line — do not arch past neutral.

COMMON MISTAKES • Hyperextending at the top, which compresses the lumbar facets. • Rounding the back to gain extra depth. • Adding heavy load before bodyweight is easy for 20 reps.		COACH TIPS • Stop at a straight line. Extension beyond neutral has no benefit and real cost. • Excellent low-back endurance builder for desk workers and runners.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Do not add a plate until 20 clean bodyweight reps are possible.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute disc herniation • Uncontrolled hypertension	

PROGRESSION	Hold a plate against the chest, or slow the eccentric to 4 seconds.
REGRESSION	Bird dog or prone hip extension on the floor.
ALTERNATIVES	Romanian Deadlift, Bird Dog, Good Morning
RECORD ID	EX-0052
TAGS #back #erectors #low-back #endurance #beginner-safe	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0052::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0052::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Resistance Band Row

EX-0053 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Back	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi, rhomboids	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Middle trapezius, biceps brachii
EQUIPMENT	Long resistance band, anchor or feet	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, General Fitness

SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-85
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-20
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale rowing, inhale returning.
EXECUTION			
1. Sit on the floor with legs extended and loop the band around the soles. 2. Hold one end in each hand, arms extended, spine tall. 3. Row the handles to the lower ribs, driving the elbows back. 4. Squeeze the shoulder blades, then return under control.			
COMMON MISTAKES		COACH TIPS	
• Rounding the back and rocking to generate force. • Letting the band snap the arms forward.		• The most portable back exercise there is — fits in a hostel drawer or a suitcase. • Shorten the band by wrapping it around the hands to increase resistance.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST	
• Ensure the band cannot slip off the feet and recoil into the face.		• Recent shoulder injury	
PROGRESSION	Thicker band, or a 3-second squeeze at the top.		
REGRESSION	Standing band row at a lighter tension.		
ALTERNATIVES	Seated Cable Row, Inverted Row, Single-Arm Dumbbell Row		
RECORD ID	EX-0053		
TAGS #back #resistance-band #travel #home #hostel #no-equipment			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0053::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0053::3set full rom 30s]			

Shoulders & Arms

Standing Barbell Overhead Press

EX-0054 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Shoulders	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Lateral deltoid, triceps brachii, upper trapezius, core
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, rack	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-60
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3-5	REPS	5-8
REST	120-180 s	BREATHING	Inhale and brace at the shoulders, exhale past the sticking point.
EXECUTION 1. Unrack the bar at collarbone height, hands just outside the shoulders. 2. Brace the abdominals and squeeze the glutes to lock the ribcage down. 3. Press the bar straight up, moving the head back slightly to clear the chin. 4. Lock out overhead with the bar over the mid-foot, then lower under control.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Leaning back and turning it into an incline press. • Pressing around the face instead of moving the head out of the way. • Letting the ribcage flare and the lower back arch.		COACH TIPS • Glutes and abs are the foundation of a strong overhead press. • Shrug the shoulders up at lockout — that is the correct finish, not a flaw.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Set safety pins at chest height. • Warm the thoracic spine and lats first.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Shoulder impingement • Acute lower back pain • Poor overhead mobility	
PROGRESSION		Add 1-2.5 kg per week; then add a push press for overload.	
REGRESSION		Seated dumbbell shoulder press or landmine press.	

ALTERNATIVES	Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press, Landmine Press, Push Press
RECORD ID	EX-0054
TAGS #shoulders #vertical-press #compound #strength #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0054::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0054::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press

EX-0055 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Shoulders	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, lateral deltoid	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii, upper trapezius
EQUIPMENT	Two dumbbells, upright bench	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-12
REST	75-120 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Sit with the back supported, dumbbells at shoulder height, palms forward.
2. Brace the core and keep the ribcage down against the pad.
3. Press up and slightly inward until the arms are nearly straight.
4. Lower under control until the elbows drop just below shoulder level.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the lower back away from the pad.
- Banging the dumbbells together at the top.
- Descending so deep the shoulder capsule takes the load.

COACH TIPS

- The safest heavy vertical press for most people — the bench takes the spine out of it.
- A neutral (palms-in) grip is gentler on irritated shoulders.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Kick the dumbbells up from the thighs; do not curl them into position.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute shoulder impingement**
- **Rotator cuff tear**

PROGRESSION	Add load, or move to a standing barbell press.
REGRESSION	Machine shoulder press or seated Arnold press with light weight.
ALTERNATIVES	Standing Barbell Overhead Press, Arnold Press, Machine Shoulder Press
RECORD ID	EX-0055
TAGS #shoulders #vertical-press #dumbbell #beginner-safe #hypertrophy	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0055::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0055::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Arnold Press

EX-0056 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Shoulders	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, lateral deltoid	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii, rotator cuff
EQUIPMENT	Two dumbbells, upright bench	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-60
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	8-12
REST	75-90 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Start seated with dumbbells at chest height, palms facing you (a supinated bottom).
2. As you press, rotate the palms outward so they face forward at lockout.
3. Reverse the rotation smoothly on the descent.

COMMON MISTAKES • Rotating too early, before the dumbbells clear the chin. • Using heavy loads that force jerky rotation. • Flaring the ribcage.		COACH TIPS • The rotation adds range and hits all three deltoid heads in one rep. • Use roughly 70% of your normal dumbbell press load.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Avoid if the rotation causes any pinching at the front of the shoulder.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Shoulder impingement • Biceps tendinopathy	
PROGRESSION	Add load slowly, or slow the rotation to 3 seconds.		
REGRESSION	Standard seated dumbbell press.		
ALTERNATIVES	Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press, Machine Shoulder Press, Landmine Press		
RECORD ID	EX-0056		
TAGS #shoulders #vertical-press #dumbbell #hypertrophy			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0056::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0056::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Machine Shoulder Press				EX-0057 Beginner
CATEGORY	Shoulders	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Lateral deltoid, triceps brachii	
EQUIPMENT	Seated shoulder press machine	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	5.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-78	
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0	
SETS	3	REPS	10-15	
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale pressing, inhale returning.	
EXECUTION				
1. Set the seat so the handles sit at shoulder height. 2. Back flat against the pad, feet planted, core braced. 3. Press up to near lockout, then return until the handles reach shoulder level.				
COMMON MISTAKES		COACH TIPS		
• Seat too low, forcing an exaggerated overhead range. • Slamming the stack at the bottom.		• Ideal for training to failure alone. • Excellent first vertical press for beginners and seniors.		
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST		
• Adjust the range-of-motion stops if the machine allows.		• Acute shoulder impingement		
PROGRESSION	Progress to dumbbell shoulder press.			
REGRESSION	Resistance band overhead press, seated.			
ALTERNATIVES	Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press, Landmine Press, Pike Push-Up			
RECORD ID	EX-0057			
TAGS #shoulders #machine #vertical-press #beginner-safe #senior-friendly				
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0057::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0057::3set_full_rom_30s]				

Dumbbell Lateral Raise				EX-0058 Beginner
CATEGORY	Shoulders	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Lateral deltoid	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Supraspinatus, upper trapezius	
EQUIPMENT	Two light dumbbells	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	4.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-75	
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1	
SETS	3-4	REPS	12-20	
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale raising, inhale lowering.	

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall, dumbbells at the sides, soft bend in the elbows.
2. Lean the torso forward about 10 degrees.
3. Raise the arms out to the sides until the hands reach shoulder height.
4. Lower slowly, resisting all the way down.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Swinging the weights with hip momentum.
- Shrugging the traps so the neck does the lifting.
- Raising the hands above shoulder level.

COACH TIPS

- Lead with the elbows, not the hands. Imagine pouring water from a jug.
- Light weight, strict form. This is a small muscle with a short lever.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- If the traps take over, cut the weight in half.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Shoulder impingement**
- **Rotator cuff tear**

PROGRESSION

Add a 2-second hold at the top; then a cable lateral raise for constant tension.

REGRESSION

Seated lateral raise (removes momentum) or a band lateral raise.

ALTERNATIVES

Cable Lateral Raise, Upright Row, Machine Lateral Raise

RECORD ID

EX-0058

TAGS #shoulders #side-delt #isolation #hypertrophy #home

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0058::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0058::3set_full_rom_30s]

Cable Lateral Raise

EX-0059 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Shoulders	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Lateral deltoid	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Supraspinatus
EQUIPMENT	Cable machine, low pulley, D-handle	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-15 per side
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale raising, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Stand side-on to a low pulley; take the handle in the far hand behind the body.
2. Raise the arm out and up to shoulder height in a wide arc.
3. Lower slowly against the cable's pull.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Leaning away from the stack to cheat.
- Shrugging.
- Letting the cable snap the arm down.

COACH TIPS

- Cables load the bottom of the raise, where dumbbells give you nothing.
- Hold the machine with the free hand for a stable base.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep the wrist neutral, not cocked.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute shoulder impingement**

PROGRESSION

Add a slow 4-second eccentric or a drop set.

REGRESSION

Dumbbell lateral raise.

ALTERNATIVES

Dumbbell Lateral Raise, Machine Lateral Raise, Band Lateral Raise

RECORD ID

EX-0059

TAGS #shoulders #side-delt #cable #isolation #constant-tension

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0059::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0059::3set_full_rom_30s]

Front Raise

EX-0060 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Shoulders	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Upper pectoralis major, upper trapezius
EQUIPMENT	Dumbbells, plate, or band	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	3.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness

SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-75
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1
SETS	2-3	REPS	10-15
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale raising, inhale lowering.
EXECUTION 1. Stand tall, weight in front of the thighs, palms facing back. 2. Brace the core so the torso cannot swing. 3. Raise the arms straight in front to shoulder height. 4. Lower under control.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Swinging the hips and using momentum. • Raising far above shoulder height, which shifts work to the traps. • Doing front raises at all when your program already has plenty of pressing.		COACH TIPS • Most people do not need direct front-delt work — pressing already covers it. • Include only if the anterior deltoid is a genuine lagging point.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the lower back neutral; brace hard.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Shoulder impingement • Lower back pain	
PROGRESSION	Use a plate held with both hands, raised to eye level.		
REGRESSION	Band front raise with light tension.		
ALTERNATIVES	Dumbbell Lateral Raise, Landmine Press, Machine Shoulder Press		
RECORD ID	EX-0060		
TAGS #shoulders #front-delt #isolation			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0060::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0060::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Upright Row (Wide Grip)		EX-0061 Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Shoulders	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Lateral deltoid, upper trapezius	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Biceps brachii, rhomboids
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, EZ bar or cable	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-55
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-12
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Exhale pulling, inhale lowering.
EXECUTION 1. Grip the bar wider than shoulder width — a narrow grip drives impingement. 2. Stand tall, bar resting against the thighs. 3. Pull the bar up by driving the elbows out and up, stopping at chest height. 4. Lower under control.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Using a narrow grip and pulling the bar to the chin. • Letting the wrists bend sharply. • Shrugging the bar with the traps.		COACH TIPS • Stop the elbows at shoulder height. Higher creates internal impingement. • Use a wide grip or switch to a face pull if the shoulders complain.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Discontinue immediately if you feel a pinch at the front of the shoulder.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Shoulder impingement • Rotator cuff tear • History of shoulder surgery	
PROGRESSION	Add load with a wide grip, or use a cable for smoother resistance.		
REGRESSION	Face pull or lateral raise — safer and equally effective.		
ALTERNATIVES	Face Pull, Dumbbell Lateral Raise, Barbell Shrug		
RECORD ID	EX-0061		

TAGS #shoulders #traps #vertical-pull #caution

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0061::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0061::3set_full_rom_30s]

Pike Push-Up

EX-0062 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Shoulders	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Lateral deltoid, triceps brachii, upper trapezius, serratus anterior
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	7.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-60
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	6-12
REST	75-90 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. From a push-up position, walk the feet in and pike the hips high.
2. The torso should be nearly vertical, head between the arms.
3. Bend the elbows and lower the crown of the head toward the floor.
4. Press back up to a fully extended arm position.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Not piking enough, so it becomes a decline push-up.
- Letting the head touch hard.
- Flaring the elbows to 90 degrees.

COACH TIPS

- Elevate the feet on a box to make it harder — this is the road to a handstand push-up.
- Keep the elbows at roughly 45 degrees from the torso.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Place a folded towel under the head.
- Warm the shoulders fully first.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Shoulder impingement**
- **Uncontrolled hypertension**
- **Glaucoma**
- **Vertigo**

PROGRESSION	Elevate the feet, then attempt wall-supported handstand push-ups.
REGRESSION	Standard push-up or incline pike push-up with hands elevated.
ALTERNATIVES	Standing Barbell Overhead Press, Machine Shoulder Press, Standard Push-Up
RECORD ID	EX-0062

TAGS #shoulders #bodyweight #calisthenics #vertical-press #no-equipment

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0062::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0062::3set_full_rom_30s]

Cuban Rotation / External Rotation (Band)

EX-0063 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Shoulders	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Infraspinatus, teres minor	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Posterior deltoid, rhomboids
EQUIPMENT	Light band or 1-2 kg dumbbell	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	2.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-85
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-2
SETS	2-3	REPS	15-20 per side
REST	30-45 s	BREATHING	Exhale rotating out, inhale returning.

EXECUTION

1. Tuck the elbow against the ribs, bent to 90 degrees, forearm across the belly.
2. Keeping the elbow pinned, rotate the forearm outward.
3. Stop when the forearm points straight ahead; do not force further.
4. Return slowly.

COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the elbow drift away from the ribs. • Using far too much resistance. • Rotating the whole torso.		COACH TIPS • The rotator cuff is an endurance muscle group. Light load, 15-20 reps. • Place a rolled towel between the elbow and ribs to lock the elbow in.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Never load this heavily — the cuff tendons are small.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute rotator cuff tear (post-surgical protocols only under supervision)	
PROGRESSION	Progress to a side-lying dumbbell external rotation.		
REGRESSION	Isometric external rotation against a wall.		
ALTERNATIVES	Face Pull, Band Pull-Apart, Reverse Fly (Dumbbell)		
RECORD ID	EX-0063		
TAGS #shoulders #rotator-cuff #prehab #corrective #warm-up			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0063::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0063::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Barbell Curl		EX-0064 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Biceps	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Biceps brachii	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Brachialis, brachioradialis, forearm flexors
EQUIPMENT	Barbell or EZ bar	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	8-12
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling, inhale lowering.
EXECUTION 1. Stand tall, bar at arm's length, shoulder-width underhand grip. 2. Pin the elbows to the ribs and brace the core. 3. Curl the bar up by flexing the elbows only, stopping at chest height. 4. Lower under control to full extension.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Swinging the torso and using the lower back as a lever. • Letting the elbows travel forward, turning it into a front raise. • Cutting the descent short and losing the strongest range.		COACH TIPS • A curl the torso helps with is not a curl. • Use an EZ bar if straight-bar curls irritate the wrists.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Do not hyperextend the lumbar spine at the top of a heavy set.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Elbow tendinopathy • Wrist injury (use an EZ bar)	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or slow the eccentric to 4 seconds.		
REGRESSION	Dumbbell curl or cable curl.		
ALTERNATIVES	Dumbbell Curl, Preacher Curl, Cable Curl		
RECORD ID	EX-0064		
TAGS #biceps #isolation #barbell #hypertrophy #gym			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0064::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0064::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Dumbbell Curl (Alternating)				EX-0065 Beginner
CATEGORY	Biceps	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Biceps brachii	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Brachialis, forearm flexors	
EQUIPMENT	Two dumbbells	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	4.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-80	
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1	

SETS	3	REPS	10-12 per side
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling, inhale lowering.
EXECUTION			
1. Stand tall, dumbbells at the sides, palms facing in. 2. Curl the right dumbbell, supinating the palm to face up as you rise. 3. Squeeze at the top, lower slowly, then repeat on the left.			
COMMON MISTAKES		COACH TIPS	
• Swinging the shoulder forward. • Not supinating fully. • Dropping the weight on the descent.		• Full supination maximises biceps shortening at the top. • Alternating gives each arm a rest and lets you use strict form.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST	
• Keep the wrists neutral, not bent back.		• Elbow tendinopathy	
PROGRESSION	Curl both arms simultaneously, or add a 2-second peak squeeze.		
REGRESSION	Seated dumbbell curl with back supported.		
ALTERNATIVES	Barbell Curl, Hammer Curl, Concentration Curl		
RECORD ID	EX-0065		
TAGS #biceps #isolation #dumbbell #home #hypertrophy			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0065::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0065::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Hammer Curl		EX-0066 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Biceps	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Brachialis, brachioradialis	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Biceps brachii
EQUIPMENT	Two dumbbells or rope on a low pulley	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-80
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-12
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling, inhale lowering.
EXECUTION 1. Hold the dumbbells with a neutral grip (palms facing each other). 2. Pin the elbows, curl the weights up without rotating the wrists. 3. Squeeze, then lower under control.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Swinging. • Letting the wrists rotate into a standard curl. • Elbows drifting forward.		COACH TIPS • The brachialis sits under the biceps — building it pushes the biceps up and adds arm width. • Usually allows 10-15% more load than a supinated curl.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the shoulders down and back.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Elbow tendinopathy • Wrist injury	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or use a rope cable hammer curl for constant tension.		
REGRESSION	Seated hammer curl with lighter dumbbells.		
ALTERNATIVES	Dumbbell Curl (Alternating), Reverse Curl, Cable Curl		
RECORD ID	EX-0066		
TAGS #biceps #brachialis #forearms #isolation #dumbbell MEDIA [IMG::EX-0066::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0066::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Preacher Curl				EX-0067 Intermediate
CATEGORY	Biceps	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Biceps brachii (short head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Brachialis	

EQUIPMENT	Preacher bench, EZ bar or dumbbell	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-65
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	4-0-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	8-12
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Set the pad so the armpits rest on the top edge.
2. Grip the bar underhand, arms resting fully on the pad.
3. Curl up to roughly 90 degrees of elbow flexion.
4. Lower slowly until the arms are almost straight — never snap into lockout.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the arms slam into full extension at the bottom under load.
- Lifting the elbows off the pad.
- Going too heavy on a movement built for control.

COACH TIPS

- The preacher bench eliminates all cheating, which is exactly the point.
- Stop just short of full lockout to protect the distal biceps tendon.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Have a spotter hand you the bar if going heavy.
- Never drop into the bottom with a straight arm.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Distal biceps tendinopathy
- Elbow hyperextension

PROGRESSION	Progress to single-arm dumbbell preacher curls.
REGRESSION	Standing dumbbell curl.
ALTERNATIVES	Barbell Curl, Concentration Curl, Cable Curl
RECORD ID	EX-0067

TAGS #biceps #isolation #strict #hypertrophy #gym

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0067::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0067::3set_full_rom_30s]

Incline Dumbbell Curl

EX-0068 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Biceps	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Biceps brachii (long head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Brachialis
EQUIPMENT	Two dumbbells, incline bench at 45-60 degrees	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-65
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	4-0-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-12
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Sit back on a 45-60 degree incline, arms hanging straight down behind the torso.
2. Curl both dumbbells without letting the elbows move forward.
3. Squeeze at the top, then lower to a full stretch.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the elbows swing forward to reduce the stretch.
- Using heavy dumbbells that force a shoulder assist.

COACH TIPS

- The behind-the-body arm position stretches the long head — nothing else does this.
- Expect to use less weight than a standing curl. That is correct.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Do not bounce out of the bottom stretch.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Shoulder impingement
- Biceps tendinopathy

PROGRESSION	Lower the bench angle to increase the stretch.
REGRESSION	Standing dumbbell curl.
ALTERNATIVES	Dumbbell Curl (Alternating), Preacher Curl, Cable Curl
RECORD ID	EX-0068

TAGS [#biceps](#) [#long-head](#) [#stretch-position](#) [#isolation](#) [#hypertrophy](#)
 MEDIA [IMG::EX-0068::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0068::3set_full_rom_30s]

Concentration Curl

EX-0069 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Biceps	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Biceps brachii (peak)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Brachialis
EQUIPMENT	One dumbbell, bench	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	3.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	2-3	REPS	10-15 per side
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Sit on a bench, feet wide; brace the working elbow against the inner thigh.
2. Let the arm hang straight, dumbbell in hand.
3. Curl the weight toward the opposite shoulder, supinating fully.
4. Squeeze for one second, then lower to full extension.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using the leg to push the elbow.
- Rocking the torso.
- Half-repping at the bottom.

COACH TIPS

- Shows the highest biceps EMG activation of any curl variation.
- Great finishing move; keep it light and slow.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep the back flat rather than hunched over the knee.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Elbow tendinopathy**

PROGRESSION	Add a 3-second peak hold.
REGRESSION	Seated dumbbell curl with the arm free.
ALTERNATIVES	Preacher Curl, Dumbbell Curl (Alternating), Cable Curl
RECORD ID	EX-0069

TAGS [#biceps](#) [#isolation](#) [#peak-contraction](#) [#finisher](#)
 MEDIA [IMG::EX-0069::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0069::3set_full_rom_30s]

Cable Curl

EX-0070 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Biceps	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Biceps brachii	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Brachialis, forearm flexors
EQUIPMENT	Cable machine, low pulley, straight or EZ bar	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-75
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-15
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Stand facing a low pulley, grip the bar underhand, elbows pinned.
2. Curl the bar up to chest height without moving the elbows.
3. Lower slowly against the cable.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Leaning back to complete reps.
- Letting the stack pull the arms down fast.

COACH TIPS

- Cables hold tension even at the bottom, where free weights unload.
- A rope attachment lets you finish with a hammer-grip squeeze.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Stand far enough back that the stack does not clang.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Elbow tendinopathy**

PROGRESSION	Add a drop set on the last round.
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REGRESSION	Resistance band curl.
ALTERNATIVES	Barbell Curl, Hammer Curl, Preacher Curl
RECORD ID	EX-0070
TAGS #biceps #cable #isolation #constant-tension	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0070::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0070::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Reverse Curl

EX-0071 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Biceps	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Brachioradialis, brachialis	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Wrist extensors, biceps brachii
EQUIPMENT	EZ bar, barbell or dumbbells	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	3.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-15
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Grip the bar overhand at shoulder width, arms straight.
2. Pin the elbows and curl the bar up, keeping the knuckles pointing up.
3. Lower slowly to full extension.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the wrists collapse into flexion.
- Using biceps-curl loads — expect roughly 60% of that weight.

COACH TIPS

- Directly builds the brachioradialis and the wrist extensors.
- Excellent for climbers, racquet-sport athletes and anyone with elbow pain.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep the wrists rigid and straight.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute lateral epicondylitis (tennis elbow) — reintroduce gradually**

PROGRESSION	Add load, or use a thick-grip bar.
REGRESSION	Dumbbell reverse curl with a lighter load.
ALTERNATIVES	Hammer Curl, Wrist Extension, Farmer's Carry
RECORD ID	EX-0071

TAGS [#biceps](#) [#forearms](#) [#brachioradialis](#) [#elbow-health](#) [#isolation](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0071::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0071::3set_full_rom_30s]

Close-Grip Bench Press

EX-0072 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Triceps	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major, anterior deltoid
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, flat bench, rack	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-60
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	6-10
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Lie on a flat bench and grip the bar at roughly shoulder width — not narrower.
2. Tuck the elbows to about 30 degrees from the torso.
3. Lower the bar to the lower sternum, keeping the forearms vertical.
4. Press up, driving through the triceps.

COMMON MISTAKES • Gripping so narrow the wrists are forced into pain. • Flaring the elbows. • Bouncing the bar off the ribs.		COACH TIPS • Shoulder-width is the sweet spot. Narrower does not add triceps, it adds wrist strain. • The best mass-builder for the triceps because it allows heavy load.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Use a spotter or safety pins.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Wrist injury • Elbow tendinopathy • Shoulder impingement	
PROGRESSION	Add load; then progress to a board press for lockout overload.		
REGRESSION	Machine triceps press or diamond push-up.		
ALTERNATIVES	Diamond Push-Up, Triceps Dip, Skull Crusher		
RECORD ID	EX-0072		
TAGS #triceps #compound #push #strength #gym			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0072::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0072::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Skull Crusher (Lying Triceps Extension)

EX-0073 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Triceps	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii (long head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anconeus
EQUIPMENT	EZ bar or dumbbells, flat bench	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-60
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	8-12
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Inhale lowering, exhale extending.

EXECUTION

1. Lie flat, holding an EZ bar above the chest with a shoulder-width grip.
2. Angle the arms back slightly so the elbows point toward the ceiling and a little back.
3. Bend only the elbows, lowering the bar toward the forehead or just behind the head.
4. Extend the elbows to press the bar back up without moving the upper arms.

COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the upper arms drift back and forth (turning it into a pullover). • Going too heavy and losing control near the head. • Locking out violently and hyperextending the elbows.		COACH TIPS • Lower behind the head rather than to the forehead to increase long-head stretch. • Use an EZ bar; a straight bar torques the wrists.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Use a spotter. • Never let the bar drop toward the face.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Elbow tendinopathy • Elbow hyperextension • Shoulder impingement	

PROGRESSION	Add load, or move to an overhead cable extension for constant tension.
REGRESSION	Dumbbell skull crusher, or a triceps pushdown.
ALTERNATIVES	Overhead Triceps Extension, Triceps Pushdown, Close-Grip Bench Press
RECORD ID	EX-0073
TAGS #triceps #long-head #isolation #hypertrophy #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0073::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0073::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Overhead Triceps Extension (Cable or Dumbbell)

EX-0074 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Triceps	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii (long head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anconeus
EQUIPMENT	Rope on a low pulley, or one dumbbell	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-75

ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-15
REST	60 s	BREATHING	Exhale extending, inhale lowering.
EXECUTION 1. Face away from a low pulley with the rope held overhead behind the head. 2. Keep the elbows tight and pointing forward, upper arms fixed. 3. Extend the elbows until the arms are straight overhead. 4. Lower slowly until a deep stretch is felt behind the arm.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the elbows flare wide. • Moving the upper arms. • Arching the lower back at lockout.		COACH TIPS • Only overhead positions fully stretch the triceps long head. Do not skip these. • Brace the abs so the ribcage does not flare.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the load moderate; the overhead position stresses the elbow.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Shoulder impingement in flexion • Elbow tendinopathy • Lower back pain	
PROGRESSION		Single-arm version for greater range; or add a 2-second stretch pause.	
REGRESSION		Seated dumbbell overhead extension with back support.	
ALTERNATIVES		Skull Crusher (Lying Triceps Extension), Triceps Pushdown, Triceps Dip	
RECORD ID		EX-0074	
TAGS #triceps #long-head #stretch-position #isolation #cable			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0074::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0074::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Triceps Pushdown (Rope)		EX-0075 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Triceps	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii (lateral head)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anconeus
EQUIPMENT	Cable machine, high pulley, rope	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-78
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-15
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale pushing down, inhale returning.
EXECUTION			
1. Face a high pulley, rope in both hands, elbows pinned to the ribs.			
2. Push down and separate the rope ends at the bottom.			
3. Squeeze the triceps for one second, then let the rope rise to a full stretch.			
COMMON MISTAKES		COACH TIPS	
• Letting the elbows drift forward and away from the ribs.		• Pinning the elbows is the entire technique. Everything else is detail.	
• Leaning forward to use bodyweight.		• Spreading the rope at the bottom adds a peak contraction.	
• Shrugging the shoulders.			
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST	
• Do not let the stack pull the arms up quickly.		• Elbow tendinopathy	
PROGRESSION	Drop set, or switch to a single-arm reverse-grip pushdown.		
REGRESSION	Resistance band pushdown.		
ALTERNATIVES	Overhead Triceps Extension, Close-Grip Bench Press, Triceps Dip		
RECORD ID	EX-0075		
TAGS #triceps #cable #isolation #beginner-safe #hypertrophy			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0075::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0075::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Triceps Dip (Bench)

EX-0076 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Triceps	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anterior deltoid, pectoralis major
EQUIPMENT	Bench or sturdy chair	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	5.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-65
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	10-20
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Sit on the edge of a bench, hands beside the hips, fingers pointing forward.
2. Slide the hips off the edge, legs extended or knees bent.
3. Lower the body by bending the elbows straight back to roughly 90 degrees.
4. Press back up without locking out aggressively.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Descending too deep, which forces the shoulder into extreme extension.
- Letting the hips drift away from the bench.
- Flaring the elbows outward.

COACH TIPS

- Stop at 90 degrees of elbow bend. Deeper is a shoulder injury waiting to happen.
- Bend the knees to regress; extend the legs or add a plate to progress.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Do not use a rolling chair.
- Stop at once if the front of the shoulder pinches.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Shoulder impingement
- Anterior shoulder instability
- Wrist injury

PROGRESSION

Elevate the feet, or rest a plate on the thighs.

REGRESSION

Bend the knees and keep the feet close to the bench.

ALTERNATIVES

Parallel Bar Triceps Dip, Diamond Push-Up, Triceps Pushdown (Rope)

RECORD ID

EX-0076

TAGS #triceps #bodyweight #home #no-equipment #travel

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0076::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0076::3set_full_rom_30s]

Parallel Bar Triceps Dip

EX-0077 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Triceps	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (lower), anterior deltoid
EQUIPMENT	Parallel bars or dip station	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	8.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-55
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	6-12
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Mount the bars with the arms locked and the torso upright.
2. Keep the elbows tucked close to the ribs throughout.
3. Lower until the upper arms are parallel to the floor.
4. Press back up, staying vertical (a forward lean shifts load to the chest).

COMMON MISTAKES

- Leaning forward, which converts it into a chest dip.
- Descending past parallel.
- Shrugging at the bottom.

COACH TIPS

- Torso upright, elbows in. That is the triceps version.
- Depress the shoulder blades hard at the top of every rep.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Progress with assisted dips before attempting bodyweight.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Shoulder impingement • Sternoclavicular pain • Elbow tendinopathy
PROGRESSION	Add a dip belt with 5-10 kg.	
REGRESSION	Band-assisted dip or bench dip.	
ALTERNATIVES	Triceps Dip (Bench), Close-Grip Bench Press, Chest Dip	
RECORD ID	EX-0077	
TAGS #triceps #bodyweight #calisthenics #advanced #compound		
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0077::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0077::3set_full_rom_30s]		

Diamond Push-Up (Triceps Focus)				EX-0078 Intermediate
CATEGORY	Triceps	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Pectoralis major (inner), anterior deltoid	
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight	
ENERGY COST	7.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength, General Fitness	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-60	
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0	
SETS	3	REPS	6-15	
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.	
EXECUTION 1. Place the hands under the sternum, index fingers and thumbs touching. 2. Hold a rigid plank; squeeze the glutes. 3. Lower with the elbows tracking backwards along the ribs. 4. Press up to lockout.				
COMMON MISTAKES • Flaring the elbows. • Placing the hands too far forward. • Hips rising before the chest.		COACH TIPS • Keep the elbows brushing the ribcage — that is what makes it a triceps move. • If the wrists hurt, do it on fists or push-up handles.		
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Warm the wrists thoroughly.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Wrist injury • Elbow tendinopathy		
PROGRESSION		Elevate the feet or wear a weight vest.		
REGRESSION		Diamond push-up with the knees on the floor.		
ALTERNATIVES		Close-Grip Bench Press, Triceps Dip (Bench), Triceps Pushdown (Rope)		
RECORD ID		EX-0078		
TAGS #triceps #bodyweight #no-equipment #home #travel				
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0078::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0078::3set_full_rom_30s]				

Resistance Band Triceps Pushdown				EX-0079 Beginner
CATEGORY	Triceps	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Triceps brachii	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Anconeus	
EQUIPMENT	Resistance band, high anchor (door or bar)	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	3.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Muscle Gain	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-80	
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1	
SETS	3	REPS	15-20	
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale pushing, inhale returning.	

EXECUTION

1. Anchor a band overhead and grip both ends with the elbows pinned.
2. Push down until the arms are straight, squeezing at the bottom.
3. Let the band draw the hands back up slowly.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Elbows drifting forward.
- Standing too close so the band has no tension.

COACH TIPS

- Step further from the anchor to increase resistance.
- The perfect hostel or hotel-room triceps builder.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Inspect the band before each session.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Elbow tendinopathy**

PROGRESSION

Thicker band or a single-arm version.

REGRESSION

Diamond push-up with knees down.

ALTERNATIVES

Triceps Pushdown (Rope), Diamond Push-Up, Overhead Triceps Extension

RECORD ID

EX-0079

TAGS [#triceps](#) [#resistance-band](#) [#travel](#) [#hostel](#) [#home](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0079::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0079::3set_full_rom_30s]

Wrist Curl (Flexion)

EX-0080 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Forearms	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Wrist flexors (flexor carpi radialis/ulnaris)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Finger flexors
EQUIPMENT	Light barbell or dumbbells, bench	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	3.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-75
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	15-20
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Sit and rest the forearms on the thighs, palms facing up, wrists past the knees.
2. Let the bar roll down to the fingertips.
3. Curl the fingers closed, then flex the wrist upward as far as possible.
4. Lower slowly to a full stretch.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using heavy weight and bouncing the wrist.
- Lifting the forearms off the thighs.
- Skipping the finger roll.

COACH TIPS

- The finger roll at the bottom doubles the range and the grip benefit.
- High reps (15-20) suit the forearms' fibre composition.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Stop at once if you feel numbness or tingling into the hand.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Carpal tunnel syndrome**
- **Acute wrist injury**
- **Medial epicondylitis**

PROGRESSION

Add load slowly, or use a wrist roller.

REGRESSION

Squeeze a stress ball or hand gripper.

ALTERNATIVES

Wrist Extension, Farmer's Carry, Reverse Curl

RECORD ID

EX-0080

TAGS [#forearms](#) [#grip](#) [#isolation](#) [#wrist-health](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0080::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0080::3set_full_rom_30s]

Wrist Extension

EX-0081 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Forearms	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Wrist extensors (extensor carpi radialis)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Finger extensors
EQUIPMENT	Very light dumbbell or band	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	2.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness

SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-85
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	15-20
REST	30-45 s	BREATHING	Exhale lifting, inhale lowering.
EXECUTION			
1. Rest the forearm on the thigh, palm facing down, wrist past the knee. 2. Lower the hand as far as comfortable. 3. Lift the back of the hand toward the ceiling, then lower slowly.			
COMMON MISTAKES		COACH TIPS	
• Loading far too heavily. • Lifting the forearm off the support.		• The single most useful drill for tennis elbow prevention and rehab. • Use 1-2 kg. That is genuinely enough.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST	
• Progress very slowly if you have current elbow pain.		• Acute lateral epicondylitis flare-up	
PROGRESSION	Add a 3-second eccentric — the eccentric drives tendon adaptation.		
REGRESSION	Rubber-band finger extension.		
ALTERNATIVES	Wrist Curl (Flexion), Reverse Curl, Farmer's Carry		
RECORD ID	EX-0081		
TAGS #forearms #elbow-health #prehab #office #corrective			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0081::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0081::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Farmer's Carry

EX-0082 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Forearms	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Forearm flexors, upper trapezius	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Core, glutes, erector spinae, quadriceps
EQUIPMENT	Two heavy dumbbells, kettlebells or farmer's handles	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	7.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Fat Loss, Athletic, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	N/A
SETS	3-4	REPS	30-40 m or 40-60 s
REST	90 s	BREATHING	Breathe shallowly and continuously; never hold your breath for the whole carry.
EXECUTION 1. Deadlift a heavy weight into each hand and stand tall. 2. Set the shoulders back and down, ribcage stacked over the pelvis. 3. Walk with controlled, normal-length steps. 4. Set the weights down under control — do not drop them.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Leaning to one side. • Shrugging the shoulders up to the ears. • Taking tiny shuffling steps.		COACH TIPS • The most transferable exercise in the entire database — grip, core, posture, work capacity. • Distance or time, not reps. 30-40 m per set is a good target.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Clear the walking path. • Use straps only once grip is the true limiter.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain • Uncontrolled hypertension	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or switch to a single-arm suitcase carry for anti-lateral-flexion.		
REGRESSION	Lighter dumbbells, shorter distance.		
ALTERNATIVES	Suitcase Carry, Barbell Shrug, Wrist Curl (Flexion)		
RECORD ID	EX-0082		
TAGS #forearms #grip #carry #core #functional #athletic			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0082::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0082::3set full rom 30s]			

Suitcase Carry		EX-0083 Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Forearms	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Forearm flexors, obliques	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Quadratus lumborum, gluteus medius, trapezius
EQUIPMENT	One heavy dumbbell or kettlebell	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Athletic, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	N/A
SETS	3	REPS	20-30 m per side
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Breathe continuously; brace the trunk.
EXECUTION			
1. Hold a single heavy weight in one hand at the side. 2. Stand perfectly tall — resist the pull to lean toward the weight. 3. Walk 20-30 m maintaining level shoulders and hips. 4. Switch hands and repeat.			
COMMON MISTAKES		COACH TIPS	
• Leaning toward or away from the weight. • Letting the shoulder on the loaded side drop. • Rotating the pelvis.		• This is a core exercise disguised as a grip exercise. • Film yourself from the front once — most people lean far more than they think.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST	
• Start with about 25% of bodyweight in one hand.		• Acute lower back pain • Scoliosis with pain	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or perform an overhead waiter's carry.		
REGRESSION	Reduce the weight and shorten the distance.		
ALTERNATIVES	Farmer's Carry, Side Plank, Pallof Press		
RECORD ID	EX-0083		
TAGS #forearms #grip #anti-lateral-flexion #core #carry #functional			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0083::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0083::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Legs

Barbell Back Squat		EX-0084 Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Adductor magnus, erector spinae, hamstrings, core
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, squat rack with safeties	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	8.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-65
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3-5	REPS	5-10
REST	150-240 s	BREATHING	Big breath in and brace at the top; hold through the descent, exhale on the way up.
EXECUTION 1. Set the bar on the upper traps (high bar) or across the rear delts (low bar). 2. Unrack, take two steps back, feet shoulder-width, toes turned out 15-30 degrees. 3. Brace the abdominals, break at the hips and knees together, and descend. 4. Reach at least parallel — hip crease level with the knee — then drive the floor away. 5. Stand tall without hyperextending the lower back.			

COMMON MISTAKES • Knees caving inward under load (valgus collapse). • The hips shooting up first, turning the squat into a good morning. • Heels lifting off the floor. • Rounding the lower back at the bottom (butt wink under load).		COACH TIPS • Screw the feet into the floor to create external rotation torque at the hips. • The bar must stay over the mid-foot for the entire rep. • Depth is limited by ankle and hip mobility, not by willpower.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Always set the safety pins just below your bottom position. • Never squat with a rounded lower back under load.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute knee or lower back injury • Uncontrolled hypertension • Severe ankle mobility restriction (fix the mobility first)	
PROGRESSION	Add 2.5 kg per session; then add pause squats and tempo squats.		
REGRESSION	Goblet squat or box squat to a controlled depth.		
ALTERNATIVES	Goblet Squat, Front Squat, Leg Press		
RECORD ID	EX-0084		
TAGS #legs #quads #glutes #squat #compound #strength #gym			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0084::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0084::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Front Squat		EX-0085 Advanced	
CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, erector spinae, upper back, core
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, squat rack	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	7.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	17-55
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3-5	REPS	4-8
REST	150-240 s	BREATHING	Brace at the top, exhale on the ascent.
EXECUTION 1. Rack the bar across the front delts, fingers under the bar, elbows high. 2. Keep the elbows pointing forward throughout — dropping them dumps the bar. 3. Descend with a vertical torso, knees travelling forward over the toes. 4. Drive up out of the hole, keeping the chest tall.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Elbows dropping, which rounds the upper back and drops the bar. • Attempting a full grip when wrist mobility does not allow it. • Leaning forward like a back squat.		COACH TIPS • Use a two- or three-finger grip if wrist mobility is limited; the shelf is the delts, not the hands. • Front squats punish forward lean instantly — an excellent form teacher.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Learn to dump the bar forward safely before going heavy. • Set the safeties.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Wrist injury • Poor thoracic mobility • Acute knee injury	
PROGRESSION	Add load; then progress to pause front squats.		
REGRESSION	Goblet squat or Zercher squat.		
ALTERNATIVES	Goblet Squat, Barbell Back Squat, Leg Press		
RECORD ID	EX-0085		
TAGS #legs #quads #squat #compound #advanced #olympic-accessory			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0085::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0085::3set full rom 30s]			

Goblet Squat				EX-0086 Beginner
CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Adductors, core, upper back	
EQUIPMENT	One kettlebell or dumbbell	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	

ENERGY COST	6.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, General Fitness, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-75
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-15
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Hold a kettlebell by the horns at chest height, elbows tucked in.
2. Feet shoulder-width, toes slightly out.
3. Squat down between the legs, keeping the chest tall and the elbows inside the knees.
4. Pause at the bottom, then drive up through the whole foot.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the weight pull the chest forward.
- Knees caving in.
- Bouncing out of the bottom.

COACH TIPS

- The counterweight at the chest automatically teaches an upright torso.
- The single best squat teaching tool. Every beginner should start here.
- Use the elbows to gently push the knees out at the bottom.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Choose a weight you can control for 10 clean reps.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute knee pain
- Severe hip impingement

PROGRESSION	Add load, then move to a front or back squat.
REGRESSION	Bodyweight box squat to a chair.
ALTERNATIVES	Barbell Back Squat, Bodyweight Squat, Leg Press
RECORD ID	EX-0086
TAGS #legs #quads #squat #kettlebell #beginner-safe #home	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0086::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0086::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Bodyweight Squat

EX-0087 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, core, calves
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	5.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	6-85
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	15-25
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Stand with feet shoulder-width, toes slightly out, arms extended forward for balance.
2. Push the hips back and down, keeping the chest up.
3. Descend until the thighs are parallel to the floor, or as low as control allows.
4. Drive through the whole foot to stand tall.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Knees caving inward.
- Heels lifting.
- Rounding the lower back to reach depth.

COACH TIPS

- Push the knees out over the second and third toes.
- If the heels lift, place a 2 cm plate or book under them while you fix ankle mobility.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Squat to a chair if balance is uncertain.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute knee injury
- Severe balance impairment (use a chair squat instead)

PROGRESSION	Add tempo, then a goblet squat, then jump squats.
REGRESSION	Box squat to a chair, standing back up with hands on the thighs.
ALTERNATIVES	Goblet Squat, Chair Squat, Wall Sit
RECORD ID	EX-0087

TAGS [#legs](#) [#bodyweight](#) [#squat](#) [#home](#) [#no-equipment](#) [#travel](#) [#kids](#)
 MEDIA [IMG::EX-0087::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0087::3set_full_rom_30s]

Bulgarian Split Squat

EX-0088 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Adductors, hamstrings, gluteus medius, core
EQUIPMENT	Bench or box; dumbbells optional	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	7.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength, Athletic, Fat Loss
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-65
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	8-12 per side
REST	75-90 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Place the top of the rear foot on a bench roughly knee height.
2. Step the front foot far enough forward that the shin stays near vertical at the bottom.
3. Lower straight down until the rear knee nearly touches the floor.
4. Drive up through the front heel; the rear leg only balances.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Front foot too close, forcing the knee far past the toes.
- Pushing off the rear foot.
- Torso collapsing forward under load.

COACH TIPS

- Shift the torso forward slightly to bias the glutes; stay upright to bias the quads.
- Brutally effective, and it exposes side-to-side imbalances that squats hide.
- Start with bodyweight only — most people cannot do 10 clean reps.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Use a low box first.
- Hold a rack for balance if needed.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute knee pain**
- **Severe balance impairment**

PROGRESSION	Add dumbbells, then a front-racked barbell.
REGRESSION	Static split squat with both feet on the floor.
ALTERNATIVES	Reverse Lunge, Static Split Squat, Step-Up
RECORD ID	EX-0088

TAGS [#legs](#) [#quads](#) [#glutes](#) [#unilateral](#) [#balance](#) [#hypertrophy](#)
 MEDIA [IMG::EX-0088::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0088::3set_full_rom_30s]

Reverse Lunge

EX-0089 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, adductors, core
EQUIPMENT	Bodyweight or dumbbells	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	6.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, General Fitness, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-70
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	10-12 per side
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Inhale stepping back, exhale standing.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall, feet hip-width.
2. Step one foot back and lower until both knees reach about 90 degrees.
3. Keep the front shin vertical and the torso upright.
4. Drive through the front heel to return to standing.

COMMON MISTAKES - Letting the front knee cave inward. - Stepping back too short, crowding the front knee. - Slamming the rear knee into the floor.		COACH TIPS - Reverse lunges load the knee less than forward lunges — the default choice for knee pain. - Keep 80% of the weight in the front leg.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS Perform near a wall if balance is a concern.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST - Acute knee injury - Balance disorders	
PROGRESSION	Add dumbbells; then progress to walking lunges or deficit reverse lunges.		
REGRESSION	Step-up to a low box, or a static split squat.		
ALTERNATIVES	Bulgarian Split Squat, Walking Lunge, Step-Up		
RECORD ID	EX-0089		
TAGS #legs #quads #glutes #unilateral #knee-friendly #home			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0089::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0089::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Walking Lunge

EX-0090 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, adductors, gluteus medius, core
EQUIPMENT	Bodyweight or dumbbells	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	7.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-60
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-0-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	20-30 total steps
REST	75-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale as you rise out of each lunge.

EXECUTION

- Step forward into a lunge, lowering until both knees are at 90 degrees.
- Drive through the front heel and bring the rear foot forward into the next lunge.
- Keep the torso tall and the steps consistent in length.

COMMON MISTAKES • Short steps, which push the knee far past the toes. • Torso pitching forward. • Losing balance and staggering sideways.		COACH TIPS • A long stride biases the glutes; a shorter stride biases the quads. • Excellent metabolic conditioning when done for distance.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Clear a straight path. • Do not perform on slippery flooring.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute knee pain • Patellar tendinopathy • Balance disorders	
PROGRESSION	Add dumbbells or a front-racked barbell.		
REGRESSION	Reverse lunge in place.		
ALTERNATIVES	Reverse Lunge, Bulgarian Split Squat, Step-Up		
RECORD ID	EX-0090		
TAGS #legs #quads #glutes #unilateral #conditioning #outdoor			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0090::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0090::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Step-Up

EX-0091 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, gluteus medius, calves
EQUIPMENT	Box, bench or step; dumbbells optional	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	6.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, General Fitness, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-80
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-0-1-0

SETS	3	REPS	10-12 per side
REST	60 s	BREATHING	Exhale stepping up, inhale stepping down.
EXECUTION 1. Place one full foot on a box roughly knee height. 2. Drive through that heel to stand fully on top of the box. 3. Control the descent, tapping the floor lightly with the other foot. 4. Complete all reps on one side, then switch.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Pushing off the bottom leg to help. • Using a box so high the hip has to hike. • Dropping down with no eccentric control.		COACH TIPS • The bottom foot should be able to hover — that proves the top leg is doing the work. • Lower the box for knee pain; raise it for a glute emphasis. • Superb for seniors, runners and rehab.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Test the box for stability. • Keep the full foot on the box, not just the toes.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute knee injury • Severe balance impairment	
PROGRESSION		Raise the box or add dumbbells.	
REGRESSION		Lower the box to 15-20 cm.	
ALTERNATIVES		Reverse Lunge, Bulgarian Split Squat, Chair Squat	
RECORD ID		EX-0091	
TAGS #legs #quads #glutes #unilateral #scalable #senior-friendly #rehab			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0091::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0091::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Leg Press		EX-0092 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, adductors
EQUIPMENT	45-degree or horizontal leg press machine	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-78
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-15
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Inhale lowering, exhale pressing.
EXECUTION 1. Sit with the back and hips flat against the pad, feet shoulder-width on the platform. 2. Release the safeties and lower the platform until the knees reach about 90 degrees. 3. Stop before the lower back lifts off the pad. 4. Press back up without locking the knees hard.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Descending so deep the pelvis tucks and the lumbar spine rounds. • Snapping the knees into full lockout. • Placing the hands on the knees during the press.		COACH TIPS • Range of motion is capped by where the lower back lifts, not by the machine's travel. • High foot placement biases glutes and hamstrings; low placement biases quads. • The safest way to load the legs heavily without spinal compression.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Engage the safety catches before dismounting. • Never let the platform crash down.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute knee injury • Lumbar disc herniation (limit depth)	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or switch to a single-leg press.		
REGRESSION	Goblet squat with light load.		
ALTERNATIVES	Barbell Back Squat, Hack Squat, Goblet Squat		
RECORD ID	EX-0092		
TAGS #legs #quads #machine #beginner-safe #spine-friendly #gym MEDIA [IMG::EX-0092::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0092::3set full rom 30s]			

Hack Squat (Machine)		EX-0093 Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps (especially vastus lateralis)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, adductors
EQUIPMENT	Hack squat machine	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-65
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-12
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.
EXECUTION 1. Set the shoulders under the pads, back flat against the backrest. 2. Place the feet mid-platform, shoulder-width. 3. Descend until the thighs pass parallel, knees tracking over the toes. 4. Drive up through the whole foot without locking out hard.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Placing the feet too low, which shears the knee. • Letting the heels lift. • Bouncing at the bottom.		COACH TIPS • The fixed path lets you push closer to failure than a free squat. • Feet slightly forward protects the knees; feet low maximises quad stretch.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Engage the safety handles before dismounting.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute knee injury • Patellar tendinopathy	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or add a 3-second pause at the bottom.		
REGRESSION	Leg press.		
ALTERNATIVES	Leg Press, Barbell Back Squat, Front Squat		
RECORD ID	EX-0093		
TAGS #legs #quads #machine #hypertrophy #gym MEDIA [IMG::EX-0093::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0093::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Leg Extension		EX-0094 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps (rectus femoris emphasis)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	None significant
EQUIPMENT	Leg extension machine	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-78
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-15
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale extending, inhale lowering.
EXECUTION 1. Adjust the seat so the knee joint lines up with the machine's pivot. 2. Set the ankle pad just above the shoe line. 3. Extend the knees until the legs are straight; squeeze for one second. 4. Lower slowly under control.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Slamming the stack down. • Using momentum from the hips. • Loading so heavily that the knee is jerked into extension.		COACH TIPS • The only exercise that isolates the quadriceps completely. • Valuable for VMO strength and knee rehab under professional guidance. • Moderate load, controlled tempo, 12-15 reps.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Align the joint pivot correctly — misalignment is what gives this exercise its bad reputation.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute patellofemoral pain (reduce range) • Recent ACL reconstruction (follow physio protocol)	

PROGRESSION	Add a 2-second squeeze at lockout, or a slow 4-second eccentric.
REGRESSION	Reduce load and range; or perform a seated knee extension against a band.
ALTERNATIVES	Leg Press, Bulgarian Split Squat, Sissy Squat
RECORD ID	EX-0094
TAGS #legs #quads #isolation #machine #rehab	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0094::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0094::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Sissy Squat

EX-0095 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps (rectus femoris)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hip flexors, core
EQUIPMENT	None, or a sissy squat bench	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	5.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-50
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	8-12
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Hold a support with one hand; rise onto the balls of the feet.
2. Drive the knees forward while leaning the torso backwards.
3. Keep the hips, knees and shoulders in one straight line.
4. Descend as far as knee comfort allows, then squeeze back up.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Bending at the hips instead of staying in a straight line.
- Going too deep too soon.
- Attempting it with existing knee pain.

COACH TIPS

- A knees-over-toes movement that, trained progressively, builds knee resilience.
- Start with a very small range — 20 degrees of knee bend — and add slowly.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Progress over months, not weeks.
- Never train through sharp knee pain.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Patellar tendinopathy
- Meniscus injury
- Any acute knee pain
- Beginners

PROGRESSION	Reduce hand support, then add a weight plate on the chest.
REGRESSION	Kneeling quad stretch with a slight backward lean.
ALTERNATIVES	Leg Extension, Reverse Nordic Curl, Bulgarian Split Squat
RECORD ID	EX-0095
TAGS #legs #quads #knee-health #bodyweight #advanced	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0095::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0095::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Wall Sit

EX-0096 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Legs	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, calves, core
EQUIPMENT	Wall	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	4.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Fat Loss, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-80
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Isometric
SETS	3	REPS	20-60 s
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Breathe normally and continuously — never hold your breath.

EXECUTION

1. Stand with the back flat against a wall, feet about 50 cm forward.
2. Slide down until the knees and hips are both at 90 degrees.
3. Keep the whole back in contact with the wall and the weight in the heels.
4. Hold for the prescribed time.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Holding the breath, which spikes blood pressure.
- Letting the knees drift past the toes.
- Resting the hands on the thighs.

COACH TIPS

- An isometric hold with almost zero joint load — ideal for knee rehab.
- Start at 20 seconds and build to 60.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Do not perform to failure if you have hypertension.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Uncontrolled hypertension**
- **Acute patellofemoral pain (raise the depth)**

PROGRESSION

Extend the hold, or add a weight plate to the lap.

REGRESSION

Reduce the depth so the knee angle is 120 degrees.

ALTERNATIVES

Bodyweight Squat, Leg Extension, Glute Bridge

RECORD ID

EX-0096

TAGS [#legs](#) [#quads](#) [#isometric](#) [#home](#) [#no-equipment](#) [#rehab](#) [#office](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0096::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0096::3set_full_rom_30s]

Romanian Deadlift (Single Leg)

EX-0097 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Hamstrings	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Erector spinae, gluteus medius, ankle stabilisers
EQUIPMENT	One dumbbell or kettlebell	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	8-10 per side
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Inhale hinging, exhale standing.

EXECUTION

1. Stand on one leg, holding a weight in the opposite hand.
2. Hinge at the hip, letting the free leg extend straight behind as a counterbalance.
3. Keep the hips square — do not let the free hip rotate open.
4. Return to standing by squeezing the glute of the standing leg.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rotating the pelvis open.
- Rounding the lower back.
- Bending the standing knee excessively.

COACH TIPS

- Place a hand on a wall until balance improves.
- The best exercise for hamstring asymmetry and hamstring-strain prevention in runners.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Start with bodyweight only.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute hamstring strain**
- **Severe balance impairment**

PROGRESSION

Increase load, then remove the hand support entirely.

REGRESSION

Two-leg Romanian deadlift.

ALTERNATIVES

Romanian Deadlift, Nordic Hamstring Curl, Glute Bridge

RECORD ID

EX-0097

TAGS [#hamstrings](#) [#glutes](#) [#unilateral](#) [#balance](#) [#hinge](#) [#injury-prevention](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0097::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0097::3set_full_rom_30s]

Lying Leg Curl

EX-0098 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Hamstrings	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings (biceps femoris, semitendinosus)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gastrocnemius, gracilis
EQUIPMENT	Lying leg curl machine	LOAD TYPE	Equipment

ENERGY COST	4.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-78
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-15
REST	60 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling, inhale lowering.
EXECUTION 1. Lie face down with the knee joint aligned with the machine pivot. 2. Set the ankle pad just above the heels. 3. Curl the heels toward the glutes, squeezing at the top. 4. Lower slowly to near full knee extension.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Lifting the hips off the pad to gain leverage. • Slamming the stack down. • Cutting the range short at the bottom.		COACH TIPS • Point the toes to bias the hamstrings; flex them to involve the calves. • Essential counterbalance to squat-heavy programming.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the hips pinned to the pad.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute hamstring strain • Recent knee surgery	
PROGRESSION		Add load, or perform single-leg curls.	
REGRESSION		Nordic curl eccentric-only, or a stability ball leg curl.	
ALTERNATIVES		Seated Leg Curl, Nordic Hamstring Curl, Romanian Deadlift	
RECORD ID		EX-0098	
TAGS #hamstrings #isolation #machine #knee-flexion #gym MEDIA [IMG::EX-0098::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0098::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Seated Leg Curl				EX-0099 Beginner
CATEGORY	Hamstrings	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings (all heads, stretched position)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gastrocnemius	
EQUIPMENT	Seated leg curl machine	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	4.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-78	
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1	
SETS	3	REPS	10-15	
REST	60 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling, inhale returning.	
EXECUTION 1. Set the back pad and align the knees with the machine pivot. 2. Secure the thigh pad firmly across the quads. 3. Curl the heels down and back, then return slowly.				
COMMON MISTAKES • Loose thigh pad letting the hips lift. • Explosive, bouncy reps.		COACH TIPS • The seated position holds the hip flexed, which lengthens the hamstring — research shows this trains the muscle in the stretched position more effectively than lying curls. • Pair with a lying curl for full coverage.		
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Do not let the pad crash at the end of the set.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute hamstring strain • Sciatic nerve irritation		
PROGRESSION		Add load or a 3-second eccentric.		
REGRESSION		Lying leg curl.		
ALTERNATIVES		Lying Leg Curl, Romanian Deadlift, Nordic Hamstring Curl		
RECORD ID		EX-0099		

TAGS #hamstrings #isolation #machine #stretch-position #gym
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0099::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0099::3set_full_rom_30s]

Nordic Hamstring Curl

EX-0100 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Hamstrings	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings (eccentric)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, erector spinae, calves
EQUIPMENT	Partner, Nordic bench, or loaded barbell to pin the ankles	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	6.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-50
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	5-0-X-0
SETS	2-3	REPS	3-6
REST	120-180 s	BREATHING	Inhale on the descent, exhale on the push back.

EXECUTION

1. Kneel on a pad with the ankles secured firmly behind you.
2. Keep the body in a straight line from knee to shoulder — no hip hinge.
3. Lower the torso toward the floor as slowly as possible, resisting with the hamstrings.
4. Catch yourself with the hands and push back to the start.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Hinging at the hips to shorten the lever.
- Dropping quickly instead of resisting.
- Doing high volume — this causes severe soreness.

COACH TIPS

- Reduces hamstring injury rates by roughly half in athlete populations — the strongest evidence base of any single exercise.
- Start with 2 sets of 3 reps. Soreness after the first session is severe.
- Use a band around the chest for assistance in early weeks.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Place a pad under the knees.
- Always have hands ready to catch the floor.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute hamstring strain
- Knee pain
- Beginners

PROGRESSION	Increase range before adding reps; eventually add a slow concentric.
REGRESSION	Band-assisted Nordic, or a razor curl with hip support.
ALTERNATIVES	Romanian Deadlift (Single Leg), Lying Leg Curl, Glute-Ham Raise
RECORD ID	EX-0100

TAGS #hamstrings #eccentric #injury-prevention #athletic #advanced
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0100::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0100::3set_full_rom_30s]

Glute-Ham Raise

EX-0101 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Hamstrings	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Erector spinae, calves
EQUIPMENT	Glute-ham developer (GHD)	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	6.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-55
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	4-0-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	6-10
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.

EXECUTION

1. Set the foot plate so the knees sit just behind the pad.
2. Start with the torso upright, body straight from knee to head.
3. Lower slowly under hamstring control until the torso is horizontal.
4. Curl back up using the hamstrings, keeping the hips extended.

COMMON MISTAKES • Hinging at the hips. • Using a hip-extension swing to return. • Attempting full reps before the eccentric is mastered.		COACH TIPS • Bridges the gap between a back extension and a Nordic curl. • Place the hands on the chest to increase difficulty.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Set the machine correctly — knee position determines the leverage.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute hamstring or lower back injury	
PROGRESSION	Hold a plate at the chest.		
REGRESSION	Perform eccentric-only, or a back extension.		
ALTERNATIVES	Nordic Hamstring Curl, Back Extension (45-Degree), Romanian Deadlift		
RECORD ID	EX-0101		
TAGS #hamstrings #glutes #posterior-chain #advanced #athletic			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0101::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0101::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Barbell Hip Thrust

EX-0102 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Glutes	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, quadriceps, adductors
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, bench, barbell pad	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-12
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Exhale driving up, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Sit on the floor with the upper back against a bench, bar across the hips on a pad.
2. Feet flat, shins vertical at the top of the movement, chin tucked.
3. Drive through the heels and extend the hips until the torso is parallel to the floor.
4. Squeeze the glutes hard for one second, then lower under control.

COMMON MISTAKES • Hyperextending the lower back instead of extending the hips. • Placing the feet too close or too far, which recruits quads or hamstrings. • Letting the chin lift and the neck extend.		COACH TIPS • Ribs down, chin tucked, posterior pelvic tilt at the top. That is the whole exercise. • Produces the highest gluteus maximus activation of any loaded movement. • A 1-second pause at lockout is non-negotiable.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Use a thick bar pad. • Roll the bar into position; do not drop it onto the hips.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain • Hip impingement (reduce range)	

PROGRESSION	Add load; then progress to a single-leg hip thrust.
REGRESSION	Glute bridge from the floor.
ALTERNATIVES	Glute Bridge, Single-Leg Hip Thrust, Romanian Deadlift
RECORD ID	EX-0102
TAGS #glutes #hinge #hypertrophy #athletic #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0102::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0102::3set full rom 30s]	

Glute Bridge

EX-0103 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Glutes	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, core
EQUIPMENT	None, or a dumbbell across the hips	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	4.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Weight Loss, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-85

ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-2-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-20
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale lifting, inhale lowering.
EXECUTION			
1. Lie on the back, knees bent, feet flat and hip-width, heels close to the glutes. 2. Tuck the pelvis slightly and brace the abdominals. 3. Drive through the heels to lift the hips until knees, hips and shoulders align. 4. Squeeze for two seconds, then lower slowly.			
COMMON MISTAKES		COACH TIPS	
• Arching the lower back at the top instead of squeezing the glutes. • Pushing through the toes. • Letting the knees fall inward.		• If you feel it in the hamstrings, move the heels closer to the glutes. • The safest glute exercise available — suitable for post-partum, seniors and back pain. • Add a band around the knees to include the gluteus medius.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST	
• Keep the ribs down; do not hyperextend the spine.		• Acute hip flexor strain	
PROGRESSION	Add a dumbbell, then a single-leg version, then a barbell hip thrust.		
REGRESSION	Reduce range; lift only halfway.		
ALTERNATIVES	Barbell Hip Thrust, Single-Leg Hip Thrust, Bird Dog		
RECORD ID	EX-0103		
TAGS #glutes #bodyweight #rehab #post-partum #home #senior-friendly			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0103::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0103::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Single-Leg Hip Thrust

EX-0104 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Glutes	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus (unilateral)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, gluteus medius, core
EQUIPMENT	Bench	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	5.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-65
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	8-12 per side
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale up, inhale down.
EXECUTION 1. Set up as for a hip thrust but with one foot planted and the other leg lifted. 2. Keep the lifted knee pulled toward the chest to stop the hip flexor cheating. 3. Drive up through the planted heel and squeeze at the top. 4. Keep the pelvis perfectly level — do not let one hip drop.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the pelvis rotate or drop on one side. • Hyperextending the lower back. • Pushing through the toes.		COACH TIPS • Exposes glute asymmetry that bilateral thrusts hide. • Excellent for runners and single-leg sport athletes.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Master the bilateral hip thrust first.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain • Hamstring cramping (move the heel closer)	
PROGRESSION	Add a dumbbell across the hip.		
REGRESSION	Two-leg glute bridge.		
ALTERNATIVES	Barbell Hip Thrust, Glute Bridge, Romanian Deadlift (Single Leg)		
RECORD ID	EX-0104		
TAGS #glutes #unilateral #hypertrophy #athletic MEDIA [IMG::EX-0104::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0104::3set full rom 30s]			

Cable Kickback

EX-0105 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Glutes	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, erector spinae
EQUIPMENT	Cable machine, ankle strap, low pulley	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-15 per side
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale kicking back, inhale returning.

EXECUTION

1. Attach the strap to one ankle and face the low pulley, holding the frame.
2. Hinge forward slightly, brace the core, and keep the working leg slightly bent.
3. Drive the leg straight back, squeezing the glute; stop when the hip is extended.
4. Return slowly without letting the stack touch down.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the lower back to gain extra range.
- Swinging the leg with momentum.
- Rotating the pelvis.

COACH TIPS

- Hip extension ends at neutral. Anything beyond comes from the spine.
- Great glute isolation, but never a substitute for hip thrusts or squats.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Brace hard; the lumbar spine takes over easily here.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute lower back pain
- Hip impingement

PROGRESSION

Add a 2-second squeeze.

REGRESSION

Standing band kickback with lighter tension.

ALTERNATIVES

Barbell Hip Thrust, Glute Bridge, Back Extension (45-Degree)

RECORD ID

EX-0105

TAGS [#glutes](#) [#isolation](#) [#cable](#) [#hypertrophy](#)MEDIA [\[IMG::EX-0105::demo_front_lateral\]](#) [\[VID::EX-0105::3set_full_rom_30s\]](#)

Banded Lateral Walk

EX-0106 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Glutes	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Gluteus medius, gluteus minimus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, tensor fasciae latae
EQUIPMENT	Mini resistance band	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-80
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-0-2-0
SETS	3	REPS	10-15 steps per direction
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Breathe continuously.

EXECUTION

1. Place a mini band just above the knees or around the ankles.
2. Adopt a quarter-squat with feet hip-width and toes forward.
3. Step sideways, leading with the heel, keeping tension in the band.
4. Take controlled steps without letting the trailing foot snap in.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the knees cave in.
- Standing too upright.
- Bouncing the trailing leg in.

COACH TIPS

- The premier gluteus medius drill — critical for knee valgus and runner's knee.
- Band at the ankles is harder than band above the knees.
- Keep the toes pointing forward, not turned out.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Stop if you feel it in the outside of the thigh (TFL) rather than the side of the hip.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute hip bursitis

PROGRESSION	Move the band to the ankles, or use a heavier band.
REGRESSION	Side-lying clamshell.
ALTERNATIVES	Clamshell, Single-Leg Hip Thrust, Step-Up
RECORD ID	EX-0106
TAGS #glutes #glute-medius #resistance-band #warm-up #knee-health #corrective	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0106::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0106::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Clamshell

EX-0107 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Glutes	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Gluteus medius	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus minimus, deep hip external rotators
EQUIPMENT	Mini band (optional)	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	2.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-90
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	2-3	REPS	15-20 per side
REST	30-45 s	BREATHING	Exhale opening, inhale closing.

EXECUTION

1. Lie on one side, knees bent to 45 degrees, feet stacked, hips stacked.
2. Place a band above the knees if available.
3. Keeping the feet together, rotate the top knee upward.
4. Stop before the pelvis rolls backwards; lower slowly.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rolling the pelvis back to gain more range.
- Rushing the reps.
- Using too heavy a band.

COACH TIPS

- Place a hand on the top hip; if it rolls, you have gone too far.
- The go-to entry point for hip stability in rehab and post-partum programming.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep the movement small and precise.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute hip bursitis (may need reduced range)**

PROGRESSION	Add a band, then progress to a side-lying hip abduction.
REGRESSION	Perform without a band.
ALTERNATIVES	Banded Lateral Walk, Glute Bridge, Side Plank
RECORD ID	EX-0107
TAGS #glutes #glute-medius #rehab #post-partum #corrective #home	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0107::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0107::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Standing Calf Raise

EX-0108 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Calves	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Gastrocnemius	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Soleus, tibialis posterior
EQUIPMENT	Calf raise machine, Smith machine, or a step	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	3.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-80
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3-4	REPS	12-20
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale rising, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Stand with the balls of the feet on a step, heels hanging free.
2. Keep the knees straight (but not locked) throughout.
3. Rise onto the toes as high as possible; squeeze for one second.
4. Lower slowly until a deep stretch is felt at the bottom.

COMMON MISTAKES • Bouncing out of the bottom stretch using the Achilles tendon's elasticity. • Cutting the range short at the top. • Bending the knees (which turns it into a soleus exercise).		COACH TIPS • A straight knee targets the gastrocnemius; a bent knee targets the soleus. Train both. • 1-second pause at the top and bottom. The calves respond to time under tension.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Hold a support for balance. • Do not bounce with a history of Achilles issues.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute Achilles tendinopathy • Recent calf strain	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or progress to single-leg calf raises.		
REGRESSION	Flat-ground calf raise without the deficit.		
ALTERNATIVES	Seated Calf Raise, Single-Leg Calf Raise, Jump Rope		
RECORD ID	EX-0108		
TAGS #calves #gastrocnemius #isolation #home #athletic			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0108::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0108::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Seated Calf Raise				EX-0109 Beginner
CATEGORY	Calves	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Soleus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gastrocnemius, tibialis posterior	
EQUIPMENT	Seated calf raise machine, or a dumbbell on the knees	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	3.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-80	
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1	
SETS	3	REPS	15-25	
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale rising, inhale lowering.	
EXECUTION 1. Sit with the balls of the feet on the platform and the pad across the lower thighs. 2. Knees bent to 90 degrees throughout. 3. Press through the toes to raise the heels; squeeze at the top. 4. Lower slowly to a full stretch.				
COMMON MISTAKES • Bouncing. • Short range at the bottom. • Skipping the exercise entirely, which most lifters do.		COACH TIPS • The soleus is the single largest contributor to standing calf endurance and Achilles resilience. • Higher reps (15-25) work best here. • Runners and cricketers should not neglect this.		
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Ensure the pad is secure before releasing the safety.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute Achilles tendinopathy		
PROGRESSION		Add load, or hold the top for 3 seconds.		
REGRESSION		Seated bodyweight heel raise.		
ALTERNATIVES		Standing Calf Raise, Single-Leg Calf Raise, Tibialis Raise		
RECORD ID		EX-0109		
TAGS #calves #soleus #isolation #achilles-health #running MEDIA [IMG::EX-0109::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0109::3set_full_rom_30s]				

Single-Leg Calf Raise				EX-0110 Intermediate
CATEGORY	Calves	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Gastrocnemius, soleus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Tibialis posterior, foot intrinsics	
EQUIPMENT	Step, wall for balance	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight	
ENERGY COST	4.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Athletic, General Fitness	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-75	

ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-20 per side
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale rising, inhale lowering.
EXECUTION - Stand on one foot with the ball of the foot on a step, holding a wall. - Lower the heel until a strong calf stretch is felt. - Rise as high as possible onto the toe; hold one second. - Complete all reps, then switch.			
COMMON MISTAKES - Using the wall to pull yourself up. - Rushing. - Rolling to the outside of the foot.		COACH TIPS - Being able to perform 25 single-leg raises is a common return-to-run benchmark. - Drive through the big toe, not the little toe.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS Progress gradually if you have Achilles history.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST - Acute Achilles tendinopathy - Plantar fasciitis flare-up	
PROGRESSION	Hold a dumbbell in the free hand.		
REGRESSION	Two-leg calf raise.		
ALTERNATIVES	Standing Calf Raise, Seated Calf Raise, Jump Rope		
RECORD ID	EX-0110		
TAGS #calves #unilateral #achilles-health #running #athletic			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0110::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0110::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Tibialis Raise

EX-0111 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Calves	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Tibialis anterior	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Extensor digitorum longus
EQUIPMENT	Wall, or a tib bar	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	2.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-80
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-2-1
SETS	3	REPS	15-25
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Breathe normally.
EXECUTION 1. Lean the upper back against a wall with the heels 30-40 cm from it. 2. Keep the legs straight and the heels planted. 3. Lift the toes and forefoot toward the shins as high as possible. 4. Lower slowly.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Bending the knees. • Rushing through the range. • Placing the feet too close to the wall.		COACH TIPS • Directly reduces shin splint risk and improves ankle dorsiflexion under load. • Highly recommended for runners, footballers and cricketers.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Expect a strong burn — that is normal.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute anterior compartment syndrome (medical emergency; seek care)	
PROGRESSION	Move the heels further from the wall, or add a tib bar.		
REGRESSION	Seated toe raises with no wall lean.		
ALTERNATIVES	Seated Calf Raise, Ankle Circles, Single-Leg Calf Raise		
RECORD ID	EX-0111		
TAGS #calves #tibialis #shin-splints #running #prehab #home			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0111::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0111::3set full rom 30s]			

Core

Plank

EX-0112 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis, transverse abdominis	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Erector spinae, glutes, shoulders
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	3.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Weight Loss, Fat Loss
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-85
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Isometric
SETS	3	REPS	20-45 s
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Breathe normally throughout; never hold the breath.

EXECUTION

1. Rest on the forearms and toes, elbows directly under the shoulders.
2. Form a straight line from head to heels — no sagging, no piking.
3. Squeeze the glutes and brace the abdominals as if bracing for a punch.
4. Breathe steadily and hold the position for the prescribed time.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the hips sag, which loads the lumbar spine.
- Piking the hips up to make it easier.
- Holding the breath instead of breathing through the hold.

COACH TIPS

- A plank is a moving target, not a static one — actively pull the elbows toward the toes to keep tension high.
- 30 quality seconds beats 2 poor minutes.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Stop the set the instant the hips sag — do not chase the clock.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute lower back pain
- Late-stage pregnancy (use an incline version)

PROGRESSION	Add a shoulder tap, a weighted plate, or progress to a long-lever plank.
REGRESSION	Perform on the knees, or elevate the hands on a bench.
ALTERNATIVES	Side Plank, Dead Bug, Hollow Body Hold
RECORD ID	EX-0112

TAGS [#core](#) [#isometric](#) [#anti-extension](#) [#home](#) [#no-equipment](#) [#beginner-safe](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0112::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0112::3set_full_rom_30s]

Side Plank

EX-0113 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Obliques (internal/external), quadratus lumborum	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus medius, shoulders
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	3.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Weight Loss
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-70
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Isometric
SETS	3	REPS	15-30 s per side
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Breathe normally.

EXECUTION

1. Lie on one side, propped on the forearm with the elbow under the shoulder.
2. Stack the feet, or stagger them for more stability.
3. Lift the hips until the body forms a straight line.
4. Hold, keeping the hips high and square — do not let them sag or rotate.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the hips drop toward the floor.
- Rotating the top shoulder forward.
- Holding the head in a strained position.

COACH TIPS

- This trains anti-lateral-flexion — resisting side-bending — which the plank does not address.
- Stagger the feet front-to-back for an easier, more stable variant.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS Support the head with the free arm if the neck complains.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST - Acute shoulder pain - Rib injury
PROGRESSION	Lift the top leg, or add a rotation reaching under the torso.	
REGRESSION	Perform with the top knee bent and resting on the floor.	
ALTERNATIVES	Plank, Pallof Press, Suitcase Carry	
RECORD ID	EX-0113	
TAGS #core #obliques #isometric #anti-lateral-flexion #home		
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0113::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0113::3set_full_rom_30s]		

Dead Bug		EX-0114 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Transverse abdominis, rectus abdominis	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hip flexors (control), obliques
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	3.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Weight Loss
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-85
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-1-2-0
SETS	3	REPS	8-12 per side
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale extending the limbs, inhale returning.
EXECUTION 1. Lie on the back, arms reaching to the ceiling, knees bent 90 degrees over the hips. 2. Press the lower back flat into the floor and keep it there for the whole set. 3. Slowly extend one arm overhead and the opposite leg toward the floor. 4. Return to the start and repeat on the other side without the back arching.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the lower back arch off the floor as the limbs extend. • Moving too fast for the core to control. • Letting the extending leg or arm touch down and rest.		COACH TIPS • The lower back staying flat is the entire point — treat every rep as a test, not a rep count. • Widely used in physiotherapy as the safest entry point for core control.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Stop extending the limb the moment the back starts to arch.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain (reduce range)	
PROGRESSION	Extend the limbs further, or add ankle weights.		
REGRESSION	Move only the arms, or only the legs, not both together.		
ALTERNATIVES	Plank, Bird Dog, Hollow Body Hold		
RECORD ID	EX-0114		
TAGS #core #anti-extension #stability #rehab #home #beginner-safe			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0114::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0114::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Bird Dog				EX-0115 Beginner
CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Erector spinae, transverse abdominis	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, rear deltoid	
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight	
ENERGY COST	3.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-90	
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-2-0	
SETS	3	REPS	8-10 per side	
REST	30-45 s	BREATHING	Exhale extending, inhale returning.	

EXECUTION

1. Start on hands and knees, spine neutral, hands under shoulders, knees under hips.
2. Brace the core, then extend the right arm and left leg simultaneously.
3. Keep the hips and shoulders square to the floor — no rotation.
4. Return with control and repeat on the opposite side.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rotating the hips as the leg extends.
- Arching the lower back to gain height.
- Moving too quickly to control the torso.

COACH TIPS

- Balance a light object on the lower back to give instant feedback on stability.
- A cornerstone rehab movement for lower back pain populations.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep movements slow and controlled.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute wrist pain (perform on forearms)**

PROGRESSION

Add a 2-second hold at extension, or add light ankle/wrist weights.

REGRESSION

Extend only the arm or only the leg, not both.

ALTERNATIVES

Dead Bug, Plank, Glute Bridge

RECORD ID

EX-0115

TAGS [#core](#) [#stability](#) [#low-back](#) [#rehab](#) [#senior-friendly](#) [#home](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0115::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0115::3set_full_rom_30s]

Hanging Leg Raise

EX-0116 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis (lower fibres), hip flexors	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Obliques, forearm grip
EQUIPMENT	Pull-up bar	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	6.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-50
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-2-0
SETS	3	REPS	6-15
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale raising, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Hang from a bar with a full grip, shoulders engaged (not a dead hang).
2. Brace the core and posteriorly tilt the pelvis before the legs move.
3. Raise the legs, straight if possible, until at least parallel to the floor.
4. Lower with control — do not let momentum swing the body.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Swinging the body to throw the legs up.
- Using hip flexors only, without the posterior pelvic tilt.
- Losing grip and dropping.

COACH TIPS

- The tilt of the pelvis, not the height of the legs, is what makes this a true ab exercise.
- Bend the knees to regress instantly if the straight-leg version breaks form.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Build grip and shoulder strength on dead hangs first.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Lower back pain**
- **Shoulder impingement**
- **Wrist injury**

PROGRESSION

Add ankle weights, or progress to toes-to-bar.

REGRESSION

Bent-knee (bicycle) hanging raise, or a captain's chair raise.

ALTERNATIVES

Captain's Chair Leg Raise, Hollow Body Hold, Cable Crunch

RECORD ID

EX-0116

TAGS [#core](#) [#lower-abs](#) [#bodyweight](#) [#calisthenics](#) [#advanced](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0116::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0116::3set_full_rom_30s]

Captain's Chair Leg Raise

EX-0117 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis (lower fibres), hip flexors	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Obliques

EQUIPMENT	Captain's chair / vertical knee raise station	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	5.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-2-0
SETS	3	REPS	10-15
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale raising, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Support the body on the forearm pads, back flat against the backrest.
2. Brace the core and posteriorly tilt the pelvis.
3. Raise the knees toward the chest, curling the pelvis under.
4. Lower with control, stopping just short of the legs swinging.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Swinging the legs using momentum.
- Arching the lower back away from the pad.
- Using tiny, incomplete range.

COACH TIPS

- A superb, back-supported entry point before hanging raises.
- Focus on the pelvis curling under, not just the knees lifting.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep the back flat against the pad throughout.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute hip flexor strain**

PROGRESSION

Straighten the legs, or add ankle weights.

REGRESSION

Reduce the range, lifting only to hip height.

ALTERNATIVES

Hanging Leg Raise, Reverse Crunch, Cable Crunch

RECORD ID

EX-0117

TAGS [#core](#) [#lower-abs](#) [#machine](#) [#beginner-safe](#) [#gym](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0117::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0117::3set_full_rom_30s]

Reverse Crunch

EX-0118 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis (lower fibres)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hip flexors, obliques
EQUIPMENT	None, or a mat	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	3.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-70
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-2-0
SETS	3	REPS	12-20
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling in, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Lie on the back, knees bent 90 degrees, shins parallel to the floor.
2. Press the lower back into the floor and keep it there.
3. Curl the knees toward the chest by tilting the pelvis, not by swinging the legs.
4. Lower under control without letting the back arch or the feet touch down hard.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using leg-swing momentum instead of a pelvis curl.
- Letting the lower back arch off the floor.
- Yanking the head and neck to assist.

COACH TIPS

- Picture drawing the hips toward the ribs, not the knees toward the chest.
- A safe, effective lower-ab builder for beginners.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep the movement slow and controlled — momentum defeats the purpose.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute lower back pain**

PROGRESSION

Add ankle weights, or progress to a hanging or captain's chair raise.

REGRESSION

Perform with bent knees kept close to the chest throughout (smaller range).

ALTERNATIVES

Dead Bug, Captain's Chair Leg Raise, Bicycle Crunch

RECORD ID

EX-0118

TAGS #core #lower-abs #home #beginner-safe #no-equipment

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0118::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0118::3set_full_rom_30s]

Bicycle Crunch

EX-0119 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis, obliques	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hip flexors
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	5.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-65
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	1-0-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	16-24 total
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale on each crunch, inhale between sides.

EXECUTION

1. Lie on the back, hands lightly behind the head, knees bent and lifted.
2. Curl the torso up slightly, bringing the right elbow toward the left knee.
3. Extend the right leg straight as the left knee draws in.
4. Alternate sides in a slow, controlled pedalling motion.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Yanking the neck with the hands.
- Moving so fast the range becomes tiny and momentum-driven.
- Letting the lower back arch off the floor.

COACH TIPS

- Slow this down deliberately — most people rush it and get little from it.
- The elbow should reach toward the knee, not touch it; a small twist is enough.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep the hands as a light cradle, not a pulling force on the neck.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute neck pain
- Lower back pain

PROGRESSION	Slow the tempo to a 3-second rotation per side.
REGRESSION	Perform without lifting the shoulders, just alternating knee drives.
ALTERNATIVES	Reverse Crunch, Russian Twist, Plank
RECORD ID	EX-0119

TAGS #core #obliques #rotational #home #no-equipment

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0119::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0119::3set_full_rom_30s]

Russian Twist

EX-0120 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Obliques (internal/external)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis, hip flexors
EQUIPMENT	Bodyweight, or a light plate/medicine ball	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	5.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-60
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	1-0-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	16-20 total
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale on each rotation.

EXECUTION

1. Sit with the knees bent, torso leaned back to about 45 degrees, feet lifted or grounded.
2. Hold the hands together (or a light weight) at the chest.
3. Rotate the torso to touch the floor beside one hip, then the other.
4. Keep the chest tall throughout the rotation — do not round forward.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rounding the lower back to reach further.
- Moving so fast the rotation becomes a blur with no control.
- Using far too heavy a weight for a rotational movement.

COACH TIPS

- Feet on the floor is a legitimate and often better regression — it is not cheating.
- This is a rotation exercise, not a distance-touched exercise.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS Keep the weight light; heavy loaded spinal rotation carries real disc-injury risk.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST - Acute lower back pain - Disc herniation - Recent abdominal surgery
PROGRESSION	Lift the feet off the floor, or add light load.	
REGRESSION	Keep the feet planted and reduce the rotation range.	
ALTERNATIVES	Bicycle Crunch, Pallof Press, Side Plank	
RECORD ID	EX-0120	
TAGS #core #obliques #rotational #home #athletic		
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0120::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0120::3set_full_rom_30s]		

Pallof Press		EX-0121 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Obliques, transverse abdominis (anti-rotation)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis, shoulders
EQUIPMENT	Cable machine or resistance band, anchored at chest height	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	4.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-75
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-12 per side
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale pressing out, inhale returning.
EXECUTION 1. Stand side-on to the anchor, cable/band held at the sternum with both hands. 2. Step out until there is real tension in the line. 3. Press the hands straight out in front of the chest, resisting the pull to rotate. 4. Hold for a beat, then return with control.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the torso rotate toward the anchor. • Pressing with bent elbows instead of full extension. • Standing too close, removing the challenge.		COACH TIPS • This is anti-rotation, not rotation — the goal is to stay perfectly still while the cable tries to twist you. • One of the best core exercises for rotational-sport athletes, including cricket.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the stance athletic and grounded.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain	
PROGRESSION	Step further out, add a reverse lunge, or increase the load.		
REGRESSION	Reduce the distance from the anchor.		
ALTERNATIVES	Side Plank, Suitcase Carry, Russian Twist		
RECORD ID	EX-0121		
TAGS #core #anti-rotation #cable #athletic #sports-conditioning MEDIA [IMG::EX-0121::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0121::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Hollow Body Hold				EX-0122 Intermediate
CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis, transverse abdominis	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hip flexors, quadriceps	
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight	
ENERGY COST	4.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, General Fitness	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-55	
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Isometric	
SETS	3	REPS	15-30 s	

REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Breathe shallowly and continuously; do not hold the breath.
EXECUTION			
1. Lie on the back, press the lower back firmly into the floor. 2. Raise the shoulders and legs a few inches off the ground simultaneously. 3. Reach the arms overhead, forming a gentle banana shape. 4. Hold, keeping the lower back glued to the floor the entire time.			
COMMON MISTAKES		COACH TIPS	
• Letting the lower back arch off the floor — this is the most common failure. • Raising the legs too high, which reduces the challenge. • Straining the neck by looking up.		• A gymnastics staple — if the back lifts off the floor, the hold has technically ended. • Bend the knees to instantly regress if the lower back cannot stay down.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST	
• Stop the moment the lower back arches; do not push through.		• Acute lower back pain	
PROGRESSION	Extend the hold, or add a rock (hollow body rocks).		
REGRESSION	Bend the knees and keep the arms at the sides.		
ALTERNATIVES	Plank, Dead Bug, Hanging Leg Raise		
RECORD ID	EX-0122		
TAGS #core #isometric #gymnastics #calisthenics #advanced			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0122::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0122::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Cable Crunch

EX-0123 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Obliques, hip flexors
EQUIPMENT	Cable machine, rope attachment, high pulley	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	5.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-20
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling down, inhale returning.
EXECUTION 1. Kneel below a high pulley, rope held beside the head, elbows fixed near the ears. 2. Hinge from the hips first, then curl the spine, bringing the elbows toward the thighs. 3. Focus on flexing the spine — a true crunch, not a hip hinge. 4. Return under control to a full stretch.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Hinging at the hips instead of flexing the spine — turns it into a bad-form good morning. • Using the arms to pull instead of the abs to curl. • Choosing far too much weight.		COACH TIPS • The single best loaded ab exercise — resistance increases as the muscle shortens, matching its strength curve. • Keep the hips relatively still; the movement comes from the spine.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Avoid loading through a rounded, unwarmed spine.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain • Disc herniation	
PROGRESSION	Add load progressively.		
REGRESSION	Bodyweight crunch on the floor.		
ALTERNATIVES	Hanging Leg Raise, Reverse Crunch, Standard Crunch		
RECORD ID	EX-0123		
TAGS #core #loaded #cable #hypertrophy #gym			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0123::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0123::3set full rom 30s]			

Standard Crunch

EX-0124 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis (upper fibres)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Obliques
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	3.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-80
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-0-1-0
SETS	3	REPS	15-25
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale curling up, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Lie on the back, knees bent, feet flat, hands lightly supporting the head.
2. Press the lower back into the floor.
3. Curl the shoulder blades a few inches off the floor by flexing the spine.
4. Lower slowly without fully relaxing between reps.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Pulling on the neck with the hands.
- Using hip flexors to yank the torso up.
- Coming up too far, past where the abs are doing the work.

COACH TIPS

- Full sit-ups are not necessary for ab development — a few inches of true spinal flexion is enough.
- Exhale fully at the top to intensify the contraction.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep the chin off the chest — a fist's gap under the jaw.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute neck or lower back pain

PROGRESSION

Add a weight plate on the chest, or move to a cable crunch.

REGRESSION

Perform with the arms crossed over the chest instead of behind the head.

ALTERNATIVES

Cable Crunch, Reverse Crunch, Bicycle Crunch

RECORD ID

EX-0124

TAGS [#core](#) [#upper-abs](#) [#beginner-safe](#) [#home](#) [#no-equipment](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0124::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0124::3set_full_rom_30s]

Ab Wheel Rollout

EX-0125 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis, transverse abdominis	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi, shoulders, hip flexors
EQUIPMENT	Ab wheel	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-50
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-2-0
SETS	3	REPS	6-12
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Inhale rolling out, exhale pulling back.

EXECUTION

1. Kneel on a pad, hands gripping the wheel directly under the shoulders.
2. Brace the core hard before initiating any movement.
3. Roll forward slowly, keeping the spine in a single neutral line — no sagging.
4. Stop before the lower back is at risk of arching, then pull back to the start.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the hips sag toward the floor at full extension.
- Rolling out further than current core strength supports.
- Using the arms to pull back instead of the abs.

COACH TIPS

- The range should be earned, not forced — most people should start with partial rollouts.
- This loads the abdominals in a long, anti-extension position that few other exercises reach.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Master planks and ab rollouts against a wall before free rollouts.
- Stop immediately if the lower back arches.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute lower back pain
- Shoulder impingement
- Beginners

PROGRESSION	Increase the rollout distance progressively toward full extension.
REGRESSION	Rollout from the knees with a small range, or use a barbell instead of a wheel for more stability.
ALTERNATIVES	Plank, Hollow Body Hold, Dead Bug
RECORD ID	EX-0125
TAGS #core #anti-extension #advanced #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0125::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0125::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Mountain Climber

EX-0126 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis, hip flexors	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Shoulders, quadriceps, cardiovascular system
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	9.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-60
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3-4	REPS	20-40 s
REST	30-45 s	BREATHING	Breathe rhythmically with the leg drive.

EXECUTION

1. Start in a push-up plank position, hands under the shoulders.
2. Brace the core to keep the hips level and still.
3. Drive one knee toward the chest, then quickly switch legs.
4. Continue at a controlled but brisk pace, keeping the hips down throughout.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the hips pike up, which turns it into a poor plank.
- Bouncing the hips up and down instead of staying level.
- Losing the plank as fatigue sets in — quality drops fast here.

COACH TIPS

- Slow the tempo down if the hips cannot stay stable — speed is not the goal, control is.
- A genuinely excellent core-and-cardio hybrid for HIIT circuits.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep the wrists warm; place hands on an elevated surface if wrist pain occurs.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Wrist injury**
- **Acute lower back pain**

PROGRESSION	Increase speed, or elevate the hands on a lower surface.
REGRESSION	Slow deliberate reps, or elevate the hands on a bench.
ALTERNATIVES	Plank, High Knees, Burpee
RECORD ID	EX-0126
TAGS #core #cardio #hiit #home #no-equipment #conditioning	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0126::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0126::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Woodchopper (Cable, High to Low)

EX-0127 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Obliques	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis, hip rotators, shoulders
EQUIPMENT	Cable machine, high pulley, rope or handle	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-60
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-0-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-12 per side
REST	60 s	BREATHING	Exhale chopping down, inhale returning.

EXECUTION

1. Stand side-on to a high pulley, feet shoulder-width, holding the handle with both hands.
2. Rotate the torso and pull the handle diagonally down and across the body.
3. Pivot the back foot naturally as the hips rotate.
4. Return along the same diagonal path under control.

COMMON MISTAKES • Using only the arms without hip and torso rotation. • Rounding the lower back at the bottom. • Choosing a weight too heavy to control the rotation.		COACH TIPS • This trains rotational power in a pattern that mirrors throwing, swinging a bat, or bowling. • Drive the rotation from the hips, not the shoulders.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Warm up the spine with cat-cow before loading rotation.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain • Disc herniation	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or perform low-to-high for the reverse pattern.		
REGRESSION	Perform with a light band instead of the cable stack.		
ALTERNATIVES	Pallof Press, Russian Twist, Landmine Press		
RECORD ID	EX-0127		
TAGS #core #obliques #rotational #athletic #cricket #sports-conditioning MEDIA [IMG::EX-0127::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0127::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Woodchopper (Cable, Low to High)		EX-0128 Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Obliques	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis, hip rotators, shoulders
EQUIPMENT	Cable machine, low pulley, rope or handle	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-60
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-0-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-12 per side
REST	60 s	BREATHING	Exhale chopping up, inhale returning.
EXECUTION 1. Stand side-on to a low pulley, holding the handle with both hands near the outside hip. 2. Rotate and pull the handle diagonally up and across to above the opposite shoulder. 3. Let the back foot pivot naturally with the hip rotation. 4. Return under control along the same path.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Isolating the arms and skipping hip rotation. • Hyperextending the lower back to add height.		COACH TIPS • Mirrors an uppercut or an underarm throw — valuable for many field-sport athletes. • Keep the movement smooth, not jerky.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the load light until the pattern is grooved.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or increase speed for a power emphasis.		
REGRESSION	Perform with a resistance band.		
ALTERNATIVES	Woodchopper (Cable, High to Low), Pallof Press, Medicine Ball Chest Pass (Wall)		
RECORD ID	EX-0128		
TAGS #core #obliques #rotational #athletic #sports-conditioning			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0128::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0128::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Farmer's Walk March				EX-0129 Beginner
CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Transverse abdominis	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hip flexors, forearms, shoulders	
EQUIPMENT	Two moderate dumbbells	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	5.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Strength	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-75	
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous	
SETS	3	REPS	30-45 s	

REST	60 s	BREATHING	Breathe continuously; avoid breath-holding.
EXECUTION			
1. Hold a moderate dumbbell in each hand, standing tall. 2. Brace the core and march in place, lifting the knees to hip height. 3. Keep the torso vertical and the dumbbells still — no swinging. 4. March for the prescribed time or step count.			
COMMON MISTAKES		COACH TIPS	
• Leaning back to counterbalance the load. • Letting the dumbbells swing forward and back. • Rushing the march and losing knee height.		• A stationary variation of the farmer's carry that emphasises anti-flexion and hip flexor endurance. • Useful where walking space is limited.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST	
• Choose a weight that does not pull the shoulders forward.		• Acute lower back pain	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or march with a high-knee emphasis.		
REGRESSION	March without weights.		
ALTERNATIVES	Farmer's Carry, Plank, Dead Bug		
RECORD ID	EX-0129		
TAGS #core #carry #apartment-friendly #home #functional			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0129::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0129::3set full rom 30s]			

V-Up

EX-0130 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hip flexors, obliques
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	5.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-55
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-0-2-0
SETS	3	REPS	8-15
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale rising, inhale lowering.
EXECUTION 1. Lie flat, arms extended overhead, legs straight. 2. Simultaneously lift the torso and legs, reaching the hands toward the toes. 3. Form a V-shape at the top, balancing briefly on the sit bones. 4. Lower both halves together under control.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Using momentum by throwing the arms and legs up. • Bending the knees to make it easier without acknowledging the regression. • Only lifting the torso and barely raising the legs.		COACH TIPS • A demanding, whole-abdomen movement — most beginners should regress rather than force it. • If the lower back arches during the lift, the load or range is too much.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the movement slow and controlled, not thrown.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain • Beginners with weak cores	
PROGRESSION	Add a medicine ball held between the hands.		
REGRESSION	Bent-knee V-up (tuck-up), lifting the knees toward the chest instead.		
ALTERNATIVES	Hollow Body Hold, Reverse Crunch, Hanging Leg Raise		
RECORD ID	EX-0130		
TAGS #core #bodyweight #home #no-equipment #advanced			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0130::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0130::3set full rom 30s]			

Stability Ball Rollout

EX-0131 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis, transverse abdominis	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Shoulders, latissimus dorsi

EQUIPMENT	Stability/Swiss ball	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	5.2 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-65
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-2-0
SETS	3	REPS	8-12
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Inhale rolling out, exhale pulling back.

EXECUTION

1. Kneel behind a stability ball with the forearms resting on top.
2. Brace the core, then roll the ball forward by extending the arms and hips together.
3. Stop before the lower back arches, keeping a straight line from knees to shoulders.
4. Pull back to the start using the abdominals.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the hips sag as the ball rolls forward.
- Rolling out further than strength allows.
- Using the ball's momentum instead of controlled muscular effort.

COACH TIPS

- A gentler alternative to the ab wheel with a larger, more forgiving base of support.
- Excellent bridge exercise between planks and a full ab-wheel rollout.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Use a ball rated for your bodyweight.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute lower back pain**

PROGRESSION

Increase the rollout distance; then move to an ab wheel.

REGRESSION

Reduce the rollout range.

ALTERNATIVES

Ab Wheel Rollout, Plank, Hollow Body Hold

RECORD ID

EX-0131

TAGS [#core](#) [#anti-extension](#) [#stability-ball](#) [#gym](#)

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0131::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0131::3set_full_rom_30s]

Weighted Sit-Up

EX-0132 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Rectus abdominis, hip flexors	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Obliques
EQUIPMENT	Bodyweight, or a plate held at the chest	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	5.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-65
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-0-2-0
SETS	3	REPS	12-20
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale rising, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Lie on the back, knees bent, feet anchored or flat on the floor.
2. Hold a plate across the chest for added resistance if progressing.
3. Curl the spine up to a full sit-up, leading with the chest.
4. Lower under control through the full range.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Yanking the body up using momentum.
- Anchoring the feet so hip flexors dominate entirely over the abs.
- Adding load before bodyweight sit-ups are controlled.

COACH TIPS

- Sit-ups load the hip flexors more than crunches — useful for some goals, less ideal for others with anterior pelvic tilt or lower back issues.
- Choose crunch variations instead if lower back discomfort appears.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Do not add load if you experience any lower back pain during the movement.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute lower back pain**
- **Anterior pelvic tilt with associated pain**

PROGRESSION

Add a weight plate progressively.

REGRESSION

Standard bodyweight crunch with a smaller range.

ALTERNATIVES

Standard Crunch, Cable Crunch, Hanging Leg Raise

RECORD ID

EX-0132

TAGS #core #loaded #home #gym

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0132::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0132::3set_full_rom_30s]

Side Bend (Dumbbell)

EX-0133 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Core	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Obliques (lateral flexors)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Quadratus lumborum
EQUIPMENT	One dumbbell	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	3.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-70
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-2-1
SETS	2-3	REPS	10-15 per side
REST	45 s	BREATHING	Exhale returning to centre, inhale bending.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall holding one dumbbell at the side, other hand on the hip or behind the head.

2. Keep the torso facing forward — no twisting.

3. Bend directly sideways toward the weighted side as far as comfortable.

4. Return to upright, then continue past neutral slightly to the opposite side if desired.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Twisting the torso instead of bending purely sideways.
- Using very heavy weight, which risks the lumbar spine.
- Rushing through the range.

COACH TIPS

- Keep this light. Heavy weighted side bends are one of the few exercises with a genuinely poor risk-to-reward ratio for the spine.
- Most people get more value from a Pallof press or suitcase carry than from this movement.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Prioritise anti-rotation and anti-lateral-flexion carries over heavy weighted side bends.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Any lower back pathology
- Disc herniation

PROGRESSION	Very slight load increase only.
REGRESSION	Bodyweight side bend, hand sliding down the thigh.
ALTERNATIVES	Suitcase Carry, Side Plank, Pallof Press
RECORD ID	EX-0133

TAGS #core #obliques #lateral-flexion #caution

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0133::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0133::3set_full_rom_30s]

Full Body & Functional

Burpee

EX-0134 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Full body (quads, chest, shoulders, core)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, glutes, triceps, cardiovascular system
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	11.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-55
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-15
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale on the jump, breathe rhythmically throughout.

EXECUTION

1. Start standing, then squat down and place both hands on the floor.

2. Jump or step the feet back into a plank position.

3. Perform one push-up (or lower the chest to the floor).

4. Jump the feet back to the hands, then explode upward into a jump with arms overhead.

COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the lower back sag in the plank phase. • Skipping the push-up depth to move faster. • Landing the jump with locked, stiff knees.		COACH TIPS • Step back instead of jumping back to reduce impact while keeping the pattern intact. • This is a technique drill first, a conditioning tool second — sloppy burpees teach poor patterns fast.		
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Land softly with bent knees. • Regress to a step-back burpee if wrist or shoulder pain appears.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Wrist injury • Uncontrolled hypertension • Late-stage pregnancy • Acute knee injury		
PROGRESSION	Add a tuck jump at the top, or a push-up clap.			
REGRESSION	Step-back burpee without the push-up or the jump.			
ALTERNATIVES	Mountain Climber, Jump Squat, Kettlebell Swing			
RECORD ID	EX-0134			
TAGS #full-body #hiit #cardio #no-equipment #conditioning #home MEDIA [IMG::EX-0134::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0134::3set_full_rom_30s]				

Kettlebell Swing (Russian)

EX-0135 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, hamstrings	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Erector spinae, core, shoulders, forearms
EQUIPMENT	One kettlebell	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	10.5 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Fat Loss, Athletic, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-65
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3-4	REPS	15-20
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Sharp exhale on the hip snap, inhale as the bell swings back.

EXECUTION

- Stand with feet shoulder-width, kettlebell on the floor a foot in front.
- Hinge and grip the handle, shoulders slightly ahead of the bell.
- Hike the bell back between the legs, then explosively extend the hips forward.
- Let the arms float to roughly chest/shoulder height — driven by hip power, not arm lifting.
- Let the bell fall back into the next hike as the hips re-load.

COMMON MISTAKES • Squatting the swing instead of hinging — this is a hip-hinge exercise, not a squat. • Using the arms and shoulders to lift the bell. • Hyperextending the lower back at the top of the swing.		COACH TIPS • The hips snap; the arms are just along for the ride. • Think of the top position as a standing plank, not a lean-back. • The single best hip-power teaching tool in the entire database.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Learn the hip hinge with a dowel before adding the kettlebell. • Never let the bell rise above chest height under momentum you cannot control.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain • Uncontrolled hypertension • Shoulder impingement	
PROGRESSION	Add load, or progress to the American (overhead) swing.		
REGRESSION	Two-hand hip hinge drill without a bell, or a lighter kettlebell.		
ALTERNATIVES	Barbell Hip Thrust, Romanian Deadlift, Goblet Squat		
RECORD ID	EX-0135		
TAGS #full-body #kettlebell #hip-power #conditioning #athletic #explosive			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0135::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0135::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Kettlebell Goblet Carry

EX-0136 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Core, upper back	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Forearms, glutes, quadriceps

EQUIPMENT	One kettlebell	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-75
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3	REPS	20-30 m
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Breathe continuously.

EXECUTION

1. Hold the kettlebell by the horns at chest height, elbows tucked.
2. Stand tall with the ribcage stacked over the pelvis.
3. Walk at a controlled pace, keeping the kettlebell still against the chest.
4. Set it down under control at the end of the distance.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the elbows flare out.
- Leaning back to counterbalance the load.

COACH TIPS

- An accessible carry variation for anyone new to loaded carries.
- Doubles as anti-flexion core training, since the load sits in front of the torso.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Choose a weight that does not force the torso to lean back.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute lower back pain

PROGRESSION

Add load or distance.

REGRESSION

Shorter distance, lighter load.

ALTERNATIVES

Farmer's Carry, Suitcase Carry, Goblet Squat

RECORD ID

EX-0136

TAGS #full-body #kettlebell #carry #beginner-safe #functional

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0136::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0136::3set_full_rom_30s]

Turkish Get-Up

EX-0137 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Full body (shoulders, core, glutes, legs)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Stabilising muscles throughout the kinetic chain
EQUIPMENT	One kettlebell or dumbbell	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	7.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-55
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Slow, deliberate throughout
SETS	2-3	REPS	3-5 per side
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Breathe steadily; never rush a rep.

EXECUTION

1. Lie on the back holding a light weight overhead with a locked arm; bend the same-side knee.
2. Roll onto the opposite forearm, then press up to the opposite hand.
3. Lift the hips high, sweep the straight leg back, and drop to a kneeling lunge.
4. Stand up out of the lunge, keeping the arm locked overhead throughout.
5. Reverse the entire sequence with control to return to the floor.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Losing sight of the weight — the eyes should track it for most of the movement.
- Rushing between positions.
- Letting the locked arm bend or waver.

COACH TIPS

- Learn each of the 6-7 positions separately before linking them.
- One of the best full-body integration and shoulder-stability drills that exists.
- Start with no load at all — a shoe balanced on the fist works well.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Practice on a soft surface while learning.
- Never rush the transitions.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Shoulder instability
- Acute lower back pain
- Beginners without coaching

PROGRESSION

Add load progressively; this movement rewards patience over years, not weeks.

REGRESSION

Half get-up (floor to elbow-support only).

ALTERNATIVES

Standing Barbell Overhead Press, Plank, Bulgarian Split Squat

RECORD ID	EX-0137
TAGS #full-body #kettlebell #stability #advanced #functional #athletic	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0137::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0137::3set_full_rom_30s]	

TRX Row EX-0138 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi, rhomboids	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Biceps brachii, core, posterior deltoid
EQUIPMENT	TRX suspension trainer	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Muscle Gain, General Fitness, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-70
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	3-0-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	10-15
REST	60-75 s	BREATHING	Exhale rowing, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Anchor the straps overhead and lean back, holding the handles with straight arms.
2. Set feet together, body in a straight line — the more horizontal the lean, the harder the row.
3. Pull the chest to the hands, driving the elbows back.
4. Lower under control to full arm extension.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Piking at the hips instead of keeping a straight body line.
- Using a small, partial range.
- Letting the shoulders roll forward at the bottom.

COACH TIPS

- Walk the feet forward to make it easier, back to make it harder — instant self-regulated loading.
- Fantastic option for hostel rooms and travel with a door anchor.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Check the anchor point rating before every set.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Shoulder injury**

PROGRESSION	Walk the feet back for a steeper, harder angle.
REGRESSION	Walk the feet forward toward the anchor.
ALTERNATIVES	Inverted Row, Single-Arm Dumbbell Row, Seated Cable Row
RECORD ID	EX-0138
TAGS #full-body #trx #horizontal-pull #travel #hostel #home	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0138::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0138::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Battle Rope Wave (Alternating) EX-0139 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Shoulders, forearms	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Core, latissimus dorsi, cardiovascular system
EQUIPMENT	Battle ropes, anchor point	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	12.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-55
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	4-6	REPS	20-30 s
REST	30-45 s	BREATHING	Breathe hard and rhythmically — this is a genuine conditioning tool.

EXECUTION

1. Anchor the ropes and hold one end in each hand, feet shoulder-width, knees soft.
2. Sit into a quarter-squat and brace the core.
3. Whip the arms alternately up and down, driving waves down the length of the rope.
4. Maintain a consistent rhythm for the prescribed interval.

COMMON MISTAKES • Standing bolt upright and using only the shoulders. • Letting the core relax, which loads the lower back. • Going all-out for so long that wave quality collapses in the first 10 seconds.		COACH TIPS • Bend the knees and engage the legs — the power comes from the whole body, not the arms alone. • Short, intense intervals (20-30 s) beat long, sloppy ones.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep a firm, dry grip on the ropes.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Uncontrolled hypertension • Shoulder impingement	
PROGRESSION	Increase interval duration, or use double waves.		
REGRESSION	Slower tempo, shorter interval.		
ALTERNATIVES	Kettlebell Swing (Russian), Burpee, Mountain Climber		
RECORD ID	EX-0139		
TAGS #full-body #battle-rope #hiit #conditioning #gym			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0139::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0139::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Medicine Ball Slam		EX-0140 Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi, core	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Shoulders, quadriceps, cardiovascular system
EQUIPMENT	Slam ball (non-bounce)	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	10.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-55
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	X-0-X-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-12
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale sharply on the slam, inhale on the reset.
EXECUTION 1. Stand with feet shoulder-width, ball held overhead with both hands. 2. Brace the core and hinge slightly as you begin the downward motion. 3. Slam the ball forcefully into the floor between the feet. 4. Catch the bounce (or pick it back up) and reset for the next rep.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Rounding the lower back on the downswing. • Using only the arms without hip drive. • Standing too close and hitting the shins with the rebound.		COACH TIPS • A superb stress-relief and power exercise in one movement. • Keep reps low and intent high — this is a power drill, not an endurance one.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Use a genuine non-bounce slam ball, never a regular medicine ball, on hard floors.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute lower back pain • Uncontrolled hypertension	
PROGRESSION	Heavier ball, or add a jump before each slam.		
REGRESSION	Lighter ball, controlled tempo.		
ALTERNATIVES	Kettlebell Swing (Russian), Battle Rope Wave (Alternating), Burpee		
RECORD ID	EX-0140		
TAGS #full-body #power #medicine-ball #conditioning #stress-relief MEDIA [IMG::EX-0140::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0140::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Jump Squat				EX-0141 Intermediate
CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Calves, hamstrings, core	
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight	
ENERGY COST	9.5 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Fat Loss, Athletic, Strength	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	13-50	

ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	1-0-X-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	6-10
REST	90 s	BREATHING	Exhale on the jump, inhale on the landing reset.
EXECUTION 1. Stand with feet shoulder-width, hands at the chest or swinging freely. 2. Descend into a quarter-to-half squat. 3. Explode upward, leaving the ground fully, reaching for maximum height. 4. Land softly with bent knees, absorbing the impact before the next rep.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Landing with stiff, locked knees. • Letting the knees cave inward on landing. • Chaining reps so fast that landing quality suffers.		COACH TIPS • The landing is the exercise. A loud landing is a warning sign, not a badge of effort. • Rest fully between sets — this is a power exercise, not a conditioning one.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Perform on a surface with some give — never on concrete. • Stop the set if landing mechanics degrade.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute knee injury • Patellar tendinopathy • Osteoporosis • Ankle instability	
PROGRESSION	Add a tuck to the jump, or progress to box jumps.		
REGRESSION	Bodyweight squat with a calf raise at the top instead of a full jump.		
ALTERNATIVES	Plyometric Box Jump, Bodyweight Squat, Broad Jump		
RECORD ID	EX-0141		
TAGS #full-body #plyometrics #power #explosive #athletic			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0141::demo front lateral] [VID::EX-0141::3set full rom 30s]			

Plyometric Box Jump

EX-0142 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Calves, hip flexors, core
EQUIPMENT	Plyo box	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	9.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Athletic, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-45
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	1-0-X-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	5-8
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Exhale on the jump.

EXECUTION

1. Stand facing a stable box roughly shin-to-knee height, feet shoulder-width.

2. Load the hips back and swing the arms down.

3. Explode upward and forward, landing softly on the box with knees slightly bent.

4. Stand fully upright on the box, then step down — never jump backwards off it.

COMMON MISTAKES • Choosing a box height that only works with knee tuck, not true hip extension. • Jumping down off the box, which stresses the joints unnecessarily. • Chasing height once landing mechanics start to break down.	COACH TIPS • Step down, always. Jumping down is where most box jump injuries happen. • Master the standing broad jump landing before adding box height.
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SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Use a box with a soft or non-slip top. • Ensure adequate space and lighting.	SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Any lower limb injury history without clearance • Ankle instability • Beginners
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PROGRESSION	Increase box height only while landing mechanics remain clean.
REGRESSION	Step-up performed explosively instead of a full jump.
ALTERNATIVES	Jump Squat, Broad Jump, Step-Up
RECORD ID	EX-0142

TAGS #full-body #plyometrics #power #advanced #athletic #sports-conditioning
 MEDIA [IMG::EX-0142::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0142::3set_full_rom_30s]

Broad Jump

EX-0143 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, quadriceps	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, calves, core
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	8.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Athletic, Strength
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-50
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	1-0-X-0
SETS	3-4	REPS	4-6
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale on the jump.

EXECUTION

1. Stand with feet shoulder-width, arms ready to swing.
2. Load the hips back, swing the arms behind you.
3. Explode forward and upward, extending the hips fully in the air.
4. Land softly with bent knees, sticking the landing before resetting.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Under-using the arm swing.
- Landing stiff-legged.
- Chaining jumps without resetting between reps.

COACH TIPS

- A true measure of horizontal power output and a foundational athletic drill.
- Distance is a bonus; a controlled, silent landing is the actual goal.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Use a surface with grip and some give.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Ankle instability
- Acute lower limb injury

PROGRESSION	Chain into consecutive broad jumps once single-jump landings are clean.
REGRESSION	Standing long step instead of a full jump.
ALTERNATIVES	Plyometric Box Jump, Jump Squat, Kettlebell Swing (Russian)
RECORD ID	EX-0143

TAGS #full-body #plyometrics #power #athletic #outdoor

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0143::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0143::3set_full_rom_30s]

High Knees

EX-0144 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Hip flexors, quadriceps	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Calves, core, cardiovascular system
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	9.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-60
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3-4	REPS	20-30 s
REST	30-45 s	BREATHING	Breathe rhythmically.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall and begin jogging in place.
2. Drive each knee up to hip height in rapid succession.
3. Pump the arms in opposition to the legs.
4. Stay on the balls of the feet throughout.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Leaning back, which reduces knee height and stresses the lower back.
- Slapping the feet down loudly instead of landing softly.

COACH TIPS

- A staple warm-up and HIIT filler — cheap on joints, high on heart rate.
- Keep the torso tall throughout.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS Land on the balls of the feet, not the heels.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST - Acute hip flexor strain - Ankle instability
PROGRESSION	Increase speed or duration.	
REGRESSION	Marching in place at a slower tempo.	
ALTERNATIVES	Mountain Climber, Jump Rope, Burpee	
RECORD ID	EX-0144	
TAGS #full-body #cardio #warm-up #hiit #home #no-equipment		
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0144::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0144::3set_full_rom_30s]		

Jump Rope				EX-0145 Beginner
CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Calves, shoulders	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Core, forearms, cardiovascular system	
EQUIPMENT	Skipping rope	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	11.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, Athletic	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-65	
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous	
SETS	3-5	REPS	30-60 s	
REST	30-60 s	BREATHING	Breathe rhythmically with the jumps.	
EXECUTION 1. Hold the rope handles lightly, elbows close to the ribs. 2. Rotate the rope primarily from the wrists, not the shoulders. 3. Jump just high enough to clear the rope — a few centimetres. 4. Land softly on the balls of the feet with slightly bent knees.				
COMMON MISTAKES • Jumping too high, which wastes energy and increases impact. • Rotating from the shoulders instead of the wrists. • Landing flat-footed.		COACH TIPS • The most time-efficient cardio tool that exists — genuinely comparable to running for calorie cost. • Start with short 20-30 second intervals if new to it; the calf demand is significant.		
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Use a surface with some give. • Wear supportive footwear.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Achilles tendinopathy • Ankle instability • Advanced pregnancy		
PROGRESSION		Add double-unders or single-leg skips.		
REGRESSION		Perform the arm and jump pattern without a rope (imaginary rope).		
ALTERNATIVES		High Knees, Standing Calf Raise, Burpee		
RECORD ID		EX-0145		
TAGS #full-body #cardio #jump-rope #conditioning #travel #apartment-friendly MEDIA [IMG::EX-0145::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0145::3set_full_rom_30s]				

Sled Push				EX-0146 Intermediate
CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Calves, core, shoulders	
EQUIPMENT	Weighted sled	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	10.5 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Fat Loss, Athletic	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-60	
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous	
SETS	3-5	REPS	15-25 m	
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Breathe rhythmically with each drive.	

EXECUTION

1. Set the hands on the sled poles at chest to shoulder height.
2. Lean into the sled with a long body line, arms mostly extended.
3. Drive through the legs in strong, deliberate steps, staying low.
4. Maintain the push for the prescribed distance.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Standing too upright, which turns it into an arm push.
- Taking short, choppy steps.
- Rounding the upper back.

COACH TIPS

- An almost injury-proof way to build leg strength and conditioning simultaneously — no eccentric loading.
- Excellent choice for anyone returning from a lower-body injury under guidance.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep the push area clear of obstacles.
- Wear shoes with good traction.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute knee injury** (light loads may be appropriate; consult a professional)

PROGRESSION

Add load, or increase distance.

REGRESSION

Reduce load significantly, shorten distance.

ALTERNATIVES

Barbell Back Squat, Kettlebell Swing (Russian), Farmer's Carry

RECORD ID

EX-0146

TAGS [#full-body](#) [#sled](#) [#conditioning](#) [#low-injury-risk](#) [#athletic](#) [#gym](#)MEDIA [\[IMG::EX-0146::demo_front_lateral\]](#) [\[VID::EX-0146::3set_full_rom_30s\]](#)**Bear Crawl**

EX-0147 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Core, shoulders	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, hip flexors, triceps
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	7.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Fat Loss, Athletic, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	8-55
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3	REPS	10-15 m
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Breathe continuously.

EXECUTION

1. Start on hands and feet, knees hovering a few centimetres off the floor.
2. Keep the back flat and the hips roughly level with the shoulders.
3. Crawl forward, moving the opposite hand and foot together.
4. Keep the knees low and the movement controlled throughout.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the hips pike up high.
- Moving the same-side hand and foot together (a loss of contralateral pattern).
- Letting the knees drag or bang the floor.

COACH TIPS

- A genuinely excellent whole-body stability and coordination drill, popular in youth and rehab settings alike.
- Keep the movements small and controlled rather than fast.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Use knee pads on hard floors if the knees are sensitive.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Wrist injury**
- **Acute shoulder pain**

PROGRESSION

Add lateral or backward bear crawls.

REGRESSION

Crawl with the knees resting down between steps.

ALTERNATIVES

Mountain Climber, Plank, Inverted Row

RECORD ID

EX-0147

TAGS [#full-body](#) [#functional](#) [#coordination](#) [#kids](#) [#home](#) [#no-equipment](#)MEDIA [\[IMG::EX-0147::demo_front_lateral\]](#) [\[VID::EX-0147::3set_full_rom_30s\]](#)**Renegade Row**

EX-0148 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
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PRIMARY MUSCLES	Latissimus dorsi, core (anti-rotation)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Shoulders, triceps, glutes
EQUIPMENT	Two dumbbells	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	7.8 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Muscle Gain
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-55
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	6-10 per side
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale rowing, inhale lowering.

EXECUTION

1. Start in a push-up plank, one hand on each dumbbell, feet wide for stability.
2. Brace hard to keep the hips square and still.
3. Row one dumbbell to the hip, keeping the torso from rotating.
4. Lower with control, then repeat on the other side.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the hips rotate toward the lifted side.
- Widening the feet so much that the row loses its anti-rotation challenge.
- Using dumbbells that are too heavy to control the rotation.

COACH TIPS

- If the hips rock, the weight is too heavy — the anti-rotation is the point, not the row itself.
- Use hex dumbbells so they do not roll.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Keep the wrists neutral and stacked directly under the shoulders throughout.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Wrist injury
- Shoulder instability

PROGRESSION	Add a push-up between rows.
REGRESSION	Perform from the knees.
ALTERNATIVES	Single-Arm Dumbbell Row, Plank, Pallof Press
RECORD ID	EX-0148

TAGS #full-body #core #anti-rotation #advanced #gym

MEDIA [IMG::EX-0148::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0148::3set_full_rom_30s]

Devil's Press

EX-0149 | Advanced

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Advanced
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Full body (posterior chain, shoulders, chest)	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Core, quadriceps, triceps
EQUIPMENT	Two light-to-moderate dumbbells	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	12.5 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	18-45
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3-4	REPS	5-10
REST	90-120 s	BREATHING	Exhale on the press, breathe rhythmically overall.

EXECUTION

1. Start standing with a dumbbell in each hand.
2. Place the dumbbells down and perform a burpee, hands on the dumbbells.
3. From the plank, jump the feet forward to the hands.
4. Stand and perform a double dumbbell swing/clean into an overhead press in one fluid motion.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rounding the back on the swing-up phase.
- Sacrificing the plank position in the burpee portion.
- Using weight too heavy for the overhead component.

COACH TIPS

- One of the most demanding conditioning exercises in strength sport — start with very light dumbbells.
- Master the burpee and the dumbbell swing separately before combining them.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Not a beginner exercise.
- Requires a solid burpee and overhead pressing base first.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Any shoulder pathology
- Lower back pain
- Untrained beginners

PROGRESSION	Increase load, or increase reps per round in a HIIT format.
REGRESSION	Separate the burpee and the dumbbell swing-press into two distinct movements.
ALTERNATIVES	Kettlebell Swing (Russian), Burpee, Standing Barbell Overhead Press
RECORD ID	EX-0149
TAGS #full-body #conditioning #advanced #hiit #athletic #crossfit-style	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0149::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0149::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Wall Ball

EX-0150 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus, anterior deltoid	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Core, shoulders, cardiovascular system
EQUIPMENT	Medicine ball, wall	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	9.5 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-55
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3-4	REPS	10-15
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale on the throw, inhale on the catch.

EXECUTION

1. Hold a medicine ball at chest height, feet shoulder-width, facing a wall.
2. Squat down to at least parallel.
3. Drive up explosively, extending the legs and throwing the ball to a target on the wall.
4. Catch the ball on the way down and immediately absorb it into the next squat.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using the arms only, without leg drive.
- Squatting too shallow to build power.
- Losing the catch and letting the ball drop uncontrolled.

COACH TIPS

- The legs generate the power; the arms just guide the ball.
- A superb combined strength-conditioning tool for time-crunched sessions.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Use a target height appropriate to ceiling clearance.
- Clear the throwing area.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute knee pain**
- **Shoulder impingement**

PROGRESSION	Heavier ball, higher target, or shorten rest.
REGRESSION	Goblet squat with a light medicine ball, no throw.
ALTERNATIVES	Goblet Squat, Medicine Ball Chest Pass (Wall), Kettlebell Swing (Russian)
RECORD ID	EX-0150
TAGS #full-body #conditioning #medicine-ball #athletic #gym	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0150::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0150::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Low-Impact Step Touch

EX-0151 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus medius	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Calves, core, cardiovascular system
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	5.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-85
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3-4	REPS	45-60 s
REST	30 s	BREATHING	Breathe naturally.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall with feet together, arms relaxed.
2. Step the right foot out to the side, then tap the left foot to meet it.
3. Step the left foot back out, tapping the right foot to meet it.
4. Add a gentle arm swing to increase the cardio demand.

COMMON MISTAKES • Bouncing so hard it becomes a joint-jarring movement rather than low-impact. • Locking the knees at the top of each step.		COACH TIPS • The default choice for joint pain, pregnancy, obesity, or true beginners who need cardio without impact. • Add arm patterns to raise heart rate without adding impact.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep a soft bend in the knees throughout.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • None significant — this is one of the safest cardio options available	
PROGRESSION	Add larger steps or arm overhead reaches.		
REGRESSION	Reduce the range of the side step.		
ALTERNATIVES	Marching in Place, Standing Calf Raise, Bodyweight Squat		
RECORD ID	EX-0151		
TAGS #full-body #low-impact #cardio #senior-friendly #beginner-safe #home MEDIA [IMG::EX-0151::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0151::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Shadow Boxing

EX-0152 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Shoulders, core	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Legs (footwork), cardiovascular system
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	8.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-70
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3-5	REPS	60-120 s
REST	30-45 s	BREATHING	Exhale sharply on each strike.

EXECUTION

- Adopt a boxing stance, one foot slightly forward, hands guarding the face.
- Throw controlled jabs, crosses, and hooks into open air.
- Keep the feet moving — small steps, pivots, and weight shifts.
- Maintain a steady rhythm and breathe out sharply on each punch.

COMMON MISTAKES • Locking the elbows on every punch (hyperextension risk over time). • Standing flat-footed with no footwork. • Holding the breath during combinations.	COACH TIPS • A genuinely enjoyable cardio option that also builds coordination and rotational power. • Snap the punches back rather than pushing them out and leaving them extended.
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Keep the wrists straight even without gloves.	SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Wrist injury • Shoulder impingement

Office Chair Squat

EX-0153 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, gluteus maximus	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Core, hamstrings
EQUIPMENT	A sturdy chair	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	4.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Weight Loss
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	18-75
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-0

SETS	2-3	REPS	10-15
REST	30-45 s	BREATHING	Inhale down, exhale up.
EXECUTION 1. Stand in front of a sturdy chair, feet shoulder-width. 2. Push the hips back and lower until the glutes lightly touch the seat. 3. Do not sit down fully — pause briefly, then drive back up to standing. 4. Keep the chest tall throughout.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Fully collapsing into the seat and resting between reps. • Letting the knees track far past the toes. • Using a chair with wheels.		COACH TIPS • A discreet way to break up sedentary desk time without needing a change of clothes. • Can be done in work attire, in a meeting-adjacent room, or between calls.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Confirm the chair is stable and cannot roll or tip.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute knee pain	
PROGRESSION	Remove the chair touch and go to a full bodyweight squat.		
REGRESSION	Sit fully and stand using the hands for assistance.		
ALTERNATIVES	Bodyweight Squat, Wall Sit, Standing Calf Raise		
RECORD ID	EX-0153		
TAGS #full-body #office #desk-break #no-equipment #beginner-safe			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0153::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0153::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Suitcase Step-Up (Loaded Carry + Step)				EX-0154 Intermediate
CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, obliques	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, forearms	
EQUIPMENT	One dumbbell or kettlebell, box or step	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	7.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Fat Loss, Athletic, Strength	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-60	
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-0-1-0	
SETS	3	REPS	8-10 per side	
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale stepping up, inhale stepping down.	
EXECUTION 1. Hold one weight at the side in a suitcase-carry grip. 2. Step up onto a box with the opposite leg to the loaded hand. 3. Stand tall on the box without letting the torso lean toward the weight. 4. Step down with control and repeat, then switch sides.				
COMMON MISTAKES • Leaning toward the loaded side. • Using momentum instead of a controlled step.		COACH TIPS • Combines two evidence-backed patterns — the unilateral step-up and the anti-lateral-flexion carry — into one efficient drill. • Popular in athletic and tactical conditioning programs.		
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Confirm the box is stable before loading it.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute knee injury • Lower back pain		
PROGRESSION		Add load, or raise the box height.		
REGRESSION		Bodyweight step-up without the carry.		
ALTERNATIVES		Step-Up, Suitcase Carry, Bulgarian Split Squat		
RECORD ID		EX-0154		
TAGS #full-body #unilateral #carry #functional #athletic MEDIA [IMG::EX-0154::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0154::3set_full_rom_30s]				

Partner Med Ball Rotational Throw

EX-0155 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Obliques	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Core, shoulders, legs
EQUIPMENT	Medicine ball, training partner	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	8.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Athletic, Fat Loss
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	14-50
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3	REPS	8-10 per side
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale on the throw, inhale on the catch.

EXECUTION

1. Stand side-on to your partner, roughly 2-3 m apart, holding the ball at the hip.
2. Load by rotating the torso and hips away from the partner.
3. Explosively rotate and release the ball toward the partner's chest height.
4. Catch the return throw and immediately load into the next rep.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Throwing with arms only, no hip rotation.
- Standing too close, removing the value of the rotational range.
- Using a ball too heavy to control safely.

COACH TIPS

- Mirrors rotational sport actions like a cricket throw or a golf swing far better than a machine ever could.
- Communicate clearly with your partner before every throw.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Use a soft-shell medicine ball for catching safety.
- Ensure adequate space free of obstacles.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute lower back pain
- Shoulder instability

PROGRESSION

Increase ball weight or throw distance.

REGRESSION

Throw against a wall solo instead of with a partner.

ALTERNATIVES

Woodchopper (Cable, High to Low), Pallof Press, Medicine Ball Chest Pass (Wall)

RECORD ID

EX-0155

TAGS [#full-body](#) [#partner](#) [#rotational](#) [#athletic](#) [#sports-conditioning](#) [#cricket](#)MEDIA [\[IMG::EX-0155::demo_front_lateral\]](#) [\[VID::EX-0155::3set_full_rom_30s\]](#)

Resistance Band Squat to Row

EX-0156 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, latissimus dorsi	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, rhomboids, core
EQUIPMENT	Long resistance band, anchor point	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	6.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Weight Loss, General Fitness
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	12-75
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	2-1-1-1
SETS	3	REPS	12-15
REST	45-60 s	BREATHING	Exhale standing and rowing, inhale squatting.

EXECUTION

1. Anchor a band at chest height and face it, holding a handle in each hand.
2. Step back for tension, then squat down with arms extended toward the anchor.
3. Stand up while simultaneously rowing the handles to the ribs.
4. Reverse smoothly back into the next squat.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Disconnecting the squat and the row into two separate, jerky movements.
- Rounding the back during the squat portion.

COACH TIPS

- A genuinely efficient full-body combination move for time-limited home sessions.
- Keep the two halves of the movement smoothly linked.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Inspect the band before each session.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- Acute knee or lower back pain

PROGRESSION

Thicker band, or slow the tempo.

REGRESSION	Separate into a bodyweight squat and a band row.
ALTERNATIVES	Goblet Squat, Resistance Band Row, Kettlebell Swing (Russian)
RECORD ID	EX-0156
TAGS #full-body #resistance-band #home #combination #travel	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0156::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0156::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Sandbag Carry (Bear Hug)

EX-0157 | Intermediate

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Core, upper back	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, forearms, shoulders
EQUIPMENT	Sandbag or heavy duffel	LOAD TYPE	Equipment
ENERGY COST	8.6 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Strength, Fat Loss, Athletic
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	16-55
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3	REPS	20-30 m
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Breathe continuously despite the compression on the chest.

EXECUTION

1. Hug the sandbag against the chest, wrapping the arms fully around it.
2. Stand tall, brace the core hard against the awkward, shifting load.
3. Walk at a controlled pace for the prescribed distance.
4. Set the bag down with a controlled squat, not a drop.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the lower back round to compensate for the awkward hold.
- Rushing the walk and losing control of the shifting sand.

COACH TIPS

- Unstable, shifting loads like sand build a different, highly functional kind of strength than fixed weights.
- A duffel bag filled with towels or clothing is a perfectly good substitute.

SAFETY PRECAUTIONS

- Lift the bag with a proper hip hinge, not a rounded back.

SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST

- **Acute lower back pain**

PROGRESSION	Add weight, or increase distance.
REGRESSION	Lighter bag, shorter distance.
ALTERNATIVES	Farmer's Carry, Sled Push, Bear Crawl
RECORD ID	EX-0157
TAGS #full-body #sandbag #functional #carry #unstable-load	
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0157::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0157::3set_full_rom_30s]	

Inchworm Walkout

EX-0158 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, core	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Shoulders, chest
EQUIPMENT	None	LOAD TYPE	Bodyweight
ENERGY COST	5.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	General Fitness, Fat Loss
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	10-70
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	2-3	REPS	6-10
REST	30-45 s	BREATHING	Breathe naturally throughout.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall, then hinge forward and place the hands on the floor.
2. Walk the hands forward into a plank, keeping the legs as straight as comfortable.
3. Hold the plank briefly, then walk the feet toward the hands.
4. Roll back up to standing one vertebra at a time.

COMMON MISTAKES • Bending the knees excessively to avoid the hamstring stretch. • Sagging the hips during the walkout plank. • Rushing through without pausing in the plank.		COACH TIPS • A superb dynamic warm-up that combines a hamstring stretch, a plank, and a hip-hinge pattern in one flow. • Bend the knees as much as needed — the walkout, not the straight legs, is the priority.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS • Warm up gradually rather than forcing the stretch on cold muscles.		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST • Acute hamstring strain • Wrist injury	
PROGRESSION		Add a push-up at the bottom of the plank.	
REGRESSION		Bend the knees generously throughout.	
ALTERNATIVES		Plank, Standard Push-Up, Romanian Deadlift	
RECORD ID		EX-0158	
TAGS #full-body #warm-up #dynamic #home #no-equipment MEDIA [IMG::EX-0158::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0158::3set_full_rom_30s]			

Olympic Barbell Clean (Power Clean)				EX-0159 Advanced
CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Advanced	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Trapezius, gluteus maximus, quadriceps	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Hamstrings, shoulders, forearms, core	
EQUIPMENT	Barbell, bumper plates, platform	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	10.0 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Athletic, Strength	
SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	17-45	
ENVIRONMENT	Indoor	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Explosive throughout	
SETS	4-6	REPS	2-4	
REST	150-240 s	BREATHING	Explosive exhale through the pull; breathe and reset between reps.	
EXECUTION				
1. Set up as for a deadlift, bar over mid-foot, shins close to the bar. 2. Pull the bar past the knees while accelerating the hips into full extension. 3. As the bar reaches hip height, shrug and pull the body under it explosively. 4. Catch the bar on the front of the shoulders in a quarter-squat, then stand tall.				
COMMON MISTAKES		COACH TIPS		
• Pulling early with the arms instead of the legs and hips. • Failing to fully extend the hips before pulling under. • Catching with the elbows low, which drops the bar off the shoulders.		• This is a technical lift that rewards patience — hire a qualified coach for the first several sessions. • The bar should stay close to the body throughout the entire pull.		
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST		
• Requires dedicated technical coaching before loading. • Do not attempt without prior instruction.		• Any wrist, shoulder, or lower back pathology • Untrained beginners • Poor overhead/front-rack mobility		
PROGRESSION	Increase load only under qualified coaching once technique is consistent.			
REGRESSION	Hang high pull or kettlebell swing to build the hip-extension pattern first.			
ALTERNATIVES	Kettlebell Swing (Russian), Conventional Deadlift, Barbell Hip Thrust			
RECORD ID	EX-0159			
TAGS #full-body #olympic-lift #power #advanced #athletic #technical				
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0159::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0159::3set_full_rom_30s]				

Dumbbell Thruster				EX-0160 Intermediate
CATEGORY	Full Body	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	
PRIMARY MUSCLES	Quadriceps, anterior deltoid	SECONDARY MUSCLES	Gluteus maximus, triceps, core	
EQUIPMENT	Two dumbbells	LOAD TYPE	Equipment	
ENERGY COST	9.4 kcal/min @ 70 kg	IDEAL GOAL	Fat Loss, Athletic	

SUITABLE GENDER	All	SUITABLE AGE	15-55
ENVIRONMENT	Both	TEMPO (E-P-C-P)	Continuous
SETS	3-4	REPS	8-12
REST	60-90 s	BREATHING	Exhale on the press, inhale on the squat.
EXECUTION			
1. Hold a dumbbell at each shoulder, feet shoulder-width. 2. Squat down to at least parallel. 3. Drive up explosively, using the leg momentum to press the dumbbells overhead in one motion. 4. Lower the dumbbells back to the shoulders as you descend into the next squat.			
COMMON MISTAKES		COACH TIPS	
• Pausing between the squat and the press, losing the momentum transfer. • Pressing with the arms alone without leg drive. • Arching the lower back at the top.		• The whole point is the seamless transfer of leg power into the press — that link is the skill. • A brutally efficient full-body conditioning tool in a short amount of time.	
SAFETY PRECAUTIONS		SHOULD AVOID / SCREEN FIRST	
• Use a weight light enough to maintain full-body coordination.		• Shoulder impingement • Acute knee pain • Uncontrolled hypertension	
PROGRESSION	Increase load or reduce rest between sets.		
REGRESSION	Separate into a goblet squat followed by a shoulder press.		
ALTERNATIVES	Goblet Squat, Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press, Wall Ball		
RECORD ID	EX-0160		
TAGS #full-body #conditioning #compound #athletic #hiit			
MEDIA [IMG::EX-0160::demo_front_lateral] [VID::EX-0160::3set_full_rom_30s]			

SECTION 2

Yoga Asana Library

Standing, seated, backbend, forward-fold, hip-opening, and restorative postures.

All Asanas

Mountain Pose (Tadasana)

YG-0001 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	30-60 s
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Posture correction	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, even breaths through the nose; 5-8 breaths.
MAY SUPPORT	Postural imbalance, Mild anxiety	PROGRESSION	Add an overhead reach on the inhale.

STEPS

1. Stand with the feet together or hip-width, weight spread evenly across each foot.
2. Engage the thighs gently and lengthen the spine upward.
3. Roll the shoulders back and down, letting the arms rest at the sides.
4. Draw the chin level and soften the gaze forward.

BENEFITS

- Improves posture awareness
- Establishes grounding before a sequence
- Gently activates the feet and legs

COMMON MISTAKES

- Locking the knees.
- Letting the ribcage flare forward.
- Tensing the shoulders toward the ears.

SHOULD AVOID

- None — safe for virtually everyone

REGRESSION

- Practice against a wall for tactile feedback on alignment.

TAGS #standing #foundational #posture #beginner-safe #all-levels

Downward-Facing Dog (Adho Mukha Svanasana)

YG-0002 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	5-10 breaths
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Fat Loss, Flexibility	BREATHING PATTERN	Long, even breaths; exhale to deepen the fold slightly.
MAY SUPPORT	Mild lower back tension, Tight hamstrings	PROGRESSION	Deepen by walking the hands forward slightly to increase the shoulder stretch.

STEPS

1. Start on hands and knees, hands slightly ahead of the shoulders.
2. Tuck the toes and lift the hips up and back, straightening the legs as much as comfortable.
3. Press the chest toward the thighs, forming an inverted V shape.
4. Pedal the feet gently to release the calves.

BENEFITS

- Lengthens the hamstrings and calves
- Builds shoulder and upper back strength
- Gently decompresses the spine

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rounding the upper back sharply.
- Locking the knees to force straight legs.
- Letting the heels force the movement instead of the hips.

SHOULD AVOID

- Carpal tunnel syndrome (use forearms instead)
- Uncontrolled hypertension
- Advanced pregnancy

REGRESSION

- Bend the knees generously and focus only on lengthening the spine.

TAGS #standing #inversion-lite #hamstrings #shoulders #flow #all-levels

Child's Pose (Balasana)

YG-0003 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	30-90 s
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SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Stress relief, Recovery	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow diaphragmatic breathing, feeling the ribs expand into the thighs.
MAY SUPPORT	Anxiety, Lower back tightness, Insomnia	PROGRESSION	Walk the hands further forward for a deeper shoulder stretch.

STEPS

1. Kneel with the big toes touching and knees wide.
2. Sit the hips back toward the heels.
3. Fold the torso forward, extending the arms ahead or resting them alongside the body.
4. Rest the forehead on the mat and relax completely.

BENEFITS

- Releases tension in the lower back and hips
- Calms the nervous system
- Gentle knee and ankle stretch

COMMON MISTAKES

- Holding tension in the shoulders instead of releasing them.
- Forcing the hips onto the heels when hip flexibility does not allow it.

SHOULD AVOID

- Knee injury (widen the knees or avoid)
- Advanced pregnancy (widen the knees)

REGRESSION

- Place a cushion between the hips and heels for support.

TAGS #seated #restorative #recovery #stress-relief #beginner-safe

Cat-Cow Flow (Marjaryasana-Bitilasana)

YG-0004 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	8-12 breath cycles
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Mobility	BREATHING PATTERN	Inhale into Cow, exhale into Cat.
MAY SUPPORT	Lower back stiffness, Desk posture strain	PROGRESSION	Add a lateral spine wave once the sagittal flow feels smooth.

STEPS

1. Start on hands and knees, wrists under shoulders, knees under hips.
2. Inhale, drop the belly, lift the chest and tailbone (Cow).
3. Exhale, round the spine toward the ceiling, tucking the chin and tailbone (Cat).
4. Continue flowing smoothly between the two positions with the breath.

BENEFITS

- Warms up the entire spine
- Improves spinal mobility segment by segment
- Coordinates breath with movement

COMMON MISTAKES

- Moving faster than the breath allows.
- Initiating from the neck instead of the spine as a whole.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute disc herniation with pain on flexion or extension

REGRESSION

- Perform seated in a chair with hands on the knees.

TAGS #mobility #spine #warm-up #office #beginner-safe #morning

Warrior I (Virabhadrasana I)

YG-0005 | Intermediate

DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	HOLD DURATION	5-8 breaths per side
SUITABLE GOALS	Strength, Muscle Gain, Balance	BREATHING PATTERN	Steady breathing, lengthening the spine on each inhale.
MAY SUPPORT	Mild hip tightness	PROGRESSION	Deepen the back-leg stretch by lengthening the stance further.

STEPS

1. From standing, step one foot back about a leg's length, turning it out slightly.
2. Bend the front knee to roughly 90 degrees, keeping it tracking over the ankle.
3. Square the hips toward the front of the mat as much as comfortable.
4. Raise the arms overhead, reaching through the fingertips.

BENEFITS

- Strengthens the legs and opens the hip flexors
- Builds shoulder stability overhead
- Improves balance and focus

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the front knee drift past the toes or collapse inward.
- Allowing the back heel to lift when it should stay grounded (or lift purposefully in a modified version).
- Overarching the lower back to raise the arms higher.

SHOULD AVOID

- Knee pain in the front leg
- Shoulder impingement (lower the arms)

REGRESSION

- Keep the hands on the hips instead of raising the arms overhead.

TAGS #standing #strength #balance #hip-opener #intermediate

Warrior II (Virabhadrasana II)

YG-0006 | Intermediate

DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	HOLD DURATION	5-8 breaths per side
SUITABLE GOALS	Strength, General Fitness, Athletic	BREATHING PATTERN	Steady, even breathing; avoid breath-holding despite the burn.
MAY SUPPORT	Hip tightness	PROGRESSION	Hold longer, or transition into a reverse warrior for added range.

STEPS

1. Step the feet wide, front foot forward, back foot turned out 90 degrees.
2. Bend the front knee to a right angle, keeping it over the ankle.
3. Extend the arms parallel to the floor, gaze over the front hand.
4. Sink the hips low, keeping the torso upright over the pelvis.

BENEFITS

- Builds lower body strength and stamina
- Opens the hips and groin
- Develops focus and steady breath under muscular fatigue

COMMON MISTAKES

- Leaning the torso over the front thigh.
- Letting the front knee cave inward.
- Raising the shoulders toward the ears.

SHOULD AVOID

- Knee pain
- Uncontrolled hypertension (limit hold duration)

REGRESSION

- Shorten the stance and reduce the knee bend depth.

TAGS #standing #strength #hip-opener #endurance #intermediate

Triangle Pose (Trikonasana)

YG-0007 | Intermediate

DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	HOLD DURATION	5-8 breaths per side
SUITABLE GOALS	Fat Loss, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Steady breathing, using the exhale to lengthen slightly deeper.
MAY SUPPORT	Mild scoliosis (under guidance), Tight hamstrings	PROGRESSION	Lower the bottom hand to the floor or a block placed outside the shin.

STEPS

1. Step the feet wide, front foot forward, back foot turned in slightly.
2. Extend the arms parallel to the floor, then hinge at the front hip.
3. Lower the front hand to the shin, ankle, or a block, extending the top arm skyward.
4. Keep both sides of the torso long — avoid collapsing into the front hip.

BENEFITS

- Stretches the hamstrings, hips, and side body
- Strengthens the legs
- Improves spinal rotation and lateral flexibility

COMMON MISTAKES

- Collapsing the torso forward instead of extending long and hinging sideways.
- Locking the front knee aggressively.
- Turning the head to look up before the neck is ready.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute lower back pain
- Uncontrolled hypertension

REGRESSION

- Rest the bottom hand higher, on the shin instead of the ankle.

TAGS #standing #flexibility #lateral-stretch #hips #intermediate

Tree Pose (Vrksasana)

YG-0008 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	30-45 s per side
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Balance	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, even breathing helps steady the balance.
MAY SUPPORT	Mild balance concerns (practice near a wall)	PROGRESSION	Close the eyes once stable, or move the arms overhead with eyes closed.

STEPS

1. Stand tall and shift weight into one foot.
2. Place the sole of the other foot on the inner calf or inner thigh, avoiding the knee joint.
3. Bring the hands to the heart or extend them overhead once stable.
4. Fix the gaze on a single still point to aid balance.

BENEFITS • Improves single-leg balance and ankle stability • Strengthens the standing leg and core • Builds focus and calm concentration	COMMON MISTAKES • Resting the foot directly on the knee joint, which stresses the ligaments. • Gripping the standing-leg toes to compensate for poor balance.
SHOULD AVOID • Acute ankle or knee injury	REGRESSION • Keep the toes of the lifted foot touching the floor for extra support.
TAGS #standing #balance #focus #beginner-safe #athletic	

Chair Pose (Utkatasana)		YG-0009 Intermediate	
DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	HOLD DURATION	20-40 s
SUITABLE GOALS	Strength, Fat Loss	BREATHING PATTERN	Steady breathing; resist the urge to hold the breath under the burn.
MAY SUPPORT	General deconditioning (build gradually)	PROGRESSION	Lower the hips deeper, or add a heel raise (Chair to Toe Stand).
STEPS 1. Stand with feet together or hip-width. 2. Bend the knees and sit the hips back as if sitting into an invisible chair. 3. Raise the arms overhead, keeping the ribs drawn in. 4. Keep the weight in the heels, not the toes.			
BENEFITS • Builds quadriceps and glute endurance • Strengthens the ankles and core • Raises the heart rate mildly		COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the knees track far past the toes. • Arching the lower back to compensate for the arm raise. • Rising onto the toes.	
SHOULD AVOID • Acute knee pain • Uncontrolled hypertension		REGRESSION • Reduce the depth of the knee bend and lower the arms to shoulder height.	
TAGS #standing #strength #quadriceps #endurance #intermediate			

Extended Side Angle (Utthita Parsvakonasana)		YG-0010 Intermediate	
DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	HOLD DURATION	5-8 breaths per side
SUITABLE GOALS	Fat Loss, Strength	BREATHING PATTERN	Long, steady breaths, expanding the ribcage with each inhale.
MAY SUPPORT	Hip and shoulder tightness	PROGRESSION	Lower the front hand to the outside of the foot for a deeper bind option.
STEPS 1. From a wide stance, bend the front knee to a right angle. 2. Lower the front forearm to the thigh or the front hand to the floor/block. 3. Extend the top arm overhead in one long diagonal line from the back foot to the fingertips. 4. Keep the chest rotating open toward the ceiling.			
BENEFITS • Stretches the side body and hip flexors • Strengthens the legs • Opens the chest and shoulders		COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the front knee collapse inward. • Dumping weight onto the front forearm instead of maintaining a long side-body line.	
SHOULD AVOID • Knee pain in the front leg • Neck pain (look forward instead of up)		REGRESSION • Rest the forearm on the thigh rather than reaching to the floor.	
TAGS #standing #flexibility #hip-opener #strength #intermediate			

Seated Forward Fold (Paschimottanasana)		YG-0011 Intermediate	
DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	HOLD DURATION	5-10 breaths
SUITABLE GOALS	Fat Loss, Stress relief	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow exhales to deepen the fold gradually over several breaths.
MAY SUPPORT	Tight hamstrings, Mild anxiety	PROGRESSION	Deepen gradually over weeks; never force a forward fold.

STEPS

1. Sit with the legs extended straight ahead, spine tall.
2. Inhale to lengthen the spine, exhale to hinge forward from the hips.
3. Reach for the shins, ankles, or feet — wherever the current range allows.
4. Relax the neck and let the head hang naturally.

BENEFITS

- Deeply stretches the hamstrings and lower back
- Calms the nervous system
- Improves spinal flexibility

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rounding the spine from the top instead of hinging from the hips.
- Forcing the reach and bouncing to gain extra range.
- Locking the knees painfully straight.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute disc herniation
- Advanced pregnancy

REGRESSION

- Bend the knees generously and use a strap around the feet.

TAGS #seated #flexibility #hamstrings #calming #intermediate

Bound Angle Pose (Baddha Konasana)

YG-0012 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	30-60 s, or up to 2 minutes for a restorative hold
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Flexibility	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, even breathing, releasing tension on each exhale.
MAY SUPPORT	PCOS (as a gentle hip opener), Menstrual discomfort	PROGRESSION	Fold the torso forward while keeping the spine long.

STEPS

1. Sit tall and bring the soles of the feet together, knees falling out to the sides.
2. Hold the feet or ankles with the hands.
3. Lengthen the spine on the inhaled; fold forward slightly on the exhale if comfortable.
4. Let the knees release toward the floor without forcing them down.

BENEFITS

- Opens the hips and inner thighs
- Improves circulation to the pelvic region
- Gently stretches the groin

COMMON MISTAKES

- Pressing down on the knees with the hands or elbows.
- Rounding the back forcefully to increase the fold.

SHOULD AVOID

- Groin strain
- Knee injury

REGRESSION

- Place cushions under each knee for support.

TAGS #seated #hip-opener #womens-health #restorative #beginner-safe

Head-to-Knee Forward Bend (Janu Sirsasana)

YG-0013 | Intermediate

DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	HOLD DURATION	5-8 breaths per side
SUITABLE GOALS	Fat Loss, Stress relief	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow exhales to ease deeper over several breaths.
MAY SUPPORT	Tight hamstrings, Mild anxiety	PROGRESSION	Deepen gradually; add a slight twist toward the extended leg.

STEPS

1. Sit with one leg extended, the other foot drawn in to the inner thigh.
2. Square the hips toward the extended leg.
3. Inhale to lengthen, exhale to fold forward over the straight leg.
4. Hold the shin, ankle, or foot without forcing the reach.

BENEFITS

- Stretches one hamstring and the spine at a time
- Calms the mind
- Improves hip flexibility asymmetrically

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the hips rotate away from the extended leg.
- Rounding aggressively from the upper back.

SHOULD AVOID

- Knee injury on the bent-leg side

REGRESSION

- Bend the extended knee slightly and use a strap.

TAGS #seated #flexibility #hamstrings #intermediate

Seated Spinal Twist (Ardha Matsyendrasana)

YG-0014 | Intermediate

DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	HOLD DURATION	5-6 breaths per side
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SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Digestion	BREATHING PATTERN	Inhale to lengthen before each rotation, exhale to twist deeper.
MAY SUPPORT	Mild digestive sluggishness, Desk-posture stiffness	PROGRESSION	Deepen the bind by wrapping the arm around the shin.

STEPS

1. Sit tall with one leg extended and the other foot crossed over it, planted near the knee.
2. Inhale to lengthen the spine.
3. Exhale and rotate the torso toward the bent knee, using the opposite elbow as gentle leverage.
4. Look over the back shoulder if the neck allows.

BENEFITS

- Improves spinal rotation and mobility
- Stimulates digestion
- Relieves tension along the back

COMMON MISTAKES

- Twisting from the lower back instead of rotating the whole spine evenly.
- Forcing the twist with the arms rather than leading with the breath.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute disc herniation
- Recent abdominal surgery

REGRESSION

- Keep the bottom leg bent instead of extended.

TAGS #seated #spine #rotation #digestion #intermediate

Cobra Pose (Bhujangasana)

YG-0015 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	3-5 breaths, 2-3 rounds
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Posture correction	BREATHING PATTERN	Inhale to lift, exhale to hold or release.
MAY SUPPORT	Mild lower back stiffness, Desk posture strain	PROGRESSION	Progress toward Upward-Facing Dog once thoracic mobility improves.

STEPS

1. Lie face down, hands under the shoulders, elbows tucked close to the ribs.
2. Press the tops of the feet and pubic bone into the mat.
3. Inhale and lift the chest, keeping the lower ribs on or near the floor.
4. Keep the elbows slightly bent — this is not a full push-up.

BENEFITS

- Strengthens the lower back and spinal extensors
- Opens the chest
- Counteracts hours of forward-flexed posture

COMMON MISTAKES

- Using the arms to force the chest too high, which strains the lumbar spine.
- Shrugging the shoulders toward the ears.
- Fully straightening the elbows (that is Upward Dog, a different, more advanced pose).

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute lower back pain
- Pregnancy (use Cat-Cow instead)

REGRESSION

- Lift only a few centimetres, keeping most of the weight in the forearms (Sphinx variation).

TAGS #backbend #posture #office #beginner-safe #spine

Bridge Pose (Setu Bandhasana)

YG-0016 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	30-60 s, or 8-10 controlled pulses
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Muscle Gain	BREATHING PATTERN	Inhale to lift, breathe steadily through the hold, exhale to lower.
MAY SUPPORT	Mild hip flexor tightness, Thyroid support (gentle, non-medical)	PROGRESSION	Progress to Wheel Pose only with adequate wrist and shoulder mobility and supervision.

STEPS

1. Lie on the back, knees bent, feet hip-width close to the glutes.
2. Press into the feet and lift the hips toward the ceiling.
3. Interlace the hands under the back and press the arms down for lift, or keep them at the sides.
4. Keep the chin gently tucked, weight even across both feet.

BENEFITS

- Strengthens the glutes and hamstrings
- Opens the chest and hip flexors
- Gently stimulates the thyroid region

COMMON MISTAKES

- Turning the head side to side while lifted.
- Letting the knees splay outward.
- Pushing off the neck instead of the feet and arms.

SHOULD AVOID • Acute neck injury • Recent shoulder surgery	REGRESSION • Place a yoga block under the sacrum for a supported, passive version.
TAGS #backbend #glutes #chest-opener #beginner-safe #restorative	

Locust Pose (Salabhasana)		YG-0017 Intermediate	
DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	HOLD DURATION	3-5 breaths, 2-3 rounds
SUITABLE GOALS	Strength, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Inhale to lift, hold with steady breathing, exhale to lower.
MAY SUPPORT	Postural weakness	PROGRESSION	Extend the hold duration, or clasp the hands behind the back for a deeper chest opener.
STEPS 1. Lie face down, arms alongside the body, palms facing down or up. 2. Inhale and lift the chest, arms, and legs simultaneously off the floor. 3. Reach long through the fingertips and toes rather than crunching the back. 4. Hold, then lower with control on the exhale.			
BENEFITS • Strengthens the entire posterior chain • Improves postural endurance • Builds spinal extensor strength without arm assistance		COMMON MISTAKES • Yanking the head back and craning the neck. • Bending the knees to gain artificial height. • Holding the breath through the entire lift.	
SHOULD AVOID • Acute lower back pain • Pregnancy		REGRESSION • Lift only the chest, keeping the legs on the floor.	
TAGS #backbend #strength #posture #spine #intermediate			

Sphinx Pose (Salamba Bhujangasana)		YG-0018 Beginner	
DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	60-90 s
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Posture correction	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, even breathing throughout the hold.
MAY SUPPORT	Desk posture strain, Mild lower back tightness	PROGRESSION	Progress to Cobra Pose for a deeper extension.
STEPS 1. Lie face down, forearms on the mat, elbows under the shoulders. 2. Press the forearms down and lift the chest, keeping the hips and legs relaxed on the mat. 3. Draw the shoulder blades down the back. 4. Keep the neck long, gaze forward or slightly down.			
BENEFITS • Gently opens the chest and lower back • Improves lumbar extension tolerance • Suitable for desk-related stiffness		COMMON MISTAKES • Shrugging the shoulders up around the ears. • Overextending the neck by looking too far upward.	
SHOULD AVOID • Acute lower back pain (case-dependent — start very gently)		REGRESSION • Reduce the height of the lift, staying very gentle.	
TAGS #backbend #office #restorative #beginner-safe #spine			

Camel Pose (Ustrasana)		YG-0019 Advanced	
DIFFICULTY	Advanced	HOLD DURATION	3-5 breaths
SUITABLE GOALS	Fat Loss, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow inhales to create space, exhale to release out of the pose.
MAY SUPPORT	Chronic forward-head posture (under guidance)	PROGRESSION	Reach the hands to the heels only once comfortable with hands-on-back version.
STEPS 1. Kneel tall with the hips stacked over the knees, hands on the lower back for support. 2. Engage the core and lift the chest, arching back gradually. 3. Reach one hand at a time to the heels only if the back allows without strain. 4. Lead the movement with the chest, not by cranking the neck back.			

BENEFITS • Deeply opens the chest, shoulders, and hip flexors • Improves thoracic extension • Counteracts prolonged sitting	COMMON MISTAKES • Compressing the neck by dropping the head back forcefully. • Sinking into the lower back instead of lifting through the chest first. • Rushing into the deepest version without building up gradually.
SHOULD AVOID • Lower back pain • Neck injury • Uncontrolled hypertension	REGRESSION • Keep the hands on the lower back throughout, a gentler variation.
TAGS #backbend #chest-opener #advanced #posture	

Pigeon Pose (Eka Pada Rajakapotasana)

YG-0020 | Intermediate

DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	HOLD DURATION	60-90 s per side
SUITABLE GOALS	Fat Loss, Recovery	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, deep breathing; use exhales to soften into the stretch.
MAY SUPPORT	Tight hips from running or desk sitting, Sciatic tension (gentle version)	PROGRESSION	Reach for the back foot for a quadriceps stretch addition (Mermaid variation).

STEPS

1. From a tabletop position, bring one knee forward behind the wrist, shin angled across the mat.
2. Extend the back leg straight behind, hips squared as much as possible.
3. Fold forward over the front leg, resting on the forearms or a bolster.
4. Breathe into any areas of tightness rather than forcing deeper.

BENEFITS • Deeply opens the hip external rotators and flexors • Relieves tightness from running or cycling • Improves hip range of motion	COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the front shin angle create pain in the knee — adjust the angle immediately if so. • Collapsing onto one hip instead of staying relatively square.
SHOULD AVOID • Acute knee injury • Hip labral tear	REGRESSION • Perform a reclined figure-four stretch instead if the floor version irritates the knee.
TAGS #hip-opener #flexibility #recovery #runners #intermediate	

Standing Forward Fold (Uttanasana)

YG-0021 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	5-8 breaths
SUITABLE GOALS	Fat Loss, Stress relief	BREATHING PATTERN	Long exhales to soften deeper into the fold.
MAY SUPPORT	Tight hamstrings, Mild anxiety, Mild hypertension (avoid dropping the head suddenly)	PROGRESSION	Straighten the legs gradually as flexibility improves.

STEPS

1. Stand tall, then hinge at the hips, folding the torso over the legs.
2. Let the head and neck hang heavy and relaxed.
3. Hold opposite elbows, or let the hands rest on the floor or shins.
4. Bend the knees as much as needed to release the lower back.

BENEFITS • Stretches the hamstrings and calves • Calms the nervous system • Gently decompresses the spine	COMMON MISTAKES • Locking the knees painfully straight. • Rounding aggressively through the lower back to reach the floor.
SHOULD AVOID • Uncontrolled hypertension • Glaucoma • Advanced pregnancy	REGRESSION • Keep a generous bend in the knees throughout.
TAGS #standing #flexibility #calming #beginner-safe #hamstrings	

Legs-Up-The-Wall Pose (Viparita Karani)

YG-0022 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	5-15 minutes
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Recovery, Sleep	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, natural breathing; let it settle on its own.

MAY SUPPORT	Tired or swollen legs, Poor sleep, Post-exercise recovery	PROGRESSION	Add a folded blanket under the hips for a gentle deeper angle.
STEPS 1. Sit sideways against a wall, then swing the legs up as you lie back. 2. Scoot the hips as close to the wall as is comfortable. 3. Rest the arms out to the sides, palms up. 4. Close the eyes and relax completely for the duration.			
BENEFITS • Promotes venous return and reduces leg swelling • Deeply calms the nervous system • Gentle inversion without strain		COMMON MISTAKES • Placing the hips too far from the wall, creating strain rather than rest. • Keeping the shoulders tense instead of letting them melt into the floor.	
SHOULD AVOID • Glaucoma • Uncontrolled hypertension (elevate legs only slightly) • Advanced pregnancy		REGRESSION • Bend the knees and rest the calves on a chair seat instead of a wall.	
TAGS #restorative #recovery #sleep #inversion-lite #beginner-safe #evening			

Corpse Pose (Savasana)		YG-0023 Beginner	
DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	5-10 minutes
SUITABLE GOALS	Stress relief, Recovery, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	No specific pattern — natural, unforced breathing.
MAY SUPPORT	Anxiety, Insomnia, Post-workout recovery	PROGRESSION	Extend the duration for a deeper restorative session.
STEPS 1. Lie flat on the back, legs relaxed and slightly apart, arms at the sides, palms up. 2. Close the eyes and allow the whole body to become heavy. 3. Release any effort in the face, jaw, and hands. 4. Let the breath return to its natural, unforced rhythm.			
BENEFITS • Facilitates complete physical and mental relaxation • Consolidates the benefits of the preceding practice • Lowers heart rate and stress markers		COMMON MISTAKES • Falling fully asleep when the intent is meditative rest (fine occasionally, just note it). • Holding subtle tension in the forehead or jaw.	
SHOULD AVOID • None — modify support if lower back discomfort arises when lying flat		REGRESSION • Place a rolled blanket under the knees to release lower back tension.	
TAGS #restorative #relaxation #closing-pose #beginner-safe #all-levels			

Half Lord of the Fishes (Ardha Matsyendrasana II)		YG-0024 Intermediate													
DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	HOLD DURATION	5-6 breaths per side												
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Digestion	BREATHING PATTERN	Inhale to lengthen, exhale to deepen the twist.												
MAY SUPPORT	Stiffness from prolonged sitting	PROGRESSION	Bind the arm fully around the shin for a deeper variation.												
STEPS 1. Sit tall, bend one knee and step the foot over the opposite thigh. 2. Bend the other leg, foot near the hip, or extend it straight. 3. Inhale to lengthen the spine, exhale to rotate toward the bent knee. 4. Use the opposite arm as a gentle lever against the outer knee. <tr><td colspan="2"> BENEFITS • Improves spinal rotation • Stretches the outer hip and shoulders • Stimulates abdominal organs </td><td colspan="2"> COMMON MISTAKES • Forcing the twist with the arm rather than initiating from the spine. • Rounding the lower back during the rotation. </td></tr> <tr><td colspan="2"> SHOULD AVOID • Acute disc herniation </td><td colspan="2"> REGRESSION • Keep the bottom leg straight rather than bent underneath. </td></tr> <tr><td colspan="4">TAGS #seated #spine #rotation #intermediate</td></tr>				BENEFITS • Improves spinal rotation • Stretches the outer hip and shoulders • Stimulates abdominal organs		COMMON MISTAKES • Forcing the twist with the arm rather than initiating from the spine. • Rounding the lower back during the rotation.		SHOULD AVOID • Acute disc herniation		REGRESSION • Keep the bottom leg straight rather than bent underneath.		TAGS #seated #spine #rotation #intermediate			
BENEFITS • Improves spinal rotation • Stretches the outer hip and shoulders • Stimulates abdominal organs		COMMON MISTAKES • Forcing the twist with the arm rather than initiating from the spine. • Rounding the lower back during the rotation.													
SHOULD AVOID • Acute disc herniation		REGRESSION • Keep the bottom leg straight rather than bent underneath.													
TAGS #seated #spine #rotation #intermediate															

Reclined Bound Angle Pose (Supta Baddha Konasana)

YG-0025 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	3-8 minutes
SUITABLE GOALS	Recovery, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, deep belly breathing.
MAY SUPPORT	Menstrual discomfort, PCOS support, General stress	PROGRESSION	Remove the knee supports as hip flexibility improves.

STEPS

1. Lie on the back and bring the soles of the feet together, knees falling open.
2. Support each knee with a cushion or block if the hips are tight.
3. Rest the arms out to the sides, palms up.
4. Close the eyes and breathe slowly, allowing the hips to release with each exhale.

BENEFITS

- Passive hip and groin opener
- Deeply relaxing for the nervous system
- Gentle support for menstrual discomfort

COMMON MISTAKES

- Forcing the knees down toward the floor.
- Holding tension in the jaw or shoulders instead of relaxing fully.

SHOULD AVOID

- Groin strain
- Recent hip surgery

REGRESSION

- Increase the cushion height under the knees for more support.

TAGS #restorative #hip-opener #womens-health #recovery #beginner-safe

Standing Forward Fold with Shoulder Opener (Uttanasana Variation)

YG-0026 | Intermediate

DIFFICULTY	Intermediate	HOLD DURATION	5-6 breaths
SUITABLE GOALS	Fat Loss, Posture correction	BREATHING PATTERN	Long exhales to deepen both the fold and the shoulder stretch.
MAY SUPPORT	Desk posture strain, Tight shoulders and hamstrings	PROGRESSION	Deepen the fold as the hamstrings and shoulders both loosen.

STEPS

1. Stand and interlace the hands behind the back, straightening the arms.
2. Hinge forward at the hips, folding the torso over the legs.
3. Let the arms fall forward over the head, opening the chest and shoulders.
4. Keep a soft bend in the knees throughout.

BENEFITS

- Combines a hamstring stretch with a shoulder and chest opener
- Relieves upper back and shoulder tension

COMMON MISTAKES

- Locking the elbows painfully straight.
- Rounding the upper back instead of hinging cleanly at the hips.

SHOULD AVOID

- Shoulder impingement
- Uncontrolled hypertension

REGRESSION

- Hold a strap between the hands instead of interlacing the fingers.

TAGS #standing #shoulders #flexibility #office #intermediate

Easy Pose with Forward Fold (Sukhasana Uttanasana)

YG-0027 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	60-90 s
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Stress relief	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, calming breaths, longer on the exhale.
MAY SUPPORT	Mild anxiety, Meditation preparation	PROGRESSION	Hold the fold longer, or walk the hands further out.

STEPS

1. Sit cross-legged with a tall, relaxed spine.
2. Inhale to lengthen upward.
3. Exhale and fold the torso forward over the crossed legs, walking the hands out.
4. Let the forehead rest toward the floor or a cushion.

BENEFITS

- Gently stretches the hips and lower back
- Calms the mind for meditation preparation

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rounding the back sharply instead of hinging from the hips.
- Forcing the fold deeper than current hip flexibility allows.

SHOULD AVOID • Acute knee pain	REGRESSION • Sit on a cushion to elevate the hips above the knees.
TAGS #seated #calming #meditation-prep #beginner-safe #hips	

Standing Side Stretch (Yoga) (Parsva Tadasana) YG-0028 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	5-6 breaths per side
SUITABLE GOALS	Fat Loss, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Inhale to lengthen, exhale to deepen the side bend.
MAY SUPPORT	Rib and side-body tightness	PROGRESSION	Add a slight backward lean for a deeper oblique stretch.

STEPS

1. Stand tall, interlace the fingers, and extend the arms overhead.
2. Keep both feet grounded and hips facing forward.
3. Lean the torso to one side, keeping length through the spine — avoid collapsing.
4. Return to centre and repeat on the other side.

BENEFITS

- Stretches the entire side body and intercostal muscles
- Improves lateral spinal mobility

COMMON MISTAKES

- Leaning forward instead of purely sideways.
- Collapsing the ribcage on the stretched side.

SHOULD AVOID

- Uncontrolled hypertension (avoid holding the breath)

REGRESSION

- Keep the hands on the hips instead of overhead.

TAGS #standing #side-body #flexibility #beginner-safe #office

Thread the Needle (Parsva Balasana) YG-0029 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	45-60 s per side
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Recovery	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, deep breathing, releasing more with each exhale.
MAY SUPPORT	Desk posture strain, Upper back tightness	PROGRESSION	Walk the supporting hand further forward for a deeper stretch.

STEPS

1. Start on hands and knees.
2. Slide the right arm underneath the body, palm up, resting the shoulder and head on the mat.
3. Keep the left hand planted for support, or extend it overhead.
4. Breathe into the stretch across the upper back and shoulder.

BENEFITS

- Releases tension in the shoulders and upper back
- Gently stretches the thoracic spine in rotation

COMMON MISTAKES

- Collapsing all the weight onto the neck instead of the shoulder.
- Rushing out of the pose instead of releasing gradually.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute shoulder injury
- Neck pain (support the head)

REGRESSION

- Place a cushion under the resting shoulder and head.

TAGS #mobility #shoulders #spine #office #beginner-safe #recovery

Happy Baby Pose (Ananda Balasana) YG-0030 | Beginner

DIFFICULTY	Beginner	HOLD DURATION	45-90 s
SUITABLE GOALS	General Fitness, Recovery	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, easy breathing throughout.
MAY SUPPORT	Lower back tightness, General stress	PROGRESSION	Straighten the legs slightly for a deeper hamstring component.

STEPS

1. Lie on the back and draw the knees toward the chest.
2. Grip the outside edges of the feet, opening the knees toward the armpits.
3. Gently rock side to side if it feels good, or hold still.
4. Keep the lower back relaxed against the mat.

BENEFITS • Gently opens the hips and inner groin • Releases tension in the lower back • Calming and grounding	COMMON MISTAKES • Forcing the knees down toward the floor with strain. • Holding the breath instead of breathing into the stretch.
SHOULD AVOID • Knee injury • Advanced pregnancy	REGRESSION • Hold behind the thighs instead of the feet if flexibility is limited.
TAGS #restorative #hip-opener #calming #beginner-safe #evening	

SECTION 3

Stretching Library

Static and dynamic stretches organised by body region.

All Stretches

Neck Side Flexion Stretch

ST-0001 | Neck | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Neck	TARGET	Upper trapezius, scalenes
DOSE	20-30 s per side, 2 rounds	BREATHING	Slow, relaxed breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add gentle overpressure with the hand.	REGRESSION	Perform without hand-assisted overpressure.

EXECUTION

1. Sit or stand tall, spine long.
2. Drop the right ear toward the right shoulder without lifting the shoulder.
3. Rest the right hand gently on the head for light overpressure if desired.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the shoulder pinned down throughout.
- Move into the stretch slowly, never jerk.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Pulling the head down forcefully.
- Lifting the opposite shoulder to compensate.

SHOULD AVOID

- Discontinue with any radiating pain, numbness or tingling into the arm.

TAGS #neck #static #office #morning #beginner-safe

Neck Rotation Stretch

ST-0002 | Neck | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Neck	TARGET	Sternocleidomastoid, upper trapezius
DOSE	15-20 s per side, 2 rounds	BREATHING	Exhale as you rotate.
PROGRESSION	Add a light hand-assisted overpressure at the end range.	REGRESSION	Reduce the rotation range.

EXECUTION

1. Sit or stand tall.
2. Slowly turn the head to look over the right shoulder.
3. Hold at the comfortable end range without forcing.
4. Return to centre and repeat left.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the shoulders level and still.
- Move slowly and stop at the first resistance barrier.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Jerking into the rotation.
- Rotating the whole torso instead of just the neck.

SHOULD AVOID

- Stop with any dizziness, numbness, or sharp pain.

TAGS #neck #static #office #beginner-safe

Upper Trapezius Stretch

ST-0003 | Neck | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Neck	TARGET	Upper trapezius, levator scapulae
DOSE	20-30 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, relaxed exhales.
PROGRESSION	Hold longer, or add the chin-tuck angle for a deeper stretch.	REGRESSION	Perform without hand overpressure.

EXECUTION

1. Sit tall and reach the right hand behind the back or hold the chair seat.
2. Tilt the head to the left, then gently rotate the chin slightly downward.
3. Use the left hand for light overpressure if comfortable.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the shoulder anchored down by holding the chair or reaching back.
- Increase pressure gradually, never suddenly.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Yanking the head with the hand.
- Shrugging the opposite shoulder.

SHOULD AVOID

- Discontinue with radiating symptoms into the arm.

TAGS #neck #static #office #desk-worker #beginner-safe

Cross-Body Shoulder Stretch

ST-0004 | Shoulders | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Shoulders	TARGET	Posterior deltoid, rotator cuff
DOSE	20-30 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, even breathing.
PROGRESSION	Deepen the pull gradually over several breaths.	REGRESSION	Reduce the pull intensity.

EXECUTION

1. Bring the right arm straight across the chest.
2. Use the left forearm to gently pull the right arm closer.
3. Keep the right shoulder down, away from the ear.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Anchor the working shoulder down throughout.
- Pull from the upper arm, not the wrist.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Shrugging the working shoulder up.
- Rotating the torso instead of isolating the shoulder.

SHOULD AVOID

- Recent shoulder dislocation

TAGS #shoulders #static #upper-body #post-workout #office

Overhead Triceps and Shoulder Stretch

ST-0005 | Shoulders | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Shoulders	TARGET	Triceps, latissimus dorsi
DOSE	20-30 s per side	BREATHING	Slow exhales to deepen.
PROGRESSION	Add a slight side bend for an additional lat stretch.	REGRESSION	Hold the upper arm without bending the elbow fully.

EXECUTION

1. Raise the right arm overhead and bend the elbow, hand falling behind the head.
2. Use the left hand to gently press the right elbow further back.
3. Keep the ribcage from flaring forward.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the core braced to avoid an exaggerated lower back arch.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the lower back to compensate.
- Forcing the elbow past a comfortable range.

SHOULD AVOID

- Recent shoulder or elbow surgery

TAGS #shoulders #triceps #static #post-workout

Doorway Chest Stretch

ST-0006 | Shoulders | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Shoulders	TARGET	Pectoralis major, anterior deltoid
DOSE	20-30 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, deep breaths into the chest.
PROGRESSION	Raise or lower the arm position to target different chest fibres.	REGRESSION	Reduce the step distance.

EXECUTION

1. Stand in a doorway, forearm against the frame, elbow at shoulder height.
2. Step forward gently through the doorway until a stretch is felt across the chest.
3. Keep the torso upright — do not let the shoulder hike up.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the shoulder blade drawn down, not shrugged.
- Step forward slowly, in small increments.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Stepping too far forward too fast.
- Twisting the torso instead of stepping straight through.

SHOULD AVOID

- Anterior shoulder instability

TAGS #shoulders #chest #static #office #posture

Shoulder Circles

ST-0007 | Shoulders | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Shoulders	TARGET	Rotator cuff, upper trapezius, deltoids
DOSE	10 circles each direction	BREATHING	Breathe naturally throughout.
PROGRESSION	Add resistance with light dumbbells.	REGRESSION	Perform seated with smaller circles.

EXECUTION

1. Stand or sit tall, arms relaxed at the sides.
2. Lift the shoulders up, roll them back, then down in a smooth circle.
3. Complete the prescribed reps, then reverse direction.
4. Keep the movement slow and full, not small and rushed.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the circles large and deliberate rather than small shrugs.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing through small, ineffective circles.
- Holding the breath.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute shoulder impingement (reduce range)

TAGS #shoulders #dynamic #warm-up #office #morning

Cat-Cow Stretch

ST-0008 | Back | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Back	TARGET	Erector spinae, abdominals
DOSE	8-10 cycles	BREATHING	Inhale into the arch, exhale into the round.
PROGRESSION	Add a lateral wave for additional mobility.	REGRESSION	Perform seated in a chair.

EXECUTION

1. Start on hands and knees.
2. Inhale, arch the back, lifting the chest and tailbone.
3. Exhale, round the spine toward the ceiling.
4. Flow smoothly between the two for the set.

COACHING CUES

- Move with the breath, not faster than it.
- Initiate from the whole spine, not just the neck.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing the movement.
- Forcing range beyond comfort.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute disc herniation with pain on flexion or extension

TAGS #back #dynamic #spine #morning #office #warm-up

Child's Pose Stretch

ST-0009 | Back | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Back	TARGET	Lower back, latissimus dorsi
DOSE	45-90 s	BREATHING	Slow diaphragmatic breathing.
PROGRESSION	Walk the hands further forward.	REGRESSION	Place a cushion between the hips and heels.

EXECUTION

1. Kneel with the big toes together, knees wide.
2. Sit the hips back toward the heels.
3. Fold forward, extending the arms ahead on the mat.
4. Relax the forehead down and breathe into the stretch.

COACHING CUES Let the hips settle back gradually rather than forcing them onto the heels.	COMMON MISTAKES Holding tension in the shoulders instead of releasing.
SHOULD AVOID Advanced pregnancy (widen the knees further)	
TAGS #back #static #recovery #cool-down #beginner-safe	

Standing Lower Back Stretch

ST-0010 | Back | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Back	TARGET	Erector spinae, gluteus maximus
DOSE	20-30 s	BREATHING	Long, slow exhales.
PROGRESSION	Hold for longer, or interlace the hands behind the back for added stretch.	REGRESSION	Rest the hands on the thighs for support.

EXECUTION

- Stand tall, feet hip-width.
- Bend the knees slightly and round forward, reaching for the shins.
- Let the head and neck relax completely.
- Hold, breathing into the lower back.

COACHING CUES Bend the knees enough to release the hamstrings from the equation.	COMMON MISTAKES - Locking the knees straight. - Bouncing to try to reach further.
SHOULD AVOID Acute disc herniation	
TAGS #back #static #office #beginner-safe	

Latissimus Dorsi Stretch (Kneeling)

ST-0011 | Back | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Back	TARGET	Latissimus dorsi, teres major
DOSE	30-45 s	BREATHING	Slow, deep breaths.
PROGRESSION	Shift the hips to one side for a deeper unilateral stretch.	REGRESSION	Use a lower surface for a gentler angle.

EXECUTION

- Kneel in front of a low bench or chair.
- Reach both arms forward onto the surface.
- Sit the hips back, letting the chest drop between the arms.
- Hold, breathing into the side of the ribcage and the armpit.

COACHING CUES - Keep the arms relatively straight throughout. - Sit the hips back to increase the stretch.	COMMON MISTAKES Rounding the shoulders forward instead of lengthening them.
SHOULD AVOID Recent shoulder surgery	
TAGS #back #lats #static #post-workout	

Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch

ST-0012 | Hip | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Hip	TARGET	Iliopsoas, rectus femoris
DOSE	30-45 s per side	BREATHING	Slow exhales to deepen the stretch.
PROGRESSION	Raise the same-side arm overhead for an added rectus femoris stretch.	REGRESSION	Reduce the forward shift and hold a support for balance.

EXECUTION

- Kneel in a half-kneeling lunge, back knee down on a cushion.
- Tuck the pelvis slightly (posterior tilt) and shift the hips forward.
- Keep the torso tall — avoid leaning forward to fake the stretch.
- Hold, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES Tuck the pelvis before shifting forward, or the stretch misses the target.	COMMON MISTAKES - Arching the lower back instead of tucking the pelvis. - Leaning the torso forward to compensate for a shallow hip shift.
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SHOULD AVOID

- Acute hip flexor strain (reduce intensity)

TAGS #hip #static #runners #desk-worker #post-workout

Figure-Four Stretch (Supine)

ST-0013 | Hip | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Hip	TARGET	Piriformis, gluteus medius
DOSE	30-45 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, deep breathing.
PROGRESSION	Pull the thigh closer for a deeper stretch.	REGRESSION	Keep the foot on the floor and only lightly press the crossed knee out.

EXECUTION

1. Lie on the back, knees bent, feet flat.
2. Cross the right ankle over the left knee.
3. Reach through and clasp the left thigh, pulling it gently toward the chest.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the crossed ankle relaxed, not flexed hard against the knee.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Pulling so hard the crossed knee feels pinched.
- Lifting the head and neck instead of keeping them relaxed.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute hip or sciatic pain (reduce range significantly)

TAGS #hip #glutes #static #sciatica-friendly #beginner-safe

Standing Figure-Four Stretch

ST-0014 | Hip | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Hip	TARGET	Piriformis, gluteus medius
DOSE	20-30 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, steady breathing.
PROGRESSION	Increase the depth of the sit.	REGRESSION	Keep both feet on the floor with a gentler cross.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall near a wall for balance.
2. Cross the right ankle over the left knee.
3. Sit the hips back and down as if sitting into a chair.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the standing-leg knee tracking over the foot.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Losing balance and rushing out of the position.
- Rounding the lower back excessively.

SHOULD AVOID

- Balance impairment (hold a wall throughout)

TAGS #hip #glutes #static #balance #intermediate

Butterfly Stretch

ST-0015 | Hip | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Hip	TARGET	Adductors, groin
DOSE	30-60 s	BREATHING	Slow, even breathing.
PROGRESSION	Fold the torso forward for an added stretch.	REGRESSION	Support each knee with a cushion.

EXECUTION

1. Sit tall, soles of the feet together, knees falling open.
2. Hold the ankles or feet with the hands.
3. Gently hinge forward from the hips if comfortable.
4. Let the knees release toward the floor without forcing.

COACHING CUES

- Press down on the knees with the elbows only very gently, if at all.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Forcing the knees down.
- Rounding the back sharply to fold forward.

SHOULD AVOID

- Groin strain
- Recent hip surgery

TAGS #hip #adductors #static #womens-health #beginner-safe

90/90 Hip Stretch

ST-0016 | Hip | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Hip	TARGET	Hip internal/external rotators
DOSE	30-45 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, controlled breathing.
PROGRESSION	Rotate between the two leg positions in a flowing sequence.	REGRESSION	Sit on a cushion to reduce the hip angle demand.

EXECUTION

1. Sit with the front leg bent 90 degrees in front, back leg bent 90 degrees behind.
2. Keep the torso tall and both sit bones grounded.
3. Hinge forward gently over the front shin for a deeper stretch.
4. Hold, then switch the leg configuration.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the front knee at true 90 degrees, not collapsed inward.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting one hip lift off the floor.
- Forcing the torso down before the hips are ready.

SHOULD AVOID

- Knee injury
- Hip labral tear

TAGS #hip #rotation #mobility #runners #intermediate

Adductor (Groin) Side Lunge Stretch

ST-0017 | Hip | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Hip	TARGET	Adductor longus/brevis/magnus
DOSE	20-30 s per side	BREATHING	Slow exhales to deepen.
PROGRESSION	Deepen the side shift, or add a slight forward reach.	REGRESSION	Reduce the stance width and the depth of the shift.

EXECUTION

1. Stand with feet wide, toes forward.
2. Shift the weight into the right leg, bending the right knee and sitting back.
3. Keep the left leg straight, foot flat, feeling the stretch in the inner left thigh.
4. Hold, then shift to the other side.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the bent knee tracking over the foot, not caving inward.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the straight-leg foot roll onto its edge.
- Bouncing between sides instead of holding.

SHOULD AVOID

- Groin strain

TAGS #hip #adductors #static #dynamic #athletic

Standing Hamstring Stretch

ST-0018 | Hamstrings | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Hamstrings	TARGET	Hamstrings, calves
DOSE	20-30 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, deep exhales to deepen the stretch.
PROGRESSION	Raise the foot to a higher surface.	REGRESSION	Keep the raised leg only slightly elevated.

EXECUTION

1. Place one heel on a low step or the floor ahead, leg straight, toes up.
2. Hinge forward at the hips, keeping the spine long.
3. Rest the hands on the thigh or reach toward the shin.
4. Hold, then switch legs.

COACHING CUES

- Hinge from the hips, not by rounding the upper back.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rounding the back to reach further.
- Locking the standing knee too hard.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute hamstring strain (very gentle only)

TAGS #hamstrings #static #post-workout #runners

Seated Hamstring Stretch

ST-0019 | Hamstrings | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Hamstrings	TARGET	Hamstrings, lower back
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DOSE	30-45 s	BREATHING	Slow exhales to deepen gradually.
PROGRESSION	Deepen gradually over successive breaths.	REGRESSION	Bend the knees generously and use a strap around the feet.

EXECUTION

1. Sit with the legs extended straight ahead.
2. Inhale to lengthen the spine, exhale to hinge forward from the hips.
3. Reach toward the shins or feet, keeping the back as straight as possible.
4. Hold, breathing into the stretch.

COACHING CUES

- Hinge from the hips first before allowing any rounding.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Forcing the reach and bouncing.
- Locking the knees painfully straight.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute disc herniation

TAGS #hamstrings #static #post-workout #flexibility

Lying Hamstring Stretch (Strap)

ST-0020 | Hamstrings | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Hamstrings	TARGET	Hamstrings
DOSE	30-45 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, relaxed breathing.
PROGRESSION	Draw the leg closer to the torso as flexibility improves.	REGRESSION	Keep a slight bend in the raised knee.

EXECUTION

1. Lie on the back, one leg extended on the floor.
2. Loop a strap or towel around the ball of the other foot.
3. Straighten that leg toward the ceiling, using the strap to gently draw it closer.
4. Hold, then switch legs.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the lower back pressed gently into the floor throughout.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the raised leg bend to fake more range.
- Yanking hard on the strap instead of easing in gradually.

SHOULD AVOID

- Sciatic nerve irritation (reduce range, keep the knee bent slightly)

TAGS #hamstrings #static #supine #beginner-safe #recovery

Standing Quadriceps Stretch

ST-0021 | Legs | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Legs	TARGET	Quadriceps, hip flexors
DOSE	20-30 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, even breathing.
PROGRESSION	Gently push the hip of the working leg forward for a deeper stretch.	REGRESSION	Hold onto a support and reduce the pull on the ankle.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall, holding a wall or chair for balance if needed.
2. Bend one knee, bringing the heel toward the glutes.
3. Hold the ankle or foot, keeping the knees close together.
4. Hold, then switch legs.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the knees close together rather than letting the bent knee flare out.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the lower back to increase the stretch.
- Yanking the ankle instead of easing into it.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute knee injury

TAGS #quadriceps #static #runners #post-workout

Couch Stretch

ST-0022 | Legs | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Legs	TARGET	Rectus femoris, hip flexors
DOSE	30-45 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, controlled breathing through the intensity.
PROGRESSION	Raise the torso to fully upright for a deeper stretch.	REGRESSION	Reduce the shin angle by using a lower support.

EXECUTION

1. Kneel in front of a couch or bench, back shin resting up against it.
2. Step the front foot forward into a half-kneeling lunge.
3. Tuck the pelvis and shift the hips forward gently.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Tuck the pelvis before adding any forward shift.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Arching the lower back instead of tucking the pelvis.
- Progressing the depth too fast for current hip flexor length.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute knee pain
- Recent knee surgery

TAGS #quadriceps #hip-flexors #static #athletic #intermediate

Calf Stretch (Wall)

ST-0023 | Calves | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Calves	TARGET	Gastrocnemius, soleus
DOSE	20-30 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, even breathing.
PROGRESSION	Bend the back knee slightly to target the soleus as a second stretch.	REGRESSION	Reduce the lean intensity.

EXECUTION

1. Stand facing a wall, hands against it at chest height.
2. Step one foot back, keeping the heel down and the leg straight.
3. Lean into the wall until a stretch is felt in the back calf.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the back heel firmly grounded throughout.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the back heel lift off the floor.
- Turning the back foot outward instead of pointing it forward.

SHOULD AVOID

- Achilles tendinopathy (reduce intensity)

TAGS #calves #static #runners #post-workout #beginner-safe

Soleus Stretch (Bent Knee)

ST-0024 | Calves | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Calves	TARGET	Soleus
DOSE	20-30 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, controlled breathing.
PROGRESSION	Increase the knee bend and forward sink.	REGRESSION	Reduce the depth of the sink.

EXECUTION

1. Stand facing a wall, one foot back, both knees slightly bent.
2. Keeping the back heel down, sink the hips down and forward.
3. The stretch should be felt low in the calf, near the Achilles.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the back knee bent throughout — a straight knee shifts the target to the gastrocnemius.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Straightening the back knee (a different stretch entirely).
- Lifting the back heel.

SHOULD AVOID

- Achilles tendinopathy (reduce intensity)

TAGS #calves #soleus #static #achilles-health #runners

IT Band Stretch (Standing)

ST-0025 | Legs | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Legs	TARGET	Iliotibial band, tensor fasciae latae
DOSE	20-30 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, steady breathing.
PROGRESSION	Raise the same-side arm overhead for a longer stretch line.	REGRESSION	Reduce the lean intensity and hold a support.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall and cross the right leg behind the left.
2. Lean the torso to the left while pushing the right hip out to the side.
3. Hold, feeling the stretch along the outer right thigh.
4. Return to centre and switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Push the hip sideways rather than just leaning the torso.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Leaning forward instead of sideways.
- Rushing through without holding.

SHOULD AVOID

- **Acute lateral knee pain (approach gently)**

TAGS #legs #IT-band #static #runners #intermediate

World's Greatest Stretch

ST-0026 | Full Body | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Full Body	TARGET	Hip flexors, hamstrings, thoracic spine
DOSE	3-5 cycles per side	BREATHING	Breathe fully into each phase of the flow.
PROGRESSION	Add a deeper rotation or a longer hold in each phase.	REGRESSION	Perform each phase separately rather than as a flow.

EXECUTION

1. Step into a long lunge, back leg straight, front knee bent.
2. Place both hands inside the front foot.
3. Rotate the torso and reach one arm toward the ceiling, opening the chest.
4. Return the hand down, then push back to a hamstring stretch by straightening the front leg.

COACHING CUES

- Rushing through the transitions without pausing to feel each stretch.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the front knee cave in during the rotation.
- Skipping the hamstring phase at the end.

SHOULD AVOID

- **Acute hip or hamstring strain**

TAGS #full-body #dynamic #warm-up #mobility #athletic

Standing Toe Touch (Dynamic)

ST-0027 | Hamstrings | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Hamstrings	TARGET	Hamstrings, lower back
DOSE	8-10 reps	BREATHING	Exhale folding down, inhale rising up.
PROGRESSION	Straighten the legs progressively as flexibility allows.	REGRESSION	Reduce the range, folding only halfway.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall, feet hip-width.
2. Hinge forward, reaching toward the toes, knees softly bent.
3. Rise back to standing, rolling up through the spine.
4. Repeat in a slow, continuous rhythm.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the movement slow and controlled, not bouncy.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Bouncing at the bottom of the fold.
- Locking the knees on the way down.

SHOULD AVOID

- **Acute disc herniation**

TAGS #hamstrings #dynamic #warm-up #morning

Arm Circles (Dynamic)

ST-0028 | Shoulders | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Shoulders	TARGET	Deltoids, rotator cuff
DOSE	20-30 s each direction	BREATHING	Breathe naturally.
PROGRESSION	Increase the speed or add light hand weights.	REGRESSION	Reduce the circle size and duration.

EXECUTION

1. Extend the arms out to the sides at shoulder height.
2. Make small circles, gradually increasing the size.
3. Continue for the prescribed time, then reverse direction.

COACHING CUES • Keep the arms at shoulder height throughout, not drifting down.	COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the arms drop below shoulder height. • Moving too fast to control the range.
SHOULD AVOID • Acute shoulder impingement	
TAGS #shoulders #dynamic #warm-up #office	

Walking Lunge with Twist

ST-0029 | Full Body | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Full Body	TARGET	Hip flexors, thoracic spine, quadriceps
DOSE	8-10 steps total	BREATHING	Exhale on the twist, inhale between steps.
PROGRESSION	Add a light medicine ball held at the chest during the twist.	REGRESSION	Remove the twist and perform a standard walking lunge.

EXECUTION

1. Step into a forward lunge, both knees at 90 degrees.
2. Rotate the torso toward the front leg, reaching the arms with it.
3. Return to centre, then push up and step into the next lunge on the other side.
4. Continue for the prescribed distance.

COACHING CUES • Rotate from the torso, not by yanking the arms.	COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the front knee cave in. • Rotating too fast to control.
SHOULD AVOID • Acute knee or lower back pain	
TAGS #full-body #dynamic #warm-up #athletic #core	

Standing Piriformis Stretch (Chair)

ST-0030 | Hip | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Hip	TARGET	Piriformis, gluteus maximus
DOSE	20-30 s per side	BREATHING	Slow, steady breathing.
PROGRESSION	Increase the forward hinge gradually.	REGRESSION	Reduce the hinge, just resting in the crossed position.

EXECUTION

1. Sit on the edge of a chair.
2. Cross the right ankle over the left knee.
3. Keeping the back straight, gently hinge forward from the hips.
4. Hold, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES • Keep the spine long rather than rounding forward.	COMMON MISTAKES • Rounding the back to force the fold. • Pressing down hard on the crossed knee.
SHOULD AVOID • Acute hip or sciatic pain (reduce range)	
TAGS #hip #glutes #static #office #sciatica-friendly	

Wrist and Forearm Stretch

ST-0031 | Forearms | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Forearms	TARGET	Wrist flexors and extensors
DOSE	15-20 s per position, per side	BREATHING	Slow, relaxed breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add gentle wrist circles after the static holds.	REGRESSION	Reduce the pull intensity significantly.

EXECUTION

1. Extend one arm forward, palm up.
2. Use the other hand to gently pull the fingers back toward the body.
3. Hold, then flip the palm down and pull the fingers back the other way.
4. Switch to the other arm.

COACHING CUES • Apply gentle, gradually increasing pressure only.	COMMON MISTAKES • Yanking the fingers back forcefully. • Ignoring pain or tingling.
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SHOULD AVOID

- Carpal tunnel syndrome (very gentle only)
- Acute wrist injury

TAGS #forearms #wrist #static #office #desk-worker

Chest and Shoulder Opener (Clasped Hands)

ST-0032 | Chest | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Chest	TARGET	Pectoralis major, anterior deltoid
DOSE	20-30 s	BREATHING	Deep breaths into the chest.
PROGRESSION	Increase the lift height gradually.	REGRESSION	Keep the hands clasped without lifting far.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall and clasp the hands behind the back.
2. Straighten the arms and gently lift them away from the body.
3. Open the chest and draw the shoulder blades together.
4. Hold, breathing into the chest.

COACHING CUES

- Lift only as high as comfortable — this is not a competition for height.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rounding the shoulders forward to compensate for tight lats.
- Hyperextending the lower back.

SHOULD AVOID

- Anterior shoulder instability

TAGS #chest #shoulders #static #office #posture

SECTION 4

Mobility Drill Library

Joint-specific mobility work for the neck, shoulder, thoracic spine, hip, ankle, and more.

All Mobility Drills

Neck Chin Tucks

MB-0001 | Neck | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Neck	TARGET	Deep cervical flexors
DOSE	10 reps, 2-3 s hold	BREATHING	Exhale on the tuck.
PROGRESSION	Add light manual resistance with the fingertips.	REGRESSION	Reduce the hold duration.

EXECUTION

1. Sit or stand tall.
2. Draw the chin straight back, creating a 'double chin'.
3. Keep the eyes level — this is a glide, not a nod.
4. Hold briefly, then release.

COACHING CUES

- Move straight back, not down or up.
- Keep the movement small and controlled.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Nodding the head down instead of gliding straight back.
- Forcing the range with strain.

TAGS [#neck](#) [#posture](#) [#office](#) [#corrective](#) [#desk-worker](#)

Neck Circles (Gentle)

MB-0002 | Neck | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Neck	TARGET	Cervical musculature
DOSE	5 each direction	BREATHING	Breathe naturally throughout.
PROGRESSION	Increase the range slightly as mobility improves.	REGRESSION	Perform only ear-to-shoulder tilts, no rolling.

EXECUTION

1. Sit tall.
2. Slowly tilt the ear toward one shoulder, then roll the chin toward the chest.
3. Continue to the other shoulder, avoiding tilting the head fully backward.
4. Complete a few slow half-circles, then reverse direction.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the movement slow and within a comfortable range.
- Avoid full backward extension of the neck.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Moving too fast.
- Extending the neck fully backward, which can pinch.

SHOULD AVOID

- Cervical disc issues (perform chin tucks instead)

TAGS [#neck](#) [#mobility](#) [#warm-up](#) [#office](#)

Shoulder Dislocates (Band or Stick)

MB-0003 | Shoulder | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Shoulder	TARGET	Anterior shoulder capsule, chest
DOSE	10-12 reps	BREATHING	Exhale as the band passes overhead.
PROGRESSION	Gradually narrow the grip as mobility improves.	REGRESSION	Perform a smaller range, front raise to overhead only.

EXECUTION

1. Hold a light band or dowel with a wide overhand grip.
2. Keeping the arms straight, raise the band overhead and continue behind the back.
3. Reverse the motion back to the front.
4. Widen the grip if the shoulders cannot complete the pass comfortably.

COACHING CUES

- Widen the grip rather than forcing a narrow one through.
- Keep the arms straight but not locked painfully.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Bending the elbows to fake the range.
- Using a grip too narrow, which strains the shoulder capsule.

SHOULD AVOID

- **Shoulder instability**
- **Recent shoulder dislocation**

TAGS #shoulder #mobility #warm-up #gym #overhead-prep

Scapular Wall Slides

MB-0004 | Shoulder | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Shoulder	TARGET	Serratus anterior, lower trapezius
DOSE	10-12 reps	BREATHING	Exhale sliding up, inhale sliding down.
PROGRESSION	Add light resistance band tension.	REGRESSION	Reduce the range where contact can be maintained.

EXECUTION

1. Stand with the back, head, and arms against a wall, elbows bent at 90 degrees.
2. Slide the arms up the wall as high as possible while keeping contact.
3. Keep the lower back from arching off the wall.
4. Slide back down with control.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the entire arm and lower back in contact with the wall throughout.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the elbows or wrists lift off the wall.
- Arching the lower back to gain more height.

SHOULD AVOID

- **Acute shoulder impingement**

TAGS #shoulder #posture #corrective #office #warm-up

Arm Circles (Mobility)

MB-0005 | Shoulder | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Shoulder	TARGET	Rotator cuff, deltoids
DOSE	20-30 s each direction	BREATHING	Breathe naturally.
PROGRESSION	Add light dumbbells.	REGRESSION	Reduce circle size.

EXECUTION

1. Extend the arms to the sides at shoulder height.
2. Draw slow, controlled circles, small at first, then gradually larger.
3. Reverse direction after the prescribed time.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the shoulder blades engaged, not shrugged.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Circles too fast to control.
- Letting the arms drop below shoulder height.

TAGS #shoulder #warm-up #dynamic #office

Thoracic Rotation (Quadruped)

MB-0006 | Thoracic | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Thoracic	TARGET	Thoracic spine, obliques
DOSE	10 reps per side	BREATHING	Exhale rotating down, inhale opening up.
PROGRESSION	Increase the rotation range and add a brief pause at the top.	REGRESSION	Reduce the rotation range.

EXECUTION

1. Start on hands and knees, one hand behind the head.
2. Rotate the elbow down toward the opposite forearm.
3. Rotate back up and open the chest toward the ceiling, following with the eyes.
4. Complete all reps, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Rotate from the mid-back, keeping the hips still and square.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rotating from the lower back or hips instead of the thoracic spine.
- Moving too fast to control.

SHOULD AVOID

- **Acute lower back pain (keep hips extra stable)**

TAGS #thoracic #spine #rotation #warm-up #desk-worker

Open Book Stretch

MB-0007 | Thoracic | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Thoracic	TARGET	Thoracic spine, chest, obliques
DOSE	8-10 reps per side	BREATHING	Exhale opening, inhale returning.
PROGRESSION	Hold the open position for 2-3 breaths at the end range.	REGRESSION	Reduce the range, stopping the rotation earlier.

EXECUTION

1. Lie on one side, knees stacked and bent to 90 degrees, arms extended together in front.
2. Keeping the knees stacked, open the top arm across the body toward the floor behind.
3. Follow the hand with the eyes and let the upper back rotate.
4. Return to the start and repeat, then switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the knees glued together throughout — that isolates the thoracic rotation.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the top knee lift, which shifts the rotation to the hips.
- Forcing the hand to the floor before mobility allows.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute shoulder pain

TAGS #thoracic #spine #rotation #warm-up #recovery

Thread the Needle (Mobility)

MB-0008 | Thoracic | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Thoracic	TARGET	Thoracic spine, shoulders
DOSE	8 reps per side	BREATHING	Exhale reaching under, inhale opening up.
PROGRESSION	Hold the open position briefly at the top of each rep.	REGRESSION	Reduce the depth of the reach underneath.

EXECUTION

1. Start on hands and knees.
2. Slide the right arm under the body, rotating the chest toward the floor.
3. Reach the left arm toward the ceiling, opening the chest.
4. Return to centre and switch sides.

COACHING CUES

- Rotate from the thoracic spine, keeping the hips relatively still.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Collapsing onto the shoulder instead of rotating through.
- Moving too quickly to feel the range.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute shoulder injury

TAGS #thoracic #spine #rotation #warm-up #dynamic

Hip Circles (Standing)

MB-0009 | Hip | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Hip	TARGET	Hip joint capsule, surrounding musculature
DOSE	8 circles each direction, per leg	BREATHING	Breathe naturally.
PROGRESSION	Increase the circle size.	REGRESSION	Reduce circle size and hold a support.

EXECUTION

1. Stand on one leg, holding a wall for balance if needed.
2. Lift the other knee to hip height and draw slow circles with the knee.
3. Complete the reps, then reverse direction, then switch legs.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the standing leg stable and the pelvis level.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the torso sway to compensate for poor balance.
- Rushing the circles.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute hip pain

TAGS #hip #warm-up #dynamic #balance

90/90 Hip Switch

MB-0010 | Hip | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Hip	TARGET	Hip internal/external rotators
DOSE	8-10 switches	BREATHING	Exhale on each switch.

PROGRESSION	Remove hand support during the switch.	REGRESSION	Use the hands to assist the transition.
EXECUTION			
1. Sit with the front leg bent 90 degrees ahead, back leg bent 90 degrees behind. 2. Lift both knees slightly and rotate them together to switch sides. 3. Land softly in the mirrored 90/90 position. 4. Continue alternating.			
COACHING CUES		COMMON MISTAKES	
• Keep both sit bones close to the floor through the transition.		• Using the hands to muscle through the switch instead of the hips. • Rushing before control is established.	
SHOULD AVOID			
• Hip labral tear • Knee injury			
TAGS #hip #rotation #mobility #warm-up #athletic			

Leg Swings (Front to Back)				MB-0011 Hip Beginner			
SUB-LIBRARY		Hip		TARGET		Hip flexors, hamstrings, adductors	
DOSE		10-15 swings per leg		BREATHING		Breathe naturally with the swing rhythm.	
PROGRESSION		Increase the swing height gradually.		REGRESSION		Reduce the range and swing speed.	
EXECUTION 1. Hold a wall or rack for balance. 2. Swing one leg forward and back in a controlled, pendulum motion. 3. Gradually increase the range as the hip warms up. 4. Complete the reps, then switch legs.							
COACHING CUES • Keep the torso tall and still; the movement comes from the hip.				COMMON MISTAKES • Using momentum from the torso instead of controlled hip movement. • Swinging so hard that control is lost.			
SHOULD AVOID • Acute hip flexor or hamstring strain							
TAGS #hip #dynamic #warm-up #runners #athletic							

Leg Swings (Side to Side)				MB-0012 Hip Beginner
SUB-LIBRARY	Hip	TARGET	Adductors, abductors	
DOSE	10-15 swings per leg	BREATHING	Breathe naturally.	
PROGRESSION	Increase the swing height gradually.	REGRESSION	Reduce the range.	
EXECUTION 1. Hold a wall or rack for balance, standing side-on. 2. Swing one leg across the body and out to the side in a controlled arc. 3. Keep the torso stable and upright throughout. 4. Complete the reps, then switch legs.				
COACHING CUES • Keep the swinging leg relatively straight but not locked.			COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the torso lean to help generate the swing. • Losing control at the end ranges.	
SHOULD AVOID • Groin strain				
TAGS #hip #dynamic #warm-up #athletic				

World's Greatest Stretch (Mobility Flow)				MB-0013 Hip Intermediate
SUB-LIBRARY	Hip	TARGET	Hip flexors, hamstrings, thoracic spine	
DOSE	4-6 reps per side	BREATHING	Breathe fully through each phase.	
PROGRESSION	Add a deeper rotation hold.	REGRESSION	Break the flow into separate static stretches.	

EXECUTION

1. Step into a long lunge, hands inside the front foot.
2. Rotate and reach one arm toward the ceiling.
3. Return the hand down, then straighten the front leg for a hamstring stretch.
4. Step forward into the next lunge and repeat on the other side.

COACHING CUES

- Move through each phase deliberately rather than rushing the flow.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Skipping phases to move faster.
- Letting the front knee cave in.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute hip or hamstring strain

TAGS #hip #full-body #warm-up #dynamic #athletic

Ankle Circles

MB-0014 | Ankle | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Ankle	TARGET	Ankle joint capsule, peroneals
DOSE	10 circles each direction, per foot	BREATHING	Breathe naturally.
PROGRESSION	Add resistance with a band around the foot.	REGRESSION	Reduce the range.

EXECUTION

1. Sit or stand, lifting one foot slightly off the floor.
2. Draw slow, full circles with the foot, leading with the toes.
3. Complete the reps, then reverse direction, then switch feet.

COACHING CUES

- Move through the fullest comfortable range.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing through small, ineffective circles.

TAGS #ankle #warm-up #dynamic #runners #office

Ankle Dorsiflexion Rock (Knee-to-Wall)

MB-0015 | Ankle | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Ankle	TARGET	Ankle dorsiflexors, Achilles complex
DOSE	10-12 reps per side	BREATHING	Exhale driving forward.
PROGRESSION	Move the foot further from the wall as mobility improves.	REGRESSION	Keep the foot closer to the wall.

EXECUTION

1. Kneel in a half-kneeling position with the front foot a few centimetres from a wall.
2. Drive the front knee toward the wall, keeping the heel planted.
3. If the knee touches easily, move the foot slightly further back.
4. Rock forward and back for the prescribed reps.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the heel glued to the floor throughout — that is what makes this a true ankle mobility drill.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Letting the heel lift to fake more knee travel.
- Rocking too fast to control the ankle.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute ankle sprain (early stages — check with a professional first)

TAGS #ankle #mobility #runners #warm-up #rehab

Ankle Alphabet

MB-0016 | Ankle | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Ankle	TARGET	Full ankle range of motion
DOSE	One full alphabet per foot	BREATHING	Breathe naturally throughout.
PROGRESSION	Increase the size of each letter traced.	REGRESSION	Trace only a few letters, keeping the range small.

EXECUTION

1. Sit with one leg extended, foot relaxed and unsupported in the air.
2. Trace the letters of the alphabet in the air with the big toe.
3. Move slowly and deliberately through each letter.
4. Switch feet after completing the alphabet.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the movement originating from the ankle, not the whole leg.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Moving the whole leg instead of isolating the ankle.
- Rushing through the letters.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute ankle sprain — use only pain-free range

TAGS #ankle #rehab #mobility #runners #post-injury

Spinal Segmental Roll-Down

MB-0017 | Spine | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Spine	TARGET	Full posterior spinal chain
DOSE	5-6 reps	BREATHING	Exhale rolling down, inhale rolling up.
PROGRESSION	Slow the tempo further, pausing at several points.	REGRESSION	Bend the knees generously throughout.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall, feet hip-width.
2. Slowly lower the chin, then roll down one vertebra at a time.
3. Let the arms and head hang heavy at the bottom.
4. Reverse the roll, stacking the spine back up one vertebra at a time.

COACHING CUES

- Move slowly enough to feel each segment of the spine articulate individually.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing straight to a full fold without articulating each segment.
- Locking the knees throughout.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute disc herniation

TAGS #spine #mobility #warm-up #morning #office

Standing Pelvic Tilts

MB-0018 | Spine | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Spine	TARGET	Lumbar spine, core
DOSE	10-12 cycles	BREATHING	Breathe naturally with the movement.
PROGRESSION	Add the movement to a squat pattern for functional carryover.	REGRESSION	Reduce the range of the tilt.

EXECUTION

1. Stand tall, hands on the hips.
2. Tilt the pelvis forward, allowing the lower back to arch slightly.
3. Tilt the pelvis backward, flattening the lower back.
4. Continue alternating in a slow, controlled rhythm.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the movement isolated to the pelvis, not the whole torso.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Moving the knees or shoulders to generate the tilt.
- Rushing through the range.

TAGS #spine #core #warm-up #office #beginner-safe

Knee Circles

MB-0019 | Knee | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Knee	TARGET	Knee joint capsule, surrounding musculature
DOSE	8-10 circles each direction	BREATHING	Breathe naturally.
PROGRESSION	Slightly increase the circle size within comfort.	REGRESSION	Reduce the circle size further.

EXECUTION

1. Stand with feet together, hands resting on the knees.
2. Bend the knees slightly and draw slow circles with them together.
3. Complete the reps, then reverse direction.

COACHING CUES

- Keep the circles small and controlled — this is not a squat.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Circles too large, which stresses the knee ligaments unnecessarily.

SHOULD AVOID

- Acute knee injury

TAGS #knee #warm-up #dynamic #office

Wrist Circles and Flexor Stretch

MB-0020 | Wrist | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Wrist	TARGET	Wrist flexors/extensors, joint capsule
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DOSE	10 circles each direction, then 15 s stretch per side	BREATHING	Breathe naturally.
PROGRESSION	Add light resistance with a stress ball squeeze.	REGRESSION	Reduce the circle range.
EXECUTION			
1. Extend the arms forward and make loose fists. 2. Draw slow circles with the wrists, then reverse direction. 3. Finish by gently stretching the fingers back with the opposite hand.			
COACHING CUES		COMMON MISTAKES	
• Keep the circles smooth and pain-free.		• Forcing the stretch at the end. • Ignoring any tingling sensations.	
SHOULD AVOID			
• Carpal tunnel syndrome (very gentle range only)			
TAGS #wrist #warm-up #office #desk-worker			

SECTION 5

Warm-Up Routines

Context-specific warm-up sequences for the gym, home, sport, office, and travel.

All Warm-Up Routines

General Gym Warm-Up (Short)

WU-0001 | Gym | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Gym	TARGET	Full body — raises core temperature and heart rate
DOSE	6-8 minutes total	BREATHING	Natural breathing throughout, settling before working sets begin.
PROGRESSION	Extend the cardio portion and add sport-specific footwork drills.	REGRESSION	Reduce to just the cardio and squats if time is very limited.

EXECUTION

1. 5 minutes light cardio (bike, row, or brisk walk) to raise core temperature.
2. 10 arm circles each direction.
3. 10 bodyweight squats.
4. 10 walking lunges (5 per leg).
5. 8 band pull-aparts.
6. Finish with 2 light, progressively heavier warm-up sets of the first exercise.

COACHING CUES

- Never proceed
- Rush through the ramp-up sets to save time.
- Skip the specific warm-up sets before the heaviest lift of the day.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Skipping straight to working weight on the first exercise.
- Treating the warm-up as optional on time-crunched days — it is the day it matters most.

TAGS #warm-up #gym #general #short

Strength Session Warm-Up (Squat/Deadlift Day)

WU-0002 | Gym | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Gym	TARGET	Hips, hamstrings, spine, ankles
DOSE	10-12 minutes total	BREATHING	Steady breathing; brace fully on the heavier ramp-up sets.
PROGRESSION	Add a paused rep at each ramp-up weight to reinforce positional awareness.	REGRESSION	Reduce to 2 ramp-up sets if time-limited, never fewer.

EXECUTION

1. 3 minutes light cardio.
2. 10 bodyweight good mornings.
3. 10 walking knee hugs (5 per leg).
4. 8 hip circles per leg.
5. 10 glute bridges.
6. Bar-only warm-up set of the main lift for 8 reps.
7. 2-3 ramp-up sets at 50%, 70%, 85% of the working weight.

COACHING CUES

- Jumping straight to a heavy first working set without ramp-up sets.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing the ramp-up sets.
- Skipping the hip-focused mobility work.

TAGS #warm-up #gym #strength #squat #deadlift

Upper Body Push Warm-Up

WU-0003 | Gym | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Gym	TARGET	Shoulders, chest, rotator cuff
DOSE	7-8 minutes total	BREATHING	Natural breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add a longer rotator cuff activation block for shoulder-sensitive lifters.	REGRESSION	Shorten to cardio plus band pull-aparts only.

EXECUTION

1. 3 minutes light cardio.
2. 10 arm circles each direction.
3. 10 band pull-aparts.
4. 8 external rotations per arm with a light band.
5. 10 push-ups (or an easier regression).
6. 1-2 light ramp-up sets of the first pressing exercise.

COACHING CUES

- Skip the rotator cuff activation before heavy pressing.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Going straight to the bench without any shoulder-specific prep.

TAGS #warm-up #gym #push #chest #shoulders

Upper Body Pull Warm-Up

WU-0004 | Gym | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Gym	TARGET	Lats, upper back, biceps, grip
DOSE	7-8 minutes total	BREATHING	Natural breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add extra dead-hang time to prime grip and shoulder capsule.	REGRESSION	Shorten to cardio plus scapular wall slides.

EXECUTION

1. 3 minutes light cardio.
2. 10 scapular wall slides.
3. 10 band pull-aparts.
4. 5 slow scapular pull-ups or dead hangs (10-15 s each).
5. 1-2 light ramp-up sets of the first pulling exercise.

COACHING CUES

- Skip grip and scapular activation before heavy pulling.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Beginning heavy rows or pull-ups with cold shoulders.

TAGS #warm-up #gym #pull #back #biceps

Running Warm-Up (Pre-Run Dynamic)

WU-0005 | Running | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Running	TARGET	Hips, hamstrings, calves, ankles
DOSE	8-10 minutes total	BREATHING	Natural, rhythmic breathing throughout.
PROGRESSION	Add strides at closer to race pace for speed sessions.	REGRESSION	Reduce to walking plus leg swings for easy recovery runs.

EXECUTION

1. 3-5 minutes brisk walking, transitioning to a light jog.
2. 10 leg swings front-to-back per leg.
3. 10 leg swings side-to-side per leg.
4. 10 high knees.
5. 10 butt kicks.
6. 3-4 short strides (20-30 m) building to near-run pace.

COACHING CUES

- Static stretching before the run instead of dynamic movement — save static holds for after.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Starting a hard run session with completely cold muscles.
- Skipping the build-up strides.

SHOULD AVOID

- Chest pain, dizziness, or unusual shortness of breath during warm-up (stop and seek care)

TAGS #warm-up #running #dynamic #outdoor #cardio

Cycling Warm-Up

WU-0006 | Cycling | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Cycling	TARGET	Quadriceps, hip flexors, calves
DOSE	8-10 minutes total	BREATHING	Natural breathing, becoming more rhythmic through the efforts.
PROGRESSION	Extend the moderate-effort intervals for race-specific preparation.	REGRESSION	Use only the easy spin phase for a recovery ride.

EXECUTION

1. 5 minutes very easy spinning at low resistance.
2. 2 minutes progressively increasing cadence.
3. 3 x 20-second moderate efforts with 40 seconds easy spin between.
4. Settle into the target zone for the main session.

COACHING CUES

- Beginning interval work directly from a cold start.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Skipping the cadence build and jumping straight to high resistance.

TAGS #warm-up #cycling #cardio #outdoor #gym

Yoga Practice Warm-Up

WU-0007 | Yoga | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Yoga	TARGET	Spine, hips, shoulders
DOSE	6-8 minutes total	BREATHING	Full, unhurried ujjayi-style breathing throughout.
PROGRESSION	Extend the Sun Salutation rounds for a longer practice.	REGRESSION	Reduce to just Cat-Cow and Child's Pose for a gentle start.

EXECUTION

1. 5-6 rounds of Cat-Cow, moving with the breath.
2. 5 rounds of gentle Sun Salutation A at a slow pace.
3. 3-4 Downward Dog to plank transitions.
4. A few gentle standing side stretches.

COACHING CUES

- Attempting deep backbends or splits on cold muscles.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing straight into advanced poses without this preparatory flow.

TAGS #warm-up #yoga #spine #flow #morning

Home Bodyweight Circuit Warm-Up

WU-0008 | Home | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Home	TARGET	Full body
DOSE	4-5 minutes total	BREATHING	Natural breathing throughout.
PROGRESSION	Add jumping jacks for a higher heart-rate ramp.	REGRESSION	Slow all movements and reduce reps by half.

EXECUTION

1. 1 minute marching in place or jogging on the spot.
2. 10 bodyweight squats.
3. 10 arm circles each direction.
4. 8 walking lunges (4 per leg).
5. 10 standing torso twists.

COACHING CUES

- Skipping straight into a HIIT circuit from a cold start.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Treating this as optional because there is 'no equipment involved'.

TAGS #warm-up #home #no-equipment #apartment-friendly #short

Kids Warm-Up Game (Ages 5-12)

WU-0009 | Kids | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Kids	TARGET	Full body, coordination
DOSE	5 minutes total	BREATHING	Natural breathing — do not over-instruct breathing for young children.
PROGRESSION	Add a favourite song and turn transitions into a dance break.	REGRESSION	Shorten to just the freeze dance and animal walks.

EXECUTION

1. Freeze dance for 60-90 seconds to get moving and laughing.
2. 10 animal walks (bear crawl, crab walk, or bunny hop) across the room.
3. 5 big arm circles each direction.
4. 10 jumping jacks at their own pace.

COACHING CUES

- Making it feel like a chore instead of a game.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Expecting adult-level compliance with precise form cues.

TAGS #warm-up #kids #fun #coordination #games

Senior-Friendly Chair Warm-Up

WU-0010 | Senior | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Senior	TARGET	Full body, joints
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DOSE	5-6 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, natural breathing throughout.
PROGRESSION	Progress to standing warm-up movements as confidence and balance allow.	REGRESSION	Reduce all repetitions and perform entirely seated.

EXECUTION

1. Seated marching in place for 30-45 seconds.
2. 10 seated arm circles each direction.
3. 10 seated ankle pumps (toes up, toes down).
4. 5 gentle seated torso twists.
5. Standing up and sitting down slowly, 5 times, using the armrests if needed.

COACHING CUES

- Any movement causing dizziness — stop and rest if this occurs.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing the sit-to-stand repetitions.
- Skipping this before any walking session.

SHOULD AVOID

- Chest pain, severe dizziness, or shortness of breath (stop and seek care)

TAGS #warm-up #senior #chair #beginner-safe #joint-friendly

Office Desk-Break Warm-Up

WU-0011 | Office | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Office	TARGET	Neck, shoulders, hips, spine
DOSE	3-4 minutes total	BREATHING	Natural breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add a short walk around the office or building.	REGRESSION	Perform the seated versions of each movement.

EXECUTION

1. Stand and march in place for 30 seconds.
2. 10 shoulder circles each direction.
3. 10 standing torso twists.
4. 5 chair squats.
5. A 20-second doorway chest stretch.

COACHING CUES

- Staying seated the entire day without any of these breaks.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing through without actually standing up.

TAGS #warm-up #office #desk-worker #short #posture

Pre-Match Sports Warm-Up (Field/Court)

WU-0012 | Sports | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Sports	TARGET	Full body, sport-specific movement patterns
DOSE	12-15 minutes total	BREATHING	Rhythmic breathing, intensifying with the effort.
PROGRESSION	Add reactive agility drills for court/field sports.	REGRESSION	Shorten the jog and strides for a lower-intensity session.

EXECUTION

1. 5 minutes light jogging, gradually increasing pace.
2. Dynamic leg swings, front-back and side-side, 10 each per leg.
3. 10 walking lunges with a twist.
4. 6 x 20 m build-up strides at increasing intensity.
5. Sport-specific movement drills — direction changes, short sprints, or ball touches.

COACHING CUES

- Sitting or standing still for long periods immediately before kickoff/start.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Static stretching as the primary warm-up (save it for after).

TAGS #warm-up #sports #athletic #pre-match #cricket #football

Cricket-Specific Warm-Up

WU-0013 | Sports | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Sports	TARGET	Shoulders, spine, hips, hamstrings
DOSE	12-15 minutes total	BREATHING	Rhythmic breathing throughout, syncing with throwing/bowling actions.
PROGRESSION	Extend the shadow-bowling progression for fast bowlers specifically.	REGRESSION	Shorten for a light net session or fielding-only day.

EXECUTION

1. 5 minutes light jogging.
2. 10 arm circles each direction, building to bowling-arm swings.
3. 10 trunk rotations (standing woodchopper pattern, bodyweight only).
4. 8 walking lunges with a reach.
5. Progressive throw-down or shadow-bowling reps building intensity.

COACHING CUES

- Bowling or batting at full intensity without a graded build-up.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Skipping shoulder-specific preparation before bowling.

TAGS #warm-up #cricket #sports #athletic #shoulders

Swimming Warm-Up (Pool Deck + Water)

WU-0014 | Swimming | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Swimming	TARGET	Shoulders, lats, spine
DOSE	12-15 minutes total	BREATHING	Rhythmic breathing matched to the stroke.
PROGRESSION	Extend the easy swimming portion for longer sessions.	REGRESSION	Reduce to 100 m easy swimming for a short session.

EXECUTION

1. 5 minutes of arm circles, shoulder dislocates with a band, and torso twists on deck.
2. 200 m easy freestyle or mixed-stroke swimming.
3. 4 x 25 m building pace progressively.
4. A few gentle shoulder stretches at the wall.

COACHING CUES

- Jumping into fast intervals with cold shoulders.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Skipping the deck-based shoulder preparation.

TAGS #warm-up #swimming #shoulders #cardio #athletic

Travel/Hotel Room Warm-Up

WU-0015 | Travel | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Travel	TARGET	Full body
DOSE	3-4 minutes total	BREATHING	Natural breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add jumping jacks for a higher-intensity version.	REGRESSION	Reduce reps by half if space is very limited.

EXECUTION

1. 1 minute marching or jogging in place.
2. 10 bodyweight squats.
3. 10 arm circles each direction.
4. 8 standing torso twists.
5. 5 push-ups against the wall or floor.

COACHING CUES

- Skipping movement entirely on travel days because 'there's no gym'.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Assuming a warm-up needs equipment — it never does.

TAGS #warm-up #travel #hostel #no-equipment #short

HIIT Session Warm-Up

WU-0016 | HIIT | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	HIIT	TARGET	Full body, cardiovascular system
DOSE	6-7 minutes total	BREATHING	Building from natural breathing to rhythmic, harder breathing.
PROGRESSION	Extend the moderate-effort ramp for very high-intensity sessions.	REGRESSION	Shorten to jogging plus squats for a lower-intensity circuit.

EXECUTION

1. 2 minutes easy jogging in place.
2. 10 bodyweight squats.
3. 8 walking lunges.
4. 10 mountain climbers (slow tempo).
5. 3 x 20-second moderate efforts (e.g. fast feet) with 20 seconds rest.
6. Settle briefly before the first HIIT round.

COACHING CUES

- Starting max-effort intervals directly from a cold, resting state.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Treating the warm-up as wasted time before 'the real workout'.

TAGS #warm-up #hiit #cardio #conditioning #gym #home

Apartment-Friendly Low-Noise Warm-Up				WU-0017 Home Beginner	
SUB-LIBRARY	Home	TARGET	Full body		
DOSE	4 minutes total	BREATHING	Natural breathing.		
PROGRESSION	Add resistance band work for more intensity without noise.	REGRESSION	Reduce to marching and arm circles only.		
EXECUTION 1 minute of standing marches (no jumping) to raise heart rate quietly. 10 bodyweight squats. 10 arm circles each direction. 8 standing torso twists. 8 standing calf raises.					
COACHING CUES Assuming a quiet warm-up cannot also be effective — it can.			COMMON MISTAKES Skipping the warm-up specifically to avoid noise, then jumping straight into loud training anyway.		
TAGS #warm-up #apartment-friendly #home #low-impact #quiet					

SECTION 6

Cool-Down Routines

Recovery-focused cool-down sequences matched to the warm-up contexts above.

All Cool-Down Routines

General Gym Cool-Down

CD-0001 | Gym | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Gym	TARGET	Full body — lowers heart rate, begins recovery
DOSE	6-8 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, extending exhales to shift toward a resting state.
PROGRESSION	Extend static holds to 45-60 seconds for a deeper recovery focus.	REGRESSION	Reduce to 2 key stretches if time-limited — never skip entirely.

EXECUTION

1. 3-5 minutes easy walking or light cycling to bring the heart rate down gradually.
2. 30-second standing quadriceps stretch, each side.
3. 30-second standing hamstring stretch, each side.
4. 30-second doorway chest stretch.
5. 60 seconds of slow diaphragmatic breathing to close the session.

COACHING CUES

- Leaving the gym immediately after the last working set without any of this.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing out before the heart rate has settled.
- Skipping stretches entirely on the grounds of being 'too tired'.

TAGS #cool-down #gym #general #recovery

Leg Day Cool-Down

CD-0002 | Gym | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Gym	TARGET	Quadriceps, hamstrings, glutes, calves
DOSE	8-9 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, relaxed breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add a foam-rolling pass on the quads and calves.	REGRESSION	Reduce to hamstring and calf stretches only.

EXECUTION

1. 3 minutes easy walking.
2. 30-second couch stretch, each side.
3. 30-second standing hamstring stretch, each side.
4. 30-second figure-four stretch (supine), each side.
5. 30-second calf stretch at the wall, each side.

COACHING CUES

- Skipping stretches after a heavy squat or deadlift session — this is when they matter most.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing through each hold in under 10 seconds.

TAGS #cool-down #gym #legs #recovery #post-workout

Upper Body Cool-Down

CD-0003 | Gym | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Gym	TARGET	Chest, shoulders, upper back, triceps
DOSE	6-7 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, deep breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add a lat stretch at a low bench for extra depth.	REGRESSION	Reduce to the chest and shoulder stretches only.

EXECUTION

1. 2 minutes easy movement (walking or light arm swings).
2. 30-second cross-body shoulder stretch, each side.
3. 30-second overhead triceps stretch, each side.
4. 30-second doorway chest stretch.
5. 30-second child's pose for the upper back.

COACHING CUES

- Neglecting the upper back after heavy pressing or pulling work.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Skipping the chest stretch specifically, which most lifters do.

TAGS #cool-down #gym #upper-body #recovery

Post-Run Cool-Down

CD-0004 | Running | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Running	TARGET	Calves, hamstrings, hip flexors
DOSE	9-10 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow breathing, letting the heart rate settle fully before stretching.
PROGRESSION	Add foam rolling for the calves and IT band.	REGRESSION	Reduce to a 3-minute walk and calf stretch if time-limited.

EXECUTION

1. 5 minutes easy walking, gradually slowing pace.
2. 30-second calf stretch at the wall, each side.
3. 30-second kneeling hip flexor stretch, each side.
4. 30-second standing quadriceps stretch, each side.
5. 45-second seated hamstring stretch.

COACHING CUES

- Stopping abruptly and sitting down immediately after a hard run.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Static stretching cold muscles before the walk-down portion.

TAGS #cool-down #running #recovery #outdoor #calves

Post-Cycling Cool-Down

CD-0005 | Cycling | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Cycling	TARGET	Quadriceps, hip flexors, lower back
DOSE	6-7 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, relaxed breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add a lat and shoulder stretch for long touring rides.	REGRESSION	Reduce to the easy spin and quad stretch only.

EXECUTION

1. 3-5 minutes very easy spinning to flush the legs.
2. 30-second standing quadriceps stretch, each side.
3. 30-second kneeling hip flexor stretch, each side.
4. 30-second standing lower back stretch.

COACHING CUES

- Dismounting abruptly after a hard interval session without an easy spin down.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Skipping the hip flexor stretch, which tightens significantly from the riding position.

TAGS #cool-down #cycling #recovery #hip-flexors

Yoga Practice Closing Sequence

CD-0006 | Yoga | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Yoga	TARGET	Full body, nervous system
DOSE	12-15 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, natural breathing, releasing all effort by Savasana.
PROGRESSION	Extend Savasana to 10 minutes for a deeply restorative close.	REGRESSION	Shorten to just Savasana if time is very limited.

EXECUTION

1. A few rounds of gentle seated forward folds.
2. Reclined figure-four stretch, each side.
3. Legs-up-the-wall pose for 3-5 minutes.
4. Corpse pose (Savasana) for 5 minutes to close.

COACHING CUES

- Rushing out of practice without any closing stillness.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Checking the phone during what should be the Savasana period.

TAGS #cool-down #yoga #restorative #closing #evening

HIIT Session Cool-Down		CD-0007 HIIT Beginner	
SUB-LIBRARY	HIIT	TARGET	Full body, cardiovascular recovery
DOSE	7-8 minutes total	BREATHING	Long, slow exhales to shift out of the sympathetic (fight-or-flight) state.
PROGRESSION	Add a longer breathing block (box breathing) for very high-intensity sessions.	REGRESSION	Reduce to walking and one stretch if time-limited.
EXECUTION 1. 3-5 minutes easy walking or marching to bring the heart rate down gradually. 2. 30-second standing quadriceps stretch, each side. 3. 30-second standing hamstring stretch, each side. 4. 60 seconds of slow diaphragmatic breathing.			
COACHING CUES • Stopping abruptly after the final HIIT round and sitting down immediately.		COMMON MISTAKES • Skipping the breathing component, which meaningfully speeds heart-rate recovery.	
TAGS #cool-down #hiit #recovery #breathing #gym #home			

Kids Cool-Down Game (Ages 5-12)		CD-0008 Kids Beginner	
SUB-LIBRARY	Kids	TARGET	Full body, calming
DOSE	4-5 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, exaggerated breathing modelled by the instructor or parent.
PROGRESSION	Add a short story or visualization to extend the calm period.	REGRESSION	Shorten to just the balloon breaths.
EXECUTION 1. 1 minute of slow walking or gentle swaying to music. 2. 'Melt like an ice cream' — slowly lower from standing to lying down. 3. 5 slow 'balloon breaths' — big inhale, slow exhale. 4. A minute of quiet lying-down time, imagining floating on a cloud.			
COACHING CUES • Ending activity abruptly with no wind-down at all.		COMMON MISTAKES • Expecting complete stillness immediately without the playful transition.	
TAGS #cool-down #kids #calming #fun #breathing			

Senior-Friendly Cool-Down		CD-0009 Senior Beginner	
SUB-LIBRARY	Senior	TARGET	Full body, joints, balance
DOSE	5-6 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, unforced breathing throughout.
PROGRESSION	Progress stretch durations to 30 seconds as tolerated.	REGRESSION	Perform entirely seated with shorter holds.
EXECUTION 2-3 minutes slow seated or standing marching to ease down gradually. 20-second seated hamstring stretch, each side. 20-second seated shoulder stretch, each side. 60 seconds of slow, comfortable breathing.			
COACHING CUES Standing up quickly right after exercise, risking dizziness.		COMMON MISTAKES Skipping the seated transition period.	
SHOULD AVOID Dizziness or lightheadedness (remain seated and rest)			
TAGS #cool-down #senior #chair #beginner-safe #balance			

Office Post-Workout Cool-Down (Before Returning to Desk)		CD-0010 Office Beginner	
SUB-LIBRARY	Office	TARGET	Full body, mental transition
DOSE	4-5 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, settling breaths.
PROGRESSION	Add a short mindfulness moment for a fuller reset.	REGRESSION	Reduce to the walk and one stretch only.

EXECUTION

1. 2 minutes easy walking.
2. 30-second doorway chest stretch.
3. 30-second standing lower back stretch.
4. 60 seconds of slow breathing to mentally transition back to work mode.

COACHING CUES

- Going straight from a hard lunch-break workout back into back-to-back meetings.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Skipping the mental transition breathing, which affects the rest of the workday's focus.

TAGS #cool-down #office #desk-worker #short #transition

Strength Session Cool-Down (Heavy Lower Body)

CD-0011 | Gym | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Gym	TARGET	Hips, lower back, hamstrings
DOSE	9-10 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, deep belly breathing throughout.
PROGRESSION	Add a longer Savasana-style lying period for full nervous-system recovery.	REGRESSION	Reduce to child's pose and hip flexor stretch only.

EXECUTION

1. 3-5 minutes easy walking.
2. 45-second child's pose.
3. 30-second kneeling hip flexor stretch, each side.
4. 30-second figure-four stretch (supine), each side.
5. 60 seconds of slow breathing lying on the back.

COACHING CUES

- Sitting immediately in a car or at a desk after heavy squats or deadlifts without any of this.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing the hip flexor stretch, which tends to tighten significantly after heavy hinging.

TAGS #cool-down #gym #strength #recovery #hips

Cricket Practice Cool-Down

CD-0012 | Sports | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Sports	TARGET	Shoulders, spine, hamstrings, calves
DOSE	8-9 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, relaxed breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add extra shoulder and thoracic mobility work for bowlers specifically.	REGRESSION	Reduce to a walk and hamstring/quad stretch for a light fielding session.

EXECUTION

1. 3-5 minutes easy walking or jogging.
2. 30-second cross-body shoulder stretch, each side (important for bowlers).
3. 30-second standing hamstring stretch, each side.
4. 30-second standing quadriceps stretch, each side.
5. 30-second doorway chest stretch.

COACHING CUES

- Fast bowlers skipping shoulder-specific stretching after a heavy bowling spell.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Leaving the ground immediately after the session without any wind-down.

TAGS #cool-down #cricket #sports #athletic #shoulders

Post-Match Team Sport Cool-Down

CD-0013 | Sports | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	Sports	TARGET	Full body, especially legs
DOSE	10-12 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, settling breaths.
PROGRESSION	Add light foam rolling for the quads and calves.	REGRESSION	Reduce to a jog and 2 key stretches if time-limited.

EXECUTION

1. 5 minutes easy jogging or walking to flush the legs.
2. 30-second standing quadriceps stretch, each side.
3. 30-second standing hamstring stretch, each side.
4. 30-second calf stretch at the wall, each side.
5. 30-second kneeling hip flexor stretch, each side.

COACHING CUES

- Sitting down immediately in the changing room without any of this.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Treating the cool-down as optional because the match is already won or lost.

TAGS #cool-down #sports #athletic #football #recovery

Post-Swim Cool-Down

CD-0014 | Swimming | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Swimming	TARGET	Shoulders, lats, spine
DOSE	8-9 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, relaxed breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add a longer easy-swim portion after very hard interval sets.	REGRESSION	Reduce to the shoulder stretches alone if pool time is limited.

EXECUTION

1. 100-150 m very easy swimming to flush the shoulders.
2. 30-second cross-body shoulder stretch, each side, at poolside.
3. 30-second overhead triceps stretch, each side.
4. 30-second child's pose or seated forward fold.

COACHING CUES

- Exiting the pool immediately after intervals without an easy swim-down.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Skipping shoulder stretches, which is where most swimmers accumulate tightness.

TAGS #cool-down #swimming #shoulders #recovery

Travel/Hotel Room Cool-Down

CD-0015 | Travel | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Travel	TARGET	Full body
DOSE	4-5 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, unhurried breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add a short legs-up-the-wall period if a wall is available.	REGRESSION	Reduce to the lying-down breathing portion alone.

EXECUTION

1. 1-2 minutes easy walking around the room.
2. 20-second standing quadriceps stretch, each side.
3. 20-second standing hamstring stretch, each side.
4. 60 seconds lying down with slow breathing.

COACHING CUES

- Skipping this entirely and going straight to sitting or lying down after exercise.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Assuming a small room means recovery work is not possible.

TAGS #cool-down #travel #hostel #home #short

HIIT to Meditation Transition Cool-Down

CD-0016 | HIIT | Intermediate

SUB-LIBRARY	HIIT	TARGET	Full body, nervous system
DOSE	8-10 minutes total	BREATHING	Progressing from natural recovery breathing into structured box breathing.
PROGRESSION	Extend the stillness period to a full 5-10 minute meditation.	REGRESSION	Shorten to walking and box breathing only.

EXECUTION

1. 3 minutes easy walking, letting the breathing rate fall naturally.
2. 30-second standing hamstring stretch, each side.
3. 60 seconds of box breathing (4-4-4-4) seated or lying down.
4. 2-3 minutes of a brief guided body scan or stillness.

COACHING CUES

- Jumping straight from maximal effort into a car, a shower, or a meeting.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Treating the breathing portion as optional rather than integral to recovery.

TAGS #cool-down #hiit #breathing #meditation #recovery #mind-reset

Apartment-Friendly Quiet Cool-Down

CD-0017 | Home | Beginner

SUB-LIBRARY	Home	TARGET	Full body
DOSE	5 minutes total	BREATHING	Slow, quiet breathing.
PROGRESSION	Add a short guided relaxation for a fuller reset.	REGRESSION	Reduce to the lying-down breathing portion alone.

EXECUTION

1. 2 minutes slow standing movement (no jumping).
2. 20-second standing quadriceps stretch, each side.
3. 20-second standing hamstring stretch, each side.
4. 60 seconds of quiet lying-down breathing.

COACHING CUES

- Skipping the wind-down because the session itself was already low-impact.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing back into other tasks immediately after finishing.

TAGS #cool-down #apartment-friendly #home #quiet #short

SECTION 7

Breathing Method Library

Pranayama, clinical, and applied breathing techniques for stress, sleep, focus, and performance.

All Breathing Methods

Box Breathing

BR-0001 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Tactical/Military	PATTERN (SEC)	4-4-4-4
DURATION	3-5 minutes	BEST TIME	Before competition, exams, or stressful meetings; anytime tension spikes
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Weight Loss, Strength, General Fitness, Stress Relief, Focus	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Sit tall or lie down comfortably.
2. Inhale through the nose for a count of 4.
3. Hold the breath gently for a count of 4.
4. Exhale slowly through the nose or mouth for a count of 4.
5. Hold the empty lungs for a count of 4, then repeat.

BENEFITS

- Rapidly reduces acute stress and heart rate
- Improves focus before high-pressure tasks
- Trains conscious control over the autonomic nervous system

COMMON MISTAKES

- Forcing the breath instead of keeping it smooth and gentle.
- Holding so long that the next inhale becomes gasping.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- Severe respiratory conditions (consult a doctor first)
- Acute panic (start with simple exhale-focused breathing instead)

TAGS #box-breathing #stress-relief #focus #pre-competition #quick

Diaphragmatic (Belly) Breathing

BR-0002 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Foundational/Clinical	PATTERN (SEC)	4 in - 6 out
DURATION	5-10 minutes	BEST TIME	Morning, before sleep, or anytime as a foundational daily practice
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	General Fitness, Weight Loss, Stress Relief, Recovery	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Lie down or sit comfortably, one hand on the chest, one on the belly.
2. Inhale slowly through the nose, feeling the belly rise while the chest stays still.
3. Exhale slowly through pursed lips, feeling the belly fall.
4. Continue, keeping the chest hand as still as possible.

BENEFITS

- Strengthens the diaphragm as the primary breathing muscle
- Lowers resting heart rate over time
- Foundational skill that improves all other breathing techniques

COMMON MISTAKES

- Breathing into the chest instead of the belly.
- Forcing a large breath instead of a natural, relaxed one.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- None significant — one of the safest breathing techniques for nearly everyone

TAGS #diaphragmatic #foundational #beginner-safe #daily #sleep

4-7-8 Breathing

BR-0003 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Clinical/Relaxation	PATTERN (SEC)	4-7-8
DURATION	4 rounds initially, building to 8	BEST TIME	Before sleep, or during anxious moments
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Sleep, Stress Relief, General Fitness	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Sit or lie down comfortably.
2. Exhale completely through the mouth first.
3. Inhale quietly through the nose for a count of 4.
4. Hold the breath for a count of 7.
5. Exhale slowly and completely through the mouth for a count of 8.

BENEFITS

- Strongly promotes pre-sleep relaxation
- Slows heart rate through the extended exhale
- Reduces racing thoughts before bed

COMMON MISTAKES

- Starting with too many rounds — dizziness is common when new to this ratio.
- Forcing the 7-count hold when it feels genuinely uncomfortable; shorten it instead.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- Respiratory conditions such as COPD or asthma (the long hold may be uncomfortable)
- Pregnancy (use gentler ratios)

TAGS #4-7-8 #sleep #relaxation #evening #beginner-safe

Anulom Vilom (Alternate Nostril Breathing)

BR-0004 | Intermediate

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Yogic/Pranayama	PATTERN (SEC)	Equal inhale-exhale, alternating nostrils
DURATION	5-10 minutes	BEST TIME	Morning practice, or before meditation and study
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	General Fitness, Focus, Stress Relief	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate

METHOD

1. Sit tall and use the right thumb to close the right nostril.
2. Inhale slowly through the left nostril.
3. Close the left nostril with the ring finger, release the thumb, and exhale through the right.
4. Inhale through the right, then switch and exhale through the left. Continue alternating.

BENEFITS

- Balances activity between the left and right sides of the nervous system
- Improves focus and mental clarity
- Traditionally associated with calming an overactive mind

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing the switches between nostrils.
- Straining the breath instead of keeping it smooth.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- Nasal congestion or a blocked nose (practice mental alternate-nostril breathing instead)
- Severe respiratory conditions

TAGS #anulom-vilom #pranayama #yoga #focus #morning #students

Bhramari (Humming Bee Breath)

BR-0005 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Yogic/Pranayama	PATTERN (SEC)	Extended humming exhale
DURATION	5-8 rounds	BEST TIME	Evening, or during moments of frustration or racing thoughts
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Stress Relief, Sleep, General Fitness	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Sit comfortably with the eyes closed.
2. Inhale normally through the nose.
3. Exhale slowly while making a continuous humming sound, like a bee.
4. Optionally, use the thumbs to gently close the ears and fingers to lightly rest on the closed eyes.
5. Repeat for the prescribed rounds.

BENEFITS • Produces a rapid, noticeable calming effect via the vibration and vagal stimulation • Reduces mental agitation and anger • Useful before sleep or in acute stress	COMMON MISTAKES • Humming so loudly it strains the throat. • Rushing through without letting the vibration settle.
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SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- Ear infections (avoid closing the ears)
- Pregnancy (practice gently)

TAGS #bhramari #pranayama #yoga #calming #anger-relief #evening

Pursed-Lip Breathing

BR-0006 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Clinical/Respiratory	PATTERN (SEC)	Inhale 2, exhale 4 (pursed lips)
DURATION	5-10 breaths, as needed	BEST TIME	During breathlessness, exertion, or respiratory flare-ups
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Recovery, General Fitness	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Sit comfortably with relaxed shoulders.
2. Inhale slowly through the nose for a count of 2.
3. Purse the lips as if about to whistle.
4. Exhale slowly and gently through the pursed lips for a count of 4.

BENEFITS

- Keeps airways open longer during exhale, easing breathlessness
- Widely used in respiratory rehabilitation
- Slows an overly rapid breathing rate

COMMON MISTAKES

- Forcing the exhale hard instead of keeping it slow and controlled.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- None significant when used as directed — this technique is often recommended by respiratory therapists

TAGS #pursed-lip #respiratory #asthma-friendly #breathlessness #clinical

Deep Belly Breathing (3-Part Breath)

BR-0007 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Yogic/Foundational	PATTERN (SEC)	Slow, full 3-stage inhale/exhale
DURATION	5-8 minutes	BEST TIME	Anytime as a grounding practice, especially before meditation
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	General Fitness, Stress Relief	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Sit or lie down comfortably.
2. Inhale slowly, filling the belly first, then the ribs, then the upper chest.
3. Pause briefly at the top.
4. Exhale slowly in reverse — upper chest first, then ribs, then belly.

BENEFITS

- Maximises lung capacity utilisation
- Deeply calming for the nervous system
- Improves body awareness of the breathing mechanism

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing through the three stages instead of feeling each distinctly.
- Straining for maximum capacity instead of a natural full breath.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- None significant

TAGS #three-part-breath #yoga #foundational #grounding #beginner-safe

Ujjayi (Ocean/Victorious Breath)

BR-0008 | Intermediate

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Yogic/Pranayama	PATTERN (SEC)	Slow nasal breathing with a soft throat constriction
DURATION	Throughout a yoga session, or 5 minutes standalone	BEST TIME	During yoga asana practice, or as focus training
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	General Fitness, Focus, Athletic	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate

METHOD

1. Inhale through the nose while gently constricting the back of the throat, creating a soft ocean-like sound.
2. Exhale through the nose maintaining the same gentle constriction.
3. Keep the sound smooth and even, like a soft, steady rasp.
4. Continue for the duration of the yoga practice or the prescribed time.

BENEFITS

- Helps maintain a steady rhythm through a physical yoga practice
- Builds heat and focus during movement
- Improves breath awareness during exertion

COMMON MISTAKES

- Constricting the throat so hard it becomes strained rather than soft.
- Losing the sound consistency as fatigue sets in during a physical practice.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- Throat irritation or recent throat surgery

TAGS #ujjayi #pranayama #yoga #focus #athletic

Kapalabhati (Skull-Shining Breath)

BR-0009 | Advanced

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Yogic/Pranayama	PATTERN (SEC)	Rapid forceful exhale, passive inhale
DURATION	20-30 rapid breaths per round, 2-3 rounds	BEST TIME	Morning, or when needing an energy and focus boost
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Focus, Athletic	DIFFICULTY	Advanced

METHOD

1. Sit tall with a straight spine.
2. Take a normal inhale, then sharply contract the abdomen to force a quick exhale through the nose.
3. Let the inhale happen passively and naturally between exhales.
4. Continue in rapid succession for the prescribed count, then rest and breathe normally.

BENEFITS

- Energising, used traditionally to build alertness and mental clarity
- Strengthens the abdominal and diaphragmatic muscles
- May improve focus when practiced appropriately

COMMON MISTAKES

- Forcing the breath too hard, causing dizziness or lightheadedness.
- Practicing on a full stomach.
- Continuing despite dizziness instead of stopping and resting.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- Pregnancy
- Hypertension
- Recent abdominal surgery
- Hernia
- Epilepsy
- Panic disorder

TAGS #kapalabhati #pranayama #energising #advanced #morning #caution

Coherent Breathing (5-5 Resonant Breath)

BR-0010 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Clinical/Research-Based	PATTERN (SEC)	5-5
DURATION	10-20 minutes for maximum benefit; even 5 minutes helps	BEST TIME	Daily practice, or before demanding cognitive or physical tasks
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	General Fitness, Stress Relief, Focus	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Sit or lie comfortably.
2. Inhale slowly through the nose for a count of 5.
3. Exhale slowly through the nose for a count of 5.
4. Continue at this steady, even pace without pauses.

BENEFITS

- Widely studied for optimising heart rate variability
- Balances the sympathetic and parasympathetic nervous system
- Simple enough for daily use without a learning curve

COMMON MISTAKES

- Rushing the counts instead of a slow, even pace.
- Adding pauses that break the smooth rhythm.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- None significant

TAGS #coherent-breathing #resonant #hrv #daily #beginner-safe

Physiological Sigh

BR-0011 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Clinical/Research-Based	PATTERN (SEC)	Double inhale, long exhale
DURATION	1-3 breaths, repeated as needed	BEST TIME	In-the-moment acute stress, panic, or overwhelm
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Stress Relief, General Fitness	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Take a deep inhale through the nose.
2. At the top, take a second short, sharp inhale to top off the lungs.
3. Exhale slowly and fully through the mouth, letting all tension go.
4. Repeat 1-3 times as needed.

BENEFITS

- One of the fastest known techniques for rapidly lowering acute stress and anxiety
- Efficiently offloads carbon dioxide
- Requires no counting or practice to use effectively

COMMON MISTAKES

- Forcing the second inhale too hard.
- Rushing the exhale instead of letting it fully release.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- None significant — safe for acute use by nearly everyone

TAGS #physiological-sigh #acute-stress #quick #research-based #anytime

Resonant Breathing for Sleep (6-Count)

BR-0012 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Clinical/Sleep	PATTERN (SEC)	4 in - 6 out, lying down
DURATION	10-15 breaths, or until sleep	BEST TIME	Immediately before sleep, in bed with lights off
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Sleep, Stress Relief	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Lie down in bed in a comfortable position.
2. Inhale gently through the nose for a count of 4.
3. Exhale slowly and completely through the nose for a count of 6.
4. Continue, allowing the body to grow heavier with each exhale.

BENEFITS

- Extends the exhale to favour the parasympathetic (rest) nervous system
- Reduces pre-sleep racing thoughts
- Simple enough to fall asleep during the practice itself

COMMON MISTAKES

- Trying too hard to 'succeed' at falling asleep, which itself creates tension.
- Counting so precisely that it becomes a source of stress rather than relaxation.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- None significant

TAGS #sleep-breathing #evening #bedtime #beginner-safe #relaxation

Lion's Breath (Simhasana)

BR-0013 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Yogic/Pranayama	PATTERN (SEC)	Sharp forceful exhale with tongue out
DURATION	5-6 rounds	BEST TIME	When feeling tense, self-conscious, or before public speaking
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Stress Relief, Confidence	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Kneel or sit comfortably, hands resting on the knees.
2. Inhale deeply through the nose.
3. Open the mouth wide, stick the tongue out toward the chin, and exhale forcefully with a 'ha' sound.
4. Relax the face and repeat for several rounds.

BENEFITS • Releases facial and jaw tension • Can reduce social anxiety and self-consciousness through playful release • Stimulates the throat and platysma muscles	COMMON MISTAKES • Holding back and doing it half-heartedly — the release is the point. • Straining the throat by forcing the sound too hard.
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SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- Recent jaw or dental surgery
- TMJ disorder (perform gently)

TAGS #lions-breath #pranayama #confidence #playful #tension-release

Extended Exhale Breathing (1:2 Ratio)

BR-0014 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Clinical/Foundational	PATTERN (SEC)	4 in - 8 out
DURATION	5-10 minutes	BEST TIME	Anytime stress or anxiety needs to be brought down
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Stress Relief, General Fitness, Anxiety Relief	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Sit or lie comfortably.
2. Inhale through the nose for a count of 4.
3. Exhale slowly through the nose or mouth for a count of 8, twice the length of the inhale.
4. Continue for the prescribed duration, adjusting counts to comfort.

BENEFITS

- A longer exhale relative to inhale reliably activates the calming nervous system response
- Simple, adjustable ratio suitable for all experience levels

COMMON MISTAKES

- Forcing an 8-count exhale before it feels natural — start with a shorter ratio like 4-6.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- None significant

TAGS #extended-exhale #1-2-ratio #anxiety-relief #foundational #beginner-safe

Breath Counting for Focus

BR-0015 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Meditative/Concentration	PATTERN (SEC)	Natural breath, counted to 10
DURATION	5-15 minutes	BEST TIME	Before study, work, or as a meditation entry practice
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Focus, Students	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Sit comfortably with the eyes closed or softly focused downward.
2. Breathe naturally, counting each exhale silently: one, two, three...
3. Upon reaching ten, begin again at one.
4. If the count is lost, simply begin again at one without frustration.

BENEFITS

- Trains sustained attention
- A widely used entry point into concentration meditation
- Builds awareness of when the mind has wandered

COMMON MISTAKES

- Getting frustrated when the count is lost — losing count is normal and expected, not a failure.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- None significant

TAGS #breath-counting #focus #students #concentration #meditation-prep

Cooling Breath (Sitali)

BR-0016 | Intermediate

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Yogic/Pranayama	PATTERN (SEC)	Inhale through curled tongue, exhale through nose
DURATION	5-8 rounds	BEST TIME	After exercise in heat, or during frustration or agitation
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Stress Relief, Recovery	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate

METHOD

1. Sit comfortably and curl the tongue into a tube shape (or purse the lips if unable to curl).
2. Inhale slowly through the curled tongue, feeling a cooling sensation.
3. Close the mouth and exhale slowly through the nose.
4. Repeat for the prescribed rounds.

BENEFITS

- Traditionally used to cool the body and calm irritability
- Useful in hot climates or after intense exercise
- Calms an agitated or frustrated mind

COMMON MISTAKES

- Forcing the inhale instead of a slow, gentle draw of air.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- Low blood pressure (practice cautiously)
- Cold or respiratory congestion

TAGS #sitali #cooling #pranayama #post-exercise #hot-climate

Square Breathing for Exam Stress

BR-0017 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Clinical/Applied	PATTERN (SEC)	4-4-4-4
DURATION	1-2 minutes	BEST TIME	Immediately before or during an exam, when stuck on a question
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Students, Focus, Stress Relief	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Sit at the desk or in the exam hall with feet flat on the floor.
2. Inhale quietly through the nose for a count of 4.
3. Hold gently for a count of 4.
4. Exhale through the nose for a count of 4, then hold empty for a count of 4.
5. Repeat 3-4 cycles before beginning or during a difficult question.

BENEFITS

- Rapidly reduces exam-related anxiety without needing to leave the desk
- Restores clear thinking under time pressure
- Discreet enough to use during an actual exam

COMMON MISTAKES

- Overthinking the counts to the point of adding new stress — approximate counting is fine.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- None significant

TAGS #exam-stress #students #box-breathing #quick #focus

Recovery Breathing (Post-Exercise)

BR-0018 | Beginner

TRADITION / ORIGIN	Clinical/Applied	PATTERN (SEC)	Slow nasal in, longer mouth-out
DURATION	2-5 minutes	BEST TIME	Immediately after a hard training session or match
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Recovery, Athletic	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Sit or stand with hands on the head or hips to open the ribcage.
2. Inhale through the nose for a count of 3-4.
3. Exhale slowly through pursed lips for a count of 5-6.
4. Continue until the heart rate and breathing rate settle.

BENEFITS

- Speeds the return to a resting heart rate after intense exercise
- Prevents the light-headedness that can follow abrupt stopping
- Signals the nervous system to shift out of a training state

COMMON MISTAKES

- Bending fully over immediately after exercise instead of keeping the chest open.

SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF

- None significant

TAGS #post-exercise #recovery #athletic #cool-down #beginner-safe

Extended Practitioner Breathwork (Guided Rapid Breathing)				BR-0019 Advanced
TRADITION / ORIGIN	Modern/Applied	PATTERN (SEC)	30 rapid breaths, then breath hold	
DURATION	3 rounds of 25-30 breaths plus holds	BEST TIME	Morning, on an empty stomach, in a safe seated or lying position	
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Athletic, Focus	DIFFICULTY	Advanced	
METHOD 1. Lie or sit comfortably. 2. Take 25-30 deep, full but relaxed breaths in rapid succession, exhaling passively. 3. After the final exhale, hold the breath for as long as comfortable. 4. Take a recovery breath in, hold for 10-15 seconds, then release and breathe normally. 5. Repeat for 2-3 rounds if desired, resting between rounds.				
BENEFITS • Some practitioners report improved subjective energy and stress resilience • Can produce a temporary lightheaded, alert state		COMMON MISTAKES • Practicing while standing, driving, or in water — the fainting risk is real. • Forcing breath holds beyond comfort out of competitiveness.		
SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF • Pregnancy • Epilepsy or seizure history • Cardiovascular disease • Never practice in water or while driving • Fainting risk — always perform seated or lying down				
TAGS #rapid-breathwork #advanced #caution #energising #morning				

Grounding Breath for Panic		BR-0020 Beginner	
TRADITION / ORIGIN	Clinical/Applied	PATTERN (SEC)	Slow exhale-led breathing with 5-4-3-2-1 grounding
DURATION	2-5 minutes, or until the acute wave passes	BEST TIME	During a panic episode or acute overwhelm
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Anxiety Relief, Stress Relief	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
METHOD 1. Sit or stand in a stable position; feel the feet firmly on the floor. 2. Exhale slowly first, longer than the inhale. 3. Inhale gently through the nose, then exhale again slowly. 4. While breathing, silently name 5 things you can see, 4 things you can touch, 3 things you can hear.			
BENEFITS • Combines breath regulation with sensory grounding for acute panic • Interrupts the spiral of catastrophic thinking common in panic states		COMMON MISTAKES • Trying to force calm immediately — allow the wave to pass gradually rather than fighting it.	
SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF • This technique supports acute distress; it is not a substitute for professional mental health care			
TAGS #panic #grounding #anxiety-relief #acute #clinical			

Two-Minute Desk Reset Breath			BR-0021 Beginner
TRADITION / ORIGIN	Applied/Office	PATTERN (SEC)	4 in - 4 hold - 6 out
DURATION	90 seconds - 2 minutes	BEST TIME	Between meetings, or when mental fatigue sets in at work
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Office Worker, Focus, Stress Relief	DIFFICULTY	Beginner

METHOD

1. Sit tall in the chair, feet flat on the floor, hands resting on the desk.
2. Inhale through the nose for a count of 4.
3. Hold gently for a count of 4.
4. Exhale slowly through the nose for a count of 6.
5. Repeat for 6-8 cycles.

BENEFITS • Breaks the tension cycle of back-to-back meetings • Restores mental clarity without leaving the desk • Takes under 2 minutes, fitting into any workday	COMMON MISTAKES • Skipping this because '2 minutes feels too short to matter' — brief, frequent resets compound.
SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF • None significant	
TAGS #desk-reset #office #quick #focus #workday	

Pre-Sleep Wind-Down Breath (Extended)			BR-0022 Beginner
TRADITION / ORIGIN	Clinical/Sleep	PATTERN (SEC)	4 in - 7 hold - 8 out, extended session
DURATION	10-15 minutes	BEST TIME	In bed, as the final step before attempting sleep
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Sleep, Stress Relief	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
METHOD 1. Lie down in bed with the lights off. 2. Perform 4-7-8 breathing for the first 4 rounds. 3. Transition into natural, slow breathing, letting the counting fade. 4. Allow the mind to rest on the sensation of the breath alone until sleep arrives.			
BENEFITS • Combines an active technique with a passive transition into natural sleep • Reduces the time it takes to fall asleep for many people		COMMON MISTAKES • Checking the time repeatedly, which reintroduces alertness. • Treating it as a task to 'complete' rather than a gentle transition.	
SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF • Respiratory conditions where breath-holding is uncomfortable — use plain extended-exhale breathing instead			
TAGS #sleep #bedtime #extended #wind-down #beginner-safe			

Performance Breath (Pre-Competition)			BR-0023 Intermediate
TRADITION / ORIGIN	Applied/Athletic	PATTERN (SEC)	Sharp inhale, powerful exhale
DURATION	1-2 minutes	BEST TIME	Immediately before competition, a big presentation, or a high-stakes moment
SUITABLE CONDITIONS	Athletic, Focus, Confidence	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
METHOD 1. Stand tall in an athletic ready position. 2. Take 3 slow, full breaths to settle the nerves. 3. Follow with 2-3 sharp, energising breaths — quick inhale, strong exhale. 4. Finish with one long, slow exhale, then move into the activity with full focus.			
BENEFITS • Balances the need for calm focus with the need for physical readiness • Widely used by athletes to bridge pre-competition nerves into controlled arousal		COMMON MISTAKES • Only doing the calming breaths and skipping the activation breaths — under-arousal hurts performance too.	
SHOULD AVOID / STOP IF • None significant for healthy competitors			
TAGS #pre-competition #athletic #performance #activation #confidence			

SECTION 8

Meditation Library

Core meditation styles for stress, sleep, focus, confidence, and athletic performance.

All Meditations

Guided Breath Awareness

MD-0001 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Breathing Focus	GOAL	Stress Relief
DURATION	10 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	General Fitness, Beginners, Stress Relief	BREATHING PATTERN	Natural breathing, unforced

MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR)

The physical sensation of air moving in and out of the body.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Sit comfortably with the spine tall and the eyes closed or softly lowered.
2. Bring attention to the physical sensation of the breath — at the nostrils, chest, or belly.
3. Simply observe each inhale and exhale without trying to change them.
4. When the mind wanders to a thought, gently note it, and guide attention back to the breath.

BENEFITS

- Builds the foundational attention-anchoring skill used in every other meditation style
- Associated with reduced markers of stress after regular practice
- Requires no imagery or special conditions — works anywhere

COACH TIPS

- Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
- Start with just 3-5 minutes if 10 feels long; consistency matters more than duration.

EVIDENCE NOTE

Breath-focused attention training is one of the most widely studied meditation approaches, with consistent evidence for modest reductions in self-reported stress.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Trying to control or deepen the breath instead of simply observing it.
- Treating a wandering mind as a failure rather than the expected, normal pattern.

PROGRESSION / REGRESSION

- Progress: Extend to 15-20 minutes, or add counting each exhale.
- Regress: Reduce to 3-5 minutes with a guided audio track for support.

TAGS [#breathing](#) [#foundational](#) [#stress-relief](#) [#beginner-safe](#) [#anywhere](#)

Body Scan Relaxation

MD-0002 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Somatic	GOAL	Sleep
DURATION	12 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Sleep, Recovery, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, natural breathing throughout

MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR)

Physical sensation in each body part, moving progressively from feet to head.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Lie down comfortably, allowing the whole body to relax into the surface beneath.
2. Bring attention to the toes, noticing any sensation without trying to change it.
3. Slowly move attention upward — feet, legs, hips, torso, arms, shoulders, neck, face.
4. Spend a few breaths at each area before moving to the next, releasing tension as you go.

BENEFITS • Widely used as a pre-sleep practice to shift out of a racing, thinking mind • Improves interoceptive awareness (the ability to sense internal bodily states) • Reliably lowers muscular tension even for first-time practitioners	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself. • It is completely fine to fall asleep during this practice if done at bedtime.
EVIDENCE NOTE Body scan techniques are a core component of mindfulness-based stress reduction (MBSR) programs, with consistent evidence for improved sleep onset.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Rushing through the body instead of dwelling briefly at each part. • Forcing relaxation instead of simply noticing what is already there.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Slow the pace further, spending a full minute at each major body region. • Regress: Scan only the major regions (legs, torso, arms, head) rather than each individual part.
TAGS #body-scan #sleep #somatic #recovery #evening #beginner-safe	

Loving-Kindness (Gratitude Circle)

MD-0003 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Gratitude	GOAL	Emotional Balance
DURATION	10 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Emotional Balance, Happiness, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, natural breathing

MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR)

The felt sense of warmth or appreciation toward each person brought to mind.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Sit comfortably and bring to mind someone you appreciate — a parent, friend, teacher, or mentor.
2. Silently or mentally offer them a simple wish: 'May you be well, may you be happy.'
3. Move through 3-4 people this way, resting briefly on the feeling each name evokes.
4. Finish by offering the same wish to yourself.

BENEFITS • Loving-kindness practices are associated with increased positive emotion and reduced self-criticism • Shifts attention away from self-focused worry toward relational warmth • Particularly useful for people who find breath-focus practices too abstract	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
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EVIDENCE NOTE

Loving-kindness (metta) meditation has a substantial research base showing increases in positive emotions and social connectedness with regular practice.

COMMON MISTAKES • Forcing a feeling of warmth that is not genuinely there — let it arise naturally, or simply hold the intention. • Skipping the final step of extending the wish to yourself.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Extend the circle to include a neutral person, then eventually a difficult person. • Regress: Focus on just one person for the full session.
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TAGS #gratitude #loving-kindness #emotional-balance #beginner-safe #relationships

Focused Attention for Students

MD-0004 | Beginner

CATEGORY	Concentration	GOAL	Focus
DURATION	10 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Students, Focus	BREATHING PATTERN	Natural breath, counted

MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR)

The single chosen anchor — most often the breath at the nostrils.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

1. Sit at the desk or a quiet spot, spine tall, eyes closed or lowered.
2. Choose a single anchor — the breath, or a repeated silent word — and rest attention there.
3. When a thought about an assignment, a worry, or a distraction arises, notice it briefly.
4. Let it pass without following it, and return attention to the chosen anchor.

BENEFITS • Builds the same attentional muscle used for sustained study and exam focus • Short daily practice is associated with improved on-task attention in student populations • Works as a genuine pre-study warm-up, not just a stress reliever	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself. • It is normal for study-related thoughts to be the most persistent distraction — treat them the same as any other thought.
EVIDENCE NOTE Attention-training meditation has shown measurable improvements in sustained attention tasks in student and young-adult samples.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Trying to suppress every stray thought by force — this backfires and increases mental noise.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Extend to 15-20 minutes before a major study session or exam. • Regress: Reduce to 5 minutes as a pre-study ritual.
TAGS #students #focus #concentration #exam-prep #beginner-safe	

Athletic Pre-Performance Focus		MD-0005 Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Visualization	GOAL	Performance
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
SUITABLE FOR	Athletic, Performance, Confidence	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, then rhythmic performance-paced breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The specific sport skill or competitive moment, rehearsed with full sensory detail.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit or lie in a quiet space before training or competition. 2. Take several slow breaths to settle the body. 3. Bring to mind the specific skill or event ahead — visualize the setting, the equipment, the sounds. 4. Mentally rehearse the movement or moment with as much sensory detail as possible, seeing yourself execute it well.			
BENEFITS • Mental rehearsal activates overlapping neural pathways to actual physical practice • Widely used by elite athletes as a genuine performance preparation tool, not just relaxation • Builds confidence by rehearsing success rather than dwelling on outcome anxiety		COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself. • If self-doubt arises during the visualization, treat it exactly like any other passing thought — notice it, let it go, return to the rehearsal.	
EVIDENCE NOTE Motor imagery and mental rehearsal are established techniques in sport psychology, supported by research showing measurable performance and confidence benefits when combined with physical practice.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Visualizing only the outcome (winning) instead of the process (the actual movements and decisions). • Letting the visualization drift into worry about failure instead of successful execution.		PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Extend the rehearsal to a full routine or match scenario, including recovering from a setback. • Regress: Shorten to visualizing a single key moment or skill.	
TAGS #athletic #visualization #performance #confidence #sports-conditioning #cricket			

Recovery-Focused Body Awareness		MD-0006 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Somatic	GOAL	Recovery
DURATION	10 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Recovery, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow diaphragmatic breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) Areas of physical fatigue, tightness, or fullness in the muscles.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Lie down in a comfortable, supported position after training or during a rest day. 2. Bring attention to any areas of muscular fatigue or tightness without trying to fix them. 3. Breathe into each area, imagining tension softening slightly with each exhale. 4. Rest in a state of simple awareness of the body's current state for the remainder of the practice.			

BENEFITS • Supports the psychological side of recovery, which is easy to neglect in training-focused programs • Encourages body awareness that can help identify when more rest is genuinely needed • Complements physical recovery methods like stretching and sleep	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
EVIDENCE NOTE Mind-body relaxation practices are associated with improved subjective recovery and reduced perceived fatigue in athletic populations.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Using this time to mentally review workout mistakes instead of simply observing sensation.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Combine with a full body-scan for a longer recovery session. • Regress: Shorten to 5 minutes focused only on the most fatigued muscle group.
TAGS #recovery #somatic #athletic #post-workout #beginner-safe	

Confidence Building Visualization		MD-0007 Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Visualization	GOAL	Confidence
DURATION	10 min	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
SUITABLE FOR	Confidence, Performance	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, steady breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The felt bodily sense of confidence and capability from a remembered success.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit comfortably and bring to mind a moment of genuine past success or capability. 2. Recall the specific details — where you were, what you did, how it felt in the body. 3. Let the feeling of that capability grow, rather than the story around it. 4. Carry that felt sense of confidence forward into a mental image of an upcoming challenge.			
BENEFITS • Anchors confidence in genuine past experience rather than empty positive self-talk • The emphasis on feeling over story makes the practice usable even with imperfect memory of details • Useful before presentations, competitions, exams, or difficult conversations		COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.	
EVIDENCE NOTE Recalling specific past successes and their associated emotional states is a technique drawn from sport and performance psychology to build self-efficacy.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Choosing a memory that is actually tied to anxiety or a poor outcome — pick a genuinely positive one. • Focusing on external validation received rather than the internal feeling of capability.		PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Layer in a second and third success memory for a fuller sense of accumulated capability. • Regress: Focus on the feeling alone without needing a specific detailed memory.	
TAGS #confidence #visualization #performance #students #athletic			

Happiness and Positive Memory Recall		MD-0008 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Positive Memory	GOAL	Happiness
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Happiness, Emotional Balance	BREATHING PATTERN	Natural, relaxed breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The core emotion of the memory, not its narrative details.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit or lie comfortably and bring to mind one memory that genuinely makes you happy. 2. Rather than replaying the whole story, focus on the core emotion the memory carries. 3. Notice where in the body that happiness is felt — a lightness in the chest, a smile forming. 4. Rest in that feeling for the remainder of the practice, returning to it whenever attention drifts.			

BENEFITS • Deliberately cultivating positive emotion has measurable mood benefits distinct from simply reducing stress • Focusing on feeling rather than storyline prevents the mind from getting lost in narrative rumination • A useful practice for days when motivation or mood is genuinely low	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
EVIDENCE NOTE Positive emotion recall practices draw on broaden-and-build theory in psychology, which links positive affect to improved resilience and wellbeing over time.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Getting pulled into analysing or narrating the memory instead of simply feeling it.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Add a second memory once the first feeling has fully settled. • Regress: Focus on a smaller, simpler positive moment if a large memory feels hard to access.
TAGS #happiness #positive-memory #emotional-balance #beginner-safe #mood	

Anxiety Relief: Grounding Awareness		MD-0009 Beginner	
CATEGORY	Grounding	GOAL	Anxiety Relief
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Anxiety Relief, Stress Relief	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow exhale-led breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) Physical points of contact with the floor and chair; ambient sound.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit with the feet flat on the floor, feeling the points of contact with the ground. 2. Bring attention to five things you can hear, without labelling them as good or bad. 3. Shift attention to the sensation of the body's weight in the chair. 4. Return to slow breathing, using the ground and chair as a steady anchor whenever the mind races.			
BENEFITS • Sensory grounding is one of the most effective tools for interrupting anxious thought spirals • Requires no special skill or prior meditation experience to use effectively • Can be used discreetly in public settings, unlike longer eyes-closed practices		COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself. • This practice supports everyday anxious moments; it is not a substitute for professional support if anxiety is persistent or severe.	
EVIDENCE NOTE Grounding techniques using sensory awareness are widely used in clinical anxiety management as an accessible first-line coping tool.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Trying to think your way out of the anxious thoughts instead of shifting to sensory awareness.		PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Extend into a full body scan once initial grounding is established. • Regress: Focus on just one sense (touch or sound) if multi-sensory grounding feels like too much at once.	
TAGS #anxiety-relief #grounding #stress-relief #beginner-safe #quick			

Stress Relief: Release and Soften				MD-0010 Beginner
CATEGORY	Somatic	GOAL	Stress Relief	
DURATION	10 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner	
SUITABLE FOR	Stress Relief, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Extended exhale breathing	
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR)				
The felt sense of muscular tension releasing at each named body area.				
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE				
1. Sit or lie comfortably, taking a few slow breaths to settle. 2. Bring attention to the jaw, and consciously soften it, letting the teeth part slightly. 3. Move attention to the shoulders, softening them away from the ears. 4. Continue through the hands, belly, and legs, inviting each area to soften with the exhale.				

BENEFITS • Explicitly targets the common sites where people unconsciously hold stress • Combines body awareness with the calming effect of a longer exhale • A practical option for the end of a stressful day	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
EVIDENCE NOTE Progressive relaxation techniques, on which this practice is based, are well established for reducing muscular tension and subjective stress.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Rushing through each body area instead of pausing to actually notice and release.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Extend to a full progressive muscle relaxation with active tense-and-release at each site. • Regress: Focus on just the jaw, shoulders, and hands — the most common tension sites.
TAGS #stress-relief #somatic #evening #beginner-safe #office	

Focus and Deep Work Priming		MD-0011 Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Concentration	GOAL	Focus
DURATION	7 min	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
SUITABLE FOR	Focus, Office Worker	BREATHING PATTERN	Coherent 5-5 breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The steady 5-5 breath rhythm, paired with a single work intention.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit at the desk, spine tall, and close the eyes or soften the gaze downward. 2. Breathe in a steady 5-count in, 5-count out rhythm. 3. Silently set an intention for the work session ahead — one specific task, not a vague goal. 4. Rest attention on the breath until the timer ends, then open the eyes and begin the task immediately.			
BENEFITS • A brief pre-work ritual measurably reduces the 'switching cost' of moving between unrelated tasks • Setting a single specific intention improves follow-through compared to vague goals • Short enough to use realistically before any deep-work block		COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.	
EVIDENCE NOTE Brief pre-task mindfulness practices are associated with improved subsequent task focus in workplace studies.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Using the practice to plan the whole day instead of just the next task — that defeats the calming purpose.		PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Add a 2-minute journaling note immediately after to capture the single intention in writing. • Regress: Shorten to 3 minutes of breath awareness alone.	
TAGS #focus #office #deep-work #productivity #beginner-safe			

SECTION 9

Chronic Condition Fitness Guidance

Non-diagnostic, non-prescriptive exercise-modification guidance for 20 common chronic conditions.

All Conditions

Asthma

CH-0001 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A condition involving airway sensitivity that can cause breathlessness, wheezing, or chest tightness, particularly during exertion or in cold, dry, or pollen-heavy air. Well-managed asthma is compatible with regular exercise, and consistent aerobic activity is generally associated with improved lung function and reduced symptom frequency over time. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Always warm up gradually for at least 10 minutes before higher-intensity work.
- Keep any prescribed reliever medication accessible during every session.
- Favour warm, humid environments over cold, dry air where possible.
- Build intensity progressively across weeks rather than jumping straight to high-intensity intervals.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Swimming in a warm, humidified pool environment
- Walking and gradually progressive jogging
- Cycling at a controlled, steady intensity
- Yoga with an emphasis on breathing control

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- Sudden maximal-effort sprints without a warm-up
- Exercise in cold, dry outdoor air during flare-prone seasons
- High-pollen outdoor exercise during personal trigger seasons

YOGA RECOMMENDATION

Diaphragmatic breathing, Pursed-lip breathing, Box breathing (between exercise bouts, not during acute breathlessness)

BREATHING RECOMMENDATION

Pursed-lip breathing during exertion, Diaphragmatic breathing as a daily practice

STRETCH RECOMMENDATION

Standing quadriceps and hamstring stretches post-session (avoid stretches that restrict chest expansion)

INTENSITY CEILING

Moderate, building gradually; avoid sudden jumps in intensity or duration.

RECOVERY ADVICE

A gradual, structured warm-up and cool-down are especially important; symptom diaries can help identify personal triggers.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Chest tightness or wheezing that does not resolve with rest and reliever use
- Bluish lips or fingertips
- Severe breathlessness preventing speech — this requires emergency care

TAGS #asthma #respiratory #chronic-condition #breathing-focus

High Cholesterol

CH-0002 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

Elevated blood lipid levels are a modifiable cardiovascular risk factor. Regular aerobic exercise, combined with resistance training, is consistently associated with improved lipid profiles, particularly increases in protective HDL cholesterol. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Aim for consistent aerobic activity most days of the week, alongside 2-3 resistance sessions.
- Favour activities that can be sustained long-term over short, unsustainable intensity spikes.
- Combine exercise guidance with the dietary and medical guidance of a qualified professional.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED • Brisk walking • Cycling • Swimming • Full-body resistance training (squats, presses, rows) • Jump rope (once cardiovascular clearance is confirmed)		EXERCISES TO AVOID • Extremely high-intensity efforts without any cardiovascular clearance if other risk factors are present
YOGA RECOMMENDATION	Coherent breathing (5-5), Diaphragmatic breathing	
BREATHING RECOMMENDATION	General wellbeing meditation (Section 8) for stress reduction, which indirectly supports cardiovascular health	
STRETCH RECOMMENDATION	Standing lower back and hamstring stretches post-session	
INTENSITY CEILING	Moderate to vigorous, built up gradually with medical clearance if other cardiovascular risk factors coexist.	
RECOVERY ADVICE	This is a long-term, consistency-driven goal; abrupt intensity spikes offer little added benefit over steady, sustained activity.	
RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW • Chest pain, pressure, or unusual shortness of breath during exercise (stop immediately and seek care)		
TAGS #cholesterol #cardiovascular #chronic-condition		

High Blood Pressure (Hypertension)

CH-0003 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

Persistently elevated blood pressure increases cardiovascular strain over time. Regular moderate aerobic exercise is one of the most consistently evidenced non-pharmacological tools for lowering blood pressure, though exercise selection should avoid movements that spike pressure acutely and dangerously. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Favour rhythmic, moderate-intensity aerobic exercise over near-maximal effort.
- Breathe continuously through all resistance exercises — never hold the breath under load (the Valsalva manoeuvre can spike pressure sharply).
- Monitor for dizziness or headache during exercise and stop if either occurs.
- Build intensity gradually and avoid abrupt, unaccustomed maximal efforts.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED • Brisk walking • Cycling at moderate, steady intensity • Swimming • Light-to-moderate resistance training with continuous breathing • Yoga emphasising breath and gentle movement		EXERCISES TO AVOID • Heavy near-maximal lifting (1-3 rep max attempts) • Breath-holding during any resistance exercise • Extended isometric holds at high effort (e.g. a maximal wall sit) • Rapid, uncontrolled inversions
YOGA RECOMMENDATION	Diaphragmatic breathing, Extended exhale breathing (1:2 ratio), Coherent breathing (5-5)	
BREATHING RECOMMENDATION	Grounding awareness meditation for daily stress reduction	
STRETCH RECOMMENDATION	Gentle standing stretches, avoiding any position with the head lowered below the heart for extended periods	
INTENSITY CEILING	Low to moderate, avoiding breath-holding and extreme exertion spikes.	
RECOVERY ADVICE	Consistency and breath control matter more than intensity; blood pressure should be reasonably controlled before beginning vigorous training, per a physician's guidance.	
RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW • Severe headache, visual disturbance, chest pain, or extreme dizziness during exercise (seek emergency care)		
TAGS #hypertension #blood-pressure #cardiovascular #chronic-condition		

Prediabetes

CH-0004 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A state of elevated blood glucose below the threshold for type 2 diabetes. Regular physical activity, particularly a combination of aerobic and resistance training, is one of the most effective known tools for improving insulin sensitivity and can meaningfully reduce progression risk. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Combine both aerobic and resistance training weekly — the two provide complementary metabolic benefits.
- Where possible, take a short walk after meals, which can help moderate post-meal blood glucose.
- Aim for consistency across most days of the week rather than concentrated, infrequent sessions.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Brisk walking (especially post-meal)
- Resistance training targeting major muscle groups
- Cycling
- Bodyweight circuits
- Swimming

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- Prolonged sedentary stretches with no movement breaks (the modification here is behavioural — build in movement — rather than avoiding any specific exercise)

YOGA RECOMMENDATION

Diaphragmatic breathing, Coherent breathing

BREATHING RECOMMENDATION

Motivation-focused meditation to support consistent adherence

STRETCH RECOMMENDATION

General full-body stretching post-session

INTENSITY CEILING

Moderate, consistent activity most days; resistance training at least twice weekly.

RECOVERY ADVICE

This is a genuinely modifiable state with strong evidence for exercise as a primary intervention; consistency matters more than any single session's intensity.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Unusual excessive thirst, frequent urination, or unexplained fatigue (discuss with a doctor)

TAGS #prediabetes #metabolic-health #chronic-condition #insulin-sensitivity

Type 2 Diabetes

CH-0005 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A metabolic condition involving impaired insulin sensitivity and elevated blood glucose. Exercise is a well-established component of management alongside medical and dietary guidance, improving glucose regulation and reducing long-term complication risk. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Coordinate exercise timing with medication and meal schedules under a doctor's guidance, particularly for anyone on insulin or medications that can cause low blood sugar.
- Carry a fast-acting carbohydrate source during sessions in case of low blood sugar symptoms.
- Check blood glucose before and after exercise if advised to do so by a healthcare provider.
- Inspect the feet regularly and wear well-fitting footwear, particularly relevant given circulation and nerve-sensitivity considerations.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Brisk walking
- Resistance training
- Cycling
- Swimming
- Post-meal short walks

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- Exercising during a period of very high or very low blood glucose without following medical guidance
- High-intensity exercise without prior clearance if complications such as retinopathy or neuropathy are present

YOGA RECOMMENDATION

Diaphragmatic breathing, Coherent breathing

BREATHING RECOMMENDATION

Motivation and consistency-focused meditation

STRETCH RECOMMENDATION

General full-body stretching, avoiding excessive pressure on any areas of reduced foot sensation

INTENSITY CEILING

Moderate, individualised, and ideally coordinated with a healthcare provider's guidance on medication timing.

RECOVERY ADVICE

Exercise is one pillar of a broader, medically supervised management plan; this entry addresses movement only.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Symptoms of low blood sugar (shakiness, confusion, sweating) during or after exercise
- Any new numbness, wounds, or infections on the feet

TAGS #diabetes #type-2-diabetes #metabolic-health #chronic-condition

PCOS (Polycystic Ovary Syndrome)

CH-0006 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A hormonal condition affecting ovulation, metabolism, and androgen levels, often associated with insulin resistance. Regular exercise, particularly resistance training combined with moderate aerobic activity, is associated with improved insulin sensitivity and menstrual regularity in many individuals. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Prioritise resistance training, which is particularly supportive for the insulin-resistance component often present.
- Balance intensity with adequate recovery — chronic excessive high-intensity training can worsen hormonal stress in some individuals.
- Track energy and cycle changes over time and discuss patterns with a doctor.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Resistance training (compound lifts, machine circuits)
- Moderate aerobic activity (brisk walking, cycling)
- Yoga, particularly hip-opening and restorative sequences
- Low-impact HIIT in moderation

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- Chronic excessive high-intensity training without adequate recovery, which can be counterproductive for some individuals with PCOS

YOGA RECOMMENDATION

Diaphragmatic breathing, Bhramari (Humming Bee Breath) for stress reduction

BREATHING RECOMMENDATION

Gratitude and emotional balance meditation; stress-reduction practices generally

STRETCH RECOMMENDATION

Bound Angle Pose, Reclined Bound Angle Pose, Gentle hip-opening stretches

INTENSITY CEILING

Moderate, balanced with genuine recovery; avoid chronic overtraining.

RECOVERY ADVICE

Hormonal response to exercise varies significantly between individuals; adjust based on energy, sleep, and cycle feedback over time, in partnership with a healthcare provider.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Severe pelvic pain
- Very heavy or prolonged bleeding
- Signs of significant hormonal imbalance requiring medical evaluation

TAGS #pcos #womens-health #hormonal #chronic-condition

Hypothyroidism

CH-0007 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

An underactive thyroid can slow metabolism and contribute to fatigue, weight gain, and reduced exercise tolerance. With appropriate medical management, regular moderate exercise supports energy levels, metabolic health, and mood. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Expect exercise tolerance to improve as thyroid levels are medically stabilised — be patient with early fatigue.
- Favour consistency over intensity, especially in the early stages of treatment.
- Prioritise adequate sleep and recovery, as fatigue can be more pronounced with this condition.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Walking
- Light-to-moderate resistance training
- Swimming
- Restorative yoga

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- Pushing through severe unaccustomed fatigue to 'match' a pre-diagnosis training intensity

YOGA RECOMMENDATION

Diaphragmatic breathing, Coherent breathing

BREATHING RECOMMENDATION

Recovery-focused body awareness meditation

STRETCH RECOMMENDATION

Gentle full-body stretching

INTENSITY CEILING

Low to moderate initially, progressing as energy levels and medical management improve.

RECOVERY ADVICE

Exercise tolerance often improves meaningfully once thyroid hormone levels are medically stabilised; coordinate expectations with a treating physician.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Unusual chest discomfort, palpitations, or extreme fatigue disproportionate to effort

TAGS #hypothyroidism #thyroid #chronic-condition #energy

Hyperthyroidism

CH-0008 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

An overactive thyroid can increase heart rate, metabolism, and anxiety, and may cause muscle weakness or tremor. Exercise guidance depends heavily on whether the condition is medically controlled, and intensity should generally be conservative until levels are stabilised. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Avoid high-intensity or high-heart-rate training until the condition is medically stabilised, given the baseline elevated heart rate and cardiovascular strain.
- Monitor for palpitations, tremor, or unusual heat intolerance during exercise.
- Prioritise gentle, restorative movement while working with a physician on medical management.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Walking
- Gentle yoga
- Light stretching
- Swimming at an easy pace, once cleared by a physician

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- High-intensity interval training
- Heavy resistance training
- Any vigorous cardiovascular exercise until medically cleared
- Hot yoga or exercise in high heat (heat intolerance is common)

YOGA RECOMMENDATION

Diaphragmatic breathing, Extended exhale breathing (1:2 ratio)

BREATHING RECOMMENDATION

Grounding awareness meditation for associated anxiety symptoms

STRETCH RECOMMENDATION

Gentle stretching only, avoiding intense or prolonged holds

INTENSITY CEILING

Low, and only progressed with explicit medical clearance as levels stabilise.

RECOVERY ADVICE

This condition carries genuine cardiovascular considerations at rest; exercise intensity decisions should be made in direct consultation with a treating physician.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Rapid or irregular heartbeat
- Chest pain
- Significant tremor or heat intolerance during activity

TAGS #hyperthyroidism #thyroid #chronic-condition #caution

Obesity

CH-0009 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A condition involving excess body fat that can increase risk for several other chronic conditions. Regular physical activity supports weight management, cardiovascular health, and mobility, and benefits accrue even without dramatic weight change. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Begin with low-impact activities to protect the joints while building an activity habit.
- Progress duration before intensity in the early weeks.
- Pair exercise with professional dietary guidance for weight-related goals — exercise alone has a modest direct effect on weight compared to combined approaches.
- Celebrate non-scale progress markers such as improved stamina, strength, and mobility.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Walking (including low-impact step-touch patterns)
- Swimming or water-based exercise
- Stationary cycling
- Seated or supported resistance training
- Low-impact strength circuits

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- High-impact plyometrics (box jumps, jump squats) before joint conditioning is established
- Extended running before a walking base is built

YOGA RECOMMENDATION

Diaphragmatic breathing, Recovery breathing (post-exercise)

BREATHING RECOMMENDATION

Motivation and future-self visualization meditation

STRETCH RECOMMENDATION

Gentle full-body stretching, seated variations where floor-based stretches are uncomfortable

INTENSITY CEILING

Low to moderate initially, building duration before intensity.

RECOVERY ADVICE

Sustainable, joint-friendly progression produces better long-term adherence than an aggressive early approach; small consistent sessions compound significantly over months.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Chest pain, severe joint pain, or breathlessness disproportionate to effort

TAGS #obesity #weight-management #chronic-condition #low-impact

Arthritis

CH-0010 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A group of conditions involving joint inflammation, pain, and stiffness. Contrary to the instinct to rest completely, regular gentle movement is generally associated with reduced pain and improved joint function over time, though exercise selection should respect flare-ups. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Favour low-impact movement that keeps joints moving without heavy impact loading.
- Warm up thoroughly — arthritic joints often respond well to a longer, gentler warm-up.
- Scale back intensity, not eliminate movement entirely, during flare-up periods.
- Work within a pain-free or mildly-uncomfortable range rather than pushing through sharp pain.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Swimming and water aerobics (minimal joint loading)
- Cycling
- Walking
- Gentle resistance training with controlled range of motion
- Tai chi or gentle yoga

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- High-impact activities during a flare (running, jumping, heavy loaded squats)
- Forcing a joint through a painful range purely to 'complete' a prescribed exercise

YOGA RECOMMENDATION

Diaphragmatic breathing, Coherent breathing for pain-related stress

BREATHING RECOMMENDATION

Recovery-focused body awareness meditation

STRETCH RECOMMENDATION

Gentle joint-specific mobility work (see Mobility Library) rather than aggressive static stretching

INTENSITY CEILING

Low to moderate, adjusted flexibly around flare-ups.

RECOVERY ADVICE

Movement is generally protective for joint health when appropriately dosed; working with a physiotherapist for individualised joint-specific guidance is recommended.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Sudden joint swelling, redness, or warmth (possible acute flare requiring medical review)
- Sharp pain that persists after stopping activity

TAGS #arthritis #joint-health #chronic-condition #low-impact

Lower Back Pain (Non-Specific, Chronic)

CH-0011 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

Persistent lower back discomfort without a specific identified structural cause. Contrary to historical advice to rest completely, graded return to movement — particularly building core and hip strength — is now the generally preferred approach for most non-specific chronic lower back pain. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Begin with gentle, pain-tolerant movement rather than complete rest, which can worsen deconditioning over time.
- Build core and hip strength progressively — a stronger surrounding musculature generally supports the spine.
- Avoid any single movement that consistently and sharply worsens symptoms, and progress around it.
- Work with a physiotherapist for an individualised diagnosis and plan where pain is persistent or severe.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Walking
- Bird Dog
- Dead Bug
- Glute Bridge
- Cat-Cow Stretch
- Swimming

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- Heavy spinal loading (deadlifts, loaded good mornings) before a rehabilitation foundation is built
- Prolonged bed rest, which is generally not recommended for non-specific back pain

YOGA RECOMMENDATION

Diaphragmatic breathing, Extended exhale breathing (1:2 ratio)

BREATHING RECOMMENDATION

Body scan relaxation for pain-related tension

STRETCH RECOMMENDATION

Child's Pose, Cat-Cow Stretch, Knee-to-chest stretches within a comfortable range

INTENSITY CEILING

Low initially, building gradually as tolerance and confidence improve.

RECOVERY ADVICE

A graded return to activity, guided by a physiotherapist, is generally preferred over prolonged rest for non-specific chronic lower back pain.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Pain with numbness, tingling, or weakness radiating down a leg
- Loss of bladder or bowel control (seek emergency care immediately)
- Pain following significant trauma

TAGS #lower-back-pain #chronic-pain #chronic-condition #core

Neck Pain (Chronic, Postural)

CH-0012 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

Persistent neck discomfort often associated with prolonged forward-head posture, such as extended desk or phone use. Targeted postural strengthening and mobility work, combined with ergonomic adjustment, generally improve symptoms over time. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Address workstation ergonomics alongside any exercise plan — screen height and posture matter significantly.
- Build deep neck flexor and upper back strength rather than relying on stretching alone.
- Take regular movement breaks during prolonged desk work.
- Progress gently — the neck responds well to light, frequent movement rather than infrequent intense sessions.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Chin Tucks
- Scapular Wall Slides
- Face Pull
- Band Pull-Apart
- Neck Rotation Stretch

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- Aggressive neck stretching during an acute flare
- Heavy overhead loading before postural strength is established

YOGA RECOMMENDATION

Diaphragmatic breathing

BREATHING RECOMMENDATION

Desk Neck and Shoulder Reset meditation

STRETCH RECOMMENDATION

Neck Side Flexion Stretch, Upper Trapezius Stretch, Doorway Chest Stretch

INTENSITY CEILING

Low to moderate, favouring frequent brief sessions over occasional intense ones.

RECOVERY ADVICE

Postural, ergonomic, and exercise interventions together tend to outperform any single approach alone for this presentation.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Numbness or tingling radiating into the arm or hand
- Severe pain following trauma
- Pain accompanied by headache, dizziness, or visual changes

TAGS #neck-pain #posture #chronic-condition #office #desk-worker

Osteoporosis

CH-0013 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A condition of reduced bone density that increases fracture risk. Weight-bearing and resistance exercise are among the most effective tools for supporting bone density, though certain high-risk movements should be avoided or modified. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Prioritise weight-bearing and resistance exercise, which provide the mechanical loading stimulus bones need.
- Emphasise balance training to reduce fall risk, since falls are the primary mechanism of fracture.
- Avoid movements involving spinal flexion combined with rotation under load (a common recommendation in osteoporosis-specific guidance).
- Progress load gradually under professional guidance, particularly for anyone newly diagnosed.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Walking
- Resistance training with controlled form
- Balance training (Tree Pose, single-leg stance work)
- Stair climbing
- Bodyweight squats and step-ups

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- High-impact activities without prior clearance if fracture risk is elevated
- Loaded spinal flexion-rotation movements (e.g. a weighted sit-up with a twist)
- Movements with a significant fall risk without adequate balance preparation

YOGA RECOMMENDATION

Diaphragmatic breathing

BREATHING RECOMMENDATION

Confidence-building visualization to support consistent participation despite fracture-risk anxiety

STRETCH RECOMMENDATION

Gentle standing stretches, avoiding forceful spinal flexion

INTENSITY CEILING

Low to moderate, with a strong emphasis on progressive resistance and balance work under guidance.

RECOVERY ADVICE	Weight-bearing and resistance exercise are strongly supported for bone health; a physiotherapist or specialist can advise on individually appropriate loading given specific bone density results.
RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW • A fall, even without immediate pain • New or worsening back pain, which can indicate a vertebral change and warrants medical review	
TAGS #osteoporosis #bone-health #chronic-condition #senior #balance	

Acid Reflux (GERD)

CH-0014 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A condition where stomach acid frequently flows back into the oesophagus, causing heartburn and discomfort. Exercise timing and choice of movement can meaningfully affect symptom frequency. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Avoid exercising immediately after a large meal — allow 2-3 hours where possible.
- Favour upright activities over positions involving significant forward bending or inversion.
- Stay well hydrated, but avoid large volumes of fluid immediately before exercise.
- Notice any specific movements that reliably trigger symptoms and modify around them.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Walking
- Cycling
- Upright resistance training
- Swimming

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- Heavy forward-flexed movements on a full stomach (e.g. weighted sit-ups shortly after eating)
- Inversions or deep forward folds immediately post-meal

YOGA RECOMMENDATION	Diaphragmatic breathing (practiced away from meal times)
BREATHING RECOMMENDATION	General stress-relief meditation, as stress can be a symptom contributor for some individuals
STRETCH RECOMMENDATION	Gentle standing stretches; avoid deep forward folds shortly after eating
INTENSITY CEILING	Moderate, timed carefully around meals.
RECOVERY ADVICE	Meal timing relative to exercise is often as important as exercise selection itself for this condition.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Difficulty swallowing
- Unintended weight loss
- Vomiting blood or black stool (seek urgent medical care)

TAGS #acid-reflux #gerd #digestive-health #chronic-condition

IBS (Irritable Bowel Syndrome)

CH-0015 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A functional digestive condition causing abdominal pain, bloating, and altered bowel habits. Moderate, consistent exercise is generally associated with symptom improvement, while very high-intensity or high-impact exercise can worsen symptoms for some individuals. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Favour moderate, consistent activity over sporadic high-intensity sessions.
- Notice individual patterns — some people tolerate certain exercise types better than others; track and adjust.
- Stay adequately hydrated, and be mindful of caffeine or pre-workout supplement intake, which can aggravate symptoms for some.
- Manage stress alongside exercise, given the well-documented gut-brain connection in IBS.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Walking
- Yoga
- Cycling at a moderate, steady pace
- Swimming

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- Very high-intensity interval training if it reliably triggers symptoms for the individual
- High-impact running immediately after eating

YOGA RECOMMENDATION	Diaphragmatic breathing, Deep belly breathing (3-part breath)
BREATHING RECOMMENDATION	Stress-relief meditation, given the documented gut-brain axis relevance to IBS symptoms
STRETCH RECOMMENDATION	Gentle abdominal-area stretches, seated spinal twists
INTENSITY CEILING	Low to moderate, adjusted based on individual symptom response.

RECOVERY ADVICE	Individual symptom triggers vary significantly; a structured trial-and-adjust approach, ideally with a dietitian or gastroenterologist, tends to work better than a one-size-fits-all plan.
RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW • Blood in stool • Unintended significant weight loss • Severe abdominal pain (seek medical evaluation)	
TAGS #ibs #digestive-health #chronic-condition #stress-related	

Constipation		CH-0016 CONDITION PROTOCOL
OVERVIEW Infrequent or difficult bowel movements. Regular physical activity is a well-supported, low-risk tool for improving bowel motility alongside adequate hydration and fibre intake. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.		
EXERCISE GUIDELINES • Build in regular daily movement, even brief walks, which support bowel motility. • Combine exercise with adequate hydration and fibre intake as part of an overall approach. • Consider gentle abdominal and twisting movements, which may support digestive movement.		
EXERCISES RECOMMENDED • Walking (particularly after meals) • Yoga twists (Seated Spinal Twist, Half Lord of the Fishes) • General moderate aerobic activity		EXERCISES TO AVOID • No specific major exercise avoidances for this condition beyond general safety principles
YOGA RECOMMENDATION	Diaphragmatic breathing, which engages the abdominal region during the breathing cycle	
BREATHING RECOMMENDATION	General wellbeing meditation	
STRETCH RECOMMENDATION	Seated Spinal Twist, Knee-to-chest stretches, Cat-Cow Stretch	
INTENSITY CEILING	Low to moderate; consistency (daily movement) matters more than intensity for this goal.	
RECOVERY ADVICE	Movement is a supportive tool alongside hydration and dietary fibre; persistent symptoms warrant medical evaluation.	
RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW • Severe abdominal pain • Blood in stool • Constipation alternating with diarrhoea persisting beyond a few weeks		
TAGS #constipation #digestive-health #chronic-condition		

Stress (Chronic)		CH-0017 CONDITION PROTOCOL
OVERVIEW Persistent activation of the body's stress response, which can affect sleep, mood, immune function, and cardiovascular health over time. Regular physical activity is one of the most consistently evidenced tools for reducing perceived stress. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.		
EXERCISE GUIDELINES • Incorporate both vigorous exercise (for acute stress discharge) and gentler practices like yoga or walking (for parasympathetic recovery). • Avoid relying solely on very high-intensity training if it is not paired with adequate recovery, which can itself become a stressor. • Build in brief daily movement rather than relying only on occasional longer sessions.		
EXERCISES RECOMMENDED • Brisk walking or jogging • Resistance training • Yoga • Swimming • Any enjoyed rhythmic activity		EXERCISES TO AVOID • Excessive, under-recovered high-intensity training used as the sole coping strategy, which can compound rather than relieve chronic stress
YOGA RECOMMENDATION	Box breathing, Extended exhale breathing (1:2 ratio), Physiological sigh	
BREATHING RECOMMENDATION	Stress Relief: Release and Soften meditation, Grounding Awareness meditation	
STRETCH RECOMMENDATION	Child's Pose, Legs-Up-The-Wall Pose, General full-body stretching	
INTENSITY CEILING	Variable — both vigorous and gentle activity have a role; the key is consistency and adequate recovery.	

RECOVERY ADVICE	A combined approach of movement, breathing practice, and adequate sleep tends to outperform any single intervention alone.
RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW • Stress accompanied by persistent low mood, hopelessness, or thoughts of self-harm (seek professional mental health support)	
TAGS #stress #mental-wellness #chronic-condition #recovery	

Anxiety

CH-0018 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A state of persistent worry, nervousness, or unease, which can be accompanied by physical symptoms such as a racing heart or muscle tension. Regular moderate exercise is a well-supported complementary tool for reducing anxiety symptoms. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Favour rhythmic, predictable activities over unpredictable high-stimulation environments if anxiety includes a sensory-overwhelm component.
- Be mindful that very high caffeine or stimulant pre-workout intake can mimic or worsen anxious physical sensations for some individuals.
- Combine exercise with breathing practice for a fuller nervous-system approach.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Walking
- Yoga
- Swimming
- Moderate resistance training
- Cycling

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- Very high-intensity, unfamiliar environments if they provoke overwhelm (introduce new formats gradually instead)

YOGA RECOMMENDATION	Box breathing, Grounding Breath for Panic, 4-7-8 Breathing
BREATHING RECOMMENDATION	Anxiety Relief: Grounding Awareness meditation, Guided Breath Awareness
STRETCH RECOMMENDATION	Child's Pose, Legs-Up-The-Wall Pose, General gentle full-body stretching
INTENSITY CEILING	Low to moderate, prioritising consistency and a felt sense of safety in the exercise environment.
RECOVERY ADVICE	Exercise is a well-evidenced complementary tool for anxiety management, and works particularly well alongside professional support when anxiety is persistent or significantly impacts daily functioning.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Anxiety accompanying chest pain, or a first-time panic attack with unclear cause (seek medical evaluation to rule out other causes)
- Anxiety significantly impacting daily functioning (seek professional mental health support)

TAGS #anxiety #mental-wellness #chronic-condition

Poor Sleep (Chronic Insomnia Pattern)

CH-0019 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

Persistent difficulty falling or staying asleep. Regular daytime physical activity is associated with improved sleep quality and reduced time to fall asleep, though exercise timing relative to bedtime matters. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Exercise earlier in the day where possible — vigorous exercise very close to bedtime can be stimulating for some individuals.
- Get outdoor light exposure during morning or daytime activity where possible, which supports circadian rhythm.
- Use gentle, calming movement (yoga, stretching) in the evening rather than vigorous training.
- Pair exercise with a consistent wind-down breathing practice before bed.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Morning or afternoon walking, cycling, or resistance training
- Evening gentle yoga or stretching
- Legs-Up-The-Wall Pose before bed

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- Vigorous, high-intensity training within 1-2 hours of bedtime, if it is personally found to be stimulating

YOGA RECOMMENDATION	4-7-8 Breathing, Resonant Breathing for Sleep (6-Count), Pre-Sleep Wind-Down Breath (Extended)
BREATHING RECOMMENDATION	Body Scan Relaxation, Night Sky Meditation
STRETCH RECOMMENDATION	Legs-Up-The-Wall Pose, Reclined Bound Angle Pose, Child's Pose
INTENSITY CEILING	Moderate during the day; low and calming in the evening hours.
RECOVERY ADVICE	The timing of activity relative to bedtime is often as important as the activity itself; individual sensitivity to evening exercise varies.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Insomnia persisting most nights for several weeks with significant daytime impact (seek medical or sleep-specialist evaluation)

TAGS #sleep #insomnia #chronic-condition #recovery

Sedentary Lifestyle

CH-0020 | CONDITION PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

Extended periods of low physical activity, common in desk-based work or limited-mobility living situations. Even modest increases in daily movement are associated with meaningful health benefits, and the transition from none to some activity carries the largest relative benefit of any activity increase. This entry provides general exercise-modification guidance only. It is not a diagnosis, medical advice, or a substitute for guidance from a qualified physician regarding this individual's specific case. Any new or worsening symptoms should be discussed with a doctor before continuing exercise.

EXERCISE GUIDELINES

- Start with small, sustainable additions — a 10-minute daily walk is a genuinely valuable starting point.
- Break up prolonged sitting with brief movement every 30-60 minutes where possible.
- Build consistency before intensity; a modest daily habit outperforms an ambitious plan abandoned within weeks.
- Choose activities that fit realistically into the existing daily schedule and environment.

EXERCISES RECOMMENDED

- Walking (including short, frequent walks)
- Office Chair Squat
- Bodyweight Squat
- Desk-break stretching routines
- Stair climbing where available

EXERCISES TO AVOID

- Jumping directly into high-intensity or high-volume training without any base level of conditioning

YOGA RECOMMENDATION

Diaphragmatic breathing, Two-Minute Desk Reset Breath

BREATHING RECOMMENDATION

Office Reset meditation, Future Self Visualization for motivation

STRETCH RECOMMENDATION

Office desk-break stretching routine (see Warm-Up/Cool-Down libraries)

INTENSITY CEILING

Low initially, focused entirely on building a consistent daily movement habit.

RECOVERY ADVICE

The single largest health benefit comes from moving from zero activity to some regular activity; perfectionism about the 'ideal' program is a common barrier worth avoiding.

RED FLAGS — STOP EXERCISE, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- New chest pain, breathlessness, or joint pain when beginning activity after a long inactive period (seek medical clearance before starting if any pre-existing conditions are suspected)

TAGS #sedentary #beginner #chronic-condition #office #habit-building

SECTION 10

Acute Recovery Guidance

Activity-modification guidance for common short-term illness and recovery scenarios.

All Recovery Scenarios

Fever

RC-0001 | RETURN-TO-TRAIN PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

An elevated body temperature usually indicating the body is fighting an infection. Exercise during an active fever is generally discouraged, since it further raises core temperature and heart rate demand at a time the body's resources are already directed toward immune response. This entry provides general activity-modification guidance for common recovery scenarios. It is not medical advice or a diagnosis. Timelines vary significantly between individuals, and anyone with severe, worsening, or unusual symptoms should seek medical care rather than follow a generic timeline.

WORKOUT MODIFICATION

- Rest completely during the active fever period — this is one of the few situations where full rest is the right call.
- Avoid all structured exercise until body temperature has been normal for at least 24 hours.
- When resuming, begin with very light activity (short walks) before returning to prior training intensity.
- Return to full intensity gradually over several days, roughly matching how many days were lost.

NUTRITION ADVICE

- Stay hydrated with water and, if appetite allows, easily digestible foods; a doctor or general practitioner can advise on specific nutrition for the underlying illness.

HYDRATION

Increase fluid intake significantly above normal, especially if sweating.

TYPICAL RECOVERY TIMELINE

Typically 3-7 days from fever onset, though this varies with the underlying cause; always let symptom resolution guide the timeline rather than a fixed calendar count.

WHEN TO RESUME TRAINING

- Resume with light walking once temperature has been normal for 24 hours; return to full training over the following week.
- Do not resume high-intensity training until energy levels feel genuinely normal, not just 'better than yesterday'.

RED FLAGS — DO NOT TRAIN, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Chest pain, difficulty breathing, confusion, or a fever that persists beyond a few days (seek medical care)
- Fever with a stiff neck or severe headache (seek urgent medical care)

TAGS #fever #recovery #illness #rest

Common Cold

RC-0002 | RETURN-TO-TRAIN PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A mild upper respiratory viral illness causing congestion, sore throat, and mild fatigue. A widely used practical guideline is the 'neck check' — symptoms above the neck (runny nose, mild sore throat) generally allow light exercise, while symptoms below the neck (chest congestion, body aches, fever) suggest rest. This entry provides general activity-modification guidance for common recovery scenarios. It is not medical advice or a diagnosis. Timelines vary significantly between individuals, and anyone with severe, worsening, or unusual symptoms should seek medical care rather than follow a generic timeline.

WORKOUT MODIFICATION

- If symptoms are limited to the head (runny nose, mild congestion) without fever, light-to-moderate exercise is often well tolerated.
- Reduce intensity significantly even if exercising — this is not the time for personal bests.
- Stop and rest if symptoms include fever, chest congestion, or body aches.
- Prioritise sleep, which supports immune recovery more than exercise does during this period.

NUTRITION ADVICE

- Warm fluids, honey and ginger tea, and easily digestible, nutrient-dense foods are commonly used comfort measures; a doctor can advise on any specific remedies.

HYDRATION

Increase fluid intake, particularly warm fluids which can ease congestion and throat discomfort.

TYPICAL RECOVERY TIMELINE

Typically 5-10 days for a standard cold.

WHEN TO RESUME TRAINING

- Light walking or gentle yoga is often fine with head-only symptoms.
- Return to full training intensity once energy and breathing feel fully normal.

RED FLAGS — DO NOT TRAIN, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Symptoms worsening after day 5 instead of improving
- High fever developing
- Chest pain or significant breathlessness

TAGS #cold #recovery #illness #respiratory

Cough

RC-0003 | RETURN-TO-TRAIN PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A persistent cough can result from many causes, from a resolving viral infection to airway irritation. Exercise, particularly activities that significantly increase breathing rate, can sometimes trigger coughing fits, so pacing and environment matter during recovery. This entry provides general activity-modification guidance for common recovery scenarios. It is not medical advice or a diagnosis. Timelines vary significantly between individuals, and anyone with severe, worsening, or unusual symptoms should seek medical care rather than follow a generic timeline.

WORKOUT MODIFICATION

- Reduce exercise intensity if coughing fits are triggered by exertion.
- Favour warm, humid environments over cold, dry air, which can aggravate airway irritation.
- Allow a longer, gentler warm-up than usual to ease into increased breathing demand.
- If a cough persists beyond 2-3 weeks, seek medical evaluation rather than continuing to self-manage.

NUTRITION ADVICE

- Warm fluids and honey (for adults and children over one year) are commonly used comfort measures.

HYDRATION

Adequate hydration supports thinner mucus and easier clearance.

TYPICAL RECOVERY TIMELINE

A cough following a cold can reasonably persist for 2-3 weeks even as other symptoms resolve; a cough beyond this warrants medical review.

WHEN TO RESUME TRAINING

- Resume light activity as soon as it does not trigger coughing fits.
- Progress intensity gradually, monitoring the cough's response at each stage.

RED FLAGS — DO NOT TRAIN, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Coughing up blood
- Severe chest pain with coughing
- A cough lasting more than 3 weeks
- High fever accompanying the cough

TAGS #cough #recovery #respiratory #illness

Throat Infection

RC-0004 | RETURN-TO-TRAIN PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

Inflammation or infection of the throat, which may be viral or bacterial, causing pain, particularly with swallowing, and sometimes fever. Exercise is generally best paused until pain and any fever resolve, particularly given the risk of certain bacterial throat infections requiring specific medical treatment and rest. This entry provides general activity-modification guidance for common recovery scenarios. It is not medical advice or a diagnosis. Timelines vary significantly between individuals, and anyone with severe, worsening, or unusual symptoms should seek medical care rather than follow a generic timeline.

WORKOUT MODIFICATION

- Rest from structured exercise while throat pain and any fever are present.
- Seek medical evaluation for a throat infection with fever, particularly to rule out conditions requiring antibiotic treatment.
- Resume gently once fever has resolved and swallowing is comfortable.
- Stay well hydrated even though swallowing may be uncomfortable, using small frequent sips if needed.

NUTRITION ADVICE

- Warm salt-water gargling (for adults) and soft, easily swallowed foods are commonly used comfort measures; a doctor should evaluate fever or significant pain.

HYDRATION

Small, frequent sips if swallowing is painful; avoid becoming dehydrated due to reduced fluid intake.

TYPICAL RECOVERY TIMELINE

Typically 3-7 days depending on the cause; bacterial throat infections may require a specific antibiotic course as directed by a doctor.

WHEN TO RESUME TRAINING

- Resume light activity once fever has resolved and pain has substantially eased.
- Return to full intensity over the following several days.

RED FLAGS — DO NOT TRAIN, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Difficulty breathing or swallowing
- Drooling (in children, this can indicate a serious airway issue)
- High fever
- A rash accompanying the sore throat
- Symptoms lasting beyond a week without improvement

TAGS #throat-infection #recovery #illness

Typhoid Recovery

RC-0005 | RETURN-TO-TRAIN PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A bacterial infection requiring medical diagnosis and antibiotic treatment, with a recovery period that can involve significant fatigue and weight loss even after the acute infection resolves. Return to exercise should be gradual and only after specific medical clearance. This entry provides general activity-modification guidance for common recovery scenarios. It is not medical advice or a diagnosis. Timelines vary significantly between individuals, and anyone with severe, worsening, or unusual symptoms should seek medical care rather than follow a generic timeline.

WORKOUT MODIFICATION

- Do not resume any exercise until explicitly cleared by the treating physician, given the risk of complications during active infection.
- Expect a longer-than-usual recovery period, with fatigue often persisting for several weeks after the fever resolves.
- Begin with very short, gentle walks once cleared, well below pre-illness activity levels.
- Progress slowly over several weeks, prioritising nutrition and sleep alongside gradual activity.

NUTRITION ADVICE

- Follow the treating physician's specific dietary guidance closely during and after treatment, which is an important part of typhoid management.

HYDRATION

Follow medical guidance closely on fluid intake during and after the acute illness.

TYPICAL RECOVERY TIMELINE

Full recovery, including energy levels, can reasonably take several weeks to a few months; this varies significantly by individual and severity.

WHEN TO RESUME TRAINING

- Begin only with physician clearance; start with very short walks and progress by small increments week to week.
- Full return to prior training intensity should be gradual and guided by ongoing energy and strength levels, not a fixed calendar.

RED FLAGS — DO NOT TRAIN, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Any return or worsening of fever after apparent recovery
- Severe abdominal pain
- This condition requires medical diagnosis and treatment — this entry addresses post-medical-clearance activity only

TAGS #typhoid #recovery #illness #medical-clearance-required

Dengue Recovery

RC-0006 | RETURN-TO-TRAIN PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A mosquito-borne viral infection that can cause significant fatigue, joint pain, and in some cases more serious complications requiring medical monitoring. Return to exercise should be gradual and only after medical clearance, given the potential for complications and prolonged fatigue. This entry provides general activity-modification guidance for common recovery scenarios. It is not medical advice or a diagnosis. Timelines vary significantly between individuals, and anyone with severe, worsening, or unusual symptoms should seek medical care rather than follow a generic timeline.

WORKOUT MODIFICATION

- Do not resume exercise until specifically cleared by a physician, given the risk of complications during and shortly after acute dengue infection.
- Expect prolonged fatigue and sometimes joint pain for several weeks after the acute infection resolves — this is a well-documented pattern.
- Begin with very light activity such as short, gentle walks once cleared.
- Progress gradually, and stop if joint pain or fatigue worsens with activity.

NUTRITION ADVICE

- Follow the treating physician's guidance on nutrition and hydration during recovery, which plays an important role in this illness.

HYDRATION

Adequate hydration is a critical part of dengue management under medical guidance during the acute phase.

TYPICAL RECOVERY TIMELINE

Fatigue can reasonably persist for several weeks to a few months after the acute infection; this varies significantly between individuals.

WHEN TO RESUME TRAINING

- Begin only with physician clearance; short, gentle walks are a reasonable starting point once cleared.
- Progress very gradually, monitoring joint pain and fatigue at each step.

RED FLAGS — DO NOT TRAIN, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Any bleeding, severe abdominal pain, persistent vomiting, or difficulty breathing (these can indicate serious complications requiring emergency care)
- This condition requires medical diagnosis and monitoring — this entry addresses post-medical-clearance activity only

TAGS #dengue #recovery #illness #medical-clearance-required

Food Poisoning Recovery

RC-0007 | RETURN-TO-TRAIN PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

An acute gastrointestinal illness typically causing nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea, and abdominal discomfort. Exercise is best paused during active symptoms, with a focus on rehydration, and can generally resume once the gastrointestinal symptoms have settled and normal eating has resumed. This entry provides general activity-modification guidance for common recovery scenarios. It is not medical advice or a diagnosis. Timelines vary significantly between individuals, and anyone with severe, worsening, or unusual symptoms should seek medical care rather than follow a generic timeline.

WORKOUT MODIFICATION

- Rest completely during active vomiting or diarrhoea, prioritising rehydration over any activity.
- Reintroduce light activity only once solid food is being tolerated normally again.
- Begin with gentle walking rather than returning directly to intense training.
- Pay particular attention to hydration and electrolyte replacement given fluid losses during the illness.

NUTRITION ADVICE

- Follow the standard graded reintroduction of bland, easily digestible foods as tolerated; a doctor or pharmacist can advise on oral rehydration solutions if needed.

HYDRATION

Oral rehydration solutions are commonly recommended to replace lost fluids and electrolytes; plain water alone may be insufficient after significant fluid loss.

TYPICAL RECOVERY TIMELINE

Typically 1-3 days for mild cases; some bacterial causes may take longer and warrant specific medical treatment.

WHEN TO RESUME TRAINING

- Begin with light walking once solid food is tolerated normally.
- Return to full training intensity over the following few days as strength and hydration normalise.

RED FLAGS — DO NOT TRAIN, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Signs of significant dehydration (very dark urine, dizziness, minimal urination)
- Blood in vomit or stool
- High fever
- Symptoms lasting beyond 3 days without improvement

TAGS #food-poisoning #recovery #illness #hydration

COVID-19 Recovery

RC-0008 | RETURN-TO-TRAIN PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A viral respiratory illness with a wide range of severity, from mild to more prolonged recovery courses involving fatigue. A cautious, graded return to activity is generally recommended, given documented cases of cardiac and respiratory involvement even after seemingly mild infections. This entry provides general activity-modification guidance for common recovery scenarios. It is not medical advice or a diagnosis. Timelines vary significantly between individuals, and anyone with severe, worsening, or unusual symptoms should seek medical care rather than follow a generic timeline.

WORKOUT MODIFICATION

- Follow current national or local health authority guidance on return-to-activity timelines, as these have been periodically updated.
- Avoid resuming intense exercise while any symptoms, including mild ones, are still present.
- A graded return protocol — days of light activity before progressively increasing intensity — is generally recommended over an abrupt return.
- Seek medical clearance before resuming intense training if symptoms were more than mild, or if any chest symptoms occurred.

NUTRITION ADVICE

- General balanced nutrition supporting immune recovery; no specific diet has strong evidence of altering the course of the illness.

HYDRATION

Maintain normal hydration; increase somewhat if fever was present.

TYPICAL RECOVERY TIMELINE

Highly variable — mild cases may allow return to activity within 1-2 weeks, while others report prolonged fatigue over a much longer period; individual medical guidance should shape the actual timeline.

WHEN TO RESUME TRAINING

- Begin with short, easy walks once free of fever and acute symptoms.
- Progress intensity gradually over 1-2+ weeks, monitoring heart rate response and fatigue at each stage.
- Seek medical clearance, particularly cardiac screening, before resuming intense training if the illness involved more than mild symptoms.

RED FLAGS — DO NOT TRAIN, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Chest pain, palpitations, or unusual breathlessness during or after exercise, at any point in recovery
- Symptoms suggesting the illness is worsening rather than improving

TAGS #covid-19 #recovery #illness #respiratory #graded-return

Migraine

RC-0009 | RETURN-TO-TRAIN PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A neurological condition causing episodes of often severe headache, sometimes with nausea, light sensitivity, or visual disturbance. Exercise during an active migraine attack is generally not advisable, though regular moderate exercise between episodes is associated with reduced migraine frequency for many individuals. This entry provides general activity-modification guidance for common recovery scenarios. It is not medical advice or a diagnosis. Timelines vary significantly between individuals, and anyone with severe, worsening, or unusual symptoms should seek medical care rather than follow a generic timeline.

WORKOUT MODIFICATION

- Rest in a dark, quiet environment during an active migraine attack rather than attempting exercise.
- Once the acute attack has resolved, a gradual return to light activity is generally well tolerated.
- Between episodes, regular moderate aerobic exercise is associated with reduced migraine frequency for many people, though intense sudden exertion can be a trigger for some.
- Identify and track any personal exercise-related triggers (dehydration, skipped meals before training, extreme heat) with a headache diary.

NUTRITION ADVICE

- Stay well hydrated and maintain regular meal timing, as both dehydration and skipped meals are common migraine triggers for many individuals.

HYDRATION

Consistent, adequate hydration is a commonly cited protective factor against migraine triggers.

TYPICAL RECOVERY TIMELINE

An acute migraine attack itself typically lasts 4-72 hours; the frequency of episodes over time varies enormously between individuals.

WHEN TO RESUME TRAINING

- Rest during an active attack; resume light walking once symptoms have substantially eased.
- Return to full training intensity gradually, being attentive to any personal exercise-related triggers.

RED FLAGS — DO NOT TRAIN, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- A first-ever severe headache, especially with fever, stiff neck, confusion, or weakness (seek emergency care to rule out other causes)
- A significant change in usual migraine pattern

TAGS #migraine #recovery #neurological #headache

General Fatigue

RC-0010 | RETURN-TO-TRAIN PROTOCOL

OVERVIEW

A state of persistent low energy that may follow illness, poor sleep, high stress, or overtraining. Exercise selection should distinguish between fatigue that will respond well to gentle activity and fatigue that signals a need for more complete rest and recovery. This entry provides general activity-modification guidance for common recovery scenarios. It is not medical advice or a diagnosis. Timelines vary significantly between individuals, and anyone with severe, worsening, or unusual symptoms should seek medical care rather than follow a generic timeline.

WORKOUT MODIFICATION

- Distinguish between everyday tiredness (often improved by light movement) and profound fatigue or exhaustion (which usually calls for rest instead).
- If fatigue follows a period of intense training, consider whether it reflects overtraining and would benefit from a deload week.
- Prioritise sleep quality and quantity as a foundation before adding more exercise volume.
- Reintroduce activity gradually, favouring low-intensity movement over high-intensity training until energy stabilises.

NUTRITION ADVICE

- A balanced, adequate-calorie diet with sufficient iron, B vitamins, and overall nutrition, as several nutritional deficiencies can present as fatigue; a doctor can test for these where fatigue is persistent.

HYDRATION

Ensure adequate daily hydration, as even mild dehydration can present as fatigue.

TYPICAL RECOVERY TIMELINE

Fatigue related to a short-term cause (poor sleep, minor illness) often resolves within days to a couple of weeks with proper rest; persistent fatigue beyond several weeks warrants medical evaluation.

WHEN TO RESUME TRAINING

- Begin with gentle walking or light stretching, monitoring how energy responds over the following days.
- Gradually reintroduce structured training only once baseline energy has meaningfully improved.

RED FLAGS — DO NOT TRAIN, SEEK MEDICAL REVIEW

- Fatigue lasting more than 2-3 weeks without clear cause or improvement
- Fatigue accompanied by unexplained weight loss, fever, or other systemic symptoms (seek medical evaluation)

TAGS #fatigue #recovery #energy #overtraining #sleep

SECTION 11

Women's Fitness Profiles

Programming frameworks across general fitness, weight loss, muscle gain, PCOS, cycle-aware training, and lifestyle-specific contexts.

All Women's Profiles

General Women's FitnessWF-0001 | WOMEN

OVERVIEW

A balanced, sustainable fitness foundation for women without a specific medical or goal-driven focus, covering strength, cardiovascular health, mobility, and bone density support across all life stages.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Balanced strength, cardio, mobility	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	30-50 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Resistance training + bone health

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- 2-3 full-body resistance sessions weekly covering all major muscle groups.
- 2-3 moderate cardio sessions (walking, cycling, swimming) for cardiovascular health.
- 1-2 mobility or yoga sessions weekly for joint health and stress management.
- Progress resistance training load gradually; women are frequently under-dosed on resistance training relative to what is beneficial.

RECOMMENDED

- Goblet Squat
- Romanian Deadlift
- Standing Barbell Overhead Press
- Walking
- Yoga flows

AVOID / MODIFY

- No universal avoidances — individualise around any personal injury history or specific conditions

COACHING NOTES

- Resistance training does not typically cause unwanted bulk in women due to hormonal differences from men — this is one of the most common and limiting myths in women's fitness.
- Bone density benefits from resistance training are particularly valuable for long-term health.

TAGS #women #general #strength #bone-health #balanced

Women's Weight LossWF-0002 | WOMEN

OVERVIEW

A fat-loss-oriented approach for women that prioritises resistance training to preserve lean mass alongside a moderate calorie deficit, avoiding excessive cardio-only approaches that can undermine long-term metabolic health.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Fat loss with muscle preservation	SESSIONS/WEEK	4-5
SESSION LENGTH	40-50 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Resistance training + moderate deficit

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- 3 resistance training sessions weekly to preserve lean mass during a calorie deficit.
- 2 moderate-intensity cardio sessions, supplemented by daily walking.
- Pair with professional nutrition guidance for a sustainable, moderate calorie deficit rather than a severe one.
- Track non-scale progress markers (strength gains, measurements, energy) alongside weight.

RECOMMENDED

- Kettlebell Swing (Russian)
- Goblet Squat
- Walking
- Full-body resistance circuits
- Jump Rope

AVOID / MODIFY

- Severe calorie restriction combined with excessive cardio volume, which risks muscle loss and metabolic slowdown

Fitness guidance only. Not medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment.

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COACHING NOTES

- Resistance training is a critical, often under-utilised component of sustainable female fat loss — cardio alone tends to underperform combined approaches.
- Very aggressive deficits often backfire through reduced adherence and muscle loss; moderate and sustainable outperforms extreme.

TAGS #women #weight-loss #fat-loss #resistance-training

Women's Muscle Gain

WF-0003 | WOMEN

OVERVIEW

A strength-and-hypertrophy-focused approach for women, built around progressive overload on compound lifts, adequate protein intake, and realistic expectations around the pace of visible change.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Progressive strength and hypertrophy	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-4
SESSION LENGTH	45-60 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Progressive overload

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- 3-4 resistance sessions weekly built around compound lifts (squat, deadlift, press, row patterns).
- Progressive overload — gradually increasing weight, reps, or sets over time — is the central driver of results.
- Pair with adequate protein intake and a slight calorie surplus or maintenance, per individual goals.
- Track lifts over time (a simple log) to ensure genuine progressive overload is occurring.

RECOMMENDED

- Barbell Back Squat
- Conventional Deadlift
- Standing Barbell Overhead Press
- Bent-Over Barbell Row
- Barbell Bench Press

AVOID / MODIFY

- Excessive isolation-only training without a compound-lift foundation, which slows overall progress

COACHING NOTES

- Muscle gain in women is a genuinely slower process than in men due to hormonal differences — this is expected and not a sign of doing something wrong.
- Consistency over 12+ months matters far more than any single program's specific exercise selection.

TAGS #women #muscle-gain #strength #hypertrophy

PCOS-Focused Fitness

WF-0004 | WOMEN

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for women managing PCOS, prioritising insulin sensitivity support through resistance training and balanced recovery, avoiding the trap of chronic excessive cardio.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Insulin sensitivity, hormonal balance	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-4
SESSION LENGTH	35-45 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Resistance training + stress management

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- 2-3 resistance sessions weekly, which meaningfully support insulin sensitivity.
- 1-2 moderate cardio sessions — avoid chronic excessive high-intensity volume, which can add unhelpful stress load.
- Prioritise sleep and stress management as genuine, evidence-relevant components of the approach, not afterthoughts.
- Track cycle regularity and energy patterns over months, not days, to gauge whether the approach is working.

RECOMMENDED

- Resistance training (all major compound patterns)
- Walking
- Yoga, particularly hip-opening sequences
- Swimming

AVOID / MODIFY

- Chronic, poorly-recovered high-intensity training, which can worsen hormonal stress markers for some individuals with PCOS

COACHING NOTES

- This condition responds to consistency over months rather than any single dramatic intervention.
- Coordinate the fitness plan with a physician's broader PCOS management guidance.

TAGS #women #pcos #hormonal-health #insulin-sensitivity

Menstrual Phase Training

WF-0005 | WOMEN

OVERVIEW

A cycle-aware approach adjusting training intensity across the menstrual cycle, acknowledging that energy and recovery capacity can genuinely fluctuate for many individuals, while emphasising that some people notice little to no change and can train consistently throughout.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Cycle-synced training intensity	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5 (varies by phase)
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SESSION LENGTH	30-50 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Listening to individual energy patterns
PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE • During menstruation, lighter activity (walking, gentle yoga) is often preferred if cramping or fatigue is present — but full training is entirely fine if energy allows. • The follicular phase (post-period to ovulation) often aligns with higher energy for many — a reasonable window for progressive strength work. • The luteal phase (post-ovulation to period) may bring lower energy for some — moderate steady training or a slight volume reduction can help. • Individual patterns vary enormously; track personal energy over 2-3 cycles rather than assuming a textbook pattern applies.			
RECOMMENDED • Walking • Gentle-to-moderate yoga during lower-energy days • Full resistance training during higher-energy days		AVOID / MODIFY • Assuming every individual must reduce intensity during menstruation — many people train at full intensity throughout with no issue	
COACHING NOTES • This is a genuinely individual pattern — the goal is self-awareness and flexibility, not a rigid universal rule. • Significant menstrual pain that limits daily function is worth discussing with a doctor, rather than simply working around it indefinitely.			
TAGS #women #menstrual-cycle #training-periodisation			

Post-Menstrual Phase Focus

WF-0006 | WOMEN

OVERVIEW

Guidance for the days immediately following menstruation, a period many people experience as a natural energy rebound, often well suited to progressive strength work.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Capitalising on rebound energy	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	40-55 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Progressive overload window
PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE - Many people experience improved energy and recovery capacity in the days following menstruation — a reasonable window to push progressive overload. - Full-intensity resistance training and higher-intensity cardio are often well tolerated during this phase. - Use this window to attempt new personal bests or higher training volumes, if the individual pattern supports it. - This is a general tendency, not a universal rule — adjust based on actual, individual energy feedback.			
RECOMMENDED - Barbell Back Squat - Conventional Deadlift - HIIT circuits - Progressive resistance training		AVOID / MODIFY None specific — this is generally a higher-capacity window for most, adjusted per individual response	
COACHING NOTES Pattern-based programming should always defer to how the individual actually feels in a given week over a theoretical template.			
TAGS #women #menstrual-cycle #energy-rebound #strength			

Strength Training for Women

WF-0007 | WOMEN

OVERVIEW

A strength-specific track for women who want to build genuine, measurable strength, moving past cardio-centric defaults toward a structured, progressive resistance program.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Maximal and functional strength	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-4
SESSION LENGTH	45-60 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Compound lift progression
PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE • Build the program around the primary compound patterns: squat, hinge, push, pull, carry. • Use a structured progression scheme (e.g. adding small increments weekly) rather than random exercise selection. • Allow 48+ hours between sessions targeting the same muscle groups for adequate recovery. • Track all major lifts in a simple log to objectively confirm progress over time.			
RECOMMENDED • Barbell Back Squat • Conventional Deadlift • Standing Barbell Overhead Press • Farmer's Carry • Bent-Over Barbell Row		AVOID / MODIFY • Constantly changing exercises before any of them are given a chance to show progressive results	
COACHING NOTES • Strength is a skill as much as an adaptation — technical consistency on a smaller set of lifts outperforms constant variety for genuine strength gains.			

TAGS #women #strength #powerlifting-adjacent #progressive-overload

Beginner Women's Fitness

WF-0008 | WOMEN

OVERVIEW

An entry-level program for women completely new to structured exercise, prioritising movement competency, confidence, and habit formation over intensity or complexity.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Movement competency and habit-building	SESSIONS/WEEK	2-3
SESSION LENGTH	25-35 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Form before load

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Begin with bodyweight versions of the fundamental movement patterns (squat, hinge, push, pull, carry).
- Prioritise learning correct technique before adding any external load.
- Build consistency with 2-3 sessions weekly before considering adding volume.
- Expect an initial adjustment period of a few weeks — early soreness and unfamiliarity are normal, not signs of doing something wrong.

RECOMMENDED

- Bodyweight Squat
- Glute Bridge
- Standard Push-Up (or a wall/incline regression)
- Walking
- Plank

AVOID / MODIFY

- **Complex barbell lifts before basic bodyweight patterns are comfortable and controlled**

COACHING NOTES

- The single biggest predictor of long-term success is consistency, not intensity — a manageable, enjoyable starting program beats an ambitious one that gets abandoned.

TAGS #women #beginner #fundamentals #confidence-building

Office Women's Fitness

WF-0009 | WOMEN

OVERVIEW

A time-efficient fitness approach for women balancing demanding office schedules, emphasising short, consistent sessions and desk-integrated movement over lengthy but infrequent workouts.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Time-efficient, desk-integrated fitness	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-4 + daily desk breaks
SESSION LENGTH	20-35 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Consistency within time constraints

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Use short, focused 20-30 minute resistance sessions rather than skipping exercise due to lack of a full hour.
- Integrate desk-break movement (Office Chair Squat, desk stretches) every 60-90 minutes during the workday.
- Consider a lunch-break walk as a genuinely valuable, easily scheduled cardio contribution.
- Plan sessions in advance around the work calendar rather than relying on finding 'free time' spontaneously.

RECOMMENDED

- Office Chair Squat
- Resistance Band Squat to Row
- Walking
- Desk Neck and Shoulder Reset

AVOID / MODIFY

- **Assuming a workout is not worthwhile unless it is a full hour — short, consistent sessions add up meaningfully over time**

COACHING NOTES

- The desk-break movement habit often has an outsized impact on daily energy and posture, disproportionate to its small time cost.

TAGS #women #office #time-efficient #desk-worker

Hostel Women's Fitness

WF-0010 | WOMEN

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for women living in hostel or shared-room accommodation, designed around minimal space, no equipment, and consideration for shared living environments.

PRIMARY FOCUS	No-equipment, small-space, quiet fitness	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	20-30 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Bodyweight training in minimal space

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Use bodyweight-only circuits that require minimal floor space (roughly a yoga mat's worth).
- Favour low-impact and quiet movement options out of consideration for roommates or neighbours, especially at night.
- Resistance bands are a lightweight, storage-friendly addition if available, expanding exercise variety significantly.
- Walking or jogging outdoors, where safe and accessible, is a valuable addition to indoor bodyweight training.

RECOMMENDED

- Bodyweight Squat
- Standard Push-Up
- Plank
- TRX Row (door-anchor version, if available)
- Apartment-Friendly Low-Noise Warm-Up

AVOID / MODIFY

- High-impact jumping exercises late at night or in shared, noise-sensitive environments

COACHING NOTES

- A genuinely effective program does not require a gym — bodyweight training, applied consistently, produces real results.

TAGS #women #hostel #no-equipment #small-space #students

SECTION 12

Kids Fitness Profiles

Age-appropriate movement guidance across early childhood, pre-adolescence, and adolescence.

All Kids Profiles

Kids Fitness: Ages 5-8

KF-0001 | KIDS

OVERVIEW

Early childhood physical activity focused entirely on fun, fundamental movement skills, and coordination development rather than structured 'exercise' in the adult sense. At this age, play is the training program.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Fundamental movement skills, fun	SESSIONS/WEEK	Daily unstructured play + activity
SESSION LENGTH	15-30 min structured, unlimited free play	KEY EMPHASIS	Coordination, balance, enjoyment

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Prioritise unstructured active play (running, climbing, ball games) over any formal 'workout' structure.
- Introduce fundamental movement skills through games: animal walks for coordination, freeze dance for body control, simple obstacle courses for balance.
- Keep any structured activity short (15-20 minutes) and highly varied — attention spans are naturally brief at this age.
- Involve caregivers directly in the activity; children at this age are strongly motivated by shared play.

RECOMMENDED	AVOID / MODIFY
• Animal walks (bear crawl, crab walk) • Freeze dance • Simple obstacle courses • Ball games (catching, kicking, throwing) • Playground climbing and balance activities	• Any structured strength training with external weights • Long-duration, low-variety repetitive drills that mimic adult training formats • High-pressure competitive framing that could create early negative associations with movement

COACHING NOTES

- Movement quality (coordination, balance, basic body control) matters far more at this age than any measure of 'fitness' in the adult sense.
- Never restrict food or frame activity around calories or body shape with children — the goal is building a lifelong positive relationship with movement.
- If a child shows persistent reluctance or distress around physical activity, a paediatrician can help rule out any underlying cause.

TAGS #kids #early-childhood #fundamental-movement #play-based #coordination

Kids Fitness: Ages 9-12

KF-0002 | KIDS

OVERVIEW

Pre-adolescent physical activity building on fundamental movement skills with the introduction of simple structured activities, sports skills, and light bodyweight training, while keeping the experience enjoyable and social.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Sports skills, bodyweight basics, teamwork	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5 (mix of sport and free play)
SESSION LENGTH	30-45 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Skill development, social enjoyment

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Introduce basic bodyweight exercises (squats, push-ups, planks) using games and challenges rather than adult-style sets and reps.
- Encourage participation in an organised sport or activity for skill development and social connection.
- Continue to prioritise variety — rotating activities across weeks keeps engagement high at this developmental stage.
- Keep structured sessions to 30-45 minutes, allowing for a warm-up game, skill practice, and a fun cool-down.

RECOMMENDED	AVOID / MODIFY
• Bodyweight Squat • Standard Push-Up (regressed as needed) • Plank (short holds) • Jump Rope • Bear Crawl • Sport-specific skill drills (e.g. basic cricket catching and throwing)	• Heavy external resistance training (barbells, heavy dumbbells) • High-volume, high-intensity training mimicking adult programs • Early single-sport specialisation to the exclusion of all other movement variety

COACHING NOTES

- This age is an excellent window for developing broad athletic skill (agility, coordination, balance) that pays dividends in any sport pursued later.
- Encourage effort and improvement over outcome-based praise (winning, being 'the best') to build durable motivation.

TAGS #kids #pre-adolescent #sports-skills #bodyweight #teamwork

Kids Fitness: Ages 13-17

KF-0003 | KIDS

OVERVIEW

Adolescent fitness incorporating structured resistance training with proper supervision, alongside continued sport participation, with attention to the physical and emotional changes of this life stage.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Structured strength training, sport performance	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	40-60 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Supervised progressive training

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Introduce structured resistance training with light loads and a strong emphasis on technique, ideally with qualified supervision.
- Continue sport-specific training and competition where the individual has interest.
- Address nutrition needs for growth and activity with age-appropriate, non-restrictive guidance from a professional if specific goals are involved.
- Be attentive to signs of overtraining or excessive pressure around appearance or performance, which can emerge during adolescence.

RECOMMENDED

- Goblet Squat
- Standard Push-Up
- Assisted or Band-Assisted Pull-Up
- Kettlebell Swing (Russian) — light load, supervised technique focus
- Sport-specific conditioning

AVOID / MODIFY

- Maximal or near-maximal lifting (1-3 rep max attempts) before technique is well established and appropriate supervision is available
- Restrictive dieting or calorie tracking, which is not appropriate for this age group
- Training to the point of interfering with growth-related sleep needs

COACHING NOTES

- Resistance training is safe and beneficial for adolescents when appropriately supervised and progressed — the historical myth of stunted growth from lifting is not supported by evidence.
- This is a period of significant physical and emotional change; a supportive, non-judgmental approach to body image is especially important.
- A qualified coach or trainer experienced with adolescent athletes is strongly recommended for structured strength programs at this age.

TAGS #kids #adolescent #strength-training #sports-performance #supervised

SECTION 13

Senior Fitness Profiles

Strength, balance, joint health, and fall-prevention programming for older adults.

All Senior Profiles

General Senior Fitness

SF-0001 | SENIOR

OVERVIEW

A balanced, safety-first fitness foundation for older adults, covering strength, balance, cardiovascular health, and mobility — the four pillars generally recognised as most protective for healthy aging and independence.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Strength, balance, mobility, cardio	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	20-40 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Consistency and fall prevention

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Include resistance training at least twice weekly — muscle mass and strength are strong predictors of long-term independence.
- Dedicate specific time to balance training, since falls are a leading cause of injury in this population.
- Layer in regular walking or another moderate cardio activity for cardiovascular and metabolic health.
- Progress gradually, and obtain medical clearance before beginning if there are existing health conditions or a long period of inactivity.

RECOMMENDED • Walking • Bodyweight Squat (chair-assisted if needed) • Tree Pose (wall-supported) • Resistance Band Row • Glute Bridge • Senior-Friendly Chair Warm-Up	AVOID / MODIFY • High-impact plyometrics without prior conditioning • Rapid, uncontrolled direction changes • Any exercise causing dizziness — stop and rest immediately if this occurs
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COACHING NOTES

- Strength training is one of the most under-utilised tools for healthy aging — muscle loss (sarcopenia) is a major, modifiable contributor to loss of independence.
- Consistency at a moderate intensity outperforms sporadic intense effort for this population's goals.

TAGS #senior #general #balance #strength #fall-prevention

Chair-Based Exercise Program

SF-0002 | SENIOR

OVERVIEW

A fully seated exercise approach for older adults with limited standing tolerance, significant balance concerns, or those recovering from illness or surgery, ensuring meaningful activity remains accessible regardless of standing ability.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Accessible seated strength and mobility	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	15-25 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Safety and accessibility

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Perform all major movement patterns in a seated, supported position — seated marching, seated rows with a band, seated leg extensions.
- Include seated mobility work for the neck, shoulders, and ankles to maintain range of motion.
- Use light resistance bands anchored to a door or chair leg for simple, safe strength work.
- Progress to standing-supported exercises only when balance and confidence genuinely allow, and never rush this transition.

RECOMMENDED • Seated marching • Seated Arm Circles • Resistance Band Row (seated) • Seated Ankle Pumps • Seated Torso Twists • Seated Hamstring Stretch	AVOID / MODIFY • Any standing exercise without appropriate support or supervision if balance is a significant concern
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COACHING NOTES

- A seated program is a complete, legitimate form of exercise, not a lesser substitute — meaningful strength and mobility gains are achievable entirely from a seated position.
- Work with a physiotherapist for an individualised assessment where mobility limitations are significant.

TAGS #senior #chair-based #accessible #beginner-safe #low-mobility

Joint Health Focus for Seniors

SF-0003 | SENIOR

OVERVIEW

A program emphasising joint-friendly movement for older adults managing arthritis or general joint stiffness, prioritising range of motion and low-impact strengthening over high-load or high-impact approaches.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Joint mobility and low-impact strength	SESSIONS/WEEK	4-6 (shorter, frequent sessions)
SESSION LENGTH	15-25 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Range of motion, gentle loading

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Favour water-based exercise where accessible — it substantially reduces joint loading while still providing resistance.
- Perform daily gentle range-of-motion work for commonly affected joints (knees, hips, hands, shoulders).
- Build strength gradually around affected joints, since supporting musculature can meaningfully reduce joint stress.
- Work within a comfortable range, scaling back — never stopping entirely — during flare-ups.

RECOMMENDED

- Water aerobics / swimming
- Cycling (stationary, adjustable resistance)
- Ankle Circles
- Knee Circles
- Wrist Circles and Flexor Stretch
- Bodyweight Squat (partial range, chair-assisted)

AVOID / MODIFY

- High-impact activities (running, jumping) during a flare-up
- Forcing a joint through a painful range purely to complete a prescribed movement

COACHING NOTES

- Movement is generally protective for joint health when appropriately dosed — complete rest often worsens stiffness over time.
- A physiotherapist can provide individualised, joint-specific guidance where arthritis or another diagnosed condition is present.

TAGS #senior #joint-health #arthritis #low-impact #water-based

Balance Training for Seniors

SF-0004 | SENIOR

OVERVIEW

A dedicated balance-focused program for older adults, recognising that balance is a trainable skill that meaningfully declines without specific practice, independent of general strength or cardiovascular fitness.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Static and dynamic balance	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	10-15 min (can be added to other sessions)	KEY EMPHASIS	Progressive, supported balance challenge

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Begin with static balance holds near a wall or sturdy chair for safety (single-leg stance, tandem stance).
- Progress to dynamic balance challenges (heel-to-toe walking, gentle weight shifts) as confidence builds.
- Always practice balance work near a stable support surface, especially in early stages.
- Combine with general lower-body strength work, since leg strength directly supports balance capacity.

RECOMMENDED

- Tree Pose (wall-supported)
- Standing Piriformis Stretch (Chair)
- Heel-to-toe walking (supported)
- Single-leg stance practice (holding a counter or chair back)

AVOID / MODIFY

- Unsupported balance challenges on unstable surfaces (wobble boards, etc.) without prior supervised progression
- Balance training performed on a slippery or cluttered floor surface

COACHING NOTES

- Balance is a specific, trainable skill that declines independently of general strength if not directly practiced — dedicated balance work is a genuinely high-value addition.
- Even a few minutes of daily balance practice is associated with measurably reduced fall risk over time.

TAGS #senior #balance #fall-prevention #beginner-safe #supported

Fall Prevention Program

SF-0005 | SENIOR

OVERVIEW

A comprehensive, safety-focused program specifically designed to reduce fall risk in older adults through combined strength, balance, and gait training, recognising falls as a leading and largely preventable cause of serious injury in this population.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Multi-component fall risk reduction	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
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SESSION LENGTH	20-30 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Strength + balance + gait, combined
PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE • Combine lower-body strength work (which supports gait stability) with dedicated balance practice in every session. • Include gait-focused drills such as heel-to-toe walking and stepping over low obstacles in a safe, supported setting. • Review the home environment for fall hazards (loose rugs, poor lighting) alongside the exercise program — this is equally important. • Have vision and any relevant medications reviewed by a doctor, since both significantly affect fall risk independent of physical training.			
RECOMMENDED • Bodyweight Squat (chair-assisted) • Standing Calf Raise (supported) • Tree Pose (wall-supported) • Heel-to-toe walking (supported) • Step-Up (very low step, supported)		AVOID / MODIFY • Any unsupported, unfamiliar balance challenge • Exercising on cluttered, poorly lit, or slippery surfaces	
COACHING NOTES • Multi-component programs combining strength, balance, and gait training are the most strongly evidence-supported approach for reducing fall risk in older adults. • This is a genuinely high-stakes area — working with a physiotherapist for an individualised fall-risk assessment is strongly recommended, particularly after any previous fall.			
TAGS #senior #fall-prevention #balance #gait #safety-focused			

SECTION 14

Adaptive & Disability Fitness Profiles

Capability-focused fitness frameworks for wheelchair users, limb difference, mobility restrictions, sensory disabilities, and cerebral palsy.

All Adaptive Profiles

Wheelchair User Fitness

DF-0001 | DISABILITY

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach built around upper-body strength, cardiovascular health, and functional capacity for wheelchair users, whether the wheelchair use is related to a spinal cord injury, limb difference, or another condition. Disability presentations vary enormously between individuals even under the same general label. This profile offers a general starting framework, not a fixed prescription — working with a physiotherapist or adaptive-sport specialist familiar with the individual's specific situation will always produce better results than any general guide.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Upper-body strength, cardio, shoulder health	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	30-45 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Shoulder health is a long-term priority

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Build upper-body pushing and pulling strength in a balanced ratio — pulling exercises are especially important, since wheelchair propulsion is push-dominant and can create imbalances over time.
- Include dedicated shoulder health and rotator cuff work, given the high demand placed on the shoulders in daily wheelchair use.
- Wheelchair-based cardio (racing wheelchair training, arm-ergometer work, or wheeling intervals) supports cardiovascular fitness effectively.
- Core training adapted to available trunk control supports both performance and daily function — work with a physiotherapist to identify what is appropriate for the individual's level of trunk control.

RECOMMENDED

- Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press (light load, careful shoulder monitoring)
- Seated Cable Row
- Resistance Band Row
- Arm-ergometer intervals
- Adapted core work per individual trunk control

AVOID / MODIFY

- Any exercise causing shoulder pain — the shoulders are already under high daily load and deserve particular caution
- Generic standing-based exercise templates that have not been adapted

COACHING NOTES

- Shoulder overuse injury is genuinely common in long-term wheelchair users due to the demands of daily propulsion — proactive shoulder health work is not optional, it is central to the program.
- Many national and local wheelchair sport associations offer adaptive strength and conditioning guidance specific to individual mobility equipment and goals.

TAGS #disability #wheelchair #upper-body #shoulder-health #adaptive

Lower-Limb Amputation Fitness

DF-0002 | DISABILITY

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for individuals with a lower-limb amputation, whether above or below the knee, emphasising core stability, single-limb strength, and a training progression coordinated with prosthetic fit and any physiotherapy guidance already in place. Disability presentations vary enormously between individuals even under the same general label. This profile offers a general starting framework, not a fixed prescription — working with a physiotherapist or adaptive-sport specialist familiar with the individual's specific situation will always produce better results than any general guide.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Core stability, single-limb strength, balance	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-4
SESSION LENGTH	30-45 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Coordination with prosthetic fitting and PT guidance

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Build core and hip strength on the sound side, which carries additional load in daily movement.
- Include upper-body strength training, which supports overall function and any mobility aid use.
- Balance training, adapted to the individual's current stage of prosthetic use or residual limb status, supports both safety and confidence.
- Coordinate exercise progression closely with the prosthetist and physiotherapist, particularly around any new or adjusted prosthetic fitting.

RECOMMENDED - Seated or supported upper-body resistance training - Core work (Plank variations, adapted to comfortable support) - Upper-body ergometer work - Balance work as cleared by a physiotherapist	AVOID / MODIFY - Any new exercise involving the residual limb without physiotherapist clearance, particularly around a new prosthetic fitting - High-impact activity before individual clearance for the specific prosthetic and activity level
COACHING NOTES - Many individuals with lower-limb amputation go on to full athletic participation, including competitive sport — capacity varies hugely by individual and this profile is a general starting point, not a ceiling. - Adaptive sport organisations can provide equipment and coaching specific to running, cycling, or swimming with a lower-limb prosthesis.	
TAGS #disability #amputation #prosthetic #core-stability #adaptive	

Upper-Limb Amputation Fitness

DF-0003 | DISABILITY

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for individuals with an upper-limb amputation, whether above or below the elbow, focusing on lower-body strength, cardiovascular fitness, and adapted upper-body training that respects individual prosthetic use and comfort. Disability presentations vary enormously between individuals even under the same general label. This profile offers a general starting framework, not a fixed prescription — working with a physiotherapist or adaptive-sport specialist familiar with the individual's specific situation will always produce better results than any general guide.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Lower-body strength, cardio, adapted upper-body work	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	30-45 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Full lower-body training + adapted upper-body

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Lower-body resistance training (squats, lunges, hip hinges) can generally proceed as a standard program.
- Adapt upper-body exercises to use the sound limb, a prosthetic attachment if applicable, or unilateral variations of standard exercises.
- Cardiovascular training (walking, running, cycling) is typically fully accessible and worth prioritising.
- Work with a physiotherapist or prosthetist on any upper-body exercise involving the residual limb or a prosthetic attachment.

RECOMMENDED - Bodyweight Squat - Walking, running, or cycling - Single-Arm Dumbbell Row (sound side) - Unilateral pressing variations adapted to individual comfort	AVOID / MODIFY Bilateral upper-body exercises that have not been adapted or cleared for the individual's situation
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COACHING NOTES

- Balance in loading (avoiding overuse of the sound limb through smart programming) is a worthwhile long-term consideration.
- Many adaptive equipment options exist for gym training — a physiotherapist or adaptive-sport coach can advise on options relevant to the individual.

TAGS #disability #amputation #prosthetic #lower-body #adaptive

Limited Knee Mobility Fitness

DF-0004 | DISABILITY

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for individuals with significantly restricted knee range of motion, whether from prior surgery, joint fusion, severe arthritis, or another cause, emphasising what remains fully accessible rather than what is restricted. Disability presentations vary enormously between individuals even under the same general label. This profile offers a general starting framework, not a fixed prescription — working with a physiotherapist or adaptive-sport specialist familiar with the individual's specific situation will always produce better results than any general guide.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Upper-body and core strength, accessible cardio	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	25-40 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Working within available knee range

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Upper-body and core strength training can typically proceed with minimal to no modification.
- Cardiovascular training via swimming, hand-cycling, or an upper-body ergometer offers full accessibility regardless of knee range.
- Where some knee flexion is available, partial-range lower-body exercises (a small-range squat or step) can maintain surrounding strength.
- Hip and ankle mobility work on the affected side supports overall function and can reduce compensatory strain elsewhere.

RECOMMENDED - Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press - Bent-Over Barbell Row - Plank - Swimming - Hand-cycling or arm-ergometer work	AVOID / MODIFY - Forcing knee range beyond what is structurally or medically available - High-impact lower-body work that loads the affected knee unpredictably
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COACHING NOTES

- A restricted joint does not mean a restricted fitness ceiling — a well-designed program built around available movement can be genuinely comprehensive.
- An orthopaedic physiotherapist can clarify exactly what range and loading is appropriate for the specific underlying cause.

TAGS #disability #knee-mobility #adaptive #upper-body-focus

Limited Shoulder Mobility Fitness

DF-0005 | DISABILITY

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for individuals with significantly restricted shoulder range of motion, whether from prior injury, surgery, or a chronic condition, built around full lower-body and core training alongside shoulder work kept strictly within a comfortable range. Disability presentations vary enormously between individuals even under the same general label. This profile offers a general starting framework, not a fixed prescription — working with a physiotherapist or adaptive-sport specialist familiar with the individual's specific situation will always produce better results than any general guide.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Lower-body and core strength, accessible cardio	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	30-45 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Working within pain-free shoulder range

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Lower-body resistance training (squats, lunges, hip hinges, leg press) is typically fully accessible with little to no modification.
- Cardiovascular options such as walking, cycling, or a stationary bike avoid shoulder demand almost entirely.
- Where some shoulder range is available, gentle range-of-motion work within a comfortable window can help maintain what mobility exists.
- Avoid any overhead or end-range shoulder loading without specific physiotherapist clearance.

RECOMMENDED

- Barbell Back Squat
- Romanian Deadlift
- Walking or cycling
- Bodyweight Squat
- Core work not requiring overhead positioning

AVOID / MODIFY

- Overhead pressing or end-range shoulder stretching without physiotherapist clearance
- Any shoulder exercise that produces sharp pain, as opposed to mild, expected stretch discomfort

COACHING NOTES

- A comprehensive lower-body and core program can stand largely independent of shoulder involvement — this is not a 'lesser' program by comparison.
- A physiotherapist can advise on the specific underlying cause and what gentle mobility work, if any, is appropriate.

TAGS #disability #shoulder-mobility #adaptive #lower-body-focus

Fitness for Hearing Impairment

DF-0006 | DISABILITY

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for individuals who are Deaf or hard of hearing, where the primary programming adaptations are communication-based rather than exercise-based, since hearing status does not typically restrict physical capacity. Disability presentations vary enormously between individuals even under the same general label. This profile offers a general starting framework, not a fixed prescription — working with a physiotherapist or adaptive-sport specialist familiar with the individual's specific situation will always produce better results than any general guide.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Standard fitness programming, communication-adapted delivery	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	30-60 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Visual and written instruction

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Most standard exercise programming is fully appropriate — hearing status does not typically limit physical training capacity.
- Favour visual demonstration, written instructions, or sign-language interpretation over purely verbal coaching cues.
- In group or gym settings, agree on visual signals in advance for starting, stopping, or emergency situations.
- For balance-related exercises, be aware that some individuals with certain causes of hearing loss (particularly inner-ear related) may also experience balance considerations worth discussing individually.

RECOMMENDED

- Any standard exercise appropriate to the individual's general fitness level and goals
- Group classes with visual or interpreted instruction

AVOID / MODIFY

- No specific exercise avoidances based on hearing status alone; individualise around any coexisting balance considerations if present

COACHING NOTES

- The most valuable adaptation here is entirely about communication and instructional format, not exercise selection.
- Ask the individual directly about their communication preference (written notes, lip-reading, sign language, an interpreter) rather than assuming.

TAGS #disability #hearing-impairment #deaf #communication-adapted

Fitness for Partial Vision Loss

DF-0007 | DISABILITY

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for individuals with partial vision loss or low vision, emphasising environmental familiarity, verbal cueing, and safety-focused adaptation while keeping the exercise selection itself as broad as safely possible. Disability presentations vary enormously between individuals even under the same general label. This profile offers a general starting framework, not a fixed prescription — working with a physiotherapist or adaptive-sport specialist familiar with the individual's specific situation will always produce better results than any general guide.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Standard fitness programming, safety-adapted environment	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	30-45 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Familiar, hazard-free training environment

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Most standard exercise programming remains appropriate; the primary adaptation is environmental and instructional, not physical.
- Establish a consistent, familiar, and hazard-free training space — clear floor space, consistent equipment placement, good lighting.
- Favour detailed verbal cueing over purely visual demonstration when coaching movement.
- For outdoor cardio (walking, running), consider a guide runner, a familiar and consistent route, or a treadmill in a known environment for safety.

RECOMMENDED

- Bodyweight resistance training in a familiar space
- Treadmill walking/running (familiar, consistent surface)
- Guided outdoor walking or running with a sighted guide if desired
- Resistance machine training (fixed, predictable movement paths)

AVOID / MODIFY

- Novel, cluttered, or unfamiliar training environments introduced without orientation
- High-speed, unpredictable-terrain outdoor activity without a guide or a well-known route

COACHING NOTES

- Orientation to a new gym or training space — walking through the layout before starting — meaningfully improves both safety and confidence.
- Many adaptive sport programs offer guide-runner and adaptive coaching support specifically for individuals with vision loss.

TAGS #disability #vision-loss #low-vision #environment-adapted #safety-focused

Fitness for Mild Cerebral Palsy

DF-0008 | DISABILITY

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for individuals with mild cerebral palsy, accounting for the wide individual variation in muscle tone, coordination, and movement pattern that the diagnosis can involve, with an emphasis on individualised technique over standardised form cues. Disability presentations vary enormously between individuals even under the same general label. This profile offers a general starting framework, not a fixed prescription — working with a physiotherapist or adaptive-sport specialist familiar with the individual's specific situation will always produce better results than any general guide.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Individualised strength, balance, and mobility	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	25-40 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Movement quality specific to the individual

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Build strength training around whichever movement patterns feel most controlled and comfortable for the individual, rather than forcing a standardised technique.
- Balance and coordination work is often genuinely valuable, given the coordination-related aspects some presentations involve.
- Allow extra time for movement pattern learning — this reflects individual neuromuscular patterns, not effort or ability.
- Fatigue management matters — some presentations involve higher energy cost for a given movement, so building in adequate rest between sets and sessions is worthwhile.

RECOMMENDED

- Bodyweight resistance training with individualised range and tempo
- Swimming (often very well tolerated given low joint impact)
- Balance work adapted to the individual's baseline
- Stationary cycling with pedal or strap adaptations if useful

AVOID / MODIFY

- Rigid insistence on a 'textbook' movement pattern where an adapted, individually comfortable pattern achieves the same training goal
- Overly fatiguing volume without adequate rest, given potentially higher movement energy cost for some presentations

COACHING NOTES

- Cerebral palsy presentations vary enormously in severity and pattern — this profile is a general starting point only, and an individualised assessment matters more here than almost anywhere else in this guide.
- A physiotherapist experienced with cerebral palsy can provide guidance tailored to the individual's specific tone pattern and movement goals.

TAGS #disability #cerebral-palsy #individualised #adaptive #coordination

SECTION 15

Lifestyle-Specific Fitness Profiles

Fitness frameworks adapted to hostel life, college, professional work, shift work, travel, parenting, and athletic careers.

All Lifestyle Profiles

Hostel Student Lifestyle

LP-0001 | LIFESTYLE

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for students living in hostel or shared dormitory accommodation, designed around minimal space, little to no equipment, shared bathroom/timing constraints, and often irregular meal access through mess or canteen schedules.

PRIMARY FOCUS	No-equipment, flexible-timing fitness	SESSIONS/WEEK	4-6
SESSION LENGTH	20-35 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Consistency despite irregular schedules

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Build a bodyweight-only circuit that requires no more space than a yoga mat.
- Keep a flexible timing window (early morning or late evening) to work around mess timings, classes, and shared room schedules.
- Use stairs in the hostel building as a free, always-available cardio option.
- Plan around mess food realistically — supplement with accessible extras (fruit, eggs, protein sources available locally) rather than assuming full control over meals.

RECOMMENDED

- Bodyweight Squat
- Standard Push-Up
- Plank
- Jump Rope (if space and noise allow)
- Stair climbing
- TRX Row (door-anchor)

AVOID / MODIFY

- Equipment-dependent programs assuming access to a gym that may not be realistically available

COACHING NOTES

- A consistent bodyweight routine will outperform an ambitious gym-based plan that gets abandoned due to access barriers.
- Building a habit here, even a modest one, tends to carry forward well beyond the hostel years.

TAGS #lifestyle #hostel #student #no-equipment #small-space

College Student Lifestyle

LP-0002 | LIFESTYLE

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for college students balancing coursework, irregular sleep, social schedules, and often first-time independent food choices, prioritising sustainable habits over rigid or extreme programs.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Sustainable habits amid a busy, irregular schedule	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	30-45 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Building lifelong habits, not short-term extremes

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Use a campus gym or recreation centre where available — many colleges include this in existing fees.
- Prioritise sleep as a foundational recovery input; college schedules commonly erode this first.
- Build a routine flexible enough to survive exam periods with reduced but not abandoned activity.
- Be mindful of very restrictive diet trends common in this age group; balanced, adequate nutrition supports both academics and training.

RECOMMENDED

- Barbell Back Squat
- Standard Push-Up
- Walking or jogging
- Full-body resistance circuits
- Yoga for stress management

AVOID / MODIFY

- Extreme diet or exercise trends promising rapid results, which are rarely sustainable through a demanding academic schedule

COACHING NOTES

- This is a formative period for lifelong habits — a moderate, sustainable approach that survives busy weeks matters more than an intense one that only works during easy weeks.

TAGS #lifestyle #college #student #habit-building #sustainable

Working Professional Lifestyle

LP-0003 | LIFESTYLE

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for working professionals managing demanding schedules, frequent meetings, and limited discretionary time, emphasising efficiency and realistic scheduling over idealised but impractical plans.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Time-efficient, schedule-integrated fitness	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	30-45 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Scheduling exercise like a meeting

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Schedule workouts as fixed calendar blocks, treated with the same priority as a work meeting.
- Use efficient full-body resistance sessions (compound lifts) rather than lengthy, low-yield workout splits.
- Build in desk-break movement for days when a full session genuinely is not possible.
- Batch-prepare meals where possible to reduce decision fatigue around nutrition during busy weeks.

RECOMMENDED

- Barbell Back Squat
- Standing Barbell Overhead Press
- Walking meetings where feasible
- Office Chair Squat
- Efficient full-body circuits

AVOID / MODIFY

- Assuming a missed full session means the day is a write-off — a short session or even just a walk is far better than nothing

COACHING NOTES

- Consistency at 70% of an ideal plan significantly outperforms a perfect plan followed only 30% of the time due to unrealistic time demands.

TAGS #lifestyle #working-professional #time-efficient #office

Night Shift Worker Lifestyle

LP-0004 | LIFESTYLE

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for individuals working night or rotating shifts, accounting for disrupted circadian rhythm, atypical meal timing, and the genuine additional health considerations that shift work can involve.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Circadian-aware scheduling, sleep protection	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-4
SESSION LENGTH	30-40 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Protecting sleep above all else

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Treat daytime sleep with the same protection an average person gives nighttime sleep — a dark, quiet, consistent sleep environment matters significantly.
- Schedule exercise for a consistent point relative to the shift (e.g. before the shift begins) rather than an inconsistent, shifting time.
- Get natural light exposure at the start of the 'day' (which may be evening) to help support circadian signalling.
- Avoid heavy exercise very close to the intended sleep period, which can make falling asleep harder for some individuals.

RECOMMENDED

- Resistance training before the shift begins
- Walking during a break
- Gentle yoga or stretching before the daytime sleep period

AVOID / MODIFY

- Vigorous exercise immediately before the intended sleep period, if it is personally found to be too stimulating

COACHING NOTES

- Shift work carries documented additional health considerations independent of exercise — consistent sleep protection is arguably the single highest-leverage intervention available.
- A doctor can advise on strategies specific to the individual's particular shift pattern if sleep or energy issues are significant.

TAGS #lifestyle #night-shift #shift-worker #circadian #sleep-focused

Traveller / Frequent Flyer Lifestyle

LP-0005 | LIFESTYLE

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for people who travel frequently for work or leisure, designed around hotel rooms, unpredictable schedules, jet lag, and inconsistent access to equipment.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Portable, equipment-free consistency	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5, adapted to travel days
SESSION LENGTH	15-30 min	KEY EMPHASIS	A minimum viable routine that always travels

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Maintain a simple bodyweight circuit that requires zero equipment and minimal space — this becomes the fallback routine on every trip.
- Use hotel stairs for a reliable, always-available cardio option.
- On arrival in a new time zone, get outdoor light exposure and light activity to help ease jet lag adjustment.
- Pack a resistance band, which weighs almost nothing and meaningfully expands exercise options in a hotel room.

RECOMMENDED

- Travel/Hotel Room Warm-Up
- Bodyweight Squat
- Standard Push-Up
- Plank
- Stair climbing
- Resistance Band Squat to Row

AVOID / MODIFY

- Assuming travel means skipping exercise entirely — even a 15-minute hotel room circuit maintains meaningful consistency

COACHING NOTES

- The goal on the road is maintenance, not progress — a modest, always-executable routine beats an ambitious plan that never happens away from a full gym.

TAGS #lifestyle #traveller #hotel #no-equipment #jet-lag

Homemaker Lifestyle

LP-0006 | LIFESTYLE

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for homemakers managing household responsibilities and often fragmented time throughout the day, built around flexible session timing and recognition of the physical demands household work itself already involves.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Flexible-timing, home-based fitness	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5
SESSION LENGTH	20-40 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Working around fragmented daily time

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Use a home-based bodyweight or light-equipment routine that does not depend on leaving the house at a fixed time.
- Consider splitting a session into two shorter blocks if a single uninterrupted block is unrealistic on a given day.
- Recognise that household tasks (carrying groceries, cleaning, childcare lifting) already provide some incidental activity, while still valuing dedicated structured exercise for its distinct benefits.
- Protect a specific, even if short, daily time window as personal exercise time — this is easy to deprioritise amid caregiving demands.

RECOMMENDED

- Home Bodyweight Circuit Warm-Up
- Bodyweight Squat
- Resistance Band Row
- Walking (including with children if applicable)
- Kettlebell Goblet Carry

AVOID / MODIFY

- Assuming incidental household activity fully substitutes for structured exercise — the two provide complementary, not identical, benefits

COACHING NOTES

- Protecting even 20 focused minutes daily tends to be more achievable and sustainable than searching for a mythical uninterrupted hour.

TAGS #lifestyle #homemaker #flexible-timing #home-based

Athlete Lifestyle

LP-0007 | LIFESTYLE

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for dedicated athletes balancing sport-specific training, competition schedules, and the recovery demands that come with a high training volume, emphasising periodisation and recovery as seriously as the training itself.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Sport-specific performance and periodised recovery	SESSIONS/WEEK	5-7, periodised
SESSION LENGTH	45-90 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Recovery as a trained skill, not an afterthought

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Structure training in periodised blocks (building, peaking, recovery) rather than constant maximal effort year-round.
- Prioritise sleep, nutrition timing around training, and active recovery methods with the same seriousness given to the training sessions themselves.
- Include sport-specific conditioning alongside general strength work for balanced athletic development.
- Schedule deliberate lower-intensity or rest weeks, especially around and after competition peaks.

RECOMMENDED

- Sport-specific skill training
- Barbell Back Squat
- Kettlebell Swing (Russian)
- Sled Push
- Sport-specific warm-up and cool-down routines

AVOID / MODIFY

- Chronic, unperiodised maximal-intensity training without planned recovery blocks, a common driver of overtraining and injury

COACHING NOTES

- Recovery is a trained variable, not a passive default — athletes who plan recovery as deliberately as training tend to sustain performance and reduce injury risk over a season.
- Working with a sports-specific coach or sports scientist provides individualised periodisation far beyond what a general guide can offer.

TAGS #lifestyle #athlete #periodisation #sports-performance #recovery

Busy Parent Lifestyle

LP-0008 | LIFESTYLE

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for parents of young children, built around unpredictable schedules, interrupted sleep, and the reality that dedicated, uninterrupted training time is often scarce and inconsistent.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Flexible, interruption-tolerant fitness	SESSIONS/WEEK	3-5, flexible
SESSION LENGTH	15-30 min	KEY EMPHASIS	A routine that survives interruption

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Favour short, efficient sessions (15-30 minutes) that can realistically fit around a child's nap or activity schedule.
- Build in flexibility to pause and resume a session if interrupted — a workout that can restart is far more sustainable than one requiring an uninterrupted block.
- Include children in activity where appropriate (a walk, active play) as a genuine, if different, form of shared movement.
- Prioritise sleep opportunistically, recognising that a new parent's recovery capacity is often genuinely reduced by interrupted sleep.

RECOMMENDED

- Home Bodyweight Circuit Warm-Up
- Bodyweight Squat
- Kettlebell Goblet Carry
- Walking with a stroller
- Short full-body circuits (15-20 min)

AVOID / MODIFY

- Assuming a 'proper' workout must be uninterrupted and 60+ minutes — this standard is rarely realistic in this life stage and leads to abandoning exercise altogether

COACHING NOTES

- A flexible, forgiving standard for what counts as 'exercise' during this period protects long-term consistency far better than an all-or-nothing approach.

TAGS #lifestyle #parent #flexible-timing #time-constrained #family

Remote Worker Lifestyle

LP-0009 | LIFESTYLE

OVERVIEW

A fitness approach for people working from home, addressing the specific risks of an entirely sedentary home-office setup — minimal enforced movement, blurred work-life boundaries, and easy access to snacking — while taking advantage of the flexibility remote work offers.

PRIMARY FOCUS	Countering total sedentary defaults, flexible scheduling	SESSIONS/WEEK	4-6
SESSION LENGTH	20-40 min	KEY EMPHASIS	Movement breaks are non-negotiable, not optional

PROGRAMMING TEMPLATE

- Schedule movement breaks every 60-90 minutes using a timer — remote work removes the incidental movement of commuting or walking between office areas.
- Take advantage of schedule flexibility to train during off-peak gym hours or fit in a midday session.
- Establish a clear end-of-workday routine, potentially including exercise, to create a boundary between work and personal time.
- Set up the home workspace to allow for standing or brief movement breaks without much friction.

RECOMMENDED

- Office Chair Squat
- Home Bodyweight Circuit Warm-Up
- Walking (including a midday walk to mark a work-day boundary)
- Desk Neck and Shoulder Reset
- Resistance Band Squat to Row

AVOID / MODIFY

- Allowing zero-movement days to become the default simply because there is no commute or office structure forcing movement

COACHING NOTES

- Remote work's flexibility is a genuine advantage for fitness if used deliberately — but without active planning, it just as easily becomes the most sedentary lifestyle pattern of all.

TAGS #lifestyle #remote-worker #work-from-home #desk-worker #movement-breaks

SECTION 16

Mind Reset Library

Attention-redirection practices using sensory visualization. Every entry follows the same core principle: notice the thought, accept it without judgment, let it pass, and gently return attention to the chosen anchor.

All Mind Reset Practices

Nature Walk ResetMD-0012 | MIND RESET | Beginner

CATEGORY	Nature Visualization	GOAL	Stress Relief
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Stress Relief, Recovery, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, natural breathing

MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR)
The unfolding sensory details of the imagined forest walk — sound, then touch, then sight.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

- Settle into a comfortable seated position and close the eyes.
- Imagine walking slowly along a quiet forest path, sunlight filtering through the leaves.
- Notice the imagined sound of birds, the feel of the ground underfoot, the smell of the air.
- Let each new detail — a stream, a breeze, a clearing — become the next resting point for attention.

BENEFITS

- Directs attention toward a positive, sensory-rich focus instead of demanding an empty mind
- Nature-themed imagery is associated with measurable reductions in stress markers even when imagined rather than real
- Accessible for complete beginners with no prior meditation experience

COACH TIPS

- Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
- There is no need to actually 'clear the mind' — the forest imagery is simply somewhere pleasant for attention to rest instead.

EVIDENCE NOTE
Simulated nature exposure through guided imagery has shown stress-reduction benefits comparable, though generally smaller, to real nature exposure in controlled studies.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Trying to force a perfectly vivid, detailed image — a vague, impressionistic sense is enough.

PROGRESSION / REGRESSION

- Progress: Extend the walk to a full imagined loop, including arriving somewhere restful like a clearing or viewpoint.
- Regress: Focus on just one sense (sound of birds, or the feel of a breeze) rather than the whole scene.

TAGS #nature #mind-reset #visualization #stress-relief #beginner-safe

Beach MeditationMD-0013 | MIND RESET | Beginner

CATEGORY	Nature Visualization	GOAL	Stress Relief
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Stress Relief, General Fitness, Sleep	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow breathing paced to imagined waves

MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR)
The rhythm of imagined waves, paired with breath.

STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

- Sit or lie comfortably and close the eyes.
- Picture sitting on a quiet shoreline, the sand warm beneath you.
- Imagine each wave rolling in and receding, and let each inhale match the wave's arrival, each exhale its retreat.
- Notice the imagined warmth of the sun and the sound of the sea as anchors whenever attention drifts.

BENEFITS • Pairing breath with an imagined rhythmic pattern (waves) makes the anchor easier to hold onto than breath alone • The associative calm of beach imagery is broadly culturally familiar, making it accessible to most beginners • Doubles well as a pre-sleep practice due to its slow, rhythmic pacing	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
EVIDENCE NOTE Rhythmic guided imagery combined with breath pacing is a common technique in clinical relaxation training.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the imagined scene turn into an elaborate story (a memory of an actual holiday) instead of staying with the present-moment sensory focus.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Extend into a body scan while remaining in the beach scene, feeling the sand supporting each part of the body. • Regress: Focus only on the sound of the waves without building the full visual scene.
TAGS #nature #mind-reset #visualization #sleep #beginner-safe	

Mountain Meditation		MD-0014 MIND RESET Beginner	
CATEGORY	Nature Visualization	GOAL	Confidence
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Confidence, Focus, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, full breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The felt sense of stillness and stability, mirrored by an upright, grounded seated posture.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit tall, as if the spine were the peak of a mountain — stable and unmoving. 2. Imagine standing at a mountain summit, cool fresh air, wide open silence around you. 3. Notice the stillness and permanence of the mountain, unmoved regardless of weather or clouds passing. 4. Let this sense of steady, grounded stability settle into the body as you continue breathing.			
BENEFITS - The 'mountain' metaphor is widely used to build a felt sense of stability that carries beyond the practice itself - Pairs a physical posture cue (tall spine) with the mental image for a stronger anchor - Useful before situations that call for calm steadiness, such as a difficult conversation or public speaking		COACH TIPS Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.	
EVIDENCE NOTE Metaphor-based imagery that links posture to a psychological quality (stability, groundedness) is a well-established technique in mindfulness-based approaches.			
COMMON MISTAKES Slouching while trying to feel 'grounded' — the tall, stable posture is part of the practice, not incidental.		PROGRESSION / REGRESSION - Progress: Add an intention to carry the mountain's steadiness into a specific upcoming situation. - Regress: Shorten to simply sitting tall and breathing, without the extended visualization.	
TAGS #nature #mind-reset #visualization #confidence #focus #beginner-safe			

Night Sky Meditation		MD-0015 MIND RESET Beginner	
CATEGORY	Nature Visualization	GOAL	Sleep
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Sleep, Stress Relief	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, extended exhale breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The imagined vastness and stillness of a starlit sky, paired with slowing breath.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Lie down comfortably and close the eyes. 2. Imagine lying beneath a clear night sky, stars scattered overhead. 3. Let the breath slow, imagining each exhale as a star settling gently into place. 4. Rest in the vastness and quiet of the imagined sky until sleep arrives or the timer ends.			

BENEFITS • The imagery of vastness has a documented calming effect, sometimes called 'awe-based' relaxation • The slow pacing and lying position make this especially suited to pre-sleep use • Requires no counting or technique — purely restful attention	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
EVIDENCE NOTE Awe-inducing imagery, including expansive natural scenes like a night sky, has been linked in research to reduced self-focused stress and improved mood.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Using a bright screen or phone immediately before or during this practice, which undermines the sleep benefit.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Extend the practice for as long as needed until sleep arrives naturally. • Regress: Focus on just a few imagined stars rather than the whole sky.
TAGS #nature #mind-reset #sleep #visualization #evening #beginner-safe	

Positive Memory Focus		MD-0016 MIND RESET Beginner	
CATEGORY	Positive Memory	GOAL	Happiness
DURATION	7 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Happiness, Emotional Balance	BREATHING PATTERN	Natural, relaxed breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The core felt emotion of one chosen memory, not its narrative detail.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit comfortably and bring to mind one memory that genuinely makes you happy. 2. Rather than replaying the whole story, focus only on the core emotion it carries. 3. Notice where that feeling shows up in the body — warmth, lightness, a natural smile. 4. Whenever attention wanders, gently guide it back to that single feeling, not the story.			
BENEFITS • Deliberately narrowing focus to feeling rather than story prevents rumination on memory details • A genuinely simple, low-barrier entry point to positive-focus meditation • Can be practiced anywhere in under 5 minutes if time is short		COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.	
EVIDENCE NOTE Positive affect recall is linked in psychological research to short-term mood improvement and reduced stress reactivity.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Getting drawn into narrating or analysing the memory instead of resting in the feeling.		PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Layer in a second happy memory once the first feeling is well established. • Regress: Focus on a smaller, everyday positive moment if a big memory feels hard to access.	
TAGS #mind-reset #positive-memory #happiness #beginner-safe #quick			

Gratitude Circle Reset		MD-0017 MIND RESET Beginner	
CATEGORY	Gratitude	GOAL	Emotional Balance
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Emotional Balance, Happiness, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, natural breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The specific felt sense of gratitude toward each person brought to mind, one at a time.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit comfortably and bring to mind someone you're grateful for — a parent, friend, teacher, mentor, or even a pet. 2. Picture their face and silently acknowledge one specific thing they've given or taught you. 3. Let the feeling of gratitude settle for a few breaths before moving to the next person. 4. Move through 3-4 people this way, finishing with a moment of gratitude directed at yourself.			

BENEFITS - Regular gratitude practice is one of the most consistently evidenced tools for improving mood and life satisfaction - Structuring it as a sequence of specific people (rather than a vague list) deepens the emotional impact - Naturally counters the mind's negativity bias by deliberately directing attention toward what is good	COACH TIPS Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
EVIDENCE NOTE Gratitude interventions have a substantial evidence base in positive psychology research linking them to improved wellbeing and reduced depressive symptoms.	
COMMON MISTAKES Rushing through the list without pausing to actually feel gratitude for each person.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION - Progress: Extend the circle to include a more difficult relationship, finding one genuine point of gratitude. - Regress: Focus on just one person for the full session, going deeper rather than broader.
TAGS #mind-reset #gratitude #emotional-balance #beginner-safe #relationships	

Future Self Visualization		MD-0018 MIND RESET Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Goal Visualization	GOAL	Motivation
DURATION	10 min	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
SUITABLE FOR	Weight Loss, General Fitness, Motivation	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, steady breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) A specific, sensory-detailed everyday moment as the imagined future self.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit comfortably and bring to mind your healthiest, most capable future self. 2. Picture how that version of you moves, stands, and feels in the body — energised, capable, at ease. 3. Imagine a specific everyday moment as that person — waking up, exercising, or simply feeling confident. 4. Notice the emotions this brings up, and let them motivate the intention for today's actions.			
BENEFITS • Concrete, everyday imagery is a more effective motivator than abstract 'goal' thinking alone • Connecting the vision to feeling (not just appearance) builds more durable motivation • Works well as a weekly practice rather than daily, to avoid the image losing its emotional charge		COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.	
EVIDENCE NOTE Goal-directed visualization combined with implementation intentions is supported in behavioural psychology as a technique that improves follow-through on health goals.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Focusing purely on physical appearance rather than capability and feeling. • Using the practice to criticise the present self by comparison — the aim is inspiration, not judgment.		PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Pair the visualization with writing down one concrete action for today that moves toward that vision. • Regress: Focus on a single specific quality (energy, confidence) rather than a full scene.	
TAGS #mind-reset #visualization #motivation #weight-loss #goal-setting			

Workout Visualization		MD-0019 MIND RESET Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Performance Visualization	GOAL	Performance
DURATION	6 min	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
SUITABLE FOR	Strength, Muscle Gain, Athletic	BREATHING PATTERN	Rhythmic, energising breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The specific movements of today's session, rehearsed with correct form and a confident mindset.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE - Sit or stand quietly before training begins. - Picture today's workout from start to finish, seeing each exercise performed with perfect form. - Imagine the feeling of strength and control in the body during the hardest set. - Finish by picturing the satisfaction of completing the session as planned.			

BENEFITS • Pre-training mental rehearsal is linked to improved movement quality and reduced hesitation on challenging lifts • Builds a confident mindset before the physical session begins • Short enough to use as a genuine part of the warm-up routine, not a separate task	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
EVIDENCE NOTE Motor imagery rehearsal before physical training is supported in sport science literature for improving subsequent movement execution and confidence.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Visualizing a workout that is unrealistic for today's actual energy and readiness level.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Extend to visualizing the full session including a plan for a difficult moment (a hard final set). • Regress: Focus on visualizing just the first and hardest exercise of the session.
TAGS #mind-reset #visualization #performance #athletic #pre-workout	

Competition Visualization		MD-0020 MIND RESET Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Performance Visualization	GOAL	Performance
DURATION	10 min	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
SUITABLE FOR	Athletic, Performance, Confidence	BREATHING PATTERN	Building, rhythmic breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The full arc of the competition, including successfully navigating one difficult moment.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit quietly in the hours or day before competition. 2. Picture arriving at the venue, seeing the setting in as much detail as possible. 3. Mentally rehearse the competition itself, including a moment of adversity and successfully working through it. 4. Finish by visualizing the specific feeling of having competed to your full capability, regardless of the final result.			
BENEFITS • Rehearsing adversity, not just success, builds genuine resilience rather than fragile overconfidence • Widely used at elite levels of sport as a core, evidence-informed preparation tool • Anchoring success to effort and execution (not just outcome) protects confidence regardless of the result		COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.	
EVIDENCE NOTE Elite sport psychology research consistently supports imagery rehearsal, including rehearsal of setbacks, as improving competitive readiness and emotional regulation.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Only visualizing a perfect, flawless outcome, which leaves no mental preparation for real setbacks that occur. • Tying the entire visualization to winning rather than to controllable process and effort.		PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Add a second adversity scenario (a bad start, a mistake) and rehearse the recovery from each. • Regress: Focus only on the first few minutes of the competition.	
TAGS #mind-reset #visualization #athletic #confidence #competition #cricket			

Student Focus Reset		MD-0021 MIND RESET Beginner	
CATEGORY	Concentration Visualization	GOAL	Focus
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Students, Focus, Confidence	BREATHING PATTERN	Steady, even breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) A calm, capable mental image of studying and recalling information with ease.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit at the study desk, spine tall, and close the eyes. 2. Picture yourself studying calmly, understanding the material clearly as you go. 3. Extend the image into an exam scenario — reading a question calmly, recalling the answer with ease. 4. Notice the feeling of quiet confidence this creates, and carry it into the actual study session.			

BENEFITS • Rehearsing calm competence directly counters the common pattern of exam-related catastrophic thinking • Short enough to use immediately before any study block or exam • Builds a specific, positive association with the studying process itself	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
EVIDENCE NOTE Visualization paired with calming breathwork is used in educational psychology interventions to reduce test anxiety and improve perceived academic self-efficacy.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the visualization drift into worry about failing instead of picturing calm, capable performance.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Extend to visualizing a full exam from start to finish, including recovering from one hard question. • Regress: Shorten to visualizing just the first five calm minutes of the study session.
TAGS #mind-reset #students #focus #exam-prep #confidence	

Office Reset		MD-0022 MIND RESET Beginner	
CATEGORY	Desk Break	GOAL	Stress Relief
DURATION	5 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Office Worker, Stress Relief, Focus	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, settling breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The physical release of tension in the shoulders, jaw, and hands.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit at the desk, close the eyes or lower the gaze, and take one long exhale. 2. Mentally set aside the last task, picturing it being placed in a drawer for now. 3. Relax the shoulders down and away from the ears, softening the jaw and hands. 4. Take a few slow breaths, then open the eyes ready for what's next.			
BENEFITS A genuinely realistic length for use between back-to-back meetings or tasks The mental 'setting aside' image helps create psychological separation between tasks Regular micro-resets are associated with sustained afternoon focus and reduced end-of-day fatigue		COACH TIPS Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.	
EVIDENCE NOTE Brief workplace mindfulness breaks are associated in occupational research with reduced perceived stress and improved task-switching.			
COMMON MISTAKES Skipping this because it feels 'too short to matter' — brief, frequent resets are the entire design intent.		PROGRESSION / REGRESSION Progress: Pair with the Two-Minute Desk Reset Breath for a fuller reset between demanding meetings. Regress: Reduce to a single slow exhale and shoulder release if time is extremely limited.	
TAGS #mind-reset #office #desk-break #stress-relief #quick			

Music Meditation		MD-0023 MIND RESET Beginner	
CATEGORY	Sound Focus	GOAL	Relaxation
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Stress Relief, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Natural breathing, unpaced
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) One chosen element of the music (melody, rhythm, or single instrument).			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Choose one calming instrumental piece of music without lyrics. 2. Sit comfortably and close the eyes, letting the music play. 3. Rest attention on a single element of the music — the melody, a repeated rhythm, or one instrument. 4. Whenever a thought pulls attention away, gently return it to that chosen element of the sound.			

BENEFITS • Using an external, ever-changing anchor (music) is often easier for beginners than the more subtle sensation of breath • Removes the awkwardness some people feel with silent meditation • Naturally adaptable — any calming instrumental track can be used	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
EVIDENCE NOTE Music-assisted attention practices are used as an accessible entry point to meditation, particularly for people who find silent practice difficult to sustain.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the mind drift into passive listening rather than actively choosing one element to focus on. • Choosing music with lyrics, which pulls attention toward language and story instead of pure sound.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Switch the focal element (melody to rhythm) partway through for a more dynamic practice. • Regress: Simply listen without a specific focal element if the added structure feels distracting.
TAGS #mind-reset #music #relaxation #beginner-safe #sound	

Rain Meditation		MD-0024 MIND RESET Beginner	
CATEGORY	Nature Visualization	GOAL	Relaxation
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Stress Relief, Sleep	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, natural breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The imagined rhythmic sound of rainfall.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit or lie comfortably and close the eyes. 2. Imagine sitting near a window, watching gentle rain fall outside. 3. Picture the rhythm of the raindrops, and the distant, soft rumble of far-off thunder. 4. Let the imagined sound of the rain become a steady backdrop for slow, calm breathing.			
BENEFITS • Rhythmic natural sounds, even imagined, are a well-known and broadly effective relaxation cue • The steady 'white noise' quality of rain imagery makes it easier to sustain attention than more complex scenes		COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.	
EVIDENCE NOTE Rhythmic ambient sound, including rainfall, is commonly used in clinical and consumer relaxation tools due to its consistent calming association.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Letting the scene shift into worry about actual weather or travel plans instead of staying with the calming imagery.		PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Extend into a full pre-sleep practice by continuing the imagery until sleep arrives. • Regress: Focus on just the sound without building the full visual window scene.	
TAGS #mind-reset #nature #relaxation #sleep #beginner-safe			

Campfire Meditation MD-0025 MIND RESET Beginner			
CATEGORY	Nature Visualization	GOAL	Relaxation
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Stress Relief, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow, natural breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The imagined warmth and crackling sound of a campfire.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit comfortably and close the eyes. 2. Imagine sitting beside a warm, gently crackling campfire. 3. Notice the imagined warmth on the skin and the sound of the wood crackling. 4. Let attention rest on the fire's imagined movement, returning to it whenever thoughts pull away.			

BENEFITS • Fire-gazing is a naturally absorbing, ancient form of attention rest that many people find easier than silent stillness • The combined warmth and sound imagery gives attention two anchors to return to	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
EVIDENCE NOTE Naturalistic, absorbing visual and auditory imagery is used in relaxation training as an accessible substitute for real-world restorative environments.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Trying to conjure a perfectly vivid image — a general impression of warmth and sound is sufficient.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Add the imagined scent of woodsmoke for a fuller sensory scene. • Regress: Focus on just the sound of crackling wood.
TAGS #mind-reset #nature #relaxation #evening #beginner-safe	

Walking Meditation		MD-0026 MIND RESET Beginner	
CATEGORY	Present-Moment Focus	GOAL	Stress Relief
DURATION	10 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Stress Relief, General Fitness, Recovery	BREATHING PATTERN	Natural breathing, paced to steps
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The physical sensation of each footstep — lifting, moving, landing.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Choose a quiet stretch of path, indoors or outdoors, at least 5-10 steps long. 2. Walk slowly, bringing full attention to the sensation of each foot lifting, moving, and landing. 3. When you reach the end of the path, pause, turn, and continue, keeping the same slow attention. 4. Whenever the mind wanders to a plan or worry, gently return attention to the feeling of the feet.			
BENEFITS • Combines gentle physical movement with attention training, useful for people who find seated stillness difficult • A practical option for a study or work break that also involves standing up and moving • Can be practiced almost anywhere with a few metres of clear space		COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.	
EVIDENCE NOTE Walking meditation is a traditional mindfulness practice with modern evidence supporting its use as an accessible alternative to seated meditation for improving present-moment attention.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Walking at a normal, fast pace instead of deliberately slowing down. • Using the walk to plan the day instead of attending to the sensation of walking.		PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Extend the path length and duration for a longer walking practice. • Regress: Practice in place, lifting the feet in small steps if space is very limited.	
TAGS #mind-reset #walking #stress-relief #beginner-safe #office #outdoor			

Tea Meditation		MD-0027 MIND RESET Beginner	
CATEGORY	Present-Moment Focus	GOAL	Mindfulness
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Stress Relief, General Fitness	BREATHING PATTERN	Natural, unpaced breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The taste, warmth, and physical sensation of drinking the beverage.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Prepare a cup of tea (or any warm beverage) and sit down without other distractions. 2. Before drinking, notice the warmth of the cup in the hands and the rising steam. 3. Take the first sip slowly, noticing the temperature, taste, and sensation fully. 4. Continue drinking slowly, returning attention to taste and warmth each time it drifts.			

BENEFITS • An easy entry point to mindfulness for people who find abstract meditation instructions difficult • Turns an already-existing daily habit into a genuine practice, requiring no extra time • Builds the general skill of single-tasking, which transfers to other daily activities	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
EVIDENCE NOTE Everyday-activity mindfulness (eating or drinking meditations) is a well-established technique for building present-moment awareness in a low-barrier, practical way.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Drinking while scrolling a phone or watching a screen — the whole point is undivided attention.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Extend the practice to the whole process of preparing the tea, not just drinking it. • Regress: Practice for just the first sip if a full cup of undivided attention feels difficult at first.
TAGS #mind-reset #mindfulness #beginner-safe #daily-habit #office	

Desk Neck and Shoulder Reset		MD-0028 MIND RESET Beginner	
CATEGORY	Somatic Mind Reset	GOAL	Office Relaxation
DURATION	5 min	DIFFICULTY	Beginner
SUITABLE FOR	Office Worker, Stress Relief	BREATHING PATTERN	Slow breathing paired with gentle movement
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) Physical sensation of tension release in the neck and shoulders.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit tall and close the eyes or lower the gaze. 2. Slowly roll the shoulders back and down three times, breathing out on each roll. 3. Gently tilt the head side to side, noticing any tension without forcing a stretch. 4. Finish with three slow breaths, mentally releasing the accumulated tension of the last work block.			
BENEFITS • Combines light physical movement with a brief mental reset, addressing both the mental and postural cost of desk work • Short enough for genuine, repeated daily use between meetings		COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.	
EVIDENCE NOTE Combining brief movement with mindful attention is supported in occupational health research as an effective, low-barrier intervention for desk-based stress and musculoskeletal tension.			
COMMON MISTAKES • Rushing through the shoulder rolls mechanically instead of pairing them with attention and breath.		PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Add the Band Pull-Apart exercise immediately after for a fuller physical-mental reset. • Regress: Perform seated with eyes open if closing them is not practical in the workplace.	
TAGS #mind-reset #office #somatic #quick #desk-worker			

Muscle Gain Focus: Performance and Recovery		MD-0029 MIND RESET Intermediate	
CATEGORY	Goal Visualization	GOAL	Motivation
DURATION	8 min	DIFFICULTY	Intermediate
SUITABLE FOR	Muscle Gain, Performance, Recovery	BREATHING PATTERN	Steady, controlled breathing
MENTAL FOCUS (THE ANCHOR) The felt sense of strong effort paired with the image of adequate recovery supporting it.			
STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE 1. Sit comfortably and bring to mind the specific training goal for this phase — strength or size. 2. Visualize a recent session where effort and form both felt strong, recalling that feeling in the body. 3. Extend the image forward to recovery — adequate sleep, food, and rest supporting that effort. 4. Let a felt sense of patient, consistent capability settle before returning to daily activity.			

BENEFITS • Explicitly linking training visualization to recovery habits reinforces that gains happen outside the gym as much as in it • Reduces the common trap of visualizing only the workout while neglecting sleep, food, and rest as part of the process	COACH TIPS • Thoughts will keep arising throughout this practice — that is normal and expected, not a sign of failure. The skill is not stopping thought, but noticing when attention has drifted, accepting the thought without judgment, letting it pass, and gently returning to the chosen focus. Repeating this return, again and again, is the practice itself.
EVIDENCE NOTE Goal visualization that includes the full behaviour chain (effort plus recovery) is more strongly associated with sustained adherence than visualization of the outcome alone.	
COMMON MISTAKES • Visualizing only the physique outcome without the process of training and recovering that gets there.	PROGRESSION / REGRESSION • Progress: Pair with a written note of tonight's specific recovery action (sleep time, a meal, a stretch). • Regress: Focus only on the training-effort portion of the visualization.
TAGS #mind-reset #visualization #muscle-gain #recovery #motivation	